

THE SUMNER PRESS · SUMNER, ILLINOIS

Roscoe's Journal

The collected columns of Roscoe D. Cunningham
1923–2020

372 columns · July 2013 – December 2020

Transcribed verbatim from the original page scans

Gathered by his grandson · 2026

"To be remembered, write."

Roscoe's Journal ran at the top right of page 3 of The Sumner Press, most weeks, for over thirty years. This volume collects every column in the paper's complete online run — 379 weekly editions, July 4, 2013 through December 31, 2020 — read straight from the scanned pages. The other seven editions carried no column, and where the paper itself noted an absence, a reprint, or an erratum, that note is preserved in the column's heading here.

Everything else is his, exactly as he typed it on Tuesday nights: the spelling, the "xxx" section breaks, the audacity. Columns after his death on November 28, 2020 are the paper's own memorial reprints, marked as such — including his earliest recovered piece, dated December 28, 1989.

2013

25 COLUMNS

July 4, 2013

Lawrence County xenophobia against revealing cell phone number has worsened. Five years ago, Press offered to create free cell phone number book. If each reader would send in his number, we would alphabetize and publish. Unanimously rejected.

xxx

Legislature could cure this inconvenience instantly: tie disclosure to driver's license. If every other necessity of life, including child support, can be thus regulated, why not phone number?

xxx

Those who lament living in a small Southern Illinois town, "no where to go; nothing to do", should listen to WGN-TV @ 9. Rarely does it report fewer than two murders. Our Chamber should advertise in the Tribune, "Move to Lawrence County, Violent Crime Almost Non-Existent."

xxx

Unless there are fewer medicine ads on TV, we shall all become hypochondriacs.

xxx

Press needs to censure its star cartoonist, Art Dale. He should have drawn for our readers what Evansville Courier-Press had for its: bedraggled citizen being berated by donkey and an elephant. His crime: told the public that their government was spying on them.

xxx

As noted elsewhere in this week's Press, it is no longer prudent to hail Edward Snowden as a hero. "Facing fearful odds" that he would spend a lifetime in jail, he rejected Russian President Putin's condition for safe refuge in Russia: "that he cease revealing secrets that might embarrass our American friends". Said Snowden, "I can't be intimidated."

xxx

Decline in number of marriages in the USA during past 50 years, more than one-third, represents a serious rejection of traditional moral values. Some cynic has noted that number of divorces has likewise decreased.

xxx

Public apathy toward religion would be cured by a more vigorous church. Removal of tax exemption might cause members to work more effectively for what they believe, and thereby extend the church's influence farther beyond the walls.

xxx

Recognizing our mortality, my brother and I would give the Press to a literary minded citizen who worked with us five years getting out this newspaper, and who pledged to continue its operation an additional five years. Rejections have been received from Johnson, Hamilton & Holmes. Latter yet cogitating. She is uniquely suited to call our hand, has two high school daughters who could run a school page that would make the Press sparkle.

xxx

Of sparkle, we have been dismayed. Not a single person has volunteered the opinion that the red, white & blue rows of LED lights across the railing of the portico at Hotel Lawrence is a thing of beauty. They are solar powered. The taste of too many is only in the mouth.

xxx

July 11, 2013

The British and too many Americans have gone gaga over the imminent birth of the heir/heiress to the British throne.

xxx

Press predicted some weeks ago that Kate & William's first born would be a girl. Had sonogram indicated otherwise, would have been trumpeted across the world. Subtle evidence of male superiority in royal thinking, though the Order of Succession, for more than 1,000 years, has been changed to first born without regard to gender.

xxx

History records that England's time of greatest military might, in comparison with other nations, was during the reigns of Elizabeth I, Victoria, and Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher, a

commoner. Perhaps this inspired Order of Succession change?

xxx

Crowned royalty fights a rear guard action against abandonment. Only the British and Japanese thrones appear secure worldwide.

xxx

Even the Limeys must have been shaken by the abdication of Netherlands' Beatrix and Belgian's Albert II in favor of their middle-aged offspring. Press hopes Queen Elizabeth II ignores that concession of royal mortality to excel Queen Victoria's record of longest reign — three years to go.

xxx

Other side of the coin is that Elizabeth's continued occupancy of the throne deprives our favorite, Camilla, of a little while in the spotlight. She has had a rough battle for acceptance by the British snobs after the beloved Diana's drunken departure.

xxx

God save the Queen! More importantly, God save the USA!

xxx

Of Almighty connection to national well-being, we think the decline of the USA commenced with the Supreme Court decision, 1947, outlawing school prayer. Now would seem an appropriate time in history for the Court to reexamine that decision, even correct its error.

xxx

Assuming an intelligent people, massive peaceful public protests may be a practical way to change democratically elected leaders who have proven hostile to the nation's future, as in Egypt.

xxx

Problem is to bring the masses down to normalcy after the upheaval.

xxx

President Obama and First Lady Michelle must have been startled, Tuesday, in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania, to discover that the Bushes, yet of bad odor in this country, are more popular in Africa than the Obamas.

xxx

Sic transit gloria mundi.

July 18, 2013

Audi alteram partem.

xxx

Ameren's advice sheet with this month's statement contains stern command, "Utility poles are not bulletin boards." Our question is: "Why not?".

xxx

Those poles are no more an eyesore with a candidate's picture or a public sale notice, or directional sign, than naked. Environmentally, their splendid location for public observance should dictate their full use.

xxx

'Tis nonsense to talk about workers' gaffs, dangerous falls triggered by a nail or staple in the wood. "Red" Dorney was the last lineman that we saw actually climbing a pole, with or without gaffs. The lift truck rendered that equipment obsolete, totally ignored.

xxx

We invite all utility companies to make their poles available for the public good, and edification, so long as invitee's use does not interfere with the host's business.

xxx

It is nonsense for the disgruntled in the Zimmerman-Martin tragedy to seek hate crime

prosecution of the defendant whom the jury turned loose, after the Sanford Police reached similar conclusion. While Martin's death was regrettable, it is a pollution of national values to paint that 17 year old drug addict, school drop-out, as a role model for better citizenship so desperately needed in this country.

xxx

Every dying community desperately seeks some distinguishing tradition for its economic resurrection. Which of the villages of Lawrence County would be best suited for an annual bull run, shamelessly patterned on Pamplona, Spain?

xxx

Some of the animals they bring to the Palestine Labor Day Rodeo appear mean enough to bring authenticity to our suggested event. Nor would we favor protective cover against the sharpness of the horns.

xxx

On front page of this week's Press is a plea to former Governor Edgar to again assist in County Lawrence's rejuvenation. Is the Press the only one who gives a dam about the unutilized potential of George Field and the Embarras River for our county's future?

xxx

When an employer goes broke and summarily terminates the business, does it make any sense, in law or morality, that the employees demand severance pay? Almost without exception the terminated employee mumbles that he is entitled.

xxx

We fear that Khrushchev was right, but a generation too early, "Your great-grandchildren will live under Socialism."

xxx

The former Senator from Texas was accurate, we have become a nation of wimps.

xxx

Alas, back to school ads no longer seem incongruous. Registration starts in two weeks.

July 25, 2013

Determined rescue workers pulled Nathan Woessner, 6, Galva, IL, from beneath 11 feet of sand, Indiana Shores, where he had been trapped four hours. How fortunate those bulldozer operators did not know that experts believe brain damage serious when oxygen shut off more than five minutes. They might have lessened their urgency to recover the body. Miraculously, Nathan's doctors believe he will make a total recovery.

xxx

One must never abandon hope, regardless of how great the odds.

xxx

Study reveals that average baseball game has only 18 minutes of action. It is a terrible waste of lives of the addicted fans. Government policy should be to discourage baseball, except as a physical exercise for the participants.

xxx

President Obama's candid comments on the George Zimmerman jury acquittal for murder of Trayvon Martin was a courageous gamble for history's accolade for improving American society's race tolerance.

xxx

George Zimmerman's assistance in rescuing motorists from wrecked automobile in flood waters last weekend should be helpful to blunt the silly protests of his acquittal.

xxx

Let us hear no more about the efficiency of government in Indiana. Bureau of Motor Vehicles requires 7-10 days to process FAX inquiries, according to 1-888-692-6841. Every Hoosier should be ashamed of such ineptitude.

xxx

We wonder why it is so difficult to lure business-industry to our county. A savvy lady who successfully operated a lumber yard pointed out to us that the unemployment insurance and Workmen's Compensation costs are 7% less across the Wabash. Union pressure forces the Legislature to continue that penalty on job growth in Illinois.

xxx

Detroit's bankruptcy with reduction of pensions for the retired should be adequate warning for public employee unions that all society is in the same boat; one segment must not profiteer at the expense of another.

xxx

Internet said it best, "Royal birth – worldwide obsession media hype?"

xxx

The omnipotent media which controls what mankind thinks will refocus the spotlight tomorrow. The world will be required to wait 20 years to know whether the birth worthwhile, or a royal dud.

xxx

If Americans didn't have Hollywood, too many would need some form of royalty, as vicarious elegance.

xxx

Sixty-nine years ago, this young soldier fell off end of overcrowded streetcar in Glasgow, Scotland in the wee hours. A dozen of the hold-ons let go and walked together a couple of miles to the hotel. One native loudly condemned the royal family every step of the way. His compatriots seemed to agree. Within five years, the formidable H. G. Wells released a scathing condemnation of British royalty. Amazing that their popularity has grown.

August 1, 2013

Have Americans regained the nerve to execute criminals as vicious as mad dogs? An animal named Castro imprisoned three girls for ten years, Cleveland. He was sentenced this week to serve

remainder of his life in prison.

xxx

Another animal, Whitey Bulger, 82, led Boston's Hill Gang; murdered more than a dozen humans; hid from the law for 16 years; is being tried in the Federal District court, Boston, much of July. Testimony graphic that he strangled simple young women lured by baubles whom he feared knew of his deals with crooked cops.

xxx

We think society would be safer, even more wholesome, if these two were executed. Do readers agree? Would they dare to explain in writing such agreement or lack thereof?

xxx

The news media emphasizes murder, violence, political protests, unemployment, racial discrimination, wild fires, hurricanes, tornados, marital discord, and threats of war.

xxx

It would be a happier world, particularly in the USA, if the news media encouraged everyone to daily proclaim, "I'm happy to be alive, and thank whatever gods there be."

xxx

Sunday's Courier-Press emphasized a letter to the editor, "Daniels intolerance disqualifies him to lead university." Former Governor of Indiana, Mitch Daniels, is President of Purdue University.

xxx

Letter writer is a professor of history at New University, NYC. He claimed that Governor Daniels, lobbied to ban a history book by Howard Zinn from the school curriculum. Governor described the book as anti-American.

xxx

The C-P was irresponsible in its headline. Majority of the public read only headlines. If Daniels

had not successfully lobbied against the book, he would have failed Indiana school children. His reputation is otherwise. Had he been an inch taller, he would have been President of the USA, 2016.

xxx

Absolute freedom of speech/press, sounds better than it plays. Alas, our Supreme Court holds that most speech, even pornography, is protected by the Constitution. Sooner rather than later, government must reexamine that question, particularly the Internet. On-line present content includes material that even the late Justice Hugo Black would bar. Black wrote that constitutional protection so broad one could falsely yell "fire" in a crowded theater.

xxx

Do our readers agree with the Press that freedom of speech is not a guaranteed Constitutional absolute, that society should limit freedom to "responsible speech"?

xxx

Theory of global warming has strong ally in melting of the polar ice caps. But the last two weeks of July suggest a pause in the process. Delightful weather.

xxx

Weiner, the disgraced, exhibitionist ex-congressman is being marginalized in NYC; mayoralty election. The front runner now is a lesbian named Quinn. Public morality has almost vanished in this nation.

xxx

Pope Francis I is down sizing the authority of the papacy disastrously. On flight back to Rome from wildly popular Rio visit, he remarked, "Who am I to judge?" on question of where the Church stood on gays. You would expect such a forgiving response from a successful politician, but not one ordained by God to be the final arbiter on earth as to moral values.

August 8, 2013

From the enviable imagination of David Finley, "Might Edward Snowden be a double agent, inserted into the heart of the Russian spy system?" There is something reassuring in the thought

that our leadership could be so devious in protecting America.

xxx

Without condoning Snowden's violation of his oath not to disclose, one must admire the change of NSA policy which he caused. It is irresponsible exercise of power to stamp "top secret" on trivial matters.

xxx

As Thoreau observed, "Most of mankind lives and dies in quiet desperation." Not Snowden; his life made a difference.

xxx

Major Hasan's court martial for murdering 13 fellow soldiers at Fort Hood, 2009, may commence within the month. The thinking public has already concluded that the military justice system is as inadequate as the civil courts. It is an insult to the victims that Hasan yet lives, though paralyzed in apprehension.

xxx

Suit was filed by the victims to secure Purple Heart benefits. These were denied by the Army's nitpicking lawyers who refused to accept Hasan's acts as "terrorist."

xxx

Seemed too optimistic, our State Department sent Assistant Director Burns alone to Cairo to defuse threatened civil war between the Army and Islamist Brotherhood who seek restoration of President Mursi. Burns will be heeded because even the radicals realize that Egypt is a basket case.

xxx

While most Americans grumble at the \$2 billion military aid annually from the USA, should be noted that Kuwait, Saudi Arabia and the Emirates contribute \$20 billion annually to keep Egypt afloat. Is foreign aid charity, or pay-off to avoid civil unrest?

xxx

What would our Treasury do if the Chinese cashed in their \$1.3 trillion American bond, and the Japanese their \$1.1 trillion? If holders of other \$5.5 trillion bonds followed suit, USA would be bankrupt.

xxx

Economics 102 is surely among most fascinating studies for underclassmen at the U of I. We wonder if the students are permitted to discuss Bernie Madoff's observation, "Government finance is a large Ponzi scheme."

xxx

Recent anthropology study should be anathema to romanticists. Their conclusion was that monogamy originated to keep other males from killing the young.

xxx

Religion prevents society from disintegrating, from living together in crowds, with constant changing alignments, like reported tribes in the South Pacific.

xxx

That ancient slander against Indiana citizens would have wider application, "Who is your father?"

August 15, 2013

Helen of Troy had the face that launched 1,000 ships. President Obama is no Helen. Avenging whatever slight he received from Russian President Putin should not be a casus belli. That insanity is too lethal to be entered into lightly.

xxx

We thought President Obama's cancellation of a meeting with Putin was childish, unworthy of responsible leadership.

xxx

If President Obama is sincere in his post-Snowden pledge of transparency for acts of the National Security Administration, he should abandon the super-secret \$1 billion boondoggle in the Utah desert and locate the super-bloggers in the abandoned Lawrenceville High School buildings.

xxx

Dominant Proctor & Gamble may be the most confident of its record keeping of all publicly traded stocks. Client missed couple of dividend checks, un-cashed. After a year, P & G sent note, without any inquiry, "You have failed to cash dividend checks. Enclosed are replacement checks."

xxx

Most companies require the negligent to jump through hoops non-stop for a week, furnish refunding bond, promise never again to be so negligent. We recommend P & G.

xxx

Video games are more of a menace to proper development of young minds, including moral values, than most vices. Permitting use of same is parental neglect, games should be banned.

xxx

We had feared that 16 year old Hannah Anderson was involved in the death of her mother and younger brother. We were delighted by San Diego Sheriff's exoneration of Hannah.

xxx

The police should be congratulated for fatally shooting James DiMaggio after that murderer-kidnapper refused to surrender and fired upon the officers. Trial would have been long, expensive and unnecessary.

xxx

Tragic that so many police do not recognize how damaging a taser strike can be. Surprising that John Howard Society, ACLU and comparable defenders of liberty against authority run amok have not mounted a campaign to forbid police carrying tasers.

xxx

We should each hope that Attorney General Eric Holder's statement that too many are going to prison too long for too little will sweep away the judicial guidelines which reduce the sentencing judge to a clerk reading what the punishment must be.

xxx

Judges are paid handsomely to dispense justice; to force them to impose a certain minimum sentence takes away discretion, the exercise of the judgment and wisdom that was bought and paid for.

xxx

Of course, reform most needed for the judiciary is a live, kicking opponent for every would-be judge after each term, not to exceed six years. If the voting public has not the sense to select the right candidate for judge, by what imaginable logic have they the ability to select the right sheriff, or any other public officer?

xxx

Lawrence County should appreciate Charles Gillespie and his tireless effort to make Route 50 Four Lanes Wide. We believe that he is making progress, though the indifference of our representatives and senators, state and Federal, couldn't be greater.

August 22, 2013

Jesse Jackson, Jr. stole \$750,000 from his campaign fund; was sentenced to 30 months in prison. Governor Rod Blagojevich took bids on Senate seat appointment (Jackson was believed to be the high bidder), Blagojevich was sentenced to 14 years! Justice is blind.

xxx

American foreign policy on Egypt is confused, incompetent. U. S. purports to support whichever group is in power. President Obama and then Secretary of State Hillary Clinton dumped President Mubarak, a proven ally of the U.S., the moment he was deposed. When the Egyptian army responded to the overwhelming public demand that Egypt not become an Islamic state, as sought by Morsi, and arrested him, Obama & Company tried to side with both.

xxx

The administration sent Senators McCain & Graham to warn the Egyptian army that it must be nice to Morsi, or our foreign aid would be terminated.

xxx

The generals replied that the Saudis had outbid the U. S. for Egyptian affection, 20 – 1.

xxx

A more rational U.S. foreign policy toward Egypt would be to recognize the Muslim Brotherhood is our unchangeable foe, as demonstrated by their public execution of pro-American President Anwar Sadat 35 years ago.

xxx

Our foreign policy should be to stand with the Egyptian army as long as they reflect the Egyptian public's hopes and dreams. The specter of civil war should not deter us. If a few thousand religious fanatics insist on martyrdom, so be it.

xxx

Senators McCain & Graham should return to the ranks. Obama & Company used them for political advantage.

xxx

Not to knock our brand of "democracy," but it is overrated. The average American has no power to change the direction his government steers the ship of state.

xxx

We long for the day that government decisions are made by all the people, as the Greeks envisioned. Electronic voting makes that goal within reach. Problem is to find and install tabulators to accurately report the national vote on each issue submitted to the public will.

xxx

Annual increase of lawyers vs doctors in Illinois has become scandalous. Press suggestion deserves to be heard: tear up license of every lawyer under 30 years of age, send him or her to medical school at government expense.

xxx

Boating on the Wabash and Embarras rivers has run dry. Why must farmers' unfounded drainage fears hold hostage God-given recreational opportunity for so many?

xxx

Would Chicago homicides, already above 250 in 2013, be reduced if TV cleansed of all homicide-filled plays? Freedom of speech should yield to freedom to live.

xxx

Franklin Roosevelt could be reelected from a wheel chair, nobody knew. Mark Kirk can't.

August 29, 2013

Every parent should note London University 's study which found that students learned faster if tucked into bed earlier, at same hour each evening. Our neighbors already follow that formula with their twins who excel.

xxx

President Obama has lost his international credibility big time with his dramatic declaration that poisonous gas was the red line that Syrian President Assad must not cross in that country's civil war. The evidence that the Syrian army did gas the insurgents is persuasive.

xxx

Notwithstanding, the Russian government blocks United Nations' joint action as would legitimize international intervention.

xxx

American public opinion is violently opposed to U.S. Army boots on the ground, unilaterally. Repeated television pictures of the dead children would appear a calculated effort to change

American opinion. Blessed be the peacemakers.

xxx

Press fears American involvement in Syrian civil war will be worse than Iraq . Must be avoided regardless of how much face lost.

xxx

Hannah Montana has metamorphosed from a charming child to a porno queen. Very sad. The butterfly changes in the opposite direction, from worm to beauty.

xxx

Another Hannah whose conduct has become suspect is Anderson . The hussy that she sent to the deceased murderer, DiMaggio, prior to his "abducting" her, must be revealed. Otherwise, the suspicion will grow that she incited DiMaggio to the murder of her mother and brother.

xxx

Nor is it any defense to say that she's a teenager. Responsible behavior must begin much younger.

xxx

Successful modern farmers are erudite. They know that 32,000 corn plants can grow on one acre, twice the average 20 years ago, and that Monsanto is the hope of adequately feeding the world population.

xxx

These high tech farmers also know that China is a major market for agricultural products and that they have this strange hang-up against genetically modified grains, though the experts are unanimous that GMO is the way to go.

xxx

We are impressed by modern leaders of local farmers growing crops without the chemicals which remove the weeds so efficiently. They will resist progress of weed killing chemicals a very few

seasons.

xxx

Lawrenceville's struggling downtown section should have a natural food store. Such have become symbols of affluent communities, though we suspect they are hokum.

xxx

If President Obama fails to pardon "Chelsea" Manning before Christmas, Press will launch petitions demanding her release. That creep "Bradley" Manning had no right to use her person to commit wikileaks. The 35 year sentence from the court martial seemed excessive. There is no reasonable basis for forcing her to serve time for the crime which he committed.

September 5, 2013

Labor Day may be the worst fraud of all holidays. It is a contrived excuse for being paid for doing nothing. If it is to continue until China overtakes the USA as a producer of useful goods, our government in fairness should rechristen to "Labor-Management Day."

xxx

The Lawrenceville High School Marching Band could be accurately described as the "Fearless Few." Disgraceful that parents of high school age children who participated in the band in Junior High allow them to drop out when they are most needed. Press intends to create a fund to financially reward bandsmen who have the courage and judgment to persevere.

xxx

We will be cheering for all the bands in the Sumner Fall Festival Parade, including Kylindi Bagpipes who have served notice that they might be deterred by the predicted modest 90° temperature.

xxx

Discouraging percentage of citizens over 50 find the smallest of building repair jobs "too much to undertake." This community desperately needs a rebirth of the can-do spirit. Together we can disprove the Texas Senator who accurately diagnosed America , a year ago, as "a nation of wimps"

xxx

Jack & Angela Houser, the resourceful publishers of Disclosure, are taken more seriously through their website and their network of skilled gossip reporters. "Imitation is the sheerest form of flattery." All newspapers may need to follow their lead, to survive.

xxx

Not in criticism, but in candor, their premise coincides with the French author, "Les hommes ne sont pas bon." Men are not good.

xxx

The alternative to the philosophical change we do not wish to take is to reform public entertainment tastes. We will welcome reader guidance.

xxx

High school class reunions in County Lawrence will be in full swing during the next few weeks. Let's each act as a recruiter to lure worthwhile citizens back to the land of their childhood. Needed community growth can be made to happen.

xxx

Our pitch may be too gruesome for the taste of some. We find it gets attention to mention that big city nightly telecasts, like Chicago , report at least one homicide each evening, numerous robberies and mayhem. Our community rarely suffers such human frailties.

September 12, 2013

Lawrence County 's downtrodden need more compassion in the Courthouse – from the Judiciary, Prosecution and the Police, to be specific. We lose statewide respect for imprisoning a higher percentage of our population than other counties; gains us nothing.

xxx

Prosecution for cannabis should be suspended while Congress debates its legalization.

xxx

Meth and other illegal drug users are automatically punished by loss of teeth, mind, and other physical problems. Why pile on to their misery?

xxx

Prosecution of the addicted has become a cottage industry, revered by the number of jobs it creates. Surely there is a higher and better use of workers' lives.

xxx

Ironic that those who feel need for boost of illegal drugs are prosecuted while the clever profit from their manufacture and sale of "energy drinks," whose long term heart damage is safely predicted.

xxx

It may not have raised mountains of money for downtown revitalization, but Jan Loeb lit up the town with her Saturday night party. She and family are community assets.

xxx

Marvelous how public opinion confronted President Obama on his harebrained scheme to bomb Syria . Insulting that the administration concluded that it could change public opinion by a media blast on the horrors of war.

xxx

But where were these guardians of liberty when Bush, Cheney, et al, decided to generate Iraqi war fever?

xxx

Amusing that the Tea Party is grooming Ron Paul II to run for President. His mini-filibuster proves that he is no Huey Long, rabble rouser who stirred the nation in the early 30's before he met Dr. Weiss in the basement of the Louisiana Capitol.

xxx

While Libertarians have many fine concepts, they become dangerous when they advocate return to the gold standard. All economists agree that such would cause a fatal depression.

xxx

All politicians must have admired presidential hopeful Hillary Clinton's fence straddling. She endorsed both Obama's bombing approach and Russian President Putin's effort to store the gas to halt the missiles.

xxx

Lawrence County must show some dexterity in the gubernatorial primaries, March 18 – Quinn vs Daley and Dillard vs Brady vs Rutherford vs Rauner.

xxx

The potent AFSCME Local 3600 could persuade Governor Quinn to move for work on four lanes for Route 50 in the interim.

September 19, 2013

When the super liner Costa Concordia ran aground January, 2012, Giglio, many Americans, focused on performance, sniffed, "incompetence." Italian engineers, apparently without American technical help, have performed a mechanical miracle. They wrested the 115,000 ton monster from the rocks and righted it from 25° slant. Leonardo Da Vinci would be proud.

xxx

We live in a world of make believe. Many assumed when Ballard located the Titanic at the bottom of the ocean off Newfoundland that it would be towed to New York as a tourist attraction, to walk on the deck @ \$10/each. It was so frail that it crumbled with every nudge. None assumes that the Costa Concordia will sail again, too twisted.

xxx

But why right the Concordia and tow it in the spring to a salvage yard? It would be a natural tourist magnet left where an incompetent captain parked it. The answer is that no one would buy tickets for a cruise on a boat that wrecked, jeopardizing 4,200 people and killing 32.

xxx

We assume that the salvage value of the ship was an important factor. Doc's Recycling, Sumner, would pay \$216/ton, but believed it would be necessary to bring in Dumes, Vincennes , to assist in a job that large.

xxx

Just as it appeared that President Obama would be red-shirted and required to sit on the bench for three years, for his remark forbidding Assad to cross a red line, the Russians threw Obama an escape rope.

xxx

He instantly claimed that Syria would never have agreed to surrender its chemical weapons without the visible threat of American bombardment.

xxx

Matters not who gets the credit. The world was saved from an unnecessary war.

xxx

Illinois Republicans were too quick to believe that Daley would defeat Governor Quinn in the March 18 primary. The AFSCME and the blacks of Chicago will prove too much for the Irish traditional Democrats. But the general election, November, 2014, looks promising.

xxx

Strength of the endorsement of Kirk Dillard's candidacy by former governors Edgar and Thompson may narrow the field for the Republican primary.

xxx

We had hoped that Mayor Wagner's first decree would ban Fall Festival clutter from Courthouse Square . That confusion lost defendability when First Christian Church discontinued its large tent on the Northeast corner to fill the public need. A dozen hot dog stands are now in place.

xxx

Clamoring children will importune financially pressed parents for many overpriced carnival rides.

xxx

See you at the Fall Festival.

September 26, 2013

The carnival is gone. Tireless workers restored Courthouse Square by church time.

xxx

Not long ago, in a land not far away, foreign substance made the drinking water unsafe. Sale of bottled water skyrocketed. The community stricken spent millions constructing state-of-the-art water treatment plant. State officials certified the purity of its water. Sale of bottled water continues at record level. Why?

xxx

Can a classic house, restored to mint condition, lure worthwhile retirees from those born and educated in Lawrence County who moved away for employment, or foreigners who seek the security of living in a cosmopolitan community progressive enough to have schools, hospital, churches and social organizations equal to those of the big city, but without violence and constant threat to life?

xxx

If you know those who fit above home-seeking specifications, send them a picture of 707 State Street , Lawrenceville.

xxx

Effective treatment of mental health in the USA is yet in its infancy, after 100 years. The Washington , D.C. Naval Yard shooter had been within police scrutiny at least four times. Society must be protected from those being followed by imaginary enemies with microwave weapons if there is a hint of violence.

XXX

If national Republican leadership, particularly congressional, does not quit babbling about shutting down government, the Press will seek to revive the Whigs, Federalists, the Know Nothings, or other political party from the past. These sly Democrats merely whisper, "Would stop Social Security," and the proposed shut-down is as popular as typhoid fever.

XXX

Congressman Shimkus, the nation doesn't need a debt ceiling. Those who purchase government bonds, particularly the Chinese, will tell us when the limit is reached. Let the good times roll.

XXX

Shame on those, of increasing number, who proclaim stock market collapse imminent. The need is for a national acceptance of Emile Coue's famous line, "Every day in every way things are getting better and better."

XXX

This state of well-being would come true if the Muslims would quit shooting the non-Muslims as their ticket to meet Allah. Their performance in the Nairobi shopping mall was disgraceful.

XXX

Now that their threatened bombardment of Damascus has been cancelled, Syrian President Assad should grant shore leave to the American sailors cluttered in the eastern Mediterranean . It would be a symbol of peace, and hope for mankind, for them to walk as invited guests in one of the cradles of civilization.

XXX

Fall is here. 'Tis the finest season of the year.

October 3, 2013

Eight years ago we suggested to the lady veterinarian proudly keeping watch over prized panda bear in the National Zoo that shortage of those delicate animals could be alleviated by painting

deep white colours on the black bears which bear a strong physical resemblance. She was horror stricken. Said pandas had an extra toe.

xxx

Judy White, Lukin, suggested that anyone wishing to see white belted animals was welcome to inspect their prize cows. Recently Internet reports that painting other animals to look like pandas has become widespread in their native China. Are we vindicated?

xxx

Next six nights are crucial. Folk lore is that if there are no killing frosts by October 10, that sad event will not happen until after October 20.

xxx

Retirement party of Circuit Judge Joe Harrison, Fairfield, November 22. Judge Harrison has served with distinction for 20 years. Many Illinois judges choose to retire when eligible for generous benefits after 20 years through their reelection by the retention ballot is pro forma. The local economy is boosted by their replacement's salary. Crawford County has perfected early judicial retirement as a cottage industry. We can't remember when that county didn't have at least two retired judges residing therein. Perhaps that is why it is more prosperous than Lawrence.

xxx

Press wishes Judge Joe Harrison well.

xxx

We simply must recruit more young to attend Lawrenceville High School. We are more impressed with the new building each time we occasion to be there, but there is simply too much space for 389 students. We do wish that the faux marble columns in the entry were genuine. The problem in Red Hill High School's similar. It is the duty of every proud citizen of Lawrence County to urge solvent families living elsewhere to move to Lawrence.

xxx

Can Bi-State Authority point to any effective effort it has made within past 10 years to lure any

employer to its grand airport? We can't find where it advertises "duty free", that legal status should be a recruitment attraction. Nor does the Illinois quarterly magazine published by the Department of Aeronautic ever mention our airport.

xxx

Above all, Illinois Department of Corrections, should be taking steps to double the size of the Sumner Correctional Facility. It's performance record, including low recidivism, should encourage the Springfield powers to make our facility larger. Needed land is already state owned; public acceptance is total. Dangerous old facilities like Menard, Joliet & Vandalia should be closed.

xxx

In another week the leaf raking starts. Ugh!

October 10, 2013

We read an interesting interview of influential Supreme Court Justice Antonio Scalia by New York Times Books.

xxx

His Honor has low regard for the social media; believes Facebook a fad that will soon disappear.

xxx

He abhors the coarse language found in most films and even in the speech of otherwise cultivated ladies.

xxx

His grasp of traditional values is firm. But he is fighting a rear guard action against society's aimless choice of path of least resistance.

xxx

Court decorum must be different in New York City than in Southern Illinois . The Internet showed a defiant biker accused of triggering the bikers' mob assault upon a hapless motorist on a major

New York City street , give the finger, both hands, to court officials, and spectators.

xxx

The chance video of the bikers' attack suggests how prevalent the obtaining and preservation of occurrence evidence where everyone is prepared with a smart phone, or comparable device.

xxx

One wonders why the off duty police were riding with a group that often attracts hoodlums; why they didn't intervene to stop the attack; and why they haven't been fired from the public payroll.

xxx

Geriatrics cheer for Zola Budd, 47, South African Olympic distance runner, 1984. Budd now lives in Myrtle Beach , SC. Last week she humbled college-age competitors in an invitational 5K at Cary , NC , beating closest competitor 50 seconds.

xxx

C-span has an interesting series on presidential wives. We suspect that they over-play the role of each during husband's presidency prior to Eleanor Roosevelt, with the possible exception of Dolly Madison. For good or evil, the liberation of women is a recent phenomena.

xxx

Republican opposition to Obamacare will be less strident as its popularity becomes more apparent. It is a large step toward traditional socialism. If that be the choice of a majority of the voters, Speaker Boehner & Company have no acceptable recourse.

xxx

Raising the debt ceiling is a larger step toward the socialism of America . All who believe in private ownership of property should encourage Boehner & Company in their lonely battle against irresponsible spending which cold cause disastrous national inflation, and most of the news media.

October 17, 2013

Frightening that the prime minister of a nation as intelligent, proud and determined as Japan would appeal to world experts to contain the radioactive water flowing from typhoon damaged Fukushima atomic power plant, 18 months after the disaster. That is exactly what Prime Minister Abe did last week.

xxx

It was a public admission that the Japanese had created a monster that conceivably could make the planet earth uninhabitable. Fish from many miles into the bordering Pacific Ocean have been determined unsafe for human consumption.

xxx

Once among the world's largest power plants, Fukushima has been decommissioned, but its six reactors apparently continue to make flood waters radioactive. Prime Minister Abe's candor is a warning to mankind worldwide. He should be saluted for asking for help.

xxx

In another field of human endeavor, the Japanese demonstrated skill and resurgence which was unthinkable when they surrendered to MacArthur, Tokyo Bay , September, 1945. There is something wrong when Toyota 's Camry outsells the Chevrolet in the USA.

xxx

Perhaps American unions should become partners in the operation of manufacturing businesses, as in Germany . It would lower unions' never satiated demand for higher wages if they shared the responsibility of the boardroom to meet the payroll and beat the competition.

xxx

The unflattering truth is that the Japanese appear to have out-thought us as the Lexus replaces the Cadillac as the standard of excellence on American highways.

xxx

Our industry starved county would be a basket case without ATS. As a symbol of public approval

of the Japanese savoir faire, the Press has advocated construction of a Japanese-style dwelling on State Street .

xxx

Would such gesture be resented or might it help restore the work ethic in this nation and remind all of globalization which has happened?

xxx

Predictably, the Senate, Congress and the President have found a solution to the debt ceiling. It was irresponsible for anyone to say, write or think that this nation might default on its solemn promise to pay creditors on account of some legal restraint.

xxx

The bigger problem is whether government will get bigger or smaller during the next 20 years. If the present trend of government support of all the weak, weary and dispirited continues, socialism will be de facto in the land that was built on Adam Smith's capitalism.

xxx

Too many are discouraged by the cooler days, and say silly things like, "Wish I lived in Florida ." "Indian Summer" is yet to come. Cheer up.

October 24, 2013

Something is wrong when Lawrence County has more overflow prisoners in the Crawford County Jail than has Crawford of its own. Its population is one-third larger than Lawrence 's. Our citizens are no less law abiding.

xxx

The Lawrence County Sheriff presides over a jail with often more than capacity occupancy. Cost of feeding, housing and caring for these miscreants, especially of those farmed out to other jails, is indefensibly wasteful of taxpayer money.

xxx

There has been silly talk of building a larger jail. A better solution would be to have far fewer non-violent prisoners in jail for inability to post bail. It has been estimated that the taxpayers would save \$50,000 a year in the cost of operation of the county jail if the bail required for release of non-violent prisoners were reduced to their financial capacity. Common sense suggests that the County Board should require the judiciary and prosecution to live within such guidelines.

xxx

It makes no sense that the Lawrence County Sheriff serves more meals to his "guests" than most of the restaurants of Lawrence County to their paying customers.

xxx

While we do not admire Texas Senator Ted Cruz, we envy the news media attention his opposition to Obamacare, and to raising the national debt limit, earned him. He should offer more specifics as to how he would make government work better.

xxx

The Tea Party should note the disasters that it brought to the nation in the Indiana and Missouri U. S. Senate races in 2012 before launching a presidential campaign in 2015. Many of its principles are worthwhile but compromise is the essence of agreement and creating a majority.

xxx

If the GOP is to rescue the nation from its present malaise of spirit in 2016, it must have the rational element of the Tea Party in its ranks. Otherwise, we think the next President will be Rahm Emanuel, a clever politician presently marking time as Mayor of Chicago .

xxx

We apologize to our readers. Though a mixed signal, the Press last week printed a letter from the President of the Illinois State Bar Association urging Congress to find more money for the federal judiciary to better serve the public need. Nothing could be farther from the philosophy of the Press . We have never seen a public office, federal or state, underfunded. In most of these positions if the budget were halved, the survivors would work harder, serve the public better, and be more appreciative of their cushion that remained.

xxx

It was a melancholy reminder of our County's decline to discover this week that Todd Reitz, a former State's Attorney of Lawrence County, voluntarily gave up such position of power and prestige to serve as Assistant State's Attorney in Richland.

xxx

We must do more to make Lawrence County attractive to every worthwhile citizen we can lure within its boundaries. We should have a parade every Saturday in the county seat, and a place where a lady can get her toenails painted at midnight which is why Amy Padgett stated on her Facebook that she loved living in Hong Kong .

October 31, 2013

Astounding that major league baseball can capture and hold attention of so many for seven months of each year – 162 games. Plus a dozen in tournament to determine "world champions."

xxx

Professional football draws larger in person crowds but its hour upon the stage is only half so long.

xxx

Why does psychiatry continue to receive such wide public approval, even admiration, and handsome remuneration? We regard it as "feel good" psychology, almost witch doctor medicine. We haven't known of a patient cured. If conventional doctors had comparable win-loss record they would be laughed off the stage.

xxx

We believe Obamacare will be as popular with the masses within a year as Medicare and Social Security. Every human hopes for a benefactor. America 's problem is that a majority require a caregiver.

xxx

Senator Ted Cruz – is he the savior of the USA , or another huckster politician? We believe the

latter, but hope that we are in error.

xxx

It is time to quit demonizing Edward Snowden. His "betrayal of trust" revealed that the USA shamelessly wiretapped everyone, including the German Chancellor Merkle. America doesn't deserve trusted allies when it behaves thusly. If Snowden had the money and Bill Clinton were still President, we think he would receive a presidential pardon. President Obama should let Snowden come home from Russia – for free.

xxx

The White House assured the world that President Obama did not know that we were spying on the Germans. We fear that W.H. was truthful.

xxx

During the three weeks until the 50th anniversary of JFK's assassination the public will be inundated with television tributes to the departed. The growing hero worship defies rational explanation. Even the blacks worship his memory, and think of LBJ as just an ordinary dead politician. But it was the latter who passed the voting act and empowered them.

xxx

Christians should be on guard that Halloween does not overtake Christmas as the most business significant season of the year.

xxx

Discussing horrendous overtime for D.O.C. employees, the spokesman for AFSCME challenged the reporter who asked if employees volunteered for overtime to increase their pay checks? "No, it is to assist short staffed fellow employees."

xxx

Why doesn't Unit #20 Board of Education inform the public its plans for abandoned, classic LHS High School building?

xxx

My motto was always to keep swinging. Whether I was in a slump or feeling badly or having trouble off the field, the only thing to do was keep swinging.

- Hank Aaron

xxx

November 7, 2013

One should not wait until old to discover that time is too precious to waste.

xxx

Were we alone in conclusion that the St. Louis Cardinals showed less determination to win the sixth/final game against Boston in the World Series? wondered whether Cardinal management had arranged for overnight hotel reservations for a seventh and unneeded game?

xxx

The lackluster finale of the Cardinals' otherwise grand season reminded all that professional sports are promoter created waste of time for millions of lazy Americans.

xxx

Terry McAuliffe's election as Governor of Virginia, Tuesday, is a substantial boost for Hillary Clinton's race for the Democratic nominee for President, 2016. As was Senator Schumer's endorsement.

xxx

The cruel reality is that Hillary's chance of winning the election against the rival Governor from New Jersey , 12 months hence, is slight. Her friends are pushing the lady into a race she can't win. She will be in her 70th year.

xxx

The Lawrence County need is to get on the right horse for the Governor's race. Our economic

survival requires us to be the favorite child of either Bruce Rauner or Kirk Dillard.

xxx

It was poetic justice that Iraqi President al-Maliki came on bended knee to President Obama last week. He has acknowledged that his Shiite faction cannot restrain the Sunni minority. It will overwhelm the government if total American troop withdrawal happens, in 2014, as scheduled.

xxx

A year ago this same al-Maliki led the chorus chanting "Yanks, go home."

xxx

The U. S. has no choice but to leave a U. S. fighting force in Iraq as long as required. The Americans that bleat "Bring the soldiers home," need to face reality.

xxx

Those concerned with Lawrence County's economic future should attend GOP Hot Dog Rally, 11:00-2:00, Saturday, November 16, west side of the Courthouse Square . Our incumbent representatives David Reis and Brad Halbrook have been invited, as have the three, Darrell Cox, Keith Garner, and Reginald Phillips, who hope to be Halbrook's successor.

xxx

Requiring political candidates to disclose campaign receipts & disbursements was touted as electoral reform. Ironically, strength of a candidate is now forecast by the amount of campaign cash he/she raises. The outcome of the election is foretold by raising impressive campaign funds. When the New York newspapers reported last month that Bill deBlasio had three times as much cash as Joe Lhota, the news media predicted his election. The band wagon public confirmed, Tuesday.

xxx

A way to take the strong influence of money out of elections has not yet been found.

xxx

Remind your friends how pleasant November in the county to which they should return.

Roscoe's Journal — Transcriptions (Part 001)

November 14, 2013

Hooray for United Health. Spot on the calendar didn't keep Lawrence County's #1 employer from working Monday. Has same dedication as predecessor, Golden Rule Insurance. Our agreement with the skilled work force at the Law Factory is that we observe only holidays recognized by United.

xxx

Had we used the Courthouse, City Hall, Post Office, or even the banks, as the guide, would be closed more than open.

xxx

Disgraceful that American foreign policy is controlled by Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu. Our interests are not identical.

xxx

Seven foreign ministers were summoned to Geneva last week for announcement of an historic agreement with Iran for the dismantling of its nuclear bomb building effort. Netanyahu called a press conference, denounced the agreement as stupid and a direct threat to Israel's continued existence. President Obama and Secretary of State Kerry pirouetted in mid-air; their strong support of the agreement was instantly converted to opposition.

xxx

Mr. Kakac was chosen in an application process that included review by a six-member screening committee appointed by Supreme Court Justice Lloyd A. Karmeier, who recommended Mr. Kakac to the Court.

xxx

We were fascinated by the election of a new mayor in New York City. His name is Bill deBlasio. He

is 6' 5" long, arrogant, dedicated to the proposition that financial resources of all be equal. Why the billionaires on Wall Street supported him we will never know.

xxx

Of billionaires, Warren Buffett, the Omaha oracle, was on television last week, with son and grandson. He is a clever man even if he is an Obama supporter. We liked his optimism of the future of the USA. "The best is yet to be."

xxx

Winter has come to County Lawrence. We should attempt to signal to Northern Illinois, where winter is more than a name, how much milder our season is than theirs.

xxx

Even as we hibernate, we should plan ways to make our county more attractive to the refugees from up north, and to those who temporarily abandon the home turf.

xxx

We must resolve together to miss no more grand opportunities, e.g., keeping the ferryboat on the Wabash at St. Francisville. Tragic that that tourist attraction deluxe was let depart 50 years ago. Another opportunity was the rappelling station on the abandoned water tower in Sumner scrapped three years ago. Third opportunity is George Field. It simply must rescue the county from present economic doldrums.

xxx

The real voyage of discovery consists no in seeking new landscapes but in having new eyes.
- Marcel Proust

xxx

November 21, 2013

Robin O'Neal, Olney, was the court reporter for a jury trial Monday in the Circuit Court of Lawrence County. Judge Robert M. Hopkins presided. One wondered why the reporter was wearing dark prescription eyeglasses. Inquiry revealed that she had flown to Cancun for a short

vacation, swam with the dolphins, lost her glasses. Notwithstanding, she performed her reportorial duties with calm confidence. Press salutes those whose lives are so venturesome.

xxx

Another court item, White County Resident Circuit Judge Scott Webb conducted court in Lawrence, Thursday. This former White County State's Attorney is new to the bench, elected in November, 2012. He fits well into the scheme of things. Lawrence County hopes that he will return often.

xxx

The Chief Judge assigns judges to preside in other counties than their own throughout this 12 county district. An arrangement that works well, lets built-up tensions and disappointments of decisions gone awry dissipate.

xxx

Little noted but ominous news item: President Xi Jinping, and the ruling Chinese clique has relaxed the one child per family limitation, in effect for more than 20 years. If the floodgates are fully opened, Rev. Malthus' theory of world starvation by over-population will soon be tested.

xxx

The boy-girl ratio in China was so out of balance, not enough girls, was the reason for the new policy.

xxx

If two men or two women applied for a marriage license and tendered the appropriate fee to Lawrence County Clerk Will C. Gibson, he would be required to issue such license. What difference would it make if a straight couple would apply for a license that one or both might marry another? In view of the demonstrable definition of marriage what possible justification is there for polygamy to be a criminal offense?

xxx

We're anxious to know the U. S. Supreme Court decision when some outlaw sect of the Mormon

Church, presently practicing polygamy, asks the Court to reconsider its decision in Reynolds vs United States .

xxx

Those devious Republicans looked confused when they partially closed down government in an effort to destroy Obamacare. The target appears to have self-destructed. Those same Republicans are made to look prescient.

xxx

The damage to President Obama's place in history is irreparable unless Affordable Health Care is resurrected. The need for health care for all is so great the hope is that a genuine bipartisan plan toward that goal will emerge from the wreckage.

xxx

The Press believes that the plan should begin with a doubling of the number of doctors and other health care providers.

xxx

Schools, including adult education, should do more to educate an indifferent public on personal hygiene that would benefit every citizen. Further, all should be disabused of the notion that there is a pill for every need. If the public paid any attention to the lengthy list of "possible side effects" from taking whatever patent medicine being touted, consumption would be decimated.

xxx

The Press wishes good health to all.

November 28, 2013

Our community's lack of venture capital and imagination caused a classic abandoned school building, New Central, Lawrenceville, to be sold at public auction, Saturday, for \$3,250. Such public inertia does not augur well for the future of Lawrenceville.

xxx

How desperate the local economy when the Governor's office trumpeted, "Airport awarded \$225,000 for construction project."

xxx

That number required another zero to deserve mention, or earn reelection in 2014.

xxx

We would wager all we own that the annual food and drink expense at the Governor's mansion exceeds that number.

xxx

16° before Thanksgiving. Let's hear no more about Indian Summer, 'tis self-delusion. We are ready for spring.

xxx

Continuing export of oil has made Abu-Dhabi, Saudi Arabia, and the Middle-east wealthy far beyond what is earned by other countries by brains, determination and sweat. This financial imbalance makes the building of the Keystone pipeline, presently stubbornly halted by President Obama, a national necessity if we are to avoid dependence upon Middle-east oil for survival.

xxx

How frightfully foolish to depend upon the Washington State Aerospace Union which refused to accept Boeing's tendered contract. It would have guaranteed that much of the 777 contract (for planes sold to Abu-Dhabi and the Middle-east) would be built in Washington .

xxx

We compliment Obama and Kerry for the spin that they have put on the bomb ban treaty with Iran . Cooperation with that alienated nation during the next six months is essential to its well-being, and ours.

xxx

None should moan the agreement with Afghanistan which will require American soldiers there for ten more years. It is the price of world leadership and preferable to the alternative.

xxx

Press Christmas Party is two weeks from Saturday night. Social crowd of the season. The writers in Pressland are reminded that each is invited if he/she has written an article for the Press within the past year, or promises to do so within six months.

xxx

Please confirm your attendance that Darin Blair will know how many fatted calves to kill.

xxx

The gloom of darkness at 4:30 p.m. forced us to relent and light the "People's Christmas Tree," 13th & State, Tuesday evening.

xxx

Happy Thanksgiving.

December 5, 2013

25th Capital Classic, Friday & Saturday, was a grand success. Would have been pluperfect if LHS & RHHS, or either team reached the championship game.

xxx

Good manners often require the host school to lose. Our confident opinion is that each school will be less mannerly a year from now. Each looks like a winner. If combined they would be unstoppable.

xxx

Though the Press often scoffs at school sports as counter-academic excellence, there is a community pride that swells when a school team triumphs. We remember the pride at Monticello two years ago. Parkview's finest are now sophomores. Aided and abetted by a remarkable freshman, Bryce Winningham. They are obvious winners.

xxx

As we watched the ultimate champions, Mt. Carmel Aces, slide past the Indians we thought of Eddie Whitmer sending the truck to move the Leighty family to Gym 30+ years ago.

xxx

The will to win another State Championship is strong enough in the City of Champions for similar piracy, summer of 2014. Target should be Metcalf, Mt. Carmel .

xxx

Press salutes the Chamber of Commerce and all who worked to make the Classic triumphant. They furnished the proper response to those who whine "nothing exciting happens in small towns."

xxx

We have one small indignation - to put head at either Classic site. The music departments short-changed the public and the musicians. Questioned, some hid behind alleged tournament rules against unreasonable noise, size and frequency of band performances.

xxx

We'll picket 2014 Classic if either site without a pep band.

xxx

We were appalled that some professor of political science, named Zimmerman , New York University, publicly mused that it was time for the American electorate to repeal the 22nd Amendment. We equate presidential term limits with several benefits of the Bill of Rights in its significance for democracy's well-being in the USA.

xxx

Tragedy is that it doesn't extend to every elected office. Professor Zimmerman should be retired. He has lost it. We repeat our charge: without term limits democracy is a farce.

XXX

Instant communication is a powerful transmitter of the public will. Yum fired a Pizza Hut manager, Elkhart , IN , because he refused to open the store on Thanksgiving (wanted to give his co-workers a little time with their families). Instant Facebook condemnation was so viral, upper echelon reconsidered and offered to rehire the manager.

XXX

Five years ago a popular Virginian governor was biding time until he made expected run for President. He used a derogatory description of a minority newsman who was reporting his campaign for the U. S. Senate. The Internet struck again, Allen chafes in anonymous retirement.

XXX

Thirty-five is when you finally get your head together and your body starts falling apart.
- Caryn Leschen

XXX

December 12, 2013

Education is too vital in the lives of the young, and the well-being of an entire community, to permit school attendance to be optional for fair weather. Tragic that so many schools in the area were closed so long for a few snowflakes.

XXX

Few world leaders have changed their whole nation as much as did Nelson Mandela. In human rights his life was a Godsend to South Africa , and the world.

XXX

We agreed with President Obama's appraisal, "Now he belongs to the ages." He should have acknowledged that the quote was lifted from Secretary of War Edmund M. Stanton's comments on the death of Lincoln .

XXX

The USA was well represented at the memorial services. Presidents Obama, Carter, Clinton and Bush were courageous, patriotic, to travel so far in a potentially dangerous gathering. We noted that they were partially protected by bullet-proof glass, and recalled a saner era in which French President Charles DeGaulle was within arm's reach of the sidewalk crowd watching FDR's burial parade in Washington , D.C.

xxx

Tragedy in Mandela's death is that he leaves such a motley crew to govern South Africa . President Jacob Zuma has been married six times, has four wives in residence, threatened to expel international experts trying to stop the spread of AIDS with incredible charge that they were trying to infect the patients, has been charged with rape, and is presently defending against public ridicule the expenditure of 20 million taxpayer dollars updating the security system of his home in a nation that has millions of homeless.

xxx

President Jimmy Carter, a fair-minded observer, hesitated in NBC interview when asked if Mandela's successors would continue equal treatment by the majority blacks of the minority whites. His answer, "I hope so."

xxx

In a sports dominated society, we are surprised how little mention there has been of the Winter Olympics which will commence in Sochi, Russia , in seven weeks. All remember how prominent reporting on Winter Games at Sarajevo . Nor is there any notice of the Summer Olympics, Rio , 2016. Perhaps Americans are becoming introspective.

xxx

High school administrators and Boards of Education in districts whose enrollment is only a fraction of capacity should be slow to expel non-violent students, who are repentant, and have sufficient IQ to carry their courses.

xxx

State Highway employees earn their pay on weeks like the past. It was encouraging how quickly

the roads were cleared, how few wrecks; no deaths or serious injuries.

xxx

The weather must not deter anyone seeking to make Lawrence County an attractive place to live, and from inviting others to come live with us.

xxx

In the spirit of Christmas, every Lawrence County citizen should sacrifice the pleasure of a white Christmas and wish that blessing upon the Hoosiers, the Chicagoans, and other romanticists.

xxx

Peace has to be created in order to be maintained. It is the product of Faith, Strength, Energy, Will, Sympathy, Justice, Imagination and the triumph of principle. It will never be achieved by passivity and quietism.

xxx

December 19, 2013

It is to the credit of the American public racial tolerance that stadiums and sporting arenas are filled by white spectators with so little racial diversity among the players.

xxx

Unfortunate that the South African blacks and whites do not share the late Nelson Mandela's belief in equal rights under the law. We found it alarming that the networks covering Mandela's memorial services also ran pictures of white Africaners in militia training "to defend our land."

xxx

The white 10% there own 90% of the land. Some redistribution of the wealth must be made for peace and harmony. Question is how much redistribution?

xxx

We have the same problem in America . The struggle is between the rich and the poor. When

President Obama speaks of redistribution of the wealth it is with great personal dedication.

xxx

The white Mayor of New York City, DeBlasio, out does even Jesse & Al, and the enforcer, Farrakhan, in his dedication to redistribution of the wealth. His campaign pledge was to tax the rich for the benefit of the poor.

xxx

Every religious individual must believe in the duty of the strong to carry for the weak, the swift to run for the slow. There must be some balance; the beneficiaries of public charity need to do more for their own survival.

xxx

Interestingly, the Affordable Health Care Act should add "Redistribution of the Wealth" to its title. The 40 million uninsured are prominently mentioned in campaign oratory are the poor who need a helping hand. Those who are already insured should not be surprised that they will pay higher rates by reason of universal coverage. There are no free lunches.

xxx

Of course, there is a point at which taxing the rich becomes counterproductive. It is called "killing the goose that lays the golden egg." UAW demonstrated that at GM.

xxx

Mayor DeBlasio is confronted by a recent study which found that top 20% of taxpayers pay 95% of all taxes.

xxx

We may be beneficiaries of others' efforts and willingness to pay more than we realize.

xxx

Press scooped Utah Federal Judge Waddoups four weeks ago, predicting that polygamy would be

legalized. His Honor so held. Kody Brown appeared delighted that he can keep his four wives, and vice versa. Will Mormon Church membership increase to cloak the rearrangement with religious respectability?

xxx

In this Christmas season, as throughout the year, we should be kind to one another.

xxx

All should rejoice in the happy certainty that spring comes Saturday. We've already had that prior season, and the daylight hours begin to lengthen.

2014

51 COLUMNS

January 2, 2014

Odd that public employee unions violently oppose Legislature's plan to extend years of employment to qualify for pension. The plan extends the lifetime of each ungrateful beneficiary.

xxx

Could every New Year's resolution be summarized by two words of questionable grammar, "try harder"?

xxx

Next crisis on whether major war imminent comes mid-May. Putin & Russia persuaded UN to make Obama & USA look foolish for the President's "red line that Iran must not cross" speech, and moving flotilla to Eastern Mediterranean, by passing resolution to negotiate for six months before any missile attack on Iran.

xxx

Common sense supported Russia, and the UN, but already the Iranians have announced that they are proceeding with building additional centrifuges, key to nuclear warheads. Presently at least a dozen nations, including Israel, are thought to have nuclear war capacity. Apparently the choice is stark: enlarge the club by one, or go to war.

xxx

Why not decide the issue by a public referendum, as was had in A&E vs Phil Robertson?

xxx

Robertson, star of A&E's hit show, "Duck Dynasty", was publicly fired for anti-gay remarks. More than 250,000 supporters demanded, via the internet, that he be reinstated and would boycott A&E and Cracker Barrel, Dynasty's sponsor. A&E and Cracker Barrel reversed their indignation mid-air and reinstated Robertson, without any retraction or apology by Robertson.

xxx

His remarks were vulgar, indecent and effective. With a single sentence he may have driven many gays back into the closet.

xxx

It was graphic demonstration of the power and utility of the Internet. We think the occurrence will make democracy, as envisioned by the Greeks long ago, where every voice is heard. It will be a restraining force on congresses and parliaments worldwide.

January 9, 2014

Bill De Blasio may be the Democratic roadblock to Hillary Clinton being the Party nominee for President, 2016. More Socialist than Obama, he advocates taxing the rich for the benefit of the poor. Nikita Krushchevt was right 50 years ago when he loudly predicted, "your children will live under socialism." The spread of something for nothing is irresistible.

xxx

Di Blasio has an ace, as strong as Obama's. His wife of 30+ years is an attractive black. With that ethnic ace one wonders why the bookies picked Blumberg's Comptroller to be the leading Democratic candidate for Mayor of NYC before the primary revealed that it was Di Blasio "hands down."

xxx

Troublesome report out of Syria. A genuine expert claims that the Assad family which has ruled there for 40 years as though royalty is actually popular enough to win a fair election. We should not be so hostile to the Syrian government if it does reflect the free will of the people. We were made to look silly in Cuba by continuing to paint the Castros as scoundrels long after it was apparent they would win any fair election. The snobbery, privileged Cubans who had fled their country to seize control of Miami have never accepted fact that Castros have majority support.

xxx

When you hear a community pining for "government grant", you are looking at losers. Government grants are like banker's loans--can't get them unless you prove that you do not need the loan.

xxx

Many have predicted that Mayor De Blasio's "soak the rich for the benefit of the poor, and

shiftless," will cause monied people to flee NYC for Jersey City. Unless this comes to pass, validity of the argument that richest deserve for others, will have lost all credibility.

xxx

During 65 years we have never encountered absence of out of town mail for two consecutive days on account of weather

xxx

During 45 years never were there two consecutive work days that farlene failed to come to the Law Factory on account of the weather.

xxx

The moment of truth approaches in which two school districts must work out terms under which they will combine. Two weeks from Wednesday will be the fateful meeting. We hope that the new guidance counselor office will be as cooperative as has been USD #10's. xxx

Travel agencies agree that Hawaii is the most popular exotic vacation spot for most Americans. Yet we never find returnees from "finest vacation ever" who express a desire to move there.

xxx

We are each a creature of habit. We can reduce disheartening tendency of worthwhile citizens to move elsewhere, by emphasizing always how grand to live in County Lawrence, where blizzards are rare. xxx

Delightful that the daylight hours are lengthening.

January 16, 2014

Florida Academy football coach was fired for running up the score against opponents, after instructed by management not to thus jeopardize harmonious relations with other schools. Some sports fans were indignant at the coach's dismissal in view of the team's 12-0 W-L record. We salute the school management.

xxx

One encounters frequently athletic contests in which more savvy coaches, without threat of dismissal, send in the subs to keep the score from being embarrassingly lopsided. But why keep score if same should be manipulated for opponent's sensitivity?

xxx

A modest athletic program at the high school level is certainly defensible if there is an intramural program to exercise the unathletic type as needed for health. There would appear less justification for the big time college programs with which this nation presently obsessed.

xxx

Only possible reason for college magnitude is the amusement of the alumni and the encouragement of their generosity. Professional sports are a job producing business.

xxx

It is noted that Illinois ' basketball team again this year wins only against Division II competition. The U of I football team has established a record for losses against conference opponents - 18 consecutive games. The University's reputation as a center of learning has grown steadily notwithstanding the ineptness of the athletic program.

xxx

It may be time to follow University of Chicago out of the Big Ten conference. If school spirit, band performance, alumni loyalty compel continuing pummeling by semiprofessional competition, the University should at least insist on an affirmative action program to bring ethnic diversity.

xxx

What an indictment of French moral values. President Francois Hollande was accused by a fearless French newspaper of putting aside his third longtime live-in, for a younger model. Hollande has never married, has sired four children by Segalena Royal, a Socialist leader who also ran for President, and served as his second live-in.

xxx

Named French President was outraged that a newspaper would accuse him of misconduct and

almost suggest his resignation. Said Hollande, "I may take legal action against them for invading my privacy."

xxx

The real downer was the French public reaction to the disclosure. Opinion polls show that very few French citizens had any concern for the President's conduct.

xxx

For years this nation has been fed constant pap about godless Russia . We have seen during the past two years more pictures of Russian President Putin in church services than any leader of the Western world.

xxx

There needs be a well defined line between a theocracy, as in Iran , and a godless France . We wish that moral values in the USA were strong enough to prevent both Chris Christie and Hillary Clinton from becoming respective nominees for President in the 2016 election. Each has been revealed to be vindictive. It appears now that each has his/her party's nomination sewed up.

xxx

What a delightful anomaly. Spring will be here in two weeks as we savor the television coverage of the winter Olympics from Sochi , Russia . Our hope is that the KGB intercepts every crazy suicide bomber sent by Allah to the winter games.

January 23, 2014

Patent medicine peddlers are making hypochondriacs out of too many Americans. We recognize need to safeguard freedom of speech. Perhaps it would be feasible for television to charge higher for publicizing the constant drumbeat of human ills.

xxx

Makes no sense – we honor the memory of a great American, Martin Luther King, Jr., by depriving children of a day's education. All school closings, except where demonstrable physical harm threatened, should be forbidden.

xxx

Churches without a projector and screen are behind the curve.

xxx

Board of Education of School District #20 missed an opportunity to demonstrate community leadership. Should have offered LHS and excess personal property for free to United Health, or ATS, with condition that recipient incorporate the facility in its expanded operation.

xxx

If that carrot failed, Board should have requested the federal and/or state government to accept such gift, with same proviso.

xxx

If neither the federal or state government showed any inclination to aid our struggling community, disposition by public sale should have included removal of the carcass to the ever stretched local government. We fear that that melancholy scenario will come to pass in 3-5 years.

xxx

The malaise of spirit which presently stifles Lawrence County comes from lack of imagination and dedication by those with leadership potential. Saturday's sale painfully demonstrated the need for revitalization of the can-do spirit which A. L. Maxwell, et al, brought to Lawrenceville a century ago.

xxx

Back to United Health and ATS: If the Lawrence County Board of Review does not permit these essentials to a viable economy make their own real estate tax evaluations, they will put the County in deadly peril of being underced by Vincennes with both named "rescuers".

xxx

Our government appears determined to quarrel with Russia . The Ukraine is the bread basket of that country. The U. S. is encouraging it to join the European Union. Russian reaction has been to

encourage street riots in opposition to the EU joinder. Though violent, they are mild in comparison to American reaction if Russia were encouraging Texas to join Mexico .

xxx

How grand it would be if First Christian could muster a quorum and have a public reception following the morning service, February 2. We would call it a "Farewell to Winter Party."

January 30, 2014

University of Illinois alumni should become philosophical about this year's edition of the Fighting Illini in men's basketball—they are "also rans" who have lost six consecutive games to Big Ten opponents. They may yet equal, or exceed, the football team's record 11 consecutive losses . Coach John Croce is no longer the toast of Champaign-Urbana; the drug store coaches remember fondly Bruce Weber, Bill Self & Lou Henson. All can take refuge in that fortress, "things will be better next year."

xxx

We know now how a bear welcomes spring after hibernating through a long, cold winter.

xxx

We have found the money needed to make route Fifty four lanes wide, Carlyle to Lawrenceville, 90 miles. Afghanistan President seeks to ingratiate himself to the Taliban who appear poised to retake control of that miserable country when and if American combat troops leave at the end of this year, by lambasting America at every opportunity. Said Karzai, "we don't need foreign money," "foreigners must quit killing our civilians (he is complaining of our effective drone guided missile attacks on specific targets)", "foreigners must not keep war going in our country to make a profit."

xxx

Last Karzai quote was his most pathological. Our Congress and President will debate much during the next 11 months whether to leave a military presence in Afghanistan after this year. Above all, we should save the one billion dollars foreign aid earmarked for Afghanistan. It would build Four Lanes for Route Fifty, and a dozen other needed projects in neglected U.S.A.

xxx

The work ethic in County Lawrence needs to be strengthened. Too many temporary employees are not accepted by our largest industry into the regular work force because they have not acquired/displayed required skill during the provisional training period.

XXX

When the Lawrence County high schools are consolidated this year, it is essential that there be a full manual arts program. We hope that the School Board of Unit # 20 didn't sell to the Amish all of the saws, lathes and other parts needed to train the young so inclined.

XXX

How fickle is public opinion. Seventy-five years ago the Dionnes of Callender, Ontario were the toast of this nation because the mother gave birth to quintuplets she appeared normal. Five years ago (January 26), Nadya Suleman gave birth to eight babies each lived and appears normal.

XXX

"Octomom" as she is derisively described by many critics, is the butt of jokes by night club comedians . California state regulators pulled the license of the doctor who planted the embryos in the mother's body. The doctor was charged with being reckless in treating the patient mother.

XXX

The unwed mother appears to have made a herculean effort to support self, six older children, and the eight, by various promotions, not seeking public dole. she did dabble in pornography which is incompatible with her professed Christianity, but perhaps excusable on account of economic need. Should be noted that the mother gave each of the eight children a name from the Bible.

XXX

In summation, Ms. Suleman has been given a bum rap. We may ask Gay Kavanaugh to add this family to the worthy causes for which she seeks contributions each year.

XXX

Surely those who believe in equal rights for women were outraged by French President Hollande's

imperial announcement, "I have put an end to my relation to Madame Trierweiler". She had worked tirelessly for his election. The decadent French do not appear embarrassed by their President's moral deficit.

xxx

We would be impressed if Michelle Obama caused the President to withdraw invitation to President Hollande to stop at the White House for free meal when in this country in March

February 6, 2014

Two Norwegian legislators have nominated Edward Snowden for the Nobel Peace Prize. If he wins, pending U. S. espionage prosecution will be untenable. His betrayal of trust has earned Snowden more favorable worldwide support than that of any person in history.

xxx

Yet other side of the coin is that, if U. S. granted clemency, might inspire others entrusted with vital national secrets to wrongfully disclose. If Snowden gets the peace prize, President Obama will have a very difficult decision to make.

xxx

Amanda Knox' near celebrity in the bankruptcy of public intelligence. The victim's family, British, were too poor for any member to attend the Italian trial for their daughter's murder.

xxx

The Kerchers should be remembered before this nation becomes too sentimentally defensive of Knox. Her admitted participation in wild drug party when roommate killed alone should persuade U. S. Justice Department to honor extradition if the cumbersome Italian court system seeks same.

xxx

The sensation seeking magazines at the grocery check-out line proclaim Bill Clinton has only six months to live. One suspects that there is no limit to the effort by Hillary to be elected in 2016.

xxx

British bookmakers/gamblers have made Hillary prohibitive favorite to be the Democratic nominee in 2016, and to win. We suggest that Press readers' contra opinion, backed by modest sums, would be a good investment.

xxx

The Lawrenceville Indians looked like state tournament material against Newton in Friday's game for third place in the Little Illini Tournament. If not this year, next for certain.

xxx

Though America's pagan religion, NFL, outdid itself in Sunday's Super Bowl, its total collapse within five years is solely predictable. Spectator concern will kick in as the masses ask themselves if they have a moral right to encourage players to damage other humans' brains.

xxx

We watched only a minute or so of brutal collisions after the Sea Hawks' total domination of the Broncos, and remembered the observation of a teen-aged girl in St. Francisville. Peggy Post could hit a baseball farther than many boys, played on their team, and said of boxing, "Of course, I am opposed to boxing, the object is to damage the opponent's brain." We thought her summation classic. Should be persuasive for all civilized.

xxx

We were delighted that Lawrence County groundhogs did not see their shadows, Sunday.

Roscoe's Journal — Part 002

Transcribed verbatim from The Sumner Press, page 3 column by Roscoe D. Cunningham. Editions Feb–May 2014. All editions are LIVE original publications (Roscoe died Nov 28, 2020; these predate his death). Spelling/grammar reproduced as printed, including apparent typographical errors.

February 13, 2014

Asst. Secretary of State Victoria Nuland should be retired to a Parisien brothel. She speaks their language. Intolerable that so high ranking public official would embarrass our government and friendly European leaders as she armed the Russians with anti-American talking points through

her failure to remember that latter had capacity to eavesdrop on her instructions to the U.S. Ambassador to Kiev

xxx

A proven friend of the U.S., German Chancellor Angela Merkel, characterized Nuland's remarks as "totally unacceptable." She could have added, "incompetent." They confirmed other nations' suspicion that U.S. was encouraging Ukraine to lessen Russian influence in that country and align itself with the European Union. Our State Department should reflect on American reaction if Mexico were attempting to persuade Texas to leave the Union and become part of Mexico.

xxx

As host of the Winter Olympics, Russia is showing the world that it is more modern, progressive and appealing than some of our news media had lead a majority of Americans to believe. When the Russian occupation troops overstayed their welcome in Germany after WWII, the story was created that German construction was erecting housing in Russia to lure occupation troops to leave. The tremendous building boom in Sochi, for the Winter Olympics apparently required no foreign construction savvy.

xxx

We have become a little weary of our reporters stressing, Russia's rich historical, cultural tradition. It should be noted that those achievements pre-date the Revolution. It is ironic hat these modern Bolsheviks include Peter the Great in the shiny Russian history presented to Olympic guests. His name is synonymous with serfdom.

xxx

Notwithstanding these misgivings, the Winter Olympics are a grand success, a positive force for international goodwill. President Putin and the Russian Government deserve the appreciation of Americans and people of goodwill everywhere.

xxx

Downstate Illinois' loss that then Mayor Richard Daley was unsuccessful in his determined effort, five years ago, to bring the 2016 Summer Olympics to Chicago

xxx

We hope that the the Brazilians, and Rio de Janerio, put on as grand a show in the much larger summer games, 2016. as have the Russians.

February 20, 2014

How symbolically appropriate, winter ended in County Lawrence at same time as the Winter Olympics in Sochi . Equally enjoyed.

xxx

To get on with rebuilding County Lawrence , we need a young Moses to lead us out of the wilderness into which the Texaco Board of Directors threw our County in 1985. Four Lanes for Route Fifty or aviation related industry at George Field are the logical economic lifelines. Favorable notice for either community booster requires gubernatorial candidates to each land at Mid-American within the next 30 days.

xxx

To attract these would-be Moses, Press has urged each to include George Field on his traditional flyaround. Promise has been made for crowd of at least 100 for the press conference that would follow, plus television coverage. Press will furnish the bus from Courthouse. We need readers' participation to keep that promise.

xxx

Discouraging that the Republican governor race has narrowed to two. Rutherford stumbled in Chicago ; Brady unsuccessful in 2010. Astounding how much feared is Rauner by the AFSCME and Teachers' Union bosses. They seek desperately, with big cash, to boost Dillard. Public opinion polls show that they may be too little, too late.

xxx

Of unions in general in the USA , defeat of UAW effort to unionize employes of Volkswagen in Chattanooga plant was a major setback. Regardless of one's personal beliefs, industry flows to "right to work" states. Illinois should build a fence to keep Caterpillar.

xxx

March 3 is starting date for trial the whole world will watch. Oscar Pistorius goes on trial in South Africa for murder of his live-in. He's a national idol in South Africa because he won an Olympic medal in 2012 with prosthetic legs. We hope he is innocent.

xxx

Historians will conclude that the GOP congressional opposition to debt limit increase caved in because government hand-outs, including Social Security, are too popular to resist. Problem is that not one in 100 on the street knows that the national debt exceeds \$17 trillion. The hope is that lender nations will continue to buy U. S. bonds forever. Otherwise, we are broke.

xxx

That's why no one can ever dispute world record swindler Madoff's observation, "The U. S. government is a grand Ponzi scheme."

xxx

We were surprised that Mitt Romney did not go to Sochi . It was at Salt Lake City 12 years ago that he first escaped anonymity. He appears determined to run again for President in 2016. Sochi would have been splendid launch pad.

xxx

Every American should repeat with Emile Coue, "Every day, in every way, things are getting better and better."

We call it back to "God's Country".

xxx

A good conversationalist is not one who remembers what was said but says what someone wants to remember.

- John Mason Brown

xxx

February 27, 2014

Richard Petty, an icon in Nascar racing, spoke disparagingly of Danica Patrick, a successful female racecar driver. It has been suggested that he come out of retirement for a grudge match to resolve the matter.

xxx

If such contest occurs, our money will be on Ms. Patrick. We are mindful of the brash Bobby Riggs vs Billy Jean King in tennis.

xxx

Olympic hockey games are a fraudulent distortion of Olympics as promoted by Avery Brundage 50 years ago. There is nothing amateur about the contestants in that particular sport. Ten Chicago Black Hawks were on Team USA. Captain of the Russian team plays on the Detroit Red wings; Canadian professionals were in every hockey team. It was a stretch for the television broadcasters to continue to hope for a Russian–American rematch of the 1980 event. In that "miracle," it was amateurs vs the Russian professionals.

xxx

Olympics would be more meaningful if there were an attempt to regain the amateur rule that Brundage insisted upon. Television is thought to require the professional skill to which the contests have descended.

xxx

In spite of our futile hope that the Olympics will return to their simple beginning, they serve well the vital process of nations contesting together in peace. Without the Olympics, the all-out war in Independence Square, Kiev, 500 miles away, could have escalated into an American vs Russia atomic showdown.

xxx

We thought Russia's President Putin came out of the Olympics with a better world image in spite of a concentrated American TV attempt to paint him as a remake of Stalin.

xxx

We remain fearful that U.S. is overplaying its hand in the Ukraine rebellion. It is dangerously wrong to encourage a group to revolt against legitimate government unless prepared to use military might to support those challenging authority. Whether Ukraine joins E.U., or remains a satellite to Russia should not be of life and death concern to the U.S.A.

xxx

What hope is there for a civilized, peaceful, law-abiding society when Yahoo questions whether it was in the best interests of this nation that Mexican & American drug investigators capture El Chapo Guzman? That murderous thug is responsible for the death of thousands, including many law enforcement officers. He should be publicly hung after a very short trial.

xxx

Yahoo's undeveloped counter argument is that American demand for drugs is what fuels this worldwide epidemic. So be it. There should be an all out effort to fight this menace to mankind on as many fronts as required to protect our civilization.

xxx

The hyacinths in the Imperial Gardens are three weeks late. We are impatient for their appearance.

March 6, 2014

The speed with which a threatened Armageddon resolved itself suggests that mankind has become smarter in the 21st Century than in all time that has gone before.

xxx

Heretofore, international disputes that spiraled out of control invariably caused one or both adversaries to scream "mobilize" The downtrodden subjects grabbed whatever weapon available and were prepared to maim or kill the human beings on the other side of the trench because some psychotic mortal so commanded.

xxx

Communication between humans in this century is as fast as electricity. The would be attacker

and the would be victim can ask "why" instantly, even of the commander in chief.

xxx

Nor is such communication limited to our enlightened nation. We were impressed by Time magazine's electronic report on the overwhelming percentage of Russians who did not share their "Adolfs" dream of a Europe-Asia Union coerced by military might. "Adolf" appears to have received the same message, "we are unwilling to die, or slaughter others for your ambition."

xxx

In mid-air the tiger changed his stripes, "we have no intent to wage a war of aggression against the Ukrainian people." The worldwide calming effect was instantaneous.

xxx

In addition to the jolting news that public opinion in his own fiefdom was so strongly against him, we suspect that Vladimir also saw the spectre of the hangman's work after the Nuremberg War Crimes trial'. Perhaps that effort to establish the rule of law worldwide, so roundly criticized for almost 70 years, has been vindicated by rescuing civilization from its guaranteed destruction?

xxx

This frightening occurrence, of only 96 hours endurance, made one old time politician look very silly: Senator John McCain was pictured on the evening televised news, Saturday, thundering, "this would not have happened if we had strengthened our armed forces, instead of concern about cost of freedom."

xxx

We believe that John McCain would have screamed "mobilize" had he been in the White House when the word came that the Russians were about to seize a peninsula that has always been Russian. Crimea was immortalized in "The Charge of the Light Brigade." before civilized people found a better way to resolve disputes than war---- keeping the goose alive that lays the golden eggs.

xxx

Here's to globalization of business and industry, it will do much to prevent nuclear war throughout this new century.

xxx

There are worse crimes than burning books. One of them is not reading them.

-Joseph Brodsky

xxx

March 13, 2014

In 2003 the owner couple and five of their employees of Brown's Chicken Restaurant, Chicago, were murdered. Their bodies were found in the walk-in freezer. Eventually, James Degorski and Juan Luna were convicted. Each is now serving a life sentence .

xxx

Last week a Federal Court jury awarded Degorski \$431,000, "for violation of his civil rights." It was alleged that a Deputy Sheriff had beaten him while in custody. The Deputy claimed self defense and was acquitted of the charge.

xxx

It is difficult for harassed taxpayers to stomach such travesty against common sense. A purposeful society would have long since executed both of these criminals. To award one with such cash is intolerable. The presiding judge who permitted such insult to the memory of the murdered should be eased into retirement, without pension.

xxx

Hillary Clinton scooped the leaders of Western civilization in her comparison of Vladimir Putin to the late Adolf Hitler. It was encouraging that German Chancellor Merkel criticized Putin for his obvious disregard of international law. Like the Chinese-Japanese, "the victors" hear when the "vanquished" speak.

xxx

We yet believe that Putin will recognize that there are limits to which his aggression will be

tolerated. We do not criticize President Obama, nor Secretary of State Kerry for their patience.. Churchill said it best, "better to jaw, jaw , jaw, than to war, war, war."

xxx

Israel's Prime Minister Netanyahu must feel like Ethiopia's Haile Selassie who pled with the League of Nations to rescue his country from Mussolini's aggression. The long range missiles which the Israelis found concealed in an Iranian ship destined for Gaza could inflict great damage to Tel Aviv., but all parties recognize that U.S. might guarantees Israel's existence.

xxx

We find it reassuring that the stock market continues to signal no serious international strife. The profit element, which is the essence of capitalism, has worldwide appeal.

xxx

Our optimism for the future notwithstanding, most Americans believe that maintaining national military strength and unity are #1 priority.

xxx

They believe that education, at every level including research is the key. Should include subsidizing English teachers worldwide.

March 20, 2014

Frightening that the Boeing 777 with 239 humans aboard could vanish from the skies, yet "pings" indicated that it flew thousands of miles after controller contact lost.

xxx

What a sad commentary on human behavior that the focus of the investigation of the disappearance of the Malaysian plane is now on the theory that one of the pilots deliberately hijacked the plane for unknown purpose. The undertow is the Muslim religion of the pilot. Western civilization must force Muslims to abandon jihad, and tolerate Christianity or die.

xxx

Rachel Canning, 18, sued parents for college tuition though she had voluntarily left their home. Fortunately the New Jersey judge dismissed the complaint and the family was reconciled. The precedent was established. A similar, silly suit in Illinois might succeed if the child driven from home, had sufficient brains for college, and under 23.

xxx

Another possible suit by an ungrateful child against parent(s) might be for inferior mental capacity caused by preconception failure by either parent to evaluate the intelligence of the other.

xxx

There is no demonstrable force to correct the evil god of genetics.

xxx

Paul Ryan, the brainy Wisconsin Congressman who ran with Romney for Vice-President, and dictates GOP Congressional budget proposals, observed that too many generations in the "inner city" have lost the will to work and support themselves, creating an unbearable burden upon those Americans who do work.

xxx

The "Black Congress" immediately jerked Ryan onto their carpet and forced a public "explanation" that he was not being a racist.

xxx

Unfortunate that the national news media did not commend Congressman Ryan for his candor.

xxx

Retired Pope Benedict XVI almost claimed that his popular successor, Pope Francis I, is too tolerant of practices in conflict with the Church's earlier teaching.

xxx

Few, if any, Americans criticized the Chinese, publicly or in their unspoken thoughts, for their

national strict birth control. Without the god-like judgment of the Chinese in this vital matter, World War III for living space would have already begun. But they are only 1/3 of the world population. The other 2/3 must face reality if peaceful co-existence on earth is to continue.

xxx

Does mental health permit the family and friends of those onboard the missing plane to yet hope that it safely landed on some remote island? In World War II an American plane landed itself after the crew bailed out deeper into the Sahara than would-be rescuers searched. Experts have suggested that had they stayed onboard the radio which remained intact could have summoned help.

xxx

One must never give up hope.

March 27, 2014

Many believe that the USA has become as godless as Russia. If true, cause has been the collapse of churches and the ridicule of media entertainment.

xxx

Needed rebirth of faith and church attendance should come from leadership example. Before he occupied the White House, Dwight Eisenhower showed scarce church attendance. While serving as President, he put on his homburg and attended church with regularity.

xxx

It is time for Barack Obama to be pictured attending church, any denomination, including Rev. Wright's, except Muslim.

xxx

The destruction of St. Xavier's in St. Francisville is imminent, unless Bishop Braxton reconsiders. It would be a tragic diminishment of that historic city that must be prevented.

xxx

Press proposes public solicitation of funds, and will contribute the first \$500 to pay the Diocese whatever amount has been agreed upon by the Ridgeway Church for the purchase of the stained glass windows if ownership of the church and parsonage transferred to a not-for-profit corporation. The Board of Directors would be initially appointed by the mayors of Lawrence County, and the church open to the public as a non-denominational house of prayer.

xxx

Further, the Press would assume responsibility for the maintenance of the church, through public solicitation, for the next 20 years.

xxx

We have total confidence in the St. Francisville Police Department and the Denison Fire District to protect the public's house of worship which we have outlined. Such majestic structure would be available for public meetings compatible with faith.

xxx

We pray that His Eminence will "call our hand" by accepting this program for the preservation of an irreplaceable community jewel.

xxx

House Speaker Michael Madigan who has dominated the Legislature for 35 years, has proposed a 3% increase of the state income tax for those earning more than \$1 million per year. His proposal is not as wildly Socialist, soak the rich, as some critics have suggested. It is innovative and necessary if present government expenditures are to continue. Graduated income taxes have been the federal rule since 1916.

xxx

Some fear that the wealthy would flee the state. We doubt that would happen. The strong recognize that they must carry the weak and the fast run for the slow. Obviously, Madigan's proposal will have to extend farther than the super rich; should taper down to the \$100,000 per year.

xxx

The alternative to increased state revenue Madigan seeks is drastically reduced government spending. The Republicans give lip service to that solution but, as they discovered with last fall's partial government shutdown, the public is too accustomed to government handouts to peacefully live without such. That is why the workers will carry the non-workers far into the future.

xxx

Finally, spring has come.

April 3, 2014

Copenhagen Zoo killed a healthy giraffe in public view and fed the meat to lions. They compounded their sang froid by killing the elderly male leader of the pride and a couple of very young cubs.

xxx

Explanation was that they brought in a new male, three years old, that he would have killed the cubs.

xxx

P.E.T.A. erupted We never imagined that we would agree with that group, but have concluded that PETA in correct in demanding boycott of that Zoo, until gentler disposition found for the old animals, and for the young .who might offend the new boss.

xxx

Congressional Republicans are gearing up to fight Obamacare, even to sabotage it. They will find that it is very popular with a majority of Americans, regardless of their financial standing.

xxx

Administration won its case when it announced that seven million had signed up by the March 31 deadline. This was the number Director Sibellius announced as the goal several months ago.

xxx

Interesting to watch N.J. Governor Chris Christie attempt to resurrect his standing as frontrunner for GOP Presidential nomination in 2016.

xxx

Christie made the mandatory trip to Israel to curry favor with the powerful Jewish Lobby in USA. Upon return in speech to latter, he inadvertently referred to West Bank and East Jerusalem as "occupied territories". Audience froze .

xxx

It was a faux pas comparable to his suspected involvement in closing George Washington Bridge to punish a non-cooperative N.J. Mayor.

xxx

The moneyed men who "keepeth watch from the shadows" next floated the balloon of Jeb Bush for President, 2016. We think it is time for a moratorium on Bushes for President.

xxx

Mischievous potential of Labor Board Judge ruling that injured quarterback of the Northwestern football team was an "employee of the University" is unlimited.

xxx

That many college football and basketball teams will form unions to bargain for a portion of the television pie is a certainty.

xxx

Unclear what the university's role in that future, other than to furnish fans.

xxx

Relationship between academic excellence and sports has always been tenuous. May be time to sever.

xxx

Intramural sports for body toning may be the shape of the future.

xxx

April 10, 2014

George W. Bush's demonstrated portrait painting skill was a coup in the public's reevaluation of this much maligned former President. With a few licks of his paintbrush he became Winston Churchillish. Perhaps Jimmy Carter's painting for habitat is more useful, but it lacks the media attracting charisma.

xxx

Bush may have rescued many who would waste retirement watching television. We will watch to see what other retirees are inspired. We have resolved to visit the Presidential Library on the Southern Methodist University campus, Dallas, which we had thought to skip.

xxx

Frontier's new Lawrence County phone book has been distributed. It is even thinner than its predecessor. All the names would fit on a postcard. Obviously its reason for being is the paid advertising. Did the company reduce the rates, or does it claim that the rich and proud, unafraid to have their phone numbers published, are in the book?

xxx

Last week's shooting tragedy at Fort Hood would have been avoided had Major Hasan been publicly hanged four years ago for his 2009 massacre of fellow soldiers at the same Army camp. The mental picture of that jihadist dangling from a rope would have steadied the nerves of Private Lopez who surely would have foreseen the danger of such cowardly behavior.

xxx

What possible justification can there be for not having executed Hasan, and Khalid Mohammed, mastermind of 911, growing fat and old at Guantanamo?

xxx

The pseudo-scientists, aka psychiatrists, should discourage the public from post-traumatic syndrome analysis for every troubled veteran. Latter surely can't have caught that "disease" in rear echelon without experiencing enemy fire.

xxx

Illinois residents too lazy to vote in the March 18 primary, who comprise more than 80% of the eligible, should note the voter turnout in the weekend Afghan election, almost 50%. Such enthusiasm for the essence of democracy was impressive, measured against the loud threats of the troublesome Afghan Taliban.

xxx

We doubt that the total withdrawal of combat troops from Afghanistan by the end of the year will occur. If public spinelessness causes such abandonment, we would hope that the drone technology, so impressively demonstrated against al-Awlaki in Yemen, would be pursued to protect the new democracy for which so many Americans died.

xxx

If our Pakistani allies(?) do not immediately commute the death sentences pronounced against a Christian couple for blasphemy (against Mohammed), there should be drone justice for the presiding judge.

xxx

Our thoughts are not as bloodthirsty as might appear. No Americans are injured in our scenario.

xxx

There is only pretty child in the world, and every mother has it.

- Chinese Proverb

xxx

April 17, 2014

We believe that the public's confidence in the infallibility of "science" is about to be vindicated through location of the wreckage of the Malayasian airplane. As the special submarine maps the floor of the 30,000' deep hole which the "pings" indicate is the plane's resting place, one wonders if we will ever know what force caused this tragedy for so many human beings.

xxx

It would seem irresponsible cruelty for the news media to speculate dissent between pilot and co-pilot based upon a failed cell phone call by the latter at the time the plane lost normal contact with traffic controllers who maintain constant vigil in the world above us.

xxx

As Russia's President Putin plays the heartless banker role of telling the Ukrainian Government to pay billions of euros on its natural gas bill, or face immediate, crippling suspension of delivery of gas, U.S. should be reminded that singular source of any essential is always a potential threat to national well being.

xxx

Some future demented Saudi monarch could put the squeeze on Uncle Sam big time. Our ever cautious environmentalists should permit Keystone pipeline to proceed, guaranteeing access to vast Canadian natural gas. If it proves to be a significant environmental problem, changes can be made.

xxx

Same observation as above in regard to "fracking" to make that would boom if fracking produces even a fraction of the oil its proponents believe.

xxx

How provincial and small minded that our government denied entry visa to the individual. Hamid Aboutaleta, who the Iranian government wished to serve as its ambassador to the United Nations. If New York is be the location of mankind's desperate attempt a world government, we must allow entry to every nation's representative though we suspect, as in this instance, that the nominee participated in the 1979 seizure of the U.S. Embassy in Tehran.

xxx

The significance of having world government in this country, rather than in Geneva which continues to siphon off UN departments, should outweigh the natural desire to punish the 1979 embassy seizure. Some historians claim that embarrassment materially aided Ronald Reagan's defeat of Jimmy Carter in the 1980 presidential election. If so, should our Republican Congressman Shimkus and/or Senator Kirk offer support to let Aboutaleta enter this country?

xxx

We wondered if the shoe throwing incident that interrupted Hillary Clinton's \$50,000/per each speech to fat cats in Las Vegas was scripted. The Clark County Sheriff released the woman who committed such lese majeste, apparently without requiring her to post bond for court appearance on disorderly conduct charge. If any Press reader is in Vegas during next few months, we urge that he/she get the lady's address, from the Courthouse, and check her residence to see if the shoe thrower has "Hillary for President" signs in front yard.

April 24, 2014

Life was simpler, easier when most everyone had a published telephone number. Now only the wealthy, proud and fearless have such luxury.

xxx

What have those who govern done to restore sanity? Nothing!

xxx

The Governor could instruct the Illinois Commerce Commission to decree that rates for stationary phones must be lower than that for cells. The witless public would gallop to return to the old system.

xxx

It is a reflection on civilization's upward and onward march that present impasse is accepted by so many, the docile and xenophobic. Are we alone in our frustration?

xxx

It is a misnomer, even a parody, that the title, "angels of mercy," is bestowed on those whose first question invariably is, "Have you insurance?".

xxx

The deadly stand-off between Russia, the European Union and the USA over Russian President Putin's determination to seize all of the Ukraine which has a Russian speaking majority continues. But few in this country believe that an all-out war is imminent, though the crisis is very similar to Hitler, Sudetenland, Danzig, and the many million deaths that followed.

xxx

Our national serenity in this matter is based on the faith that economic sanctions being applied against Russia will restore sanity to its leader.

xxx

While we believe in the power of sanctions, we shudder as we recall that FDR's oil embargo on Japan caused Pearl Harbor.

xxx

Discouraging that the wizardry of electronics has been unable to locate the Malaysian jetliner. Impressive that so many nations would spend so much in the futile search.

xxx

NBC has apparently concluded that Hillary Clinton will be the next president. Otherwise, why would it headline the news that she's an expectant grandmother? There is reason to hope that neither a Clinton, nor a Bush, will inherit the White House in 2016.

xxx

Where is God when so many Korean school children are drown because the boat crew, captain and shore-side controllers were incompetent?

xxx

Are gamblers' odds sufficient basis for faith? Those who spend a lifetime resisting religion gain nothing if proven correct in their belief that life is nihilistic.

xxx

Spring really is the finest season of the year.

May 1, 2014

Donald Sterling made a billion dollars in Los Angeles real estate. He bought the LA Clippers, an NBA basketball team, as a hobby.

xxx

He is alleged to have ordered his other women not to be photographed with blacks nor to bring them to Clipper games. Arguably, one of the voices on the secretly taped telephone conversation between two humans is his.

xxx

Public screams for Sterling's execution have been led by Reverends Jackson and Sharpton. They appear to demand: (1) That Sterling be banned by Commissioner Silver from owning an NBA team; (2) That fans, regardless of color, boycott all Clipper games.

xxx

Should be noted that NBA is a powerful business held together for 30 years by a clever Hebrew, David Stern. He recognized the incongruity of one race paying another race billions to watch superb athletes put a ball through a hoop ad nauseam.

xxx

Our guess is that Stern held his breath as to when that gigantic bubble of silliness would burst. For the economic well-being of many, one must hope that his successor has similar savvy in public mind manipulation.

xxx

This is a classic case of stupid saviors trying to kill a very productive milch cow for no discernible reason.

xxx

Only Michael Jordan, a truly great basketball player, had the good sense to urge a little restraint in public furor. The evil god of gold may have influenced Jordan; he's an owner of the North Carolina Hornets.

xxx

Momentous as it appeared, Sterling's problem was but a warm-up act in the black and white crises. Cliven Bundy, an impoverished Nevada cattle raiser, refused to pay grazing rights to U. S. Land Management. Bundy instantly became a poster boy for the Tea Party talking heads, Cruz, Paul & Hannity. "Big government stifling free enterprise."

xxx

Television fame was more than Bundy could handle. Unrelated to the cows, he remarked in a broadcast interview, "and a further thing, blacks are better off under slavery than being slaves to the government."

xxx

His creators were stunned, ran to be apart. The President of the United States, on a world tour seeking peace, paused to describe Bundy as ignorant, which seemed overkill.

xxx

If Bundy included all blacks in the better off under slavery category, his comment was too stupid to deserve argument. But if limited to blacks dependent upon government and crime for existence the question is worthy of philosophical debate.

xxx

Millions of blacks, especially in small communities, are assimilated, accepted by their neighbors as equals. The problem is that in the inner city too many blacks are held in the grip of government and/or crime for the necessities of life.

xxx

Society must make a greater educational effort to equip those thus imprisoned with a useful skill.

May 8, 2014

Nigeria has the largest population of any African nation. Almost, 80 billion Thanks to American oil companies it has great potential from oil production.

xxx

It also has too many militant Muslims from whom Allah omitted brains. Their name translates, "Western Education Forbidden." On April 15 these monkeys kidnapped more than 300 teen age Nigerian Boarding School youth, carried them into the jungle and have boasted they will be sold as slaves. While about 100 have escaped, 200+ are yet held.

xxx

Nigeria's weak central government appears unable or unwilling to combat this outrage.

xxx

While the Press is reluctant to ever recommend avoidable war, this might be the instance in which maximum use of drones is necessary to maintain America's moral standing worldwide.

xxx

Even if it becomes necessary to send in the Rangers and Seals to rescue these children, and to send a message to our enemies everywhere, including the Kremlin, we think it should be done, immediately.

xxx

One nation to which we must not send American troops is Ukraine. The world has heard non-stop rhetoric from President Obama, Vice President Biden, S/S Kerry about "serious consequences President Putin if you cross this line," but Russia continued to nibble away. It will swallow the entire nation within 60 days.

xxx

This nation can live with Russia reclaiming what was theirs for centuries so long as we have the cooperation of the Germans

xxx

America is protected by the fear of the Russians of Germany, and the high regard Chinese leaders who would conquer the world have for Japanese soldiers.

xxx

The U.S. should not attempt to change these realities.

xxx

One need not travel thousands of miles to find anarchy. For a year the Sumner City Council has been terrorized by brother alderman named Perrott. During regular council meetings they demand that the Mayor resign. In recent days, Brett is alleged to have sent threatening letters to the Chief of Police that Alderman's resignation should not await the decision of State's Attorney Quick

xxx

While churches everywhere should applaud the Supreme Court opinion that upheld right of Greece, Oklahoma city board to include a prayer in its proceedings, we fear that only a handful of churches nation wide will shout, "Amen."

xxx

Church leadership reluctance to become involved with every aspect of the average citizen's life is what has made so many churches totally irrelevant in the scheme of things.

xxx

Frightening how quickly this school year has gone. Within a week the schools of Unit 10 and 20 will each commence summing up what has been accomplished. Then, those significant careerists called graduation and the brave march into the future.

xxx

Before another school year starts, there needs to be decision on consolidation. Without an influx of new students, some degree of consolidation is an absolute necessity.

xxx

Hooray for the hot weather.

xxx

May 15, 2014

Good news for Donald Sterling, owner of the LA Clipper, before he sold the blacks, pinkos & super sensitive. Unseen who guide public opinion have decreed he can continue to own the ball club and enjoy his senility in peace.

xxx

His rehabilitation commenced Monday evening in an hour long cry on Anderson Cooper show that he loves blacks, loves everyone, is not a racist, was lead to say bad things by a manipulative lady. Re apologized and begged forgiveness non stop.

xxx

His defense was credible—would bar black males from the ball games because he feared their being too close to his black mistress.

xxx

Our guess is that the NBA will decide that Sterling can keep his beloved basketball team, after a one year trusteeship in name of some other family member, not V Stiviano.

xxx

From the ridiculous to the pathetic: Nigerian government shows no determination to rescue the teen age girls kidnapped from their boarding school... Leader of the Boko Haram is too well known to escape determined effort by our drones, liked used so effectively against Yemen cleric al

Awki.

xxx

Perhaps the Nigerian government does not share Western civilization revulsion against those who would cause such misery to prevent education of girls Such insanity should be corrected lethally.

xxx

What a tragedy if the victims convert to Islam while being held captive. Western civilization including college campuses, should refuse any tolerance to any Muslim group which sympathizes Boko Haram bestiality.

xxx

The banjo player who accompanies Monte McKillup in Chevron's annual salute to the memory of Texaco Refinery mentioned that Stephen Hawking, the guru of many who believe that science is god communicates with his computer by brain waves. We doubted such out of this world connection.

xxx

Theory and workable model may seem too close to fail Though science appears focused toward that goal, we cannot conceive such miracle.

xxx

We found it discouraging that already this year, more than 1000 Americans have voluntarily surrendered their passports in renunciation of citizenship. Usual reason given for such drastic action is avoidance of taxes. That's nonsense; other countries tax at higher rate.

xxx

Americans should work together to stop this affront to our promised land Perhaps our penal system is too unforgiving? Less government regulation must be the goal Our government should defend its citizens unfairly restrained overseas swiftly and firmly.

xxx

"Proud to be an American should be the theme song for every citizen."

xxx

The spotlight of public attention has been turned off Russian President Putin's continuing take over of Ukraine. We agree with our masters—it was not casus belli.

xxx

May 22, 2014

.We hope that our readers noted that LA Clipper owner Don Sterling is making a come back. Calling a person a "racist" is no longer a death sentence. Depends on how the word is defined. If thinking self "better than another," all ambitious people are racist.

xxx

There never was a Hebrew who didn't think himself superior to all encountered. Often they prove that superiority. That's Sterling's trump card.

xxx

How odd of God to choose the Jews. Not odd of God. Goyim annoy 'em. But not so odd as those who choose

A Jewish God Yet spurn the Jews.

— Ogden Nash

xxx

Nations need live symbols. British monarchy has existed more than 1,000 years. Last week the Canadians fawned over Prince Charles and Princess Camellia. Simultaneously, the Australians and New Zealanders displayed their reverence for Prince William and the Duchess of Cambridge.

xxx

American movie and television stars have such demonstrable human frailties they are inadequate

national symbols. Might we enthrone former presidents without violating the stern Biblical rule, "Thou shall have no other gods before me."?

xxx

Matters not that our former presidents are viewed with various degrees of respect. Neither were the Greek demi-gods equal.

xxx

On wonders why it has taken so long for the CIA to dispatch the Nigerian Boko Haram leader, Abubakar Shekau. That Osama bin Laden wannabe's address is well known.

xxx

If President Obama would give the signal to thus solve international embarrassment of kidnapping school girls, their safe return to parents would be greatly enhanced.

xxx

It is encouraging that Russian/Greek Orthodox hierarchy are meeting with their counter parts from the Roman Catholic Church for closer collaboration.

xxx

For almost a century American news media has described Russia as godless. Yet Putin is photographed in church more often than Obama.

xxx

No explanation offered for President Putin's decree that profanity be barred from Russian films. Sometimes one wonders whether American dedication to freedom of speech is responsible for public vulgarity.

xxx

LHS Principal Paul Higginbotham may have unintentionally fingered Lawrence County's problem in his graduation remarks, Sunday, "When you come back to this building 30 years from now you

will remember that yours was the first graduating class."

xxx

The tragedy is that too many of our graduates move away. We simply must create more business/job opportunities that they might brighten the corner where they were born.

xxx

May 29, 2014

Regrettable that Lawrenceville Swimming Pool did not open Memorial Day, as was once the practice. That weekend brought out the greatest number of swimmers in pricey years, Present management aims for June 2 opening. Too little, too late

xxx

Lawrenceville City Hall announcement of raise in water rates is a train wreck in slow time. Our struggling community did not need that added handicap. Should have been avoided — even by reduction in personnel.

xxx

Under 5000 population municipalities are never taken very seriously. Might be worthwhile to encourage Nob Hill, and other just across the line settlements to support annexation.

xxx

We need a "welcome wagon", as the Chamber of Commerce inspired 50 years ago. The goodies in the wagon should include \$100 cash, raised by passing the hat it such required, but payable only to new citizens who file income tax returns. A city can have too many members who are not required to file an annual income tax return.

xxx

Most painless path to more citizens for Lawrence-County might be an unwritten law that no group dispensing taxpayer dollars will hire non-resident if qualified "local" available.

xxx

The record of both school districts appears indifferent to economic survival of the county. Teachers and craftsmen employed in this county would make excellent new investments.

xxx

Painfully numerous are the fronts upon which there have been Lawrence County slippage. For more than half a century the skilled, resident Kolter girls, Margaret & Cathy, furnished that specialty for our courts. Now our reporter comes from Crawford (Tracy Akin), Richland, (Robin O'Neal) and Wabash (Sylvia Harrawood.) Talented ladies all, but they should live in Lawrence County. Same with Public Defender Charles Bradley Vaughn.

xxx

Enough of our negative carping, Lawrence County tans swelled with pride listening to Ashlaw Nelms sing at the Memorial Day services, Lawrenceville City Cemetery. Hooray for Asher's poem (Tracy Akin) for McDonalds' for bringing such favorable notice to County Lawrence.

xxx

When one has nothing to do, the mind is asleep. - mine

xxx

You can discover what your enemy fears most by observing the means he uses to frighten you.

-Eric Hoffer.

xxx

June 5, 2014

Some wise person has written, "The price of everything is the amount of life which must be exchanged for it." Surprising how many things cost life itself, and yet are found irresistible by many.

xxx

Health advocates would ban many foods and practices which are demonstrably detrimental to

health. Their rationale is compelling, "The pleasure these foods and practices bring are outweighed by the adverse effect on life itself."

xxx

The counter-argument is "One can't live forever, why not enjoy even though life is shortened?". Rarely does one hear even when the consequences of this conduct has brought user to the brink of eternity, "Had I known I would have done differently."

xxx

We remember a clever professor at the University of Illinois 70 years ago, "Automobiles cause 35,000 deaths a year. If the question had been posed by the auto makers 35 years earlier, We will bring society a marvelous means of transportation, but we'll extract 35,000 lives selected at random as the price of this machine, would a civilized society have responded, 'We'll buy it.'?"

xxx

Gambling is a deadly addiction, a vice whose attraction has grown over the centuries. Today, the majority of the State Legislatures have chosen gambling as a major income producing policy. How can it be recognized as affordable when measured against the cost extracted from traditional values?

xxx

Illinois recently became the 50th state to license the carrying of a concealed firearm. Last month, a privileged youth in Santa Monica shot and killed five girls and self. Such tragedy is not isolated. Multi sayings by guns occur nationwide with sickening frequency. The cost of the "freedom" to carry a concealed weapon is presently too high to justify its continuance. That menace to life and limb should be suspended until psychiatric tests devised to exclude potential mass killers.

xxx

Society needs to reexamine the cost of carrying a concealed weapon for the safety and benefit of all. Not should any give credence to the argument that an armed public is necessary to prevent tyrannical government. We've never had a political leader in the history of the USA who showed any such delusions.

xxx

Curiously, mountain climbing may be a sport too dangerous, too costly in human lives to justify its tolerance, even encouragement. Last month three experienced climbers were killed on Mt. Rainier, in an avalanche. Earlier in the year six expert Sherpa guides were killed on Mt. Everest.

xxx

Could not the same thrill of being on top of the mountain be obtained, at a lower cost in human lives, in a helicopter?

xxx

We admire the ability of Facebook to provoke instant, clever blogs to provocative statements. Newspapers would have a better survival rate if comparable response occurred.

xxx

June 12, 2014

News media has decreed political correctness in public idols. Steve Coburn had reached that exalted status by being a visible/vocal co-owner of California Chrome, winner of the Kentucky Derby and the Preakness, and by being a working man in the sport of the wealthy.

xxx

When the unthinkable happened, Saturday, CC was soundly beaten in the Belmont Stakes, a visibly distraught Coburn erupted on national television other owners were "cowards" for skipping the exhausting Derby & Preakness races to have fresh horses to run in the Belmont, to prevent a "triple crown" winner for 36 years.

xxx

NBC's Bob Costas magnified such gross breach of etiquette by asking the patrician owner of Belmont winner, "Tonalist" within two minutes, to comment on Coburn's claim. Secure in the fact that rules for running in the Belmont had not been changed in 100 years. Mr. Evans sniffed "I will not go there"

xxx

We admired Coburn for his unvarnished candor. Though common sense and some racing experts agree that it is not kosher to require a weary winner to beat fresh competition to be "triple crown" winner, all knew that systemic pressure would cause Coburn to wilt. Within 48 hours, he begged the public to forgive him—for telling the truth.

xxx

Incidentally, the Press handicapper, relying on Derby time being almost five seconds slower than Secretariat's in 1973 win, predicted CC's loss. He will have another chance to prove that he is the super horse that captured the racing world's heart in the Breeder's Cup, November 1.

xxx

Another champion fell last week: Dr. Alexander Imich, NYC, died at 111. This Polish emigré had survived a Russian gulag 60 years ago. His reign as "world's oldest man" lasted only six months. He was younger than 65 living women.

xxx

'Midst national furor over concealed delay in medical care for veterans it was reassuring that VA Hospital at Marion received minimal complaint from former patients. Many were complimentary. And grateful.

xxx

As one grows older, the wait period before a special day passes more quickly. For us, the 10 days before the summer solstice go with extraordinary speed.

xxx

One should savor every day , particularly the daylight hours, whether they be expanding, or contracting.

xxx

We forgot to mention to Governor-to-be Bruce Rauner when in County Lawrence, Friday, statewide need for cell phone directory. Would cost cash strapped Illinois nothing, but would save

his frustrated constituents hours of frustration.

xxx

The game plan would be quite simple cell phone numbers would be permanently assigned, like SS #s. Applicants would be required to consent to publication of those numbers.

xxx

Until then, we shall continue grateful for each rich, proud friend who has published phone number.

xxx

June 19, 2014

Defeat of Eric Cantor in the Virginia primary was a Republican disaster. He was the only Jewish Republican Congressman. Though a token, he held a significant position, majority leader, and provided the party's last, best hope to break the Jewish tradition of voting solidly Democratic.

xxx

The USA is closer to the Greek concept of democracy, roll-call on every decision, than ever before.

xxx

The individual public will is being expressed and heard through public opinion polls. In 1997, Pew Institute reported 27% of the American public favored gay marriages. In 2014, Pew reported public opinion now supports gay marriages, 54%. Hillary Clinton, a politician with a highly tuned ear to the public will, switched sides. She was against gay marriage when husband signed the Defense of Marriage Act, but now supports such marriages.

xxx

Referring every question to the public for a nose count decision may become feasible through the wizardry of electronics. Then, as now, the danger remains of evil forces tampering with the figures.

xxx

Is the public decision preferable to the present system wherein public opinion is formed by strong leaders?

xxx

General Sherman expressed his disdain for public wisdom in partial Latin, "vox populi es vox bunco."

xxx

One would have thought that our leaders would have contemplated the probability of an all Malawi Shiite army collapsing in Iraq, and immediately have rescue plan in place.

xxx

Last week that collapse occurred. President Obama and Secretary of State Kerry are negotiating with Iran for permission to send aircraft carriers into the Persian Gulf. So far Iran has said "No." That's leadership from the rear.

xxx

The Iraqi Sunnis are fiercer fighters than the Shiites, though outnumbered three to two. They are each our enemy. We should stand aloof and watch them murder each other until Allah orders a halt to their senseless behavior.

xxx

The American Embassy in Baghdad is more than the conventional embassy. It is a fortress designed to withstand the humiliation of Benghazi, Khartoum, and Tehran. If the Sunni insurgents overran Baghdad, as now seems likely, we may see Cleric al Sadr, a vicious anti-American, flee to our embassy. That will be poetic justice.

xxx

Lawrenceville has state-of-the-art water treatment; yet mere bottled water is being sold than ever before. Why?

xxx

A personal apology to the ArtWine promoters for failure to have the doors open at 1109 & 1113 State and 717 - 12th for Saturday's delightful party. We were distracted by other problems. Guarantee that each will be in operation for the Fall Festival, even if for shuffleboard.

xxx

Summer comes tomorrow. It is the grandest season of the year.

xxx

June 26, 2014

Our friend, Karl Koerge, continues to bombard with condemnation of former VP Cheney's criticism of President Obama's handling of the Iraq government collapse. We don't print KK's interesting, biased comments because, while he who beats a dead horse." History will render final verdict on Cheney, a chief architect of the Iraqi misadventure. We always believed that Wolfowitz and Paul Bremer equally culpable.

xxx

Another dead horse, albeit aristocratically poised, being beaten by Republican strategists, is Hillary Clinton. They won't quit repeating Karl Rove's diagnosis of brain damage from a fall, and from stale claim that she was unethical, as a defense attorney fresh out of Yale Law School, in securing slap on wrist punishment for a guilty rapist. "Victim" was resurrected to publicly proclaim that "Hillary, put me through hell" while defending client known by her to be guilty, thereby showing that her concern for women's rights is non-existent.

xxx

Nonsense to argue that a defense lawyer is a scoundrel merely because he/she succeeded in defending scum. In every criminal prosecution the cards are stacked against the defense. Latter should be allowed space for innovation. Otherwise, the process is kangaroo to conviction.

xxx

Many Americans doubted that the Brazil had the infrastructure to successfully host the World Cup, this year, and the Olympics, in 2016, even after Rio de Janeiro was chosen over Chicago for

the Olympic site. While chaotic in hosting the World Cup last week and this, Rio stumbled acceptably through, and will confound its critics in the larger Olympics.

xxx

While on the subject of courtroom defense of the unpopular, impoverished, unwashed accused, we express our belief that rarely, if ever, is an innocent convicted. To say that many "innocent" have been executed is hogwash. When a conviction is reversed on appeal for some procedural error, case sent back to the trial court for re-trial, if prosecutor decides not to retry—witnesses become too old or unwilling—charges dropped. Conviction may have been improper, but defendant not innocent.

xxx

Gordon Chelsea J. Gomez, 30, Bridgeport, was fined \$750 plus \$498 costs, February

(Continued on page 4)

July 3, 2014

"Land of the free, home of the brave," the proud national ideal is in danger of becoming a mockery on account of governmental regulation

xxx

The late George Orwell saw the peril approaching 50 years ago. Unfortunate that his epic, "1984," was a warning unheeded...

xxx

Seventy-five years ago the American public was told that an evil country called Germany numbered its members, paid its unmarried maidens to have babies, and watched the members' every move. The USA has copied these evils in toto

xxx

It is arguable whether individual freedom in the USA is greater than that in any of the dictatorships we so piously condemned. Try to gain entrance to any public building without at least one form of picture identification, or even to open a bank account to prove that government

has a record of you...

xxx

Power to the people sounds better than it plays.

Year after year the same individuals, as elected public servants, control our destiny. That observable development has made democracy a joke.

xxx

How can this present melancholy situation be reversed, and individual liberty reborn? By term limits for every elected official.

xxx

There is a courageous effort, led by the Governor to be Bruce Rauner to bring term limits to Illinois. Within a few days, a Cook County Court will rule on whether the people will have an opportunity to vote on term limits in the November 4, 2014 general election. It is likely that there will be an appeal to the Illinois Supreme Court of the trial court's decision on proposed Constitutional amendment which will make term limits possible for members of the General Assembly.

xxx

Hope that the court will let the bell of liberty ring, that the people might be heard. If this comes to pass it will be a great day for individual liberty.

(Continued on page 4)

xxx

The hottest place on earth is Dallol, Ethiopia, with an annual mean temperature of 94 degrees.

xxx

July 10, 2014

It is incongruous for any courthouse office to refuse to accept personal checks. Yet, one often sees in those centers of authority signs that proclaim, "No personal checks."

xxx

The state's attorney of each county should hold a seminar for his/ her timid companions in public service and advise, "this office will collect instant any check that bounces."

xxx

There can be no more persuasive tool to guarantee that a check will be paid than the jail door.

xxx

The policy we advocate is the right psychological move to inspire public confidence in and commitment to law abidance. Nor is any expenditure of taxpayer monies required to enforce.

xxx

Within a day or so, the South African jury will return its verdict in the murder trial of the Olympic amputee runner Oscar Pretorius. We think that he will be found "not guilty by reason of temporary insanity."

xxx

If a guilty verdict is returned, the Court will find reason that he not be imprisoned. National symbols cannot be replaced.

xxx

This may be a case that should never have been brought. There are no unpunished crimes. He must love the balance of his life with the knowledge that his poor judgment caused one he apparently once loved to die.

xxx

We recognize that our rationale should never be applied to insensitive accused. We suggest that

neither an expensive clinical psychologist, nor psychiatrist, is needed by prosecutors and judges smart enough to get elected in their determination of whether the accused lacks a moral compass.

xxx

Surprising that al Maliki thinks he is indispensable to lead Iraq though every faction, including the godfather, President Obama has asked that he step aside that a leader who can unite that troubled nation be found.

xxx

When we saw that old cleric with the beard ex tolling the Shi ites in the mosque to volunteer to join the jihad against the Sunnis we wondered at the gullibility of the Iraqi people.

xxx

Then we thought of the Arizona voters who send John McCain back to the U.S. Senate for almost 40 years. If term limits do not become the law of the land, future elections should be labeled, "for amusement only."

July 17, 2014

The Iraqi disaster suggests that nation building by the U.S. is too expensive for results obtained to justify expansion. Yet, weekend agreement Secretary of State Kerry reached in Afghanistan with two presidential candidates over the weekend is being hailed as progress.

xxx

An election was held last month for successor to outgoing President Hamid Karzai. That sly politician who has a brother in the grocery business in Michigan and was installed by the U.S. Army & State Department has recently taken out "life insurance" by increasingly anti-A m e r i c a n speeches .Though election results have not been announced, supporters of the two top candidates, former Finance Minister Ashraf and former Foreign Minister Abdullah, claimed fraud in the election and threatened civil war unless another, expensive, internationally supervised election held.

xxx

Kerry's "breakthrough" is a physical recount of eight million ballots. They will be , helicoptered by

U.S. to Kabul for individual checking, including allegations of fraud. Cost to the U.S. will exceed one hundred million dollars. Whether the losing candidate will keep promise to congratulate and cooperate with the winner is problematic. Likely that the winner will be deposed by the Taliban within 30 days after American soldiers come home. Money could be far better spent building Four Lanes for Route 50 in the U.S.A.

xxx

Democracy is not for every country. It is dependent upon a literate electorate. The U.S.A. barely qualifies for that blessing. We should cease trying to install democracy in any country lacking that foundation for its survival.

xxx

Vanity Fair has published more of the tapes made during the Richard Nixon presidency. the picture that emerges is a far more compassionate, tolerant, puritanical leader than his numerous critics claim. In conversation with Haldeman and Kissinger, he expressed surprise that women sometimes swore like men. Surely, he was not as isolated the White House as suggested by a repeat from our late friend Perry Piper of conversation with Nixon at the cattle barn, Illinois State Fair, circa 1973, "I only know what they (his aides) want me to know."

xxx

Public interest in the additional tapes suggests that Nixon's mystic hold on a nation is not erased, it is merely dormant. Perhaps his day historians will vindicate his leadership. But obviously he was a shy politician which is an oxymoron. We were impressed by his concern for the future of this nation if the moral values of the people and its leaders faltered, as he, Kissinger & Haldeman considered the debauchery of the Romans under Nero.

xxx

AP maligned Ft. Sill when they described that 150 year old major Army installation as "an outpost in hot dusty south Oklahoma." Sill has been chosen by U.S. Immigration to house thousands of teen age illegal immigrants, mainly from Mexico and Central America, as they await hearing on deportation charges. AP believed the locale would diminish the vision detainees had of an opulent America.

xxx

Several Lawrence Countians have served at Ft. Sill. We know none who does not have an affection for the post. We recall the first sergeant advising 19 year old artillery recruits in June-August, "You will find the ranges very warm, but a wind comes off Medicine Mountain in the evening. You will sleep under a blanket."

xxx

Of the detainees, we wish them well in their efforts to persuade the immigration judge to permit them to remain in the USA.

xxx

We suspect that American munitions makers are using present war between Israel & Palestine, the "iron shield", designed to destroy incoming rockets.

xxx

It will be unfortunate if the the interceptors are proven 100% effective Such would lessen the mutual deterrent now preventing nuclear war between super powers.

xxx

As one watches Israel's merciless pounding of the civilians crowded together in Gaza, one is reminded of the Jews in the Warsaw ghetto who came out of hiding and fought the German as Russian Army restless appeared imminent. Perversely, the Russians stalled to permit the German massacre to continue. Other side of coin is that the Gaza civilians obviously make no effort to restrain Hamas militants from raining missiles on Israel. Mutual self interest should stop this war.

xxx

Next week back to school ads will be in full bloom. Where did the summer go?

July 24, 2014

We are in total agreement with our friend Karl if he extends his abhorrence of Putin to the entire Soviet hierarchy as does former VP Cheney, and is vilified by leftwing media for his realism.

xxx

Regardless of how painful the sanctions which President Obama, and the European Union inflict on Russia, there is no danger of Putin launching WWII. He can count, and knows that in the next war the U.S. will stand with Germany.

xxx

If democracy were more than a word in Russia, Putin would be forced from office, on a Russian vote of , "no confidence". Rep. King, NY, said it best, "he does fit well in civilized society."

xxx

To show our revulsion from Putin & Company, we will no longer serve Russian caviar at parties in the Law Factory.

xxx

Couple of parting thoughts on Koertge: his submitted criticism of Sarah Palin was clever, but too violent for our editorial board. He blames McCain for her escape from the snowbanks. The truth is she has a charm that older American males find irresistible.

xxx

In another broadside, Mr. Koertge lamented, "a new American fighter plane program will cost more than a \$600,000 dwelling for every homeless family in the world". Quoting Karl's idol, JFK, "America will pay any price to protect freedom", Besides, many homeless make no effort to justify their existence, by any useful service to society, and do not deserve luxury.

xxx

The enormity of the Russian crime against humanity is not diminishing by pointing out that last week the Israelis murdered as many Gazan civilians as was the loss of life in downing of Malaysian Flight MH17.

xxx

The Gaza-Israeli tragedy got far less media coverage than the plane massacre.

xxx

There is some excuse for Israelis murdering Gazans, "they permitted Hamas to launch rocket attacks upon us." The entire scenario indicates how dangerous the world, how essential United States spend whatever the cost to shield us from our enemies.

xxx

As for the Israelis, they should reconsider how nicely the entire state would fill in Southern Illinois—in peaceful prosperity.

xxx

One should celebrate daily how great to be alive in this exciting world.

xxx

I think dogs are the most amazing creatures; they give unconditional love. For me they are the role model for being alive.

— Gilda Radner

Roscoe's Journal — Part 004

July 31, 2014

We pray that President Obama finds the courage of his leadership. Specifically, he should send a couple thousand soldiers into Nigeria & Cameroon this week. He doesn't need a declaration of war to apprehend international criminals. The leadership of Bok Haram qualify to be drone targets, in the splendid tradition of the dispatch of the late Osama bin Laden, and Yemen's cleric, al Wiliki.

xxx

Though Africa's greatest oil producer, Nigeria is without a government strong enough to stop Bok Haran after those criminals kidnapped 200 teen age girls, more than three months ago. Their only

offense was attending a Christian school! Over the weekend these fanatics kidnapped the wife of the prime minister of adjacent Cameroon.

xxx

A quick surgical strike and American soldiers on the ground would restore civilization to those two countries. Thoughtful world leaders would applaud. Significant oil production and reserves would be safeguarded for future American need. Why the delay?

xxx

Solution of the Israeli holocaust against the million and half terrified civilians almost defenseless in Gaza is not so simple. Israel must defend its people from rocket attacks launched from that Biblical town. Unless and until the Muslim world recognizes Israel's right to exist, this tragic war will continue until the Israelis agree to be transplanted to Southern Illinois, lock, stock and wailing wall.

xxx

The Duke Law School must be embarrassed by the profanity spoken by its prize graduate, Richard Nixon. He knew as he spoke that his words were being recorded. Out of character that he would use language that makes him appear uncouth. Present media emphasis on the taped profanity gives a distorted picture of Nixon's presidency. History will record that he opened trade with China, and thereby made Wal Mart possible. Few American presidents changed this nation, for the better, more than Nixon.

xxx

We intend to lure Karl Koertge into becoming a regular contributing editor to the Press if the violence of his thinking can be controlled. The e-mails lengthy, thoughtful quotes from Andrew O'Hehir. We invite Karl to condense his commentary on that writer to our available space. Any of his observations which the Press publishes must conceal his conviction that all Republicans are evil.

xxx

Why all the wringing of hands and soul searching that execution of a couple murderers took longer than expected? The end result was worth whatever overtime expense incurred in

dispatching these criminals.

xxx

Government should concentrate on protecting its law abiding citizens by executing every defendant convicted of first degree murder. We were impressed by, and agreed with, some Federal Judge who urged that the firing squad be returned as a means of execution.

xxx

Condemned murderers deserve the execution some Indians favored: Securely tie the criminal naked, near an ant hill, on a hot sunny day without shade. The ACLU would probably object to that form of execution, too.

xxx

Only 98 days until election. All concerned with Lawrence County's future should explain to their friends and neighbors that Lawrence County's future will be brighter if Bruce Rauner is elected governor.

August 7, 2014

Americans believe that every human activity is best performed in this country; as compared with all other nations of the world. A French refugee from Hitler, Maurice Schwartz, made this observation to us at the U of I, 1941. He asked, "why do American writers refer to every American boxing champion as 'world champion'?"

xxx

Our certainty of American superiority was shaken last week by a story from S. Korea. Their baseball stadiums suffer from same lack of spectators as do ours. To conceal the empty bleachers from television cameras hundreds of wired mannequins were placed in empty seats. Then came their ingenuity, selected fans were each given a control box by which each could control a mannequin, causing him to cheer, boo, gesture, etc.

xxx

The frightening thought followed: USA has no comparably clever response to low attendance at baseball games.

XXX

The struggle to remain #1 is never ending. We must each try harder that our national pride be deserved.

XXX

Readers will remember that four years ago the Press offered to publish alphabetically, for free, the name and cell phone number for each who responded. A time saving cell phone number book would have been thereby created. The response was unanimously-negative.

XXX

One would have thought that present insane requirement that phone users waste hours each day searching for cell phone numbers would prove intolerable, causing government to ride to the rescue. No such luck. Nor has the problem cured itself.

XXX

What a boon to Illinois if the General Assembly and Governor Rauner enact a law making assignment of cell phone numbers permanent, and require that they be published.

XXX

When we run for the school board, we will promise each voter that each school year will commence on day after Labor Day, and end on day before Memorial Day, just as our ancestors intended.

XXX

Lawrence County Young Republicans of the late 1960s remember affectionately James Brady, who died over the weekend, in Alexandria, VA, at 73. Genial, witty, this Centralia native was Press Secretary to President Reagan. He suffered crippling brain injury 3/15/81, when Hinckley attempted to assassinate Reagan "Diamond Jim" was a skilled organizer, had contagious enthusiasm, successfully touted state and national candidates.

XXX

Though the rains came as the crops needed, the Wabash River will be non navigable by August 15. Already one needs skilled river person on board, from the Port of Francisville, to steer away from the concealed sandbars. Division of Waterways, D.O.T., should send one of its barges to clear the channel of that would be area jewel.

xxx

School resumes one week from tomorrow. Unless August temperatures mimic July's delightful coolness, it is safely predictable that several school days will be lost, "too hot for school."

xxx

We fear that historians will equate "Gaza" with "Auschwitz" in recognition of tragic loss of life, especially school children and other civilians from Israeli shelling.

xxx

Why the Palestinians do not stop Hamas & and other fighters from launching rockets from their territory defies reason. Perhaps there areas some Israeli general as famously said, "no innocent civilians."

xxx

The barbarism of war aside, humanity can never countenance the slaying of the unarmed.

xxx

Time, which changes people, does not alter the image we have retained of them.

-Marcel Proust

xxx

August 14, 2014

"Life is but a shadow. A poor stick of a player who struts, and frets, his hour upon the stage. And then is heard no more." Shakespeare--Macbeth, Act V

xxx

When the hour is greatly extended, the complications to the next wave of humanity, are many , e.g. Queen Elizabeth II, 62 years on the British throne, determined to top great-great grandmother, Queen Victoria's record 64 years, chafing on the sidelines is Prince Charles, heir apparent since he was born November 14, 1948.

xxx

One senses that the news media has written off Prince Charles, as no longer worthy of the coverage Fleet Street usually gives British royalty succession. During last few years, British news media has focused on Prince William as heir apparent to the throne. Within the past year, they have transferred their attention to William and Kate's son, Prince George, as the fair haired boy who will one day occupy the British throne.

xxx

Comparable impatience as with royal succession not occurring on schedule is found among all commoners, everywhere on the pattern of life.

xxx

National patterns of longevity create problems of remaining competitive in a world of challenge. Experts note that Japan has more old folks than other industrialized nations, lowering its per capita productivity and ability to compete.

xxx

Perhaps the burden of caring for the old was a factor in alleged policy of some Eskimos to place their elderly in boats, with warm clothes, food for several days and shove them out to sea ? Those who fondly contemplate retirement should ask themselves what useful service they will render for mankind that their extra hour upon the stage not be resented by their successors.

xxx

Too soon to be certain but the European Union and the U.S. may have landed a knockout blow against Russian President Putin's popularity with the Russian people. The Ukrainian Army proved more resilient than any of the "talking heads" contemplated. It surrounded the pro-Russian forces

in East Ukraine's largest city, Donetsk, and tightened the noose until the pro-Russian forces ask for a truce to remove their fighters and civilians who wished to move to Moscow

xxx

Putin may claim that annexation of Crimea more than offsets the setback at Donetsk. We doubt that the Russian public will reach same conclusion. Unlike the less informed days of Josef Stalin, favorable opinion of the Russian public is a requisite for a would be dictator to remain in charge.

xxx

If this crisis plays out as we have suggested, without Putin plunging Russia into large scale war, it will be a great triumph for E.U. & U.S. and for worldwide collective security, in peace.

xxx

A correspondent for The Economist asked Turkish President Erdogan, "In an Islamic nation may one ever ask "why?" (for a controversial national position) Erdogan's revealing response, "woman, remember your place."

xxx

For many years, the U.S. government has attempted to sell the idea that Erdogan is a "moderate" Muslim, and that Turkey is sufficiently westernized (under Kemal Attaturk) to fit smoothly into the European Union

xxx

We think that Erdogan is no better than any other Muslim, that all are a menace to American values and should be isolated in a freedom loving world. Franklin Graham said it best, long ago, "Islam is a cruel religion."

xxx

The atrocities the shock troops for Islam, ISIS et al., have committed against Christians and Yazidis in Iraq during the last month should justify reclassifying Muslims as a cult, rather than continuing the nonsense that they are a religion entitled to our constitutional protection

August 21, 2014

Rick Perry became Governor of Texas when George Bush went to Washington, 2000. He holds the record for years served as Texas Governor. Highly respected, he sought the GOP presidential nomination in 2012 ; and may try again in 2016. Shocking that a partisan grand jury would indict him for expanding authority of the Governor beyond the constitutional limits.

xxx

Significantly, national media gave the indictment only momentary notice. One would have expected every talking head on television to proclaim Governor Perry "dead meat." Experts reminded that Congressman Robert DeLay, highly effective congressional "whip" while Bush in the White House, was indicted by same Austin grand jury for campaign fund irregularities, and actually convicted by a jury. The conviction was set aside on appeal.

xxx

Texans need to quit using the courts for their political battles if their judicial system is to be taken seriously by other states.

xxx

When Texaco and Marathon abandoned Lawrence County, we've many feared for our County's future. Pioneer Oil and Rex Energy have stepped into the breach. As soon as these naysayers on "fracking" go away, our departed benefactors will be forgotten .

xxx

We have grown weary of those politicians who proclaim that our armed forces are "most powerful on earth." It's time for performance. Our friends will cheer, our enemies will fear if the assassination of the leadership of the Islamic State can be effected within the next few weeks. These are the mad men who behead Christian males in terrorized NE Iraq who fail to convert to Islam. Their bestial conduct deserves the violence we recommend.

xxx

If the industrialized nations of the world continue to stand united against Russia in sanctions imposed for its attempt to dismember Ukraine, there is no way Putin can win, nor do we believe that he is sufficiently insane to launch World War III. The bullies of the past were all before

atomic warfare. If trade sanctions succeed, mankind will have found a powerful new tool with which to preserve worldwide peace.

xxx

We would think more highly of Rev. A. L. Sharpton if he marched with the rioters in Ferguson, Mo. rather giving them pep talks to destroy their own buildings, which seems silly, and actually incur the considerable danger of continuing to defy the law.

xxx

Obviously there should have been more minority representation on the Ferguson Police force; but when will there be affirmative action for white ball players?

xxx

The Ladner Building on State Street in the county seat will be ready for a second dedication within two months. It is a thing of beauty, purged of every possible life threatening virus, bug, or evil spirit. Completed three years ago, it has undergone a complete rebuilding. Word on the street was that over zealous inspector found a speck of mold and decreed the overkill. Matters not that "mold" has replaced "asbestosis" as the magic word to require horrendous repair cost

xxx

Long live United Health. Determination with which it has pursued the repair of the Ladner Building suggest that fit will remain a mainstay in Lawrence County far into the future. We are glad that Rooney family chose United Health to carry on the grand tradition when they grew weary.

August 28, 2014

Sixty years ago, Ruth Garrett, Lawrence County Public Aid Supervisor, (now euphemistically called "Human Resources") to conceal any stigma from being society's burden chaired periodic luncheon meetings of county officials. Purpose was to identify county problems and seek solutions.

xxx

As State's Attorney, I participated in such meetings and was startled how unanimous the group's

finding that mental health was the greatest health problem confronting Lawrence County.

xxx

In spite of a commendable effort, by every branch of government over the years to diagnose, treat and cure, it remains my belief that mental health irregularities restrict more Lawrence County citizens than the next two maladies combined.

xxx

Almost 100 years after Sigmund Freund, effective treatment of irregularities in the thinking process remains in its infancy. Nor is this melancholy lack of progress unique to Lawrence County. It is nationwide.

xxx

The problem is demonstrated, and we believe even exacerbated, by our government overselling "privacy". Citizens who cannot spell the word invoke it as though it were a "cure all". Call any hospital and ask if Jane Doe is a patient. Invariably, the operator, emboldened by a mystic concept never seen, replies, "I am sorry but "hippa" does not permit us to answer your question."

xxx

It were as though the law of common sense had been repealed. After a couple more thrusts at the paid employee hiding behind a curtain of ignorance, parroting the same nonsensical reply, the caller is justified to bluntly inquire. "why do you answer the phone if you can give no information?"

xxx

The causal relation between mental health and the overselling of "privacy" is also revealed by asking the afflicted the cell phone number of a third party. Tragically, many reply, "I cannot reveal the number to you, but I will tell him/her that you wish to talk." The absurdity of that response is indicated by original inquirer responding, "No, I do not wish to give my unpublished number to him/her, or anyone. I, too, have the right of privacy."

xxx

Blanket repeal of all privacy laws is not an acceptable solution. Perhaps other health problems should not be revealed to the public, nor business transactions including amount of money one has, or owes. Our legislators should enumerate the facets of life one may keep secret, notwithstanding Benjamin Franklin's wise observation, "three can keep a secret if two are deceased."

xxx

We will know that there is hope for the future when a law is passed that all cell phone numbers must be published. Second law should require cost of operation of stationary phone be no higher than for a cell. It would restore pride to the thrifty, and give better reception.

September 4, 2014

Labor Day ties Martin Luther King Day as the worst fraud against our national productivity

xxx

Impossible to turn back the clock on a giveaway program, but if Labor Day is to remain on the books, should change name to Labor-Employer Day to bring balance to its observance.

xxx

Too often being rich is merely the consolation prize for old age.

xxx

A significant step in the secularization of the USA was the Supreme Court decision, 1947, banning school prayer.

xxx

Church resistance to that assault on faith was weak.

xxx

The authors of that decision have each gone to his reward.

xxx

If any were alive, we doubt that he would approve the direction the decision pointed government.

xxx

Few who cherish human liberty would find a theocracy (Iran) tolerable, but neither is the exclusion of religion from government, and its citizenry.

xx

Friday, Russian President Putin blustered against the European Union and the USA, who have attempted for several months to force the Russians to retreat from their goal of annexing Ukraine. Said this would be Hitler, "none should meddle with us, we are nuclear armed."

xxx

It would helpful for a restoration of sanity in this matter if President Obama's facebook included pictures of Hiroshima & Nagasaki, taken in late August, 1945.

xxx

Ironically, it is neither prayer nor nuclear stockpile which appear to be pushing Putin toward sanity. The trading partners on either side of the great divide, and the collapse of the Russian currency vs dollar & euro on the world's stock exchanges could rescue mankind.

xxx

September 11, 2014

Other lawyers enjoy roughing up doctors on the witness stand. Usually they are more articulate than the "victim." This sport should cease. It diminishes camaraderie between two useful professions.

xxx

We were attempting to persuade a Terre Haute pathologist to accept a factual assertion. In desperation, we said, "on our word as a lawyer." His rejection was instantaneous, "that's it."

xxx

We needed his cooperation and persisted, " we are also a newspaper publisher.--- You can read the Sumner Press on the Internet for free." To our surprise he countered, "that's worse."

xxx

One more try, "we are a member of First Christian, and regularly attend." It was the magic word.

xxx

The drug problem in this Country, and in this County, is epidemic. All concerned with the future, specifically including the entertainment world, must ban together to oppose the use of illegal drugs.

xxx

Shame on Colorado for leading the way in legalization of marijuana. Respected authority believes its use tends to lead to stronger, more addictive drugs, e.g. heroin

xxx

Shame on Illinois, including Olney, who seek to profit by feeding others' weakness.

xxx

Department of Corrections reports the recidivism rate for heroin addicts has topped 70%. We think the figure is higher. We have never known a heroin addict, firmly hooked, who "stayed clean" longer than one year.

xxx

Tragic but Facebook has written "finis" for newspapers.

xxx

Misery loves company; the Internet may also be the writing on the wall for lawyers,

xxx

No longer do lawyers study merely to meet the requirements of the Continuing Legal Education. Most lawyers realize that it is time to focus and give a thoughtful reply when a would be client innocently observes, "we read on the Internet that the "parole evidence' rule would make the contract enforceable."

xxx

There are no employable unemployed in our County. Too many unemployed lack any skill or training for which society is willing to pay. Those whom the evil god of genetics stamped "unemployable" are a legitimate burden for workers to bear. But those accepted for employment who fail the drug test should suffer economic consequences.

xxx

We were reassured to read that at the managerial level American industry tops its foreign competition, but shocked that the reverse is true in comparison with effort made by workers.

xxx

It is a national curse that foreign automobiles clog American highways.

xxx

When we are no longer able to change a situation, we are challenged to change ourselves.

- Victor Frankl

September 18, 2014

Families of James Foley and Steven Sotloff, American journalists beheaded by the Islamic State, reveal that U.S. State Department warned both that they might be criminally prosecuted if they attempted to meet the ransom demand of IS for their release. Trusting one's government is a hallmark of patriotic citizenship. Terrible dilemma for the parents of each. High officials are telling them that the government will do everything within its power to cause the release of the son, but they must not attempt to help by raising, or soliciting money for his release.

xxx

We recognize that hindsight always 20/20, but it appears to us that the high officials were tragically reckless with the lives of the two victims by not winking as they mentioned possible criminal prosecution for doing something to get their sons out of the hands of these mad men. In theory, trusting one's government is always the right move except in those desperate situations where mad men are confronted.

xxx

NFL/sports writer indignation in the Ray Rice affair was laughable. So, the Baltimore Ravens' star knocked his wife unconscious, and such disciplinary action caught on video, should shock no one. Professional football players are different.

xxx

Violence is the essence of professional football, and the prime lure of its astounding popularity. Historians will fault the USA that watching such behavior is the reason for living for too many Americans.

xxx

Commissioner Goodell understood the appeal of his cash cow, hence the two game suspension. His contriteness at sensitive women's outrage about earn him an Oscar, and will safeguard his million dollar/year job.

xxx

Five will get you ten that Rice will be reinstated within two years. He may play alongside a stellar quarterback named Vick, who was a dog fight promoter, suspended for life and rehabilitated.

xxx

The carnival rides have returned to Courthouse Square. They are an excrescence on the face of humanity, regrettably necessary to draw a crowd. Shameful that impoverished parents are squeezed by clamoring kids to ride.

xxx

These ungrateful children should be spanked. Alas, if such common sense applied, parents would

be prosecuted by the Department of Children & Family Service. Regrettable that society has gotten that far out of round.

xxx

We again salute Ben & Heather Horner for opening "State Street Vapor" at 1103 State Street. The willfully misinformed continue to parrot the tobacco industry's claim that this lifeline is actually harmful. Named new merchants act from honest motive.

xxx

Fall Festival lost its soul in the county seat ten years ago when First Christian Church got too old, and lazy, to man the soup tent at the northeast corner of the Courthouse Square.

xxx

We hope that all enjoy the Fall Festival.

September 25, 2014

Families of James Foley and Steven Sotloff, American journalists beheaded by the Islamic State, reveal that U.S. State Department warned both that they might be criminally prosecuted if they attempted to meet the ransom demand of IS for their release. Trusting one's government is a hallmark of patriotic citizenship. Terrible dilemma for the parents of each. High officials are telling them that the government will do everything within its power to cause the release of the son, but they must not attempt to help by raising, or soliciting money for his release.

xxx

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xxx

The Carnival has departed Courthouse Square. Good riddance!

xxx

That the Fall Festival without parent impoverishing rides is worthwhile was illustrated by an encounter with an effective hospital worker, Kelly Pinkstaff. Asked what she and Jared Brian enjoyed most about the Fall Festival, instant reply was, " soup at Calvary Apostolic tent."

xxx

It would appear that First Christian's replacement in this annual community celebration has been found. Our congratulations to Rev. Donaldson & crew.

xxx

Political heresy, but we have admired President Obama's duplicity in the battle against IL IS. Without question his reassurance that U.S. troops will have no on ground role in the battle to send those head choppers to meet Allah, is willfully inaccurate. But he had no choice than to engage in that deception.

xxx

It is a weakness of democracy that the leader cannot tell his people all the background at the beginning of a project as significant as a war. When Pearl Harbor came, President Roosevelt did not mention in his historic "day in infamy" speech that the U.S. had imposed trade bans against Japan two weeks prior that severely restricted that adversary's continued prosperity, and gave the militarists an excuse to attack Pearl Harbor.

xxx

To prevent present war against IL IS from being, in the eyes of the Muslim world, simply Christians killing Muslims, U.S. needed to create the semblance of a broad coalition of nations, including Muslim, aligned against the head choppers. Our investment of men and money in Iraq for 13 years are such that its Army, American trained and equipped, could logically be expected to furnish the foot soldiers for victory. So, our President has repeatedly stated that no American soldiers will have ground contact with the enemy, and that Iraq would lead our allies on the ground, with Jordan, Turkey & Iran.

xxx

That plan collapsed when the last three nominated ground troop providers declined, and a

skeptical American public remembered Iraqi soldiers' disgraceful resistance to IL IS at Mosul. They abandoned millions of dollars worth of high grade American military equipment and ran. Had our President mentioned the Iraqi Army's performance, it would have alienated many Muslim nations. So, President Obama named Iraq as a major provider of foot soldiers for the coming battle.

xxx

So, we give our President an "A" for effort and suggest that the American news media should commence the campaign to reconcile the public to a boots on the ground war against an enemy longer on bravado and atrocities, than the courage in battle which American soldiers bring on the ground, in the air, and on the ocean.

xxx

India is the only nation with a population comparable to China's. The Chinese gross national product is many times that of India. We have wondered whether the Chinese people more intelligent, more energetic. Yet, we've encountered many Indians long on those qualities.

xxx

Scheiffer on CBS was questioning the President of India on this very point in Sunday's "Face the Nation." Might the disparity in GNP be caused by China's centralized, autocratic government, as compared with India's proud claim, "world's largest democracy?" One would have expected the Indian President to grab the "easy out". He didn't.

xxx

Fall is here. It is the grandest season of the year.

October 2, 2014

More time than money is much better than the reverse, more money than time.

xxx

The TV clip of a sad Amsterdam Airport retrieving forgotten item of a debarked passenger, delivering same to the careless owner in the waiting room, based on smell to match item and owner, was incredible.

XXX

Since there was no evidence that the film had been photo shopped, we concluded that this novel retrieval via clever dog possible with smelly passengers, but believe American passengers too fastidious for such magic.

I

American news media should delay canonization of retiring Attorney General Eric Holder. Fair and impartial appraisal gives his job performance no more than "average."

XXX

His obsession was with civil rights, trying captured terrorists in Federal Court rather than before an Army Tribunal, and banning the word "nigger." Over emphasis of first contributed to turning America into a nation of wimps.

XXX

His hang-up on Federal Court as proper venue for trial of foreign terrorists has created confusion of whether Sheik Mohammed, architect of 9/11 tragedy, will ever be publicly hanged. He could die from gout, from over eating.

XXX

The silliness of Holder and every public official about ultimate destructiveness of the n-word is nauseating. They lack any authority to edit the dictionary. It would seem that as long as blacks are permitted to disparage whites with "honkey", whites should be entitled to reciprocate with "nigger". Perhaps that is among our civil rights?

XXX

A caring society would generate more public outrage at the senseless murder of the lady trying to sell a house in Little Rock, and the decapitation by fellow worker of a lady processing meat in Oklahoma. There would be violent reaction if a side line frustanter innocently tripped your team's player running for the touchdown that would have won the game. nor did either tragedy generate any enthusiasm for the justice of capital punishment. We are a nation of wimps.

xxx

Appalling, the amount of paperwork one causes by every trip to the doctor. Obamacare will surely deforest the nation.

xxx

We've learned to appreciate the deadly accuracy of weather forecasters. We shudder as they advise that the warm days of summer end today.

xxx

WANTED: A new football coach at the University of Illinois.

xxx

Time will explain it all. He is a talker and needs no questioning before he speaks.

- Euripides

October 9, 2014

It is discouraging, being a wild ass braying in the wilderness. For 26 years the Press has urged non stop that there be a directory for cell phone numbers. We've appealed to the law makers, Illinois Commerce Commission, and all within earshot, noting that that goal could be obtained by making assignment of cell phone number for life, publicized when issued. Progress toward that common sense goal has been none.

xxx

Opposition is xenophobic. Opponents to this modicum of reason dare not to expand their world circumscribed by the numbers imbedded in their cell phones. It were as though they do not wish to increase their number of friends.

xxx

These opponents to a published cell phone directory are also sadists. They enjoy inflicting pain on those of us without cell phones, who wish to expand our circle of friends, who must spend too

much time searching for these elusive numbers.

xxx

We will publish the names of those who respond to our plea to let the sun shine in.

xxx

The weekend witnessed end of vice-President Joe Biden's hope to be the Democratic nominee for President, 2016, when Hillary decides she is too old to run. The loquacious Biden apologized to President Reecep Erdogan of Turkey and following day to Crown Prince Mohammed Zayed of United Arab Republic The VP offended each by suggesting ground troops from their respective countries would be appropriate in the fight against the Islamic State.

xxx

After the Obama years of being so sensitive of the approval of every dinky nation, we doubt that America wants another leader of such fearful demeanor. Biden should have said to these client states, "measure up, or get out of our way."

xxx

In two or three weeks, the schools will release names of students who have excelled academically. Might it be appropriate, and even encourage other students to excel in the future if the schools published the names of the parents of students honored? We suspect that without parental involvement many students would not excel.

xxx

Weekend was cold enough to usher in Indian summer. We hope that the Golden days of autumn last until spring.

October 16, 2014

Illinois Democrats, fearing that Bruce Rauner will be elected Governor 19 days from today, have shifted to their traditional campaign strategy--- class warfare.

xxx

Unctuously they inquire, "Did you read how much Rauner made last year?" "He paid only 17 million dollars income tax, and gave only five million away."

xxx

Republican campaign workers are justified for reply to such assaults with, "How does that compare with your tax and your charity?"

xxx

This "soak the rich" rallying cry is a pernicious, popular mindset. For the down trodden, it is an understandable crutch. For those who believe in private ownership of property, that everyone should be permitted to rise to the limit of his ability, it is a sly, unfair appeal to the basest elements of all. It was effective against Mitt Romney in 2012.

xxx

Private ownership of property can't be limited to those who have, or make less than we.

xxx

The most virulent group against Rauner is the AF-SCME. The members of that union have nothing to fear from Rauner's election. They are being played for suckers by the union bosses.

xxx

For all who believe in fiscal sanity for state government, a vote for Rauner for Governor in the November 4 General Election should be a "given".

xxx

Too much finger pointing by Drs. Frieden and Fauci about standard of care given by the Dallas Hospital to the ebola patient from Africa who died. Two care givers have tested "positive". Public apprehension is understandable but the mob must not make the decisions as to treatment of the afflicted.

xxx

It was unfortunate that in Spain an angry, ignorant crowd threw surgical gloves at public officials risking their lives to oversee treatment of afflicted. Mob reaction in these situations is always the same- isolate, quarantine even to extent of abandonment as with the leprosy colonies of another century. Mankind has a greater obligation than to seek to ignore the tragedy.

xxx

We are watching to see what role the wealth of oil in west Africa plays in confronting a very serious threat to mankind.

xxx

There is reason for hope that negotiations in Cairo between Israel & Palestine will bring peace to combatants for more than 50 years. Israel must accept Palestine as a separate state; Palestine must accept Israel's right to exist. Project is pushed by Egypt's Sisi. U.S. must pressure Netanyahu who earned worldwide criticism for the slaughter of thousands in recent destruction of refugee packed Gaza by the Israeli Army.

xxx

Incredible, amount of money pledged for rebuilding of Gaza---one billion dollars from Qatar alone. U.S. has pledged 300 million initially. Enough to make Route 350 four lanes wide, coast to coast. It would be insane to rebuild Gaza without firm agreement that Israel will not destroy within a year or so.

xxx

We were appalled that Gary Kasparov, a Russian Jew recognized as the world's greatest chess player, would publicly state that Russian President Putin is a greater threat to the U.S.A. than IS IL. Putin is no Hitler, nor do Russians see themselves as world conquerors.

xxx

You cannot run away from a weakness; you must sometimes fight it out or perish. And if that be so, why not now and where you stand?

- Robert Louis Stevenson

XXX

October 23, 2014

Disgraceful, national hysteria over the ebola threat. The Texans who risked their lives for the care of the single afflicted received much undeserved criticism.

XXX

President Obama and the televised news media which appears to control thinking of too many tardily saw problem ignorance had created and calmed the waters.

XXX

Impressive that there has been no panic, no people jumping out of windows, though the stock market, lost almost 10% during early October. Investors are reassured by the Federal Reserve Board, particularly its President, whether male or female.

XXX

In October '08, Chairman Greenspan made the right statement, "The FRB preserve the liquidity of the banks." Meant printing more money quickly. President Chairman Janet Yellen has made similar comment in this crisis.

XXX

Had there been an activist FRB in 1929 the stock market crash would have been avoided, as would the Great Depression that followed.

XXX

These attention seekers who predict economic disaster non-stop will look foolish. As are the Pauls, pere et fils. The older of those over-rated has even suggested return to the "gold standard". All economists agree that would be insane, would cause uncontrollable depression.

XXX

Forty years ago, working as a bright young idealist in Richard Nixon's White House, Patrick

Buchanan was an inspiration to many who needed a role model. Now, he is weary old political pundit earning a livelihood on television opposing whatever is proposed.

xxx

It is sad when a public figure's "hour upon the stage is done", if the actor fails to recognize and move off to the wings.

xxx

Why is so difficult to lure worthwhile citizens back to Lawrence County. Even if they have moved to spots tormented by hurricanes and heat for 10 months that bakes the brains, or where the earth shakes non stop?

xxx

We should each invite everyone we know who lives afar to move back to County Lawrence whose climate is non pareil—no killing frost until after November 1! Home secure without locking the doors. Happy, carefree citizenry without industrial problems in the air they breathe.

xxx

We need to trumpet without blushing, "move to County Lawrence; you'll live longer and be happier."

xxx

We liked the slogan on the front window of City Hall, Sumner, "Little city with big heart."

xxx

We remain determined to bring a camel ride to the county seat , though we missed the Labor Day opening promised long ago. Oliver resists the saddle fiercely. His trainer, Robert Wilson, assures us that Oliver will accept the stardom we plan for him.

xxx

March 1, 2015 is now the day the camel ride, and photo, to come to an arena at side of Beryl's

Barber Shop, 15th & Nile, Lawrenceville.

xxx

If we fail to meet that deadline, turn Wilson's picture to the wall, and mine, too.

October 30, 2014

Someone is spending a scandalous amount of money in slanderous advertising attempt to defeat Supreme Court Justice Lloyd Karmeier.

xxx

His Honor was elected 10 years ago from the 37 counties of Southern Illinois which compose the 1st Supreme Court District.

xxx

Fair minded lawyers, regardless of their political affiliation will vote for Karmeier's "retention", in Tuesday's election, though a radical fringe would have the simple believe that he is corrupt because of Supreme Court decisions with which they apparently disagree.

xxx

Decisions require approval by a majority of the seven justices. His nameless opponents ignore the fact that his fellow justices joined with Justice Karmeier and hold his in high esteem as a legal scholar.

xxx

Though this newspaper opposes the retention ballot, change must come in the Legislature. We will vote "Yes" for retention of Justice Karmeier and Judges Vaughn, Overstreet, Foster and Tedeshi.

Though none of them has purchased advertising in the Press, there isn't a bad apple amongst them

xxx

Last political item,, this week. NBC television reported increased speculation that Jeb Bush, former Governor of Florida, would become a candidate for GOP Presidential nomination in 2016. Theory is that Christie, too far left; Rand & Cruz, too far right. To beat Hillary, would need candidate whose political philosophy in middle

Snapshot interviews with those pro, and con. Then, a picture of large gathering of the illustrious Bush family, and closup of the grand dame, Barbara Bush, She announced, "we've had enough Bushes in the White House."

xxx

We agree with Barbara.

xxx

Apparently the viewer audience for the World Series was petite. That thee will be a New York, Boston, or Philadelphia team in the 2016 World Series is a given..

xxx

It is an oxymoron to dwell on the purity of professional sports.

xxx

Tuscola rejoices that a foreign chemical combine, Cronus (Switz & Turkish) proposes to build a fertilizer plant in their area.. While construction will bring an obvious short term boom, we doubt that the payroll for the plant will be larger than that of the Sumner Correctional Facility, after Bruce Rauner is elected Governor, Tuesday and doubles the size of our area's economic salvation.

xxx

Let's not worry or envy about Tuscola's good fortune. Every voter in Lawrence County can strike a decisive lick for a brighter tomorrow by electing Rauner, Tuesday.

xxx

See you at the polls

November 6, 2014

We admire the sophistication of sports writers who predict outcome of games with a gamblers' "point spread" factored in.

xxx

Our friend Bill Richardson, The Daily Record, has consistent high accuracy predicting winners, but many of the wins are lopsided. You or I could have guessed those.

xxx

A dude named Greenstein in The Chicago Tribune calls the winner after the point spread added to the underdog, e.g., in Saturday's embarrassment of the Illini, plus 28 ½ points, vs OSU, Greenstein "reluctantly" predicted the Illini to be the winner. The score was 55-14.

xxx

Those challenging Las Vegas will pare their losses if they read Greenstein before investing.

xxx

Of Illini Coach Beckman, he must go. The Homecoming game surprising win was only a temporary reprieve.

xxx

Present generation of high school band musicians is woefully lacking in economic reality. None appears to have any concept of how significant money is in attaining life's goals.

xxx

Children reared in poverty often succeed because of the ingrained appreciation acquired from that poverty. Especially those raised in Sumner in the 1930's.

xxx

We dangled a \$10 bill before each musician in the LHS and RHHS bands to play at Saturday's Rally for Rauner on the Courthouse Square. There were no takers.

xxx

Happily, Sue Gerhart and Lorie Cunningham took turns on the calliope, calling the party faithful to battle. Our distinguished visitors seemed impressed by the musical greeting. We explained to the talented calliopists that there are things in life besides money.

xxx

We are grateful to the 350 citizens who came to the Rally for Rauner. We had guaranteed his handlers 500.

xxx

Voter turn-out is disgracefully low. It makes a mockery of democracy's effort to accurately reflect the public will. Too many simply do not care who leads.

xxx

We suggest a common sense solution to this mental inertia, i.e., charge each who wishes to vote \$2 payable to the election judges who will act as custodians for the public treasury. Our system would guarantee that choices are made by interested citizens, and reduce the public cost of conducting elections to zero

xxx

To the bleeding hearts who will claim that the poor would be disenfranchised, we would offer that in lieu of the \$2 any impoverished person perform an hour of public service.

xxx

We will publish any response received to this suggestion, limited to 100 words.

November 13, 2014

A great man died Saturday. His name was Frank Ladner.

xxx

It was Lawrence County's good fortune that he was the roommate at a small, church affiliated college in Minnesota, of another great man, J. Patrick Rooney. Latter was the son of Michael Andrew Rooney, a business man of rare ability who dreamed of a huge insurance company which he would nurture in his basement and name "Golden Rule". Mr. Rooney spent a lifetime pursuing that dream and lived to see it come true.

xxx

In 1948, Frank Ladner, an impoverished recent graduate of St. John's came to Lawrenceville as the first paid salesman of Golden Rule Insurance. . Under the tutelage of Andy Rooney, he was a crackerjack salesman. He sold policies to individuals and groups who had no intent to purchase, including the Illinois State Police. He won the admiration of Andy Rooney during the first week on the road.

xxx

Golden Rule's star policy salesman wooed and won the heart and hand of one of the boss' charming daughters, Julia Rooney. In 1952 they exchanged wedding vows and lived happily together ever after. Six children were born to this union. Each in the mold of his/her extraordinary parents.

xxx

This family enterprise became nationally and favorably known, doing business in most of the states of this nation. Like any other large business, competition tends to force consolidations for operational efficiency. Golden Rule reached that point about 20 years ago. None did more than Frank Ladner to place Golden Rule on the pinnacle. It was purchased by the insurance industry's leader, United Health. Frank Ladner became wealthy beyond his fondest dreams

xxx

Civic minded and firm in the faith from the days first a resident of Lawrence County, Frank added a new passion during the last 20 years of his life---- philanthropy. He was his brother's keeper. He was an enthusiastic supporter of every project designed to improve Lawrence County and all who reside therein. His generosity was without equal. His name became synonymous with "strong helping hand".

xxx

Mr. Ladner's passing is a body blow to a community which had come to rely upon him in times of peril. there is a wound in the heart of each of us who knew, admired and loved this extraordinary individual.

xxx

His life must be an inspiration to each of us to do more for the common good, otherwise, it was "wasted on the desert air."

xxx

Next week we will explain why schools should teach the young that politics can be a wholesome process, and that good citizenship requires participation therein.

November 20, 2014

Ghastly that we have measurable snow, November 16, and 11°, November 18.

xxx

Should we quit trying to lure new residents with claim that we live in a sheltered valley?

xxx

The beer industry has targeted college towns. Coors has even purchased from the U of I Board of Trustees the right to claim that it is the "Illini Beer."

xxx

We salute David Garagin, Director of Alcohol Management and Youth, John Hopkins University's Bloomberg School for Public Health: "Now let's talk about college drinking. Each year, 1,825 deaths; 69,000 assaults; 97,000 victims of alcohol related assault or date rape. It is a major factor in college life."

xxx

The misery that alcohol causes may equal the pleasure that many get from it.

xxx

Russian President Vladimir Putin is no Adolf Hitler. As a would-be world conqueror, he rates no higher than Benito Mussolini. That he would bring four antiquated Russian warships to last week's summit of world leaders in Australia was laughable.

xxx

Our State Department should use same technique to combat his saber rattling as it did when the Chinese began claiming their neighbors' islands in the South China Seas, U.S. announced that Japanese police force was being strengthened.

xxx

The Russians would remember 20 million deaths in World War II if it were announced that German Home Guard was being strengthened. Putin's popularity with the Russian people would evaporate.

xxx

President Obama's sanctions against Russia for its aggression against Ukraine appear to be working, as does U.S. air support for the Kurdish and Iraqi soldiers against IS in Syria.

xxx

Republicans should pause before condemning the President for his cautious approach on these fronts. American public opinion is strongly against soldiers' boots on foreign lands, even if Chief of Staff Dempsey recommends same next week upon his return from Iraq.

xxx

We think that U of I alumni should be wearing their school caps. Anyone can proudly parade when their team is winning. The Illini record five losses in the last six games, requires morale booster from the alumni. Hopefully, the basketball team will restore the alma mater to respectability in the Big Ten.

xxx

We checked the empty seats at First Christian, Sunday. Found always present Wanda Litherland Diver absent. Inquiry revealed that she had departed for Florida just hours before the storm.

xxx

Florida is nice for old folks. Wanda does not qualify for that rating. Should be here facing the challenge of a brisk autumn with this generation.

xxx

We are impatient that Governor Rauner get started with four lanes for Route 50, a low level dam across the Wabash, doubling the size of Sumner Correctional Facility, or any of these projects which would revitalize Lawrence County.

November 27, 2014

Napoleon said it best, "ability without opportunity is of little value"

xxx

Rudolph Guiliani was a washed up politician, albeit the mayor of NYC, when Mohammed Atta & Co. flew the hi-jacked planes into the World Trade Center, 9/11/01. Rudy's energetic response, directing firemen and stretcher bearers with unchallenged authority captured the public imagination. He was instantly restored to his popularity as a crime fighting young district attorney, He has coasted comfortably on that public acclaim to the present day.

xxx

Robert McCulloch was a harmless, relatively unknown prosecuting attorney in St. Louis County, Missouri, until a policeman named Wilson shot and killed Michael Brown, a teenage unarmed black youth on., a warm evening in August, in Ferguson, Missouri. Blacks in Ferguson, and in numerous large American cities commenced daily riots demanding criminal prosecution of the officer who fired the shots which killed Brown

xxx

As national attention and outrage focused on this St. Louis suburb, the prosecutor weighed public reaction. He recognized that Brown's partisans were vocal, loud and numerous, and that Wilson's supporters were equally determined though less in the public spotlight. As in Illinois, Missouri

prosecutors have the option of instituting criminal prosecutions alone, or of summoning a grand jury to hear the evidence and advise whether Wilson's use of deadly force was legally justified.

xxx

The grand jury route and spent three months presenting the evidence surrounding Brown's death to that grand jury.

xxx

While would be rioters proclaimed their intent, even as he gently chided the public for its "insatiable demand" for news of the Ferguson killing, McCulloch reaped the benefit of his central role. He publicly described., with great skill and detail, the event and the role of the various players, in this intensely watched drama.

xxx

The grand jury found that the officer was justified in firing the shots that killed Brown;, and that no criminal prosecution should be launched against him. Millions recognized what a significant role Robert McCulloch played in the calming of the public cry for vengeance.

xxx

That prosecuting Attorney McCulloch will be a candidate for governor, or other high political office, next election, is a given.

xxx

We have cynically analyzed the political implications of a national problem that remains—to cause all races to live together In peace.

December 11, 2014

Public confidence in the police is an essential for an harmonious community. It is another blessing of living in small communities that almost never are the police thought to be " bullies", anxious to display their authority, or even fire their weapons. The tragedies of Ferguson, MO., and NYC indicate that no such confidence exists in either, especially among minorities. The P.D.s in the big cities simply must try harder to regain the confidence of the entire public.

xxx

Our sympathies are usually with the police. It is a difficult role that they play in the scheme of things. They need be psychologists, fearless, compassionate, and imbued with common sense.

xxx

The Ferguson tragedy was regrettable, but more understandable than the NYC public execution of Eric Garner. In the latter, too many police made too much of too small an offense. The deceased was a fat, peaceful citizen apparently selling cigarettes, one at a time. Societal harm from that scenario is minimal. Why the police decided that he should be forcibly thrown to the pavement for his obstinacy defies reason. For the head of the policemen's union to proclaim, "if he could talk, his air wasn't shut off" was an insult to common sense. The application of a technique, choke hold, specifically barred by the department rules made each involved a rogue cop.

xxx

That the policeman who applied the fatal choke hold should be fired is a given. Should have happened on each of three prior claims of physical abuse by him against other citizens. Disciplinary action should be taken against all other police who participated in such outrage. That nothing will be done to any is also a given.

xxx

We don't often agree with Senator Rand Paul, R., KY., (has same off the wall opinions as his father), but thought it great that he publicly opined that high taxes on cigarettes caused the arrest which result in Garner's death. His solution would be to reduce government spending to level that taxes would be minimal. It is an ideal that would work if Social Security and substantial subsidy to every group in the nation were eliminated. Unfortunately, society has grown accustomed to these government handouts: will never consent to their discontinuance.

xxx

The money to pay for these government programs has to come from taxes. The individuals who receive these monthly checks have forfeited the right to protest the taxes which make such payments possible. Every citizen should take pride in the amount of taxes which he pays. It is the barometer of how much of the weight of government he is bearing. We would publish the amount of taxes each pays if such information were available. Presently, only persons brave enough to run

for high office are required to make public disclosure of how much they are lifting.

xxx

We non-smokers are free loaders in regard to the present exorbitant tax on cigarettes. Shamelessly we cheer because those addicts are required to pay so much. The rationale is that cost to government for healthcare for smokers justifies ever higher taxes on tobacco. Reality is that all enjoy an undeserved handout. Legislators adding more taxes to cigarettes sometimes argue that it is for the health of the user, that additional cost will help him discontinue a fatal habit. That is nonsense, every smoker would quit if he could.

xxx

One wonders why neither Lawrence County High School has a manual arts program comparable to that which each offered 50 years ago. Ozzie Brown, at BTHS, and Leslie Wright, at LTHS, taught manually inclined students skills that benefitted the students and the public for a lifetime.

December 18, 2014

These sunless days of early December are depressing. This annual challenge may be a major factor in the growing popularity of Christmas lights.

xxx

When historians explain the diminished role of organized religion in the maintaining of civility within families, between neighbors and strangers, we think they will credit the increased role of the judicial system in all the affairs of life, including harmoniously living together.

xxx

A dozen years ago the General Assembly with the Governor enacted a law that permits the trial level courts to issue what are described as "protective orders."

xxx

This new legal writ is the written command from the judge to whomever believed to be a threat to the safety and well-being of others.

xxx

They have become very popular, widely used in many courts in Illinois including the Circuit Court of Lawrence County. Their appeal in part is how quick, summarily they strike without notice to the accused/restrained.

xxx

The threatened individual appears before a judge, usually without a lawyer. Under oath, he fills out a written form explaining in own words how he/she was "threatened" by a named defendant.

xxx

His Honor issues a temporary restraining order which commands the defendant to cease and desist objected to conduct, and usually to stay away from the person seeking such protection, often her husband. Latter, after receiving such written command by it or risk being jailed for contempt.

xxx

Within 20 days following such initial order, a hearing with notice to the defendant is held to determine whether a plenary order should issue to be in effect for two years.

xxx

While restraining orders were thought to be a safeguard against physical violence, some courts have extended its application.

xxx

One of the judges, not the presiding, of the Lawrence Circuit Court held that a small dog trespassing on the neighbor's lawn, after its owner had been commanded by a protection order, was a "significant factor" to extend the order for the full two years.

xxx

With such micromanagement of morale and human behavior by the judicial system, the historic role of the church has been supplanted.

xxx

Winter is here, Sunday. 'Tis the grandest season of the year.

December 25, 2014

Frightening that a country as backward appearing, and as impoverished as North Korea has the technical skill to invade the computer brains of a major U.S. movie maker, Sony. Even to remove therefrom secrets for the amusement of curious outsiders.

xxx

We are told that the purpose of such intrusion was to blackmail Sony to cancel planned distribution of "The Interview", a movie it had made contemplating the assassination of N. Korea's pudgy, maniacal President Jung.

xxx

That such blackmail was successful is particularly frightening. One can imagine its expanded future use.

xxx

Individuals and businesses whose monetary existence is recorded in the mystic world of cybernic must ask themselves, "If Sony's secrets were not secure, might Computershare's be equally vulnerable.?"

xxx

Even more frightening than above fear is the fact that many suspect that the entire casus belli is a promotion of "The Interview." These cynics cite another movie, about a tail wagging the dog.

xxx

We do not believe that our government would knowingly participate in such a fraud. Nor does the American public believe the evidence against N. Korea strong enough to justify going to war.

xxx

NYC Mayor Bill de Blasio deserves the widespread contempt in which he is held. He fanned the mindless fury of those protesting the tragedy in Ferguson, MO. Some nut job in Brooklyn was unhinged by the riots and fatally shot two NYC policemen in retaliation.

xxx

Even with their many imperfections, a respected police force is an absolute essential for an organized society.

xxx

It should be as unacceptable to call police, "pigs", as it is to call black people, "niggers". Yet no one sounded the alarm, or even raised an eyebrow, when the cowardly assassin of the NYC police e-mailed many that he was going to "put wings on a couple of pigs."

xxx

Chicago Mayor Rahm Emanuel has more of a battle for the Democratic nomination for a second term, in the February 24 primary, than one would have expected. His opponents rally against the hated red light cameras the Emanuel supports. (They do little for traffic safety, but are great revenue producers.)

xxx

If Emanuel survives, he will give the grandmothers Hillary Clinton & Elizabeth Warren, great competition for the 2016 Democratic presidential nomination.

xxx

Early public opinion polls suggest that the GOP nomination may be more valuable. We hope that the GOP will pause awhile before making choice, to determine which of the new Republican governors elected in November is presidential material.

xxx

Brutality of the National Football League was underscored last week. The Chicago Bears seeking a better W-L record benched their multi million dollar QB, Jay Cutler for a gorilla named Jimmy Clausen. Cutler suffered a brain concussion in first game (against Detroit Lions). Cutler was

reinstated

xxx

The hypocrisy of those who would deny path to citizenship to illegal Mexican workers is troubling. Discouraging that so many locally would deport all.

xxx

Capable workers for undesirable jobs are always in short supply. Common sense should encourage tolerance of these workers. They are useful.

xxx

We believe the new policy on Cuba was long overdue. The diehards playing dominoes on Calle Ocha, Miami must accept reality. We have no national duty to force restoration of their lands to wealthy Cuban refugees.

2015

53 COLUMNS

January 1, 2015

[Transcriber note: page 1 masthead reads JANUARY 1, 2015, but the page-3 running header in this scan reads "THURSDAY, JANUARY 15, 2015"; content is the New Year's edition. Transcribed from page 3 of the 2015-01-01.pdf file as instructed.]

The tyranny of the merchants holding parents and friends hostage in the name of Christmas and gift exchange has ended. We're glad.

xxx

Were it not so essential to the existence of the capitalistic system upon which our nation is built, we would urge return of Christmas to its beginning, worship of a Supreme Being and eliminate the gift exchange.

xxx

That process is unique in that one is embarrassed either way the value of the gift is tilted. We doubt our carping criticism will diminish the joy that most of us receive from Christmas.

xxx

Should mention that Santa brought me a steel bar, about 4 feet in length, might have been taken from an automobile axle spring. If I shake and flex this gadget 15 minutes each day, guaranteed to be like new in 30 days. Will keep readers advised.

xxx

Now for resolutions: We're going to cause more reader response, or throw in the towel before 2015 is done.

xxx

Sometimes we wonder if anyone reads the Press. If so, why was there no Letter to the Editor this week demanding that Lois Ross be tarred and feathered? Last week (page 4) that treasured contributing editor suggested that President Obama apologize to the North Korean dictator for permitting Sony to produce and distribute "The Interview."

xxx

If our President should dare to apologize to those monkeys we shall immediately join the nut crew who have been urging his impeachment.

xxx

Americans have the right to be self-righteous, arrogant and have an egotistical stance. These perks were earned for us by the work and sacrifice of our ancestors to keep the lesser tribes that inhabit the earth afloat.

xxx

That piano playing musician a few years ago had the correct tune, "Proud to be an American."

xxx

We intend to keep Lois' confidence, goodwill, and will welcome her future writings, even if we do not always agree.

xxx

Another New Year's resolution is to effect an immediate entente with Karl Koertge and will publish such of his opinions which are seriously made, as distinguished from his role of a provocateur.

xxx

Another New Year's resolution are not confined to the resurrection of the Press. We believe that if we will all resolve together to demand of Springfield and Washington that our pet projects: Four Lanes for Fifty; Low level dam on the Wabash; aeronautic related industry at George Field, aka Mid-Continent International Airport d& community college related classes in manual arts be taught at either high school given top priority, progress and will be made in in each.

xxx

None should fear to ask his political servant what he has done to make our goals come alive.

xxx

We must not accept benign neglect as our area's due while the good things that government can bestow are being passed out.

xxx

Shocking that the Courthouse was closed from mid afternoon Tuesday and will remain so until Monday. Similar work pattern in prior week.

xxx

Happy New Year!

January 8, 2015

Mass deportation of illegal immigrants from the USA is inhumane nonsense.

x x x

Illegal immigrants have won their case to remain by working energetically, often at jobs Americans avoid. They have become indispensable for the American economy.

x x x

Their work is not limited to seasonal harvesting of crops. We talked with an informed mega-hog raiser from Iowa. He noted that three fourths of the workers on the large hogs farms in his area were Mexicans, whose legality is questionable.

xxx

We were discouraged that Governor Rauner chose Grayville, rather than Lawrenceville, for a hearing site for tomorrow's fly-around-tie-state. Other meetings are in Casey and Shelby County.

xxx

We remain confident that His Excellency will bring to George Field the urgency required for it to spearhead Lawrence County's renaissance.

xxx

First Lady Dianna Rauner has promised to come again to the county seat to see "The Finishing Touch", finest western art gallery south of Chicago. We will also show her, "New Leaf", the spa of eye popping opulence.

xxx

When the Christmas lights are turned off in drab little towns, they seem very dark drab little towns. I would vote that they sparkle year around.

xxx

The bright children with whom we associate were delighted when the holidays were done and school commenced anew.. Often I wonder if there are too many days when school is closed.

xxx

The process of obtaining an education is too important to be interrupted for trivial reasons. Christmas is the only birthday that close schools.

xxx

Of December 25, as the correct date of Christ's birth, last month's newsletter from Pleasant Ridge Christian Church, has a thoughtful article.

xxx

Ryan Cox was born to lead. We wond'ered how he reconciles Genesis with archeologists' opinion that the earth is millions of years old, and Darwin's "Origin of Species."

xxx

Some wise man cautioned, "be careful what you wish for, you may receive it." The talking heads were filled with gloom when oil sold for more than \$100/barrel, and gasoline almost reach \$5/gallon. Those figures have recently halved. Gasoline at the new truck stop in Grayville last week was \$1.87

xxx

The urgency of manufacturing electric cars has vanished. Fracking old oilfields, like Bridgeport, no longer seems life or death. Price of land that produces corn that makes gasohol will surely drop.

xxx

Notwithstanding, we hope that the new, Republican controlled Congress will put completion of the Keystone Pipeline from Canada on the fast track. We must never fear to venture into uncharted projects that hold promise of a better tomorrow.

xxx

Those who do not fear in flation always take refuge in the line, "a rising tide lifts all boats".

xxx

If the doom & gloom "talking heads" were less fearful, the stock market would demonstrate that principle.

January 15, 2015

Impressive that so many national leaders locked arms and marched down Paris' broad boulevards in Sunday's unity parade, with more than three million other humans determined to defend freedom of speech worldwide from radical Islam. We admired how quickly President Obama confessed error in limiting American participation in this historic moment to our ambassador.

xxx

Someone should tell our President that he can be air brushed into this historic picture, already a worldwide symbol that ideological differences, including religion , can be put aside and mankind move about this earth in peace, harmony and mutual trust..

xxx

That those differences continue was demonstrated by post parade comment of President Erdogan, Turkey, of President Netanyahu, Israel, "I was surprised that he had nerve enough to appear (in parade leaders' row) after Israel's murderous attacks on the Palestinians."

xxx

U.S. Attorney General Holder was in Paris, Sunday: disappointing that he did not grab the opportunity to lead for America by participating in the parade. We understood him to say, CBS "Face the Nation", that the U.S. should make an effort to understand why Muslim radicals commit such murders, as the assault on the French magazine. The "understanding" should come from the assailants, that their religious convictions are not license to murder those with whom they disagree, that the punishment for such murderous attacks is summary execution.

xxx

We admired the marksmanship of the French gendarmes. It is preferable to American judicial failure to timely protect this nation from radical Islam, including Mohammad Khalid, mastermind of 9/11, alive, well fed in Guantanamo, seven years; Major Hassan, U.S. Army psychologist, convert to Islam, alive & well fed Ft. Hood, though he murdered or injured 40 Americans, 2009, and Dzhokhar Tsarnaev, the Boston Marathon bomber, alive and well fed 21 months later.

xxx

Our guess is that none of these murderers will be executed. Each will remain a burden on U.S. taxpayers for many years

xxx

We were encouraged by Governor Rauner's statement, Friday, at Grayville, that educational emphasis of his administration would include manual arts programs. Now is the moment for one or more of the community colleges which surround us to revive the late Frank Ladner's dream of manual arts in the 13th Street facility.

xxx

Biggest show this weekend is the opening of New Leaf. What sparkle that jewel brings to downtown Lawrenceville.. Jan Loeb & Company are exemplary citizens.

xxx

Only two weeks from Monday until Groundhog Day. We plan a party that afternoon at the Law Factory, 2 p.m. Cake & ice cream. Readers are invited. We will celebrate the coming of spring

regardless of whether the groundhog sees its shadow

xxx

We have not forgotten the promised camel ride. Oliver is being groomed. It will be at 15th & Water. March 1 & 2 are the target dates.

January 22, 2015

Spot on the calendar was sufficient to close the schools, Monday. Shameful. Students lose.

xxx

Intellectual honesty has caused many to delete "Doctor" from the name Martin Luther King. Evidence of plagiarism in his doctorate thesis was clear.

xxx

We are opposed to closing the school for Lincoln too.

xxx

Cowardly or realistic? TV news described in detail front page of first edition of "Charlie Hebdo" published after murderous assault on its Paris offices. We were told that the drawn face of the Prophet Mohammed had tears, from the insane acts of the assailants, who were promptly executed by the police. But none of these accounts included a picture of the front page.

xxx

How far does the right of free speech extend? U.S. Supreme Court Justice Holmes wrote, "One cannot falsely shout 'fire' in a crowded theater." Justice Hugo Black would have held the opposite, that the right of free speech is unlimited.

xxx

The worldwide backlash against Charlie Hebdo's persistent satirical attacks on Muslims and their prophet has been surprising, and impressive.

xxx

Most prominent who suggested that the murders were provoked was Pope Francis I. Our initial reaction was that the old man had lost it, would soon join Pope Benedict in early retirement.

xxx

We now believe that he foresaw the reaction and placed himself in a position to call for a worldwide summit of Christian, Jewish, and Muslim leaders. If there is to be peace on earth, that summit is needed, with a clear resolution that each religion faith respect that of all others.

xxx

When that attainable solution is reached, mankind can go back to limiting wars to the basic cause of almost all wars—economics, material gain.

xxx

Russian President Putin's war with Ukraine and the European union tragically continues to sputter though the writing is on the wall against Putin. The almighty dollar as involved in international trade sanctions will erode his popular support until a peace comes.

xxx

Trade sanctions have cut the value of the ruble. That's why sanctions work.

xxx

Had international trade been as wide spread in 1939 as today, we doubt that World War II would ever have happened.

xxx

While we crown them kings, queens, presidents, the real rulers of the world are the bankers and those who control monetary policy. It is for their wisdom one should pray.

xxx

Those who seek to outguess the stock markets hope that President Obama did not spook a jittery

market by his state of the union contradictions on present DJIA as compared to figures when he became President.

xxx

When one runs out of things to do, mind is asleep.

xxx

Hooray for the January thaw.

January 29, 2015

Potency of TV was demonstrated last week when the RNC sent notice that it would organize a traveling road show of all who dreamed to be the GOP presidential nominee in 016.

xxx

A dozen shouted , "here am I send me,. They are Rubio, Reed, Cruz, Palin, Huckabee, Perry, Christie, Walker, Paul, Bush, Romney and Trump. Another dozen awaits breathlessly in the wings.

xxx

Most haven't a snowball's chance of winning the nomination, and even less for the grand prize in a contest that will be sharply challenged. The lure of being beamed into millions of homes many times was an irresistible ego trip.

xxx

Does anyone believe that Donald Trump, in his wildest fantasy, thinks that he might be the nominee? Trump was quick to locate the cameras and utter the sound bytes calculated to be repeated "neither Mitt Romney, nor Jeb Bush can be elected."

xxx

Rand Paul, a glib rub doctor from Kentucky who has served only four years in the Senate and has no significant legislation to his credit, is a quick study who observed that Trump caught the camera, joined anti-Romney cabal, "no, no, no, never Romney."

xxx

Unintentionally, Trump and Paul made Romney the clear front runner. Alas for Romney, William Jennings Bryan proved a century ago that a hard try for the white House won't go.

xxx

One week's stimulation of a lethargic public guarantees that we shall have great theater television, for the next 18 months, to and through the Republican National Convention, mid-July, 2016, Cleveland. Democrats will continue the show the following week by the crowning of Hillary as their nominee, probably in NYC.

xxx

Those of us who believe that politics is the essence of life were reminded anew that most television viewing Americans are far more interested in the 2016 Olympics, Summer Games, Rio de Janeiro. Neither party dared have its convention compete with that extravaganza, last week of July and first week of August.

xxx

Monday morning we watched the introduction of a new level of technology to the Courthouse. Heretofore, a Deputy Sheriff chauffeured one or more prisoners, always in leg irons which we thought demeaning/unnecessary, from the jail to appear before the Presiding Judge. Latter advised the miscreant nature of the charge against him/her, right to counsel, fix bail for release (which too many are unable to post), and outline time periods for future steps in the criminal process.

xxx

Closed circuit television has changed such archaic procedure. Judge Robert M. Hopkins, wearing his judicial robe, was seated on the bench; State's Attorney Chris Quick stood within the unseen camera's line of sight. Each could see a television monitor on the bench. Prisoners residing in the jail appeared individually on the monitor screen. Each saw the Judge and State's Attorney. Questions and answers were exchanged as audibly as though each were standing before the bench (in shackles), as in the pioneer days.

xxx

We are told that this is a great leap forward, saves the expense of a deputy bringing the unfortunates to court We doubt that it will save the taxpayers a dime. Cheaper to hire deputies than to rent the expensive technology. Comparable "saving" from computer involvement in elections has doubled the cost of that process. To some extent, this new wrinkle dehumanizes the criminal process.

xxx

Keeping up with the Joneses applies to counties as totally as to individuals. The imminent danger is that technology will obviate need for a courthouse in every county. Within 20 years consolidation will come to courthouses, too. Lawrence's has already been built—in Effingham.

xxx

xxx

1 Corinthians 13: 13 And now these three remain: faith, hope and love. But the greatest of these is love.

xxx

February 5, 2015

Fascinating how quickly N.J. Governor Christie's comment, "parents should have input on whether children vaccinated for measles," became toxic to his kinder hope to be the Republican nominee, 2016

xxx

His office quickly issued a "what he meant to say is"

xxx

Senator Rand Paul, another GOP Presidential hopeful immediately entered the fray with recital of young grievously injured by vaccinations which mal-functioned..

xxx

Who to believe becomes a very serious question. A society grown accustomed to total reliance upon medication has been shaken by repeated notice that the flu shots urged non-stop for everyone were only 23 per cent as effective.

xxx

That modern medicine makes people live longer, more productive lives is demonstrable. The nation must continue to listen to the experts, and each to his own body.

xxx

We thought Dr. Fauci and Center for Disease Control casual in acknowledging vaccinations falling short of expectations.,

xxx

The Democrat primary for Mayor of Chicago, in 19 days, would have been more colorful, and unpredictable, had not the lady president of the Chicago Teachers, Karen Lewis, been diagnosed with brain cancer in October. She might have been the nominee to dethrone Rahm Emanuel.

xxx

Neither her Latino replacement, called "Chuy", nor a half dozen other hopefuls present serious challenge to Emanuel's nomination, and election. We think he will challenge Hillary's coronation at the DNC convention.

xxx

Karen Lewis' description of Governor Bruce Rauner is classic, "Scott Walker on steroids." Walker is Governor of Wisconsin whose successful struggle with public employee unions made him a credible candidate for the GOP Presidential nomination.

xxx

Conceivable that the chemistry teacher has launched, "Rauner for President, 2016."

xxx

The Press has written the Department of Natural Resources to urge more speed in re-opening Trace Inn

xxx

We were discouraged that a successful operation, Hogg Heaven, Mt. Carmel, apparently declined to compete.

xxx

The Department needs to recognize that Red Hills State Park is not comparable to Starved Rock, nor those along Lake Michigan. Concession stand rental should be the lowest in the state. It is time for government to give monetary incentive to those holding back the Indians and crab grass.

xxx

Readers will notice elsewhere in this week's Press a letter to the editor from Karl Koertge. We would print more of Karl's thoughtful comments if he were not so anti. His opposition to organized religion is analytical, but he offers no alternative. When he finds the answer to "What kind of a world this would be without churches," we'll consider publishing.

Xxx

Along this vein, we failed to publish two letters to the editor because they were too long. Only management is permitted to be prolix. We limit published letters to 200 words, with rare exception.

February 12, 2015

CTU President Meeks may have been righter than she intended when she described Bruce Rauner as, "Scott Walker on steroids." Our Governor has captured the national spotlight by confronting public employee union bosses with executive order and Federal Court suit.

xxx

How instantly the mighty fall from the pinnacles. Brian Williams' Evening News, NBC television, held top rating for years, against fierce opposition. His smooth delivery built a national fan club.

xxx

Two weeks ago he saluted a retiring Air Force sergeant who had protected Williams and crew while reporting the Iraqi war from a helicopter ten years ago. Williams mentioned that his helicopter "took enemy fire." That story was repeated by the announcer at the hockey game that our favorite TV newscaster and the sergeant attended that evening.

xxx

The next day, "Stars & Stripes" published a letter from a helicopter crew member stating that the helicopter fired upon was an hour earlier than Williams'. Williams promptly issued a forthright apology, "in my mind it conflated (the two helicopters)."

xxx

The blood thirsty competitors, led by Fox News, were merciless in their ridicule of Williams. It was devastating revenge. His assistant is presently handling the news show.

xxx

We were intrigued by "conflated." Those who attended Sumner High, Fern Henry and Bess Boley English classes, believe they know all the words. Graduates of Miss Henry's Latin courses are doubly fortified. Even that well chosen Latin derivative, unknown to us, could not sway the jury of viewers who had already found him guilty.

xxx

Another institution which has decided before hearing the evidence is the U. S. Supreme Court. It enjoined Alabama from refusing to issue same sex marriage license. Pending case in that Supreme Court will not be heard until April, and decision expected in late June.

xxx

None believes the Court will find same sex marriages unconstitutional after making same available two months prior.

xxx

More than five feet of snow in six days. No wonder Benjamin Franklin migrated south from

Boston three hundred years ago.

xxx

We hope that worthwhile New Englanders will follow Franklin's decision and move to Lawrence County, Illinois, immediately.

xxx

Our county has too many houses "for sale."

February 19, 2015

Six inches of beautiful snow and our county is paralyzed. Boston had more than six feet of snow and kept on ticking. We should follow that example .

xxx

There would be more spectator interest in college basketball games if there were more ethnic diversity.

xxx

Yet on roundball, we thought Lou Henson's induction into the Hall of Fame was deserved, and overdue.

xxx

U.S. Health Department is considering removal of warning about cholesterol in diet. Who to believe?

xxx

Too often one hears some loser lament, "should have moved", "nothing to do in small towns", etc.

xxx

We noted a 40 plus vehicle pileup on an expressway in downtown Chicago, 6 dead, many injured, and wondered what part of living in the big city, with one hour commute, morning and evening,

appealing?

xxx

On Macy's wall, NYC, "Smart to be thrifty" Why pay \$26/year for the Press when you can get it for \$17, picking up your copy at the Law Factory after 1 p.m., each Wednesday?

xxx

The Muslim psychiatrist, father of 2 talented U N C dental students murdered by some nut job over a parking spot, condemned the news media for emphasizing atrocities committed by ISIS and other Jihadist Muslims. While every fair-minded American regrets this tragedy, that religion. must do more to purge itself of "duty to kill infidels."

xxx

Specifically, our vaunted CIA has the demonstrated technical ability to eavesdrop on millions, but we doubt that they (CIA) regularly monitor the mullahs' message at Friday prayers in even the largest mosques.

xxx

Our CIA should do this to protect our country and deserve half of the billions of taxpayer dollars which they waste each year.

xxx

Are visitors welcome at meetings of this religion? If not, why is there a prominent building for its practice on Godwin St., Urbana?

xxx

Our President is too cautious that this nation not offend Muslims. We believe that unless they adopt a "live and let live" policy toward other religions, we should deport them all, and keep the Mexican workers.

xxx

Barbara's double entendre: Muslims want to snuff out Copenhagen (for pix of Mohammad.)

xxx

Next week we intend to discuss the drug/alcohol eval process. We think it farcial make work; foisted on the impoverished by a careless legislature, enforced by a timid judiciary to the financial

February 26, 2015

What's the point of taking the test if the teacher is required, as a condition of her employment, to give an unfavorable grade?

xxx

Illinois is committed to a drug-alcohol evaluation for every motorist convicted of operating a motor vehicle while under the influence. The applicant is graded le level of his addiction and given a given a corrective program whereby his rehabilitation may be encouraged.

xxx

Lawrence County motorists who have the misfortune of a second ticket for driving a motor vehicle while under the influence, even if the conviction occurred more than 10 years prior, and the defendant has rehabilitated himself in the interim,l will receive a "high risk" Further, the evaluator will recommend that the punishment include 75 hours of community service, plus 20 hours of classes.

xxx

This "one size fits all situations" policy makes no sense. If the evaluator has no discretion on the scenario outlined, what purpose the test?. Would save money (\$140) if a clerk asked the miscreant whether he had prior conviction and stamp his "test" result accordingly. If rehabilitation of the accused is a goal, should proven abstinence over a period of 10 years count for nothing?.

xxx

Lawrence County is blessed with two groups of drug-alcohol evaluators; one in he Department of Public Health, the other at a private industry counseling service. They are organized specialists, who have adopted administrative rules to protect their cottage industry, e.g. one cannot overrule the ratin' of the other. To talk to the one at Public Health is expensive. It cost the writer \$25 to

receive an affirmative reply to question, "Are you required to find the accused 'high level risk' and recommend 75 hours of public service, plus 20 hours of classes, regardless his good behavior for more than 10 years prior?"

xxx

The General Assembly should re-examine the role of drug-alcohol evaluators in the pursuit of justice, and highway safety. If is morally wrong to attempt to balance the budget on the backs of the predominantly poor. Too often it is they who bear the cost of this unnecessary layer of bureaucracy which bars workers from driver's license necessary for employment.

xxx

In an upscale section of Las Vega, a mother enraged by another motorist's behavior drove to her home, enlisted the support of her son who was armed with a pistol and drove in search of the offender. She was fatally injured when shots were exchanged. This tragedy suggests that most Americans haven't sense enough to safely own & operate fire arms. After the Illinois General Assembly makes change urged above, should repeal the law that permits one to carry concealed weapons.

xxx

The law legalizing gun carry was enacted because every other state had such a law. Monkey see, money do should not guide law making.

xxx

In our opinion, mental health is this nation's greatest health problem. Alas, effective treatment is non-existent.

March 5, 2015

"In like a lamb, out like a tiger." The hope is that quoted weather maxim for March is true in reverse. February was bestial.

xxx

It is silly to hope that spring comes on Groundhog Day, regardless of the animal's shadow.

xxx

We must change the proud slogan for Lawrence . Henceforth, "County of Champions." Who would have thought that the Indians would win regional championship in 2A in boys basketball, and the Salukis would duplicate that feat in 1A?

xxx

The community is indebted to all who assisted in constructing this public image of excellence. Surely worthwhile citizens will realize that if they would live with champions, they must move to County Lawrence.

xxx

News media has repeated his story until Jihadi Johnny, now identified as Mohammed Emwazi a Muslim psychopath educated in England, has become a feared symbol of heartless power.

xxx

Our CIA should Check with British school to be certain sufficient body tissue available for DNA identity verification, then offer \$10,000,000 for Emwazi's. head. Would thereby equate that killer's life to the technique some farmers use, buying the ears of sheep/chicken killing coyotes.

xxx

If the CIA gets Emwazi's GPS, it should send a drone and not await the grisly evidence of his joining allah. Proposed bounty would remain in the U.S. Treasury.

xxx

Gary Kasparov, champion Russian chess player, did not hesitate to attribute public assassination of Boris Nemtsov, Putin's most effective critic, to Russian President Putin. For latter to head the "investigation" of the murder is a cruel joke. Size of Sunday's Moscow protest of the murder suggests that justice might yet come to those responsible.

xxx

U.S. House of Representative Speaker John Boehner suffered severe loss of face when 50 "tea

party" Republican Congressmen refused to vote with him on money for home land security.. They insist on deletion of immigration amnesty from the bill. NBC TV opines Boehner hopes the Supreme Court will rescue by taking up question of immigration reform. We thought Is Israeli President Netanyahu's acceptance of Boehner's invitation to address a joint session of the U.S. Congress, Tuesday, was a sufficient coup to save his job.

xxx

Most Americans admire the Israelis, and wish them well. but Netanyehu has no right to stop Amercan agreement with Iran to put its nuclear program under international control. Israel has America's guarantee to go to war to prevent its destruction by the Muslims who surround it. That should suffice.

March 12, 2015

Politicians are inherently devious. If the electorate were more perceptive, their would-be public servants would display more candor. Some may have thought Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu's impassioned speech to the U.S. Congress was an effort to change U.S. foreign policy.

xxx

Israeli public opinion polls indicate that Herzog's party may defeat Likud in Tuesday's election. If so, possible that Netanyahu would be ousted. His trip to the U.S. was to seek votes at home.

xxx

That's the reason that our President Obama did not become greatly agitated by the diplomatic affront Netanyahu presented. If Herzog gains control, peace negotiations between Israelis and Palestinians will resume, and a separate Palestinian state inside Israel will become likely. We believe this scenario probable.

xxx

After the Teutopolis Wooden Shoes caught the Mighty Indians on a down night, we assumed that the State Championship plaque would be mailed to the Shoes without their appearance at Peoria to validate.

xxx

Alas, the ease with which Carterville ousted the Shoes in sectional final suggests that our hopes outran reality in evaluating the Indians. We belonged to the Little League without realizing it.

xxx

Notwithstanding such cruel reality, an entire impoverished community is indebted to the Indians for the feeling of triumph they brought to all. Next year will be even better.

xxx

The transitory nature of basketball fame suggests that parents, teachers and students recognize how much more important and lasting are the traditional studies.

xxx

We attended a few of the musical competitions at LHS Saturday. We were appalled how many "no shows" by scheduled contestants from other schools and how few spectators at the performances. The need is great for increased musical participation throughout Lawrenceville High School.

xxx

Hopefully the trip to Disney World, yesterday until Sunday night, will inspire every junior high student, and their parents, to continue his musical education and participation, including band, through the glorious years of high school.

xxx

It is an investment that will pay great dividends for life.

xxx

One must not speak ill of one of the county's larger employers, ATS, but we find it frightening that the Japanese have captured the imagination and support of American car buyers.

xxx

Many of their (Japanese) engineers are American educated. Why does their work product have more appeal than that of their determined American classmates?

xxx

We have seen no official breakdown percentage of the nationality of cars on American highways. The eyeball count is that there are too many foreign vehicles at every price level, even Lexus vs Cadillac.

xxx

We doubt that American vehicles are as numerous as the homegrown variety on the streets of Tokyo.

xxx

Our General Motors is making an all-out effort to be competitive in the vast Chinese market. It will be interesting to see how sales compare with Japan's in Shanghai.

March 19, 2015

If one watched the Imperial Gardens over the weekend, he could see the daffodil blossoms unfold. Our proofreader opined that most people call these crocuses. They are members of the daffodil family according to another flower expert whom we consulted. Anyway, 'twas miraculous.

xxx

While mankind has improved over nature in many ways, e.g., electronic communication, the actual creation of a plant, or a human, without outside help remains a mystery.

xxx

We are honored that Karl Koertge "lifted" the Press' opinion last week that Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu was more concerned with garnering Israeli votes in his Congressional speech than in starting a war against Iran for nuclear proliferation.

xxx

At press time seems apparent that the Israelis want Netanyahu to form the new government, rather than Herzog's left-leaning, peace-seeking Israeli Union Party, though later outpolled Likud.

xxx

We had thought Senator Tom Cotton, Arkansas, just another average senator, until he captured KK's total fury. The Senator is 37, Harvard law graduate, believes only thing wrong with detention center at Guantanamo is that all the beds are not filled. We suspect that most Americans share that opinion, and that Cotton's future is brighter than his detractors'.

xxx

What grand delusion – we discuss national and international affairs as though we could change the course of history. That awesome power is solely possessed by our elected officials who couldn't care less what you, KK or the Press believes.

xxx

We believe that Governor Rauner's popularity with the legislators, of each party, will plummet when they realize that he is determined that there shall be term limits. Without term limits democracy is a placebo for a frustrated public.

xxx

Governor Rauner inspired a petition drive a year ago, obtained almost a half million signatures to give the public a chance to vote on the question of term limits in the November, 2014 election. Predictably, the courts found the position unconstitutional.

xxx

Almost 30 years ago, a bright history teacher in Georgia named Newt Gingrich backed the Republican congressional candidates into a solemn "Compact with the People," wherein each pledged to serve no more than eight years. Most of the signers were overwhelmingly elected. We do not know of any who kept that pledge. Notwithstanding the melancholy track record recited, we admire those who persist in the effort to make democracy meaningful.

xxx

Spring is here. 'Tis the grandest season of the year,.

March 26, 2015

Paraphrasing Stephen Decatur, U.S. Naval Officer early 19th Century, "Our President, right or wrong, may he ever be right. but right or wrong, our President.

xxx

We are amused by the facial expression of surprise of most visitors to the Law Factory when they notice a picture of President Barrack Obama, and family, prominently displayed.

xxx

The picture is not intended as an endorsement of the politician, but is rather in recognition of the worldwide significance of his office and the power entrusted to him.

xxx

Twenty years ago, the wily Foreign Minister of Iraq said to a Western journalist who was condescending of Iraqi knowledge of the U.S. and the western world, "We watch CNN." Every American should remember that our President is, in the eyes of foreigners, both the symbol and the spokesman of our country

xxx

It is in our national interest to build up our President, that the leaders in Tehran and Jerusalem defer to him, rather than show disdain. One wondered whether Khomeini had watched Rudy Giuliani question the President's loyalty on all of our major television networks.

xxx

Where is God when seven exemplary children in a devout Brooklyn family perish in a home fire apparently started by an electrical hot plate operated in observance of their religious belief?

xxx

The gravitational pull of the larger to the smaller appears irresistible at every level the small cities of rural America are dwindling to nothing as the talented youth are drawn to a larger community. Seems impossible that Los Angeles is so large and magnetic it can pull St. Louis' only professional football team 1800 miles, to be housed with the symbol of economic grandeur it already owns, in

one multi-million dollar stadium. that will happen within three years.

xxx

Weep no more for St. Louis, unlike the villages of Illinois from whence the college trained youth have fled, St. Louis will find a replacement for the lost jewel. Perhaps they will fill Edward Jones Stadium with Christians battling lions, or maybe chariot races?

xxx

Robert Durst, 71, is a degenerate billionaire (NYC real estate) who has wasted his life in riotous living. He is accused of murdering three human beings along the way. Yet there isn't a lawyer alive who wouldn't rejoice at an opportunity to represent that scoundrel.

xxx

Monday's appearance by Durst before a New Orleans court, with his Texas lawyer Dick DeGuerin, was classic. Durst is accused of having a pistol in his hotel room. Normally bail would be set by a phone call. In this instance the presiding Judge refused to set bail (adopted prosecution argument that defendant was a flight risk). But release on bail would have been to two Los Angeles policeman to haul Durst back to LA to answer murder charge!

xxx

The Judge and prosecution obviously concluded Durst more likely to beat the LA rap than the gun charge. That the decision will be reversed on appeal is almost a given, DeGuerin did not appear anguished by the bail denial. Durst drug racked mind and body showed no reaction to the adverse court ruling. Perhaps he has already received the earthly punishment his suspected crimes against other humans deserve.

xxx

There are no unpunished crimes. Perhaps the entire criminal prosecution system is redundant. An expensive burden for taxpayers, but does furnish employment for many.

April 2, 2015

When the Marseilles prosecutor first announced that co-pilot Andreas Lubitch had deliberately driven his plane into the French Alps, thus murdering 149 other humans, we thought he was

getting a bad rap. We even wrote that the "evidence" was too circumstantial, flimsy, and accused too dead to refute.

xxx

Sadly, after more bits from his life are revealed, we have concluded that albeit circumstantial the evidence is too great to leave room for reasonable doubt. Some of his pictures suggest that Lufthansa should have noted a wild, disturbed look from his right eye. Where was German thoroughness at the critical moment when so many innocent lives were entrusted to his fidelity?

xxx

Nor is it irreligious for us to ask, where was God?

xxx

Is a lifetime too important, too short to waste days watching agile giants throw a ball through a hoop, and repeat the process ad nauseam?

xxx

Saturday afternoon and evening, and again Monday evening, 40 million Americans will be be glued to their television sets as the Final Four, NCAA Men's Basketball Tournament reaches its grand finale at Indianapolis.

xxx

Would have saved a ton of money, and mountains of work, if those in charge had mailed the trophy to Lexington, Ky. when the scheduled season ended , and Kentucky's repeat as national champion was apparent to all.

xxx

Chancellor Robert M. Hutchens took the university of Chicago out of the Big Ten, 75 years ago. Its academic standing has grown each year thereafter. America should deemphasize its sports craze, and seek excellence in other pursuits more beneficial to mankind.

xxx

We must change our prediction on outcome of Tuesday's mayoralty election in Chicago. The black minister with the largest congregation, Rev. Meeks, endorsed Rahm Emanuel for re-election We think that will suffice.

xxx

We have been surprised how often the Tribune observe that Meeks is Gov. Rauner's nominee to head Department of Education, and that the Governor and the Mayor have taken summer vacations together.

xxx

April 9, 2015

"Neville Chamberlain got a better deal from Adolf. Matter going to end with a mushroom cloud somewhere near Tehran," Senator Mark Kirk commenting on agreement of EU/US vs Iran that latter cease nuclear bomb development.

xxx

Quote was sufficient to ignite that curmudgeon Karl Koertge who does not appreciate Republicans. "Our fine stroke-damaged soon-to-be ex-GOP Senator from Illinois."

xxx

KK missed the point. Senator Kirk has a difficult reelection race against a Congresswoman named Duckworth who lost both legs flying helicopters in Vietnam. Kirk must have the normally Democratic Jewish vote to win in '16. Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu will personally write every Illinois Jewish voter to urge that they vote for Kirk twice.

xxx

KK, politics is as complicated as farming. Kirk will win.

xxx

We admired the apparent sincerity of the Iranian Foreign Minister at Lausanne. He reported frequently to his ayatollah masters. Unfortunately, the mullahs lead the mob at Friday prayers in

Tehran chanting, "Death to America."

xxx

Perhaps Senator Kirk was right. At least, America should send drones to change the message from the blood-thirsty mullahs to the Friday faithful.

xxx

We have been discouraged that NBC continues to hang Brian Williams 'out to dry.' His confusion as to whether his helicopter, or another target of enemy fire in Middle East war, was adequately explained by his word, "conflation". Those of us blessed by four years of English under the stern Fern Henry and Bess Boley at Sumner High never heard that word.

xxx

Anyway, televised nightly news relies on hype which attracts the public. Fox and National Enquirer established that human facility long ago. Williams lacked mens rea. Bring him back.

xxx

Much moaning at the bar when Wisconsin upset Kentucky in the NCAA men's quarter finals at Indy. Unfounded fear was that surprise winner would not give champion Duke full test.

xxx

Though our doubt remains that professional athletics give a nation worthy purpose, confess that the "amateur" games are entertaining.

xxx

Now that baseball has nudged basketball off the stage of public attention, should be noted that another sport, with an even longer season has begun: selection of presidential nominee by each of the two major parties. The bookies say Hillary Clinton, who will announce next week, will be the Democrat nominee, but that the Republican choice is far from resolved

xxx

Next 12 months will be interesting. We hope that the candidates will examine their opponents with unvarnished candor. In a dangerous world, strength in national leadership is vital for everyone's well being.

April 16, 2015

The mentally alert, aka those who own, understand and operate computers, should go "on-line" to notify President Obama their choice for the new face on \$20 bills, replacing Andrew Jackson.

xxx

The nominees were determined by earlier petitions. They are: Eleanor Roosevelt, Rosa Parks, Ellen Tubman, and Wilma Mankiller. We'll vote for Eleanor.

xxx

How crude has become American discussion. The barnyard term for sexual intercourse is so generally used, even among otherwise cultural individuals of either gender, it may be recognized when the Board of Scholars monitors usage for inclusion in the dictionary.

xxx

We will then know that mankind has bottomed out.

xxx

We rather admired Rand Paul's brash entrance into the GOP presidential selection process. In the unlikely event of his nomination at Cleveland in July, the record of the Democratic nominee will be examined with unvarnished candor.

xxx

The intellectual bankruptcy of the Democratic party is clearly signaled by its nomination of Hillary Clinton for President, 18 months before the election.

xxx

Senator Paul bears heavy burden of his 80 year old father who predicts the economic collapse of this country every time he is within news media range. Campaign managers must shut his mouth.

xxx

Entrance of Senator Mario Rubio, Florida, into the contest will surely prevent Jeb Bush from becoming the nominee by acclamation. We hope so. Two Bushes are enough.

xxx

President Obama shaking hands with President Castro, Jr. at the Inter-American Conference, Panama city, Panama, was a coup. It signaled the death knell for Atlantic City gambling casinos. They will all move to Havana within the year.

xxx

Perhaps there will be bargain jackpots in desperate effort to stay open before the inevitable?

xxx

Governor Rauner's characterization of the Illinois Supreme Court as "a part of a corrupt system," could have been applied to the Administrative Hearing Section, Driver's License Branch, Office of the Secretary of State.

xxx

Those who cannot resist fire water run great risk of being ensnarled in a bureaucracy that won't quit.

xxx

If a policeman sees a car weave, issues DUI ticket, the driver is required by the court to have a drug/ alcohol evaluation, even a near teetotaler, unless dismissed, or acquitted.

xxx

That group of would-be psychologists shows neither mercy, nor common sense. They recognize that the purpose of the law is to furnish their employment and that goal is served by requiring maximum penalty permitted by the guidelines without regard to the evidence.

xxx

Strangely, the judiciary and the prosecution treat their self-serving findings as irrefutable gospel and often abdicate their (judicial & prosecutorial) responsibility to challenge nonsense.

xxx

Cost of resistance of the present system is beyond the financial reach of the poor and downtrodden which it ensnares.

xxx

So, the accused jump through hoops ad nauseam in the futile hope of regaining their license to earn a livelihood to support themselves and their dependents.

xxx

Society suffers from this self-inflicted wound that should be corrected.

xxx

Happy motoring.

xxx

April 23, 2015

For some the birds sing. Professor Lee Martin and Allen Johnson, two splendid contributing editors to the Sumner Press write books and hope that they will become "best sellers". Each eagerly attends book signing events sponsored by literate groups at which the author autographs his book to the delight of the purchaser. It is basic retail merchandising that requires stamina and determination.

xxx

We can imagine the envy of each named friend as he witnessed this week the public proclamation by Senator Rand Paul, who seeks the Republican nomination for President in next year's election, that a book, Clinton Cash, by Peter Schweizer, will be released May 4, and that it will "derail" the candidacy of Hillary Clinton, who is the uncontested Democratic nominee for President.

xxx

The lines of purchasers of Schweizer's book will be longer than those for a Harry Potter book! The author can ignore the tedium of book signing. His book is a guaranteed best seller. Whether it will be a political bombshell must await the public reaction to its charge that Bill & Hillary Clintons' Foundation accepted a billion dollars from foreign governments, who received U.S. government favors instigated by the Clintons.

xxx

We were not impressed that the parents of Martin Richard, an eight year old boy killed in the Boston Marathon explosion two years ago, publicly urged that Massachusetts not seek the death penalty for the convicted bomber, Dzhokhar Tsarnaev. The public has the right to be protected from future terrorism. Execution of this non repentant murderer would surely deter other criminals from such atrocious conduct.

xxx

His execution should be in such manner as will facilitate maximum salvage of his body organs, including his malignant heart, that Americans in need thereof might have their lives vicariously extended. Those of us who believe in atonement for sins would hope that harvest and transplants suggested would benefit Tsarnaev when he meets his god.

xxx

Our doubts of the utility of psychiatrists were strengthened last week as a Federal judge confining the terms under which John Hinckley, Jr., who shot President Ronald Reagan, 1981, will be released from a hospital for the criminally insane, for home visit with his 88 year old mother, ordered "the defendant will continue to receive his regular psychiatric treatment."

xxx

One would think that 34 years so long enough for any bona fide medical treatment.

xxx

The Iranian ayatollah seems determined to torpedo the non proliferation treaty negotiated by EU

& USA with his representatives at Geneva. He proclaimed that Iran would resume full scale nuclear research unless all economic sanctions against Iran are lifted immediately; the sanctions appear to have had a salutary effect on Iranian behavior. One would think the ayatollah would listen to his impoverished subjects and accept the gradual lifting, as American and European experts confirm Iranian dismantling of their nuclear research, as promised.

xxx

Last week we mentioned that we would vote on the internet that Eleanor Roosevelt's replace Andrew Jackson on the \$20 bill. But after reading Treasury & President Obama's reasons for replacing Jackson: too tough on displaced Indians from needed frontier land and his dislike of huge banks, we believe Jackson should stay. "If it isn't broken, don't fix it."

April 30, 2015

We received the standard fund solicitation letter from Laura Bush for Bush Center, Dallas. "There is no better way to show you support for these principles----." We admire the lady, the future President married well, and we have enjoyed visiting almost all of the presidential libraries, wouldn't a give a dime for the aggrandizement of any.

xxx

Essentially, presidential libraries are personal monuments in addition to grand tourist attractions. Shouldn't offend anyone that the honoree participate in its cost and operation. We almost admired President Clinton. He granted a presidential pardon to one who had black marketed oil during the Gulf War. Simultaneously, the pardonee's wife gave multi millions to the Clinton Foundation for building & maintenance of the Little Rock Library.

xxx

Jodie Buchman and Larry Whitner share an interest in Custer's Last Stand, Little Big Horn, June 25-26, 1876. They combined their scholarly research to present an informative program to 80 other history buffs at the Lawrence County Historical Society, Monday evening.

xxx

Jodie had a more personal connection to this military disaster in which 10,000 Indians massacred 270 members of the 7th Cavalry. Her great grandfather, Private Adams was there.

xxx

We were glad that their program didn't follow modern tendency of ridiculing leader of the American troops, General George Custer, as an arrogant, publicity-seeking showman. They noted that Custer was the youngest general in the Civil War, cited repeatedly for bravery. Nor did they express sympathy for the Indians who were resisting American effort to place them in reservations.

xxx

Though Hitler's #1 henchman, Herman Goering, delighted to remind the world that Americans, "murdered the redskins" difference between Nazi behavior and ours is total. They sent the displaced to gas chambers; our ancestors placed the Indians in living quarters far finer than teepees. They fed, clothed and cared for a backward people who lacked an alphabet, language, written record, or any ambition to justify their existence.

xxx

Grayville High School sent the 20 members of its graduating class to Washington, Philadelphia & New York City this week. In 1941, Sumner High School sent the 20 members of its graduating class to Giant City State Park. Then, no more developed that Red Hills State Park.

xxx

What the SHS children needed least was more exposure to rural America. How we envy GSH students, to savor big city America in one magnificent week.

xxx

Our compassion and indication of progress in educating the young is not a criticism of Superintendent H.A. Dollahan. He was a gifted educator who deserved to have chipped on his gravestone, "gave to the taxpayers more than he received."

xxx

Our Class was blessed with several extraordinary teachers: The curse of small townints did not infect us, but the trip to Giant City State Park was a waste of time--life's most valuable component.

May 7, 2015

Not a single May Day Parade in the county. Where were the mayors?

xxx

There is a shortage of daycare services in the county seat. Big bottom bureaucracy in Springfield closed two formidable providers: First Christian Church, some years ago, and United Methodist Village, more recently.

xxx

It is time to throw bricks at each and all connected with EPA. That group of pay-rollers is more interested in making the would-be providers jump through hoops than in solving the problem.

xxx

Our legislators need to be reminded non-stop of Thomas Jefferson's priceless wisdom, "That government is best which governs least."

xxx

Don't ever go to a board meeting of your church. It is the blind leading the blind: timid, insecure, fearful. Why is liability insurance a major item in every church's budget? Insurance sales people have brainwashed all.

xxx

Surely to God the believers are numerous enough that a competent lawyer can find one on a jury to say "whoa" when some malingerer seeks to bankrupt the house of the Lord.

xxx

Of monstrous medical bills, is there room in hell for a surgeon who charges \$1,750 for a 15 minute evidentiary deposition taking, on a routine rotator cuff resection? Greed ill becomes anyone, including "angels of mercy." Government could cure this malady by doubling the number of med school admissions and printing more copies of Mary Baker Eddy's handbook.

xxx

Saturday evening's prom procession at LHS gym was impressive. A few male students forgot that there is a time to be solemn. Press awarded prize for decorum to Henrik Kjaervik, Norwegian exchange student who resides in the home of Scott & Angela Hancock. Nor was their son, Nicholas Clark, rowdy. Nice event.

xxx

We look forward to graduation. That should-be solemn ceremony always comes too quickly after May commencements.

xxx

Lawrence County Circuit Court was honored Thursday to have Associate Judge Jerry Crisel, Albion, on the bench. His Honor noted that he believes it worthwhile for older citizens to write pleasant memories from their past. We intend to pursue that conviction with Press readers.

xxx

With all the injustices, labored excessively in this column, life is worthwhile regardless how gorgeous the weather. One should not drift into the "waiting to die syndrome." Best we're alive and living.

May 14, 2015

Seymour Hersh's record as an investigative reporter is too solid to be dismissed as another publicity sensation seeker. This Pulitzer prize winner and regular contributor to the New Yorker published an accusation in a London daily that the White House version of the summary execution of Osama bin Laden in 2011 was a total lie.

xxx

Hersh claimed that Osama was sent to meet Allah by drones in Afghanistan, rather than by the Navy Seals in Pakistan capitol suburb. Further, that \$25M paid by the CIA to a Pakistan general for the target's address.

xxx

The White House firmly supported the original announcement which filled this country with pride

in its leadership. The discrepancy is too broad to permit ignoring. In addition, the taxpayers' \$25M should bring total restraint to CIA waste.

xxx

The Boston jury is expected to recommend life imprisonment for Dzhokhar Tsarnaev within the day for murdering four spectators at the marathon race two years ago and maiming hundreds.

xxx

For that criminal to remain alive makes as much sense as sending a mad dog to a veterinary hospital. Though the video proof that the defendant planted the bomb was irrefutable, 150 witnesses were called in trial that commenced in early March. The criminal justice system too often is an employment agency for lawyers with theatrical ability, performing at taxpayer expense.

xxx

The crowning development in this travesty was the statement of the warden at the federal prison in Colorado in which the defendant will probably reside for the next 40 years. He can watch television, write a book, and earn a college degree if he wishes to apply himself. Tsarnaev's fate may prove more of an inducement to other Muslim fanatics than a deterrent.

xxx

Governor Rauner received a rude introduction to the legislative process last week. The bill to support the multi-million dollar expenditure reduction which he has proposed was unanimously rejected by the Democratic controlled House of Representatives as its Republican legislators each voted "present," a cowardly refusal to stand up and be counted.

xxx

It is safely predictable that the State income tax increase to 7.5%, which was scheduled to expire, will be restored by June 1 as the Governor bends to the Democrat-controlled House and Senate determination not to reduce spending.

xxx

We found Justice Karmeier's rationale for rejecting prior administration's effort to reduce future

pension load curious. He believed and the other Supreme Court members unanimously concurred that reduction of future pensions unconstitutional because it took property without process. But the opposite is also true, the public will pay more taxes to secure the benefits for public employee union members.

May 21, 2015

Scrivener's error is a legal term that permits the drafter of a written instrument to escape error by substituting words intended for those inadvertently used, or copied. We claim a scrivener's error. Last week this column confidently predicted that the Boston Marathon murderer would receive sentence Dzhokhar Tsarnaev to death. We intended to say that he would never be executed.

xxx

With change noted, we repeat the prediction. It was expensive theatrics that he was solemnly sentenced to be executed by lethal injection. That practical disposition of murderers belongs to an earlier era when a majority of mankind believed in the hereafter.

xxx

If it were possible to exchange life expectancy with his criminal, we would gratefully do so, with whatever boot required.

xxx

We never miss the graduation ceremony. It is a significant event in the lives of the young people involved. Many recognize that reality.

xxx

We complement the Lawrenceville High School graduation planners. The program clearly stated, "Remain seated for recessional." East bleacher escapes obeyed such command until half of the graduates had marched by; west bleachers ignored such civility. We urge armed police next year to maintain that minimum of dignity at this solemn occasion.

xxx

Another change that must be made is the boy-girl alignment as the proud graduates march in and out. Too often a pair are the same gender. We urge a mix until the supply of boys is exhausted.

XXX

That problem seemed particularly obvious in the presentation of the Top Ten at Red Hill High School graduation, nine girls, one boy. Perhaps there is an over-emphasis of boys' sports with academic loss?

XXX

As we looked into the eyes of the graduates at both schools, we saw the same determination, "we'll escape this small town and find excitement in the big city." Inability to retain its young is the tragedy of every small town. We must try harder, more effectively, to lure industry/ jobs.

XXX

The Band is an essential component of the graduation ceremony. Each year LHS must draft junior high musicians for a quorum, LHS needs a band minded Board of Education. Our unsolicited advice is for our members to inquire of the Newton Bd of Ed how.

XXX

We envy the 128 graduates. They enter a new phase of life, in a world that's getting better and better, every day, in every way. Their opportunities are unlimited. We wish them well.

May 28, 2015

Last week the Illinois General Assembly received two commission reports that should be of interest to all taxpayers. First, on healthcare received by 48,000+ inmates, prepared by allies of the John Howard, the ultimate in do-gooders concerned about prisoner treatment. The second, apparently ordered by the GA, concerned allegations that top personnel in community colleges were being overpaid and that reckless waste of taxpayer funds was rampant.

XXX

The DOC report concluded that healthcare received by inmates was inadequate, inferior. Other experts have refuted such finding on too. Our opinion based on personal contact with former inmates, is that every prisoner receives better healthcare than when free, and better than that received by the average taxpayer. DOC has a budget of almost \$1,000,000,000. No mber of suicides among prisoners was cited as a reason for the conclusion, as though there were a relation.

Our suggestion is that manual labor be incorporated in every prisoner's daily routine, over strong union opposition. Would the therapeutic. Prison time should be sufficiently severe that none would wish to return after release. Presently, 50% do.

xxx

The report on waste in the community college expenditures may be more accurate, but the belt tightening should commence at the university level. New President of the U of I will receive \$500,000/ year. Football & basketball coaches receive more. Argument for this generosity with taxpayers money is that winning teams sell more tickets, up the news media reward, money-makers. If this explanation is valid, shouldn't coaches' salaries be contingent on W-L record? None are.

xxx

A 64 year old school teacher in Berlin had her hormones in proper alignment, appeared in excellent health, desired to give birth to children by artificial insemination. Germany forbids that procedure under those circumstances. So, Fraulein Annegret Raunik went abroad for that procedure. Last week she gave birth to quadruplets, three boys and a girl... Bild was critical of her behavior, "anti-social."

xxx

We thought her reply classic, "They can see it how they want to. I will see it the way I think is right." We thought her reply was classic.

xxx

Forty years from now, every civilized nation will limit human reproduction.

xxx

Though the public grumbles at the traffic delay as blacktop roads are being resurfaced, all part in satisfaction when the process is complete. One should drive on Route 250 from W. Lawrenceville to West line of Bridgeport. Smooth.

xxx

Regrettable that the District Highway Engineer, and his DOT superiors remain determined to build new multi million dollar bridge across Embarras River at 15th Street, Lawrenceville. New bridge will be eight feet higher at one point than the old, which is adequate and would last another 40 years.

xxx

Common sense suggests that the new bridge should be built upstream 3/8ths of a mile, to carry the north two lanes of route 50. Same amount of money, could almost use the same plans, would give hope to a community in desperate need of good news that Four Lanes for Fifty will one day happen.

xxx

Impressive that mass murderer Wint identified within 48 hours, apprehended within four days of the Washington D.C. family murder. Unfortunate that he surrendered too meekly to permit summary execution by the police. How can the soft headed who abound in this nation keep Wint alive until he dies of old age?

xxx

June 4, 2015

None needed to go to Bay View, Michigan, Sunday-Tuesday, to escape the summer heat. Bay View came to County Lawrence. Ten months out of twelve we have finest climate on earth. Should advertise our good fortune.

xxx

Public humiliation of Dennis Hastert demonstrates the police state, which the USA has become, in action. FBI investigated the "target" because he withdrew large amounts of cash, found no criminal activity, but chose to prosecute this former Speaker of the House because he was too embarrassed to admit that he paid hush money for terrible lapse of judgment 30 years ago. FBI used the catch-all charge, lying to the omniscient.

xxx

One wonders if Rev. (ugh) Al Sharpton was questioned as to who started the fire that burned his income tax records and apparently stalled Sharpton's prosecution. If Hastert were black, he would

not have been ruined. We do not condone his indiscretion. Revealed his judgment so bad that one shudders when he became President of Bush and Cheney had been killed or removed from office.

xxx

Press will give \$10 to first Press subscriber who calls 943-2300 with acronym by which students remembered order of presidential succession, before Congress changed the order, more than 30 years ago, to make the Speaker next in line after President and Vice-President.

xxx

Mike Huckabee showed more moral courage in defending Duggar who had sinned as a teenager than did Wheaton College. Latter group instantly disassociated itself from Hastert who had benefited the college greatly. Gutless.

xxx

Spring session of the Illinois General Assembly has concluded without any identifiable legislation that helps Lawrence County. The impasse between the Governor and the House-Senate leadership continues. Struggle is to determine whether to balance the budget by lowering state expenses or by higher taxes. It will continue through the special session that has been called. Unlikely, but if the deadlock continues into the 2016 election, it will be a do or die struggle for each side.

xxx

Scary that the public opinion polls continue to show that Hillary Clinton would beat any of a dozen Republican hopefuls for President. Her announced opponents for the nomination, Vermont Senator Sanders and Marilyn's former Governor O'Malley, are tokens to create the illusion of a genuine primary contest. Every Democrat and too many Republicans consider the election a formality.

xxx

Alas, if Jed Bush beats Mario Rubio in the Florida primary, April, he is the likely Republican nominee. The USA must not substitute coronation for election. Many Americans will vote, "none of the above."

June 11, 2015

The nationally televised pageantry of Catholic burials is beneficial to mankind. Encourages all to cling to the desperate hope that life is more than what we see, that after this short, bitter struggle the best of life is yet to be.

xxx

The affection of Delaware citizens for the late Beau Biden was palpable. Nor was his funeral mass demeaned by the political rally which it became.

xxx

Hillary Clinton showed nerve in decision to attend the funeral. The Vice-President might decide that in the normal course of politics he should be the nominee for President next year.

xxx

Legalized medical marijuana is almost here. What a challenge that will be to law enforcement at every level. Our guess is that the homegrown illegal brand will outweigh the other three-fold. Our fear is that the addiction that marijuana has will spread to meth and other species which cause the teeth to fall out and the cheeks to sink. Such teens should brighten the corner where they are.

xxx

We know of no area more neglected in brick home building than our hometown, Sumner. Two Sumner families, Bridwell & Inyart, have furnished brick masons of great skill for several generations. We would not have been remiss when we built our home, 1968, to seek the addiction that marijuana has will spread to meth and other species which cause the teeth to fall out and the cheeks to sink. Such teens should brighten the corner where they are.

xxx

One would think that the homegrown illegal brand will outweigh the other three-fold. We note on Facebook that Dan & Holly Scherer are retiring July 1, and that they have not sold the greenhouse for the medical marijuana distribution center as reported. Our guess is that it is 99% certain that the Canadian entrepreneur named as the purchaser will be back with the dough. Otherwise, people as thrifty and work oriented as Dan & Holly would never retire.

xxx

The work ethic has died throughout Illinois, and probably other states as well. It would have a salutary effect, might even help revive that priceless human trait, if regular bus tours were held for recipients of government checks from the Post Office to Allison Prairie to watch the Mexican families hoeing watermelon plants.

xxx

We thought that we saw Dorothy Jean Viehman out in the fields with a hoe trying to keep up with the Mexicans.

xxx

Shame on all who would deport Mexican workers regardless of the legality of their entry into this land of opportunity.

xxx

Almost 40 years since Hal Heidbreder, Adventures, Rooney & Ladner published the last Lawrenceville Directory. Almost as useful as the Bible. Let's all recruit returnees to Lawrence County until the population and the savoir faire cause another city directory.

June 18, 2015

We had resolved nevermore to mention in this column the name of a certain farmer, Karl Koertge. Though his own writing had a certain charm, a tribute to the BTHS English Department's effort to give him polish, Mr. Koertge became a pimp for every leftwing columnist encountered and apparently expected your newspaper to publish their drivel.

xxx

KK offended our sensibilities by touting the left wing comment of someone named Taylor, "Antoini Scalia is unfit to be a justice on the U. S. Supreme Court." Basis of the unfitness claimed is that justice's religious faith. There is no lawyer, living or dead, who will deny that Scalia is the intellectual leader of the court. Shameless, dishonest that these jokers would thus attack him. KK knows better than he acts in this instance.

xxx

We know of no area more neglected in brick home building than our hometown, Sumner. Two Sumner families, Bridwell & Inyart, have furnished brick masons of great skill for several generations. We would not have been remiss when we built our home, 1968, to seek out the addiction that marijuana has spread to meth and other species which cause the teeth to fall away from the body and to sink. Such teens should brighten the corner where they are.

xxx

We had resolved nevermore to mention the name of the certain farmer, Karl Koertge, who has authored a few books in his time, but if he is going to be a pimp for leftist columnists we'll combat all such with all the powers of this column.

xxx

A small bounty on killing sharks would cure the problem very quickly. Predictably the environmentalists would protest, extinction of the species. The answer should be that the environmentalists personally swim in these waters to prove humane safety.

xxx

All Americans are appalled at the price of wonder drugs, as much as \$1,000 a pill, to combat HIV in prison patients. Traditionally drug companies have cited, "tremendous cost of research and development." We found a refreshing instance to support that claim in "what the doctor said," column of Decatur Herald & Review.

xxx

Happily, competition seemed to play the right role this week, drug prices were halved in those instance, prices for HIV/AIDS medication down. The mechanic, demonstrated that reduction of drug prices, "is in the bottle."

xxx

The royal race has begun — Hillary Clinton vs. Jeb Bush to be their respective party's nominee in next year's presidential election. Discouraging that major news media treat the race as a fait accompli, and that the dozen other aspirants are merely warm-up ponies for the front-runners.

xxx

Is the Press alone in its conviction that a democracy of 300+ million has more than two royal families capable of leading this nation to peace, prosperity, and world leadership?

xxx

June 25, 2015

Irresponsible, but we believe that a great many otherwise decent citizens hope that s & y, convicted murderers who escaped more than two weeks ago from a maximum security prison in New York, are never captured. They dare believe that these criminals will get to a remote section of Mexico; that each will reform his personal values, and will spend the next 40 years teaching their nonsuspecting hosts good citizenship. We Americans have a morbid appetite for underdogs. Underdogs they are, every bloodhound, canine and human, in New York & Pennsylvania is on their trail. Chance of their escaping capture 90 days is nonexistent.

xxx

The track record on recapture of escapees is so total if any could real be incarcerated from being trying. Every prison should be minimum security, with a sign on the barbed wire fence, "Gentlemen, if you run, we'll catch you and double your sentence." Whiney Bolger, the Boston mob executioner, captured 2 years ago after almost 10 years on the lam was a different in that he had an old flame who could keep quiet about his past.

xxx

Our sympathies are with the husband of the limbo prison employee who smuggled chisels to these rascals, and discussed husband's execution with the scare commodities by recapture without killing either, and without injury to any of the bloodhounds.

xxx

There has been so much idle prattle about good coming from the terrible tragedy at Emanuel AME Episcopal Church, Charleston, S.C. Our solution would be a little different than those we've read. We would hope the defendant had exhausted his appeals from conviction as a mass murderer within six months, that justice be swift, that revenge fight could be settled by the Pacman weather fight could be divided and dependent be killed. New cited mass murders New Loxion, Colorado, & Ft. Hood.

xxx

We believe that this approach to a problem would have salutary effect in future cowardly assaults.

xxx

Sadly insult, the politician who has authored Emanuel's December, who was a state senator, tragedy, because he had voted concealed carry in that state. Rare is the individual with sufficient judgment to safely carry a concealed pistol, but politicians who hope to be re-elected have no choice than to vote against their conscience, and common sense.

xxx

We fear that many more Charleston tragedies must occur before common sense is restored in America, and NRA is ignored.

xxx

July 2, 2015

Last week's column over estimated maximum time Sweat & Matt, the escaped murderers from New York's maximum security prison, might avoid recapture. Matt was fatally shot two miles from prison when discovered and captured on 23rd day.

xxx

It was a reflection on the life of every American whose attention was riveted on these losers for 23 days.

xxx

In retrospect, only feature of this melancholy affair that was heroic was the ingenuity, determination that Matt & Sweat brought to their jail break. We should each bring such qualities to our daily lives, outside the prison walls.

xxx

Another lesson from this event, for the Department of Corrections, is for less panic about escapees

and the tremendous expense of overtime for the hunters. We saw this rush to spend 2-3 years ago when a harmless old prisoner at the Robinson Correctional Facility wandered away from a work detail. D.O.C. estimated cost of his recapture at \$3,000,000. We think there should be a manhunt for a felon who escapes from one of the categories in which superior prisons are measured... including community acceptance, and need.

xxx

We thought President Obama's rendition of "Amazing Grace" at the memorial service for the victims of the Emanuel Church tragedy was classic. But our President's versatility must not sidetrack closed circuit hanging of the assassin, with distribution of the net from ticket sales to the families of the victims. Had such win-win solution already occurred might have saved 38 Europeans, primarily British, from being murdered last week at a Tunisian Mediterranean resort.

xxx

Attorney Lindsay Reece, Taylorville, has authorized disclosure that he is the third member of the Committee to Draft John Kasich, Governor of Ohio, for the GOP Presidential Nomination in 2016. Election. Ours is not a closed corporation. We invite all interested in good government to join our Committee. We will publish your names. You will taste with us the thrill of victory.

xxx

CLC postponed its Fish Fry/Fireworks on the Wabash at St. Francisville, from June 27 to July 25. Reason, high waters. But when they saw the crowd which competing grilled chicken dinners at Bethlehem church, Saturday evening, drew, they must have concluded that postponement was fortuitous. We were impressed by the number of young workers the chicken fry featured. This non-denominational, non-affiliated group is a magnet for new members, featured by Rev. Steve Potts.

xxx

Roscoe's Journal — Part 008

July 9, 2015

If there are a couple more three day shut downs, "in honor of something," we believe each will need to learn Chinese, to commensurate with the new owners. Disgraceful that the Courthouse was closed the 3rd, and that United Health follow suit. Hooray for the Post Office and the banks'

neither arbitrarily removed a day from the lives of each they seek to serve.

xxx

Obviously it is their finest who emigrate from Greece. Alas, those left behind appear priceless. How else can one describe a citizenry who refuse to repay loans from other countries, vote almost two to one against repayment, yet demand that the lenders whom they describe as "vampires" loan more to sustain bloated social services benefits which the Greeks awarded themselves, and are demonstrably larger than Greek productivity can support. They rioted in the streets against lenders' suggestion that the government adopt austerity measures, that the people live within their income. Lead by their President Tsipras, they partied until the dawn the vote count against loan repayment.

xxx

The awakening came at dawn. The German bankers refused to loan Greece another euro. The ATMs will run out of money within a day or so, the once proud cradle of democracy will be reduced to a barter economy, not unlike third world nations in Africa. We await President Tsipras' explanation for the riots that will come.

xxx

The advocates of "genuine democracy", where every citizenry votes on every matter, should conclude from Sunday's vote fiasco that the ideal is impractical. It assumes that all the voting citizens are fully informed as to the issues, ramifications. Our founding fathers had the wisdom to create a "representative democracy"

which has worked well for more than two centuries.

xxx

Startling that retiring Attorney General Eric Holder would mention at press conference that the Department might consider a deal with Edward Snowden, the whistle-blower on government surveillance of all citizens. Snowden presently lives in Moscow in political asylum.

xxx

The decision will require Solomonic wisdom by our leaders: Snowden struck an effective lick for

every American's individual liberty. Some of the changes he urged have been adopted. But if rewarded by total a amnesty on pending felony charges of violation of his oath of secrecy, would shred our intelligence gathering systems. Whistle blowers would abound. Not even the Sumner Press would welcome responsibility to make that decision.

xxx

The Committee to Draft John Kasich for the GOP Presidential Nomination has been discouraged that there has not been a stampede of other concerned citizens who wish to join the Committee. Unlike every other political action committee, this group seeks no cash contribution. Merely send to Sumner Press, Box 511 Lawrenceville, IL 6243. following signed message, "I wish to join the Committee to Draft John Kasich for GOP Presidential Nomination". name & address.

xxx

As we approach baseball's All-Star Game, recognition should be given to the St. Louis Cardinals. Even without their two best pitchers, the Cards have best won record in the majors, as is their wont. Present members do a splendid job of keeping alive spirit of the gashouse gang of Dizzy & Daffy Dean, GM Branch Rickey, 1934, and of the great Cardinal teams in the years that followed.

July 16, 2015

The problem with atheism is that there is no prize if proven correct.

xxx

At age five or six, we accompanied grandfather, 90+ on morning visit to Civil War buddies, Kromill Sceggs, Salisbury and Baker, all of whom live in Sumner. None complained about the Confederate flag flying throughout the South. If those involved in that terrible war did not begrudge any solace the defeated found in flying the flag, why should these do-gooders purposely create national disharmony by urging that the flag come down 85 years later?

xxx

The political hypocrisy that surrounded the entire affair was a disgrace to the memory of a half million Confederate dead. We were startled that the Governor Nikki Haley, S.C., thought to have national potential, lacked the nerve to resist the flag burners.

xxx

As we dwell on national problems over which we have absolutely no control, we realize anew that our political leaders have purposely led public opinion away from the important question that should be asked of every elected official: "What have you done for the well-being of Lawrence County?"

xxx

Too often the obvious answer is, "nothing." Perhaps there is merit in that bumper sticker, "Fight Organized Crime, Vote to re-elect no one."

xxx

Sad but true, inequival 20r4k may have died in County Lawrence. Where are the shoe cobblers, dry cleaners, laundries, bicycle, typewriter, radio, television and plumbing repair, people who once distinguished our County from the common herd?

xxx

In our over-regulated society too many semi-skilled operations may be performed only by licensed personnel.

One suspects that society's best interests would be served if half of the procedures now limited to "licensed" personnel were deregulated.

xxx

First essential returned to the public's convenience and common sense usage is plumbing. Those licensed monopolists make life impossible.

xxx

Why not let the sun shine in. Any responsible citizen with observable common sense should be permitted to assist his neighbor fasten two pipes together without fear of criminal prosecution.

xxx

Try to find a plumber after banker hours, or on a holiday, even a weekend. The writer is not

adamant that when he was your servant in the General Assembly, he introduced the bill to deregulate horse shoeing.

XXX

The law of common sense has never been repealed. The public is smart enough to determine who has sufficient skill to perform by their results.

XXX

If failure of college graduates to return to the little towns in which they were raised is what causes their hometowns to wither on the vine, and we so believe, might government solve the problem by waiving student loan repayment for every grad who came from a county of less than 30,000 and returned to live in that county for five years.

XXX

Our suggestion would work wonders for little county. It is as morally defensible as the tremendous taxpayer contribution to mass transit in the large communities, and for extra police to lessen chance of the bright new residents being murdered.

XXX

We must each brighten the corner where we are and make every day count for community improvement.

July 23, 2015

Press suggestion that repayment of college loan balance be waived for students who came from a county of less than 30,000 population and returned to similar sized county for five years immediately after leaving college, deserves wide public discussion, and enactment by the General Assembly.

XXX

Brain drain of students from small communities going after college to the big cities has been disastrous to the communities in which they were raised.

XXX

Government created the problem through the college loan program. It is appropriate that government solve the problem.

xxx

The program we've outlined would be easy to administer, and to monitor.

xxx

The curse of small communities dwindling to nothingness will not go away without determined government effort. The need is great.

xxx

Rare is the Illinois county south of Springfield which has not suffered a large population drop during the last 50 years.

xxx

Donald Trump's campaign statements are so outrageously politically incorrect, it is surprising that he is not laughed off the stage. Far from dismissal, many cheer his candor. He says what they believe but lack the courage to utter. He shredded Senator John McCain's "war hero" mantle. "It is based on having been captured in Viet Nam; I prefer soldiers who do not surrender."

xxx

We remembered the campaign of the late James Alexander for Representa-

tive in the General Assembly 65 years ago. POW was prominently displayed on his campaign literature. Snorted the late

Curley Stull, "In Russia they shoot their soldiers who surrender." The candidate's presence status was deleted from campaign literature.

xxx

In fairness, should be noted that criticism of neither Alexander, or McCain, for surrendering was

unjustified. Each was an airman, shot down, landing deep in enemy territory. That reality, plus Trump's lack of a service record will surely doom his campaign after the first debate. In the interim, we think the public will find his bluntness refreshing in this high stakes game in which each seeks to be on both sides of every issue.

xxx

Lenin dismissed religion as, "the opiate of the masses." He could have accurately thus described television. Life should have more purpose than merely watching television.

xxx

Eight months and counting since there has been a parade in the county seat. Something exciting should happen each weekend in one of the five municipalities in the County. Press will give a cash prize to the city which has an event within the next year which creates most outside interest in our County, e.g. Russellville's Polar Plunge.

xxx

Regrettable that Fall Festival in the County Seat, September 16-19, is touted as a major community building effort. Carnivals should be banned because their rides impoverish parents unable to say "no" to clamoring children.

July 30, 2015

Our President showed courage, and confidence in the Secret Service, as he visited one of the least law abiding nations in Africa, albeit his irresponsible father's homeland, Kenya. Perhaps living in Chicago created that derring-do. We are glad he has returned safely to the USA.

xxx

We found it reassuring that Obama has wasted fewer taxpayer dollars on the lost cause called Africa than did his predecessor.

xxx

Regrettable that the last years of his term diminished by wild news media speculation as to his successor. Hillary noted that it is six months until the Iowa primary.

xxx

The news media, including The Sumner Press, should self-impose restraint on coverage of 2016 presidential election until that year arrives. This column will do so unless Donald Trump does something too outrageous to ignore, e.g., public parade in his underwear.

xxx

Garbage removal in County Lawrence has become an expensive luxury. Government should intervene by lessening regulations that competition might bring cost down to bearable limits.

xxx

When feasible, competition rather than government regulation should be the consumer's protection against price gouging.

xxx

Even the thousand dollar a pill syndrome could be corrected by shortening time period original manufacturer protected from generic competition.

xxx

Too little change comes to County Lawrence. Twenty years ago we floated down the large creek in Indiana euphemistically called Blue River. We thought Lawrence should have such a tourist attraction. Wielded an embankment at 15th & Embarras labeled Lorie's Landing, negotiated a passenger pick-up spot a mile downstream, persuaded Department of Conservation to give the project 12 flat bottom boats which were being replaced. We were in actual operation (in our mind). Then, we noticed that the river had run dry.

xxx

We attempted to interest the U.S. Corps of Engineers in a low level dam on the Wabash just below Pulleyville. They appeared to believe that that river in its present neglected, untouched state was all that County Lawrence deserves.

xxx

Surely to God, Senator Righter, Representatives Phillips & Reis, Congressman Shimkus, and/or Governor Rauner could cause the Division of Waterways to make a quick feasibility study of suggested project, including a reaming out of the Embarras below Lawrenceville. Department has three dredge boats which rarely come below Peoria.

xxx

Cost of the project which we outline would be minimal. Would make St. Francisville a boating mecca. Might not raise the water level sufficiently for the long overdue Blue River imitation, but would be a marvelous step into a brighter future for a neglected area.

xxx

Though we doubt that a tillable acre would be flooded, the brave new beginning would need to be defended against adjacent pitchfork yielding farmers.

xxx

Dare to hope.

August 6, 2015

About ten years ago Richland County built a large jail, across the street south from the Courthouse. It is state of the art; could house 100 "guests," either gender.

xxx

How could a county no richer than Lawrence afford such a facility? Ironically, Lawrence County taxpayers pay the Richland County Jail about \$50,000 a year to house our overflow.

xxx

Common sense suggests that this financial hemorrhage should be stopped instanter. We are not advocating building a new, bigger, better jail here. Release of every non-violent prisoner awaiting trial on his own recognizance would solve the need to enrich Richland Crawford counties to run an expensive hotel at Lawrence County taxpayers' expense.

xxx

With the simple policy change suggested, present Lawrence County Jail is adequate for another 40 years. Saving to the taxpayers needs no laboring. The idea needs to be adopted by the police, prosecution and judiciary.

xxx

Present stalemate between Governor Rauner and the General Assembly is killing any hope for progress in Lawrence County - roads, recreation, new industry, jobs to keep the young amongst us. We think that the parties are in pari-delicto.

xxx

Democrat control of the Illinois Senate is an interesting flip-flop. After pass-

ing a bill to implement scheduled pay raise for large jail, across the street south from the Courthouse. legislators over time employees, which the Governor vetoed, the Senators voted not to override the veto. In effect they voted to reduce the compensation of elected officials in violation of the Constitution prohibition against reduction. Some legal eagle observed that the elected officials could sue the State (Court of Claims) for failure to pay the agreed additional compensation.

xxx

We hope that that improbable suit happens. It would underscore how disproportionate State compensation has become.

xxx

Governor Rauner may have set the stage for just such a suit by his newspaper interview in January in which he described the Illinois Supreme Court as "part of a corrupt system, I have no confidence in them."

xxx

It is a certainty that the Court will retaliate at first opportunity for such glaring indiscretion.

xxx

We have assured Springfield that not a single farmer adjacent to the Wabash in Lawrence County has objected to the Press' urging construction of a low level dam below St. Francisville.

xxx

But government construction is rarely caused by one lone ass braying in the wilderness. The need is for an area uprising in indignation, demanding the good things that government alone can bring.

August 13, 2015

The curtain of ignorance self-inflicted upon society is intolerable. Hospitals, nursing homes, etc. should be able to answer whether X is a patient in such institution.

xxx

It were as though everyone had xenophobia. Let's throw off the shackles and let the sun shine in. Useful subterfuge around such mental paralysis is to ask, "Does X have a phone in his room?"

xxx

Frightening indictment of public intelligence that Donald Trump's presidential campaign was taken seriously by so many.

xxx

Capital is hard to accumulate. Once amassed it guarantees large listening audience, even for the least brilliant citizen.

xxx

Trump's father started his pup with a substantial nest egg. Not unlike John D. Rockefeller, Jr. Trump has cruised behind that splendid beginning. Maybe an unfair comparison. Rockefeller, Jr. was long on philanthropy. Trump has known no such affliction.

xxx

We admired the courage of Republican National Chairman Erickson. He had no choice than to bar

Trump from the next presidential debate, Atlanta, five weeks, after his outrageous comment on Megan Kelly. Common decency barred hormonal explanation for tough questioning.

xxx

We predict that the next debate will be equally attractive to viewers even without Trump. No is there any danger of a sustained third party candidacy; he lacks the determination of Ross Perot, a self-made billionaire. Alas, the main bout with Hillary will be a worthy challenge for every Republican patriot.

xxx

Skilled artisans/ repairmen are as rare in the county seat as in Kuwait, where foreign immigrants do all the manual labor. We have often bemoaned absence of a bicycle repair shop, as distinguished Lawrenceville 25 years ago – Slim Cox & Merton Sechrest. Now discover that a skilled small motor repairman, Chris Ballard, North 7th, repaired bicycles in California for many years. Press may circulate a petition that he return such skill to his repertoire.

xxx

We were also anguished at absence of dry cleaners. Noticed sign on South 15th, "Dry Cleaning, 943-4141," but the phone has been disconnected.

xxx

Together we can return the work ethic to County Lawrence.

xxx

Now that school is in session 11 months each year, should be easier for the teachers to incorporate paycheck year around.

August 20, 2015

Fireworks Saturday night, on the banks of the Wabash, St. Francisville, were the best of the area.

xxx

Detonator remembered that anticipation is one of the joys of life—waited until 9 p.m. to

commence, though dusk arrives at 8:00.

xxx

The serenity of the setting was pierced by a steady stream of explosions. Large, appreciative audience concluded that the \$10,000 burned was worthwhile.

xxx

It was a tour de force by CIC, the remarkable corporation of gung-ho ladies in St. Francisville who have made good things happen for 24 years. Performing bands enhanced the occasion. It was no ordinary fish fry.

xxx

As we surveyed the camaraderie of this community celebration, and particularly the setting, we doubted that there is a major river anywhere in the nation for which government pays less to maintain.

xxx

It is time for everyone to stand on his/her hind legs and demand that Springfield and Washington develop this natural beauty spot, commencing with a low level dam at Pulleyville. Cost would be minimal and benefit large.

xxx

New sidewalk on State between 11th and 12th, Courthouse Square, is a thing of beauty, a ray of hope. We hope the fancy spot on N 12th will open

before Christmas.

xxx

Lawrence County taxpayers are being taken for a sleigh ride in payment to jail in Robinson, Olney and even faraway Carmi to house prisoners unable to post bail. The public officials who could correct this situation are the State's Attorney and Circuit Judges. Penniless, nonviolent defendants should be released on their own signature.

xxx

We were startled that when what's his name shamelessly brayed on national television, "I want to pay as little income tax as possible."

xxx

All who make money should be proud of the amount we pay the government that will take care of us, and our descendents from cradle to the grave.

xxx

Most recent fact that Japanese motor vehicles outsell American brands. They suggest patriotism should cause one to buy American, but their case collapses when one realizes that Japanese cars are in large part manufactured in the USA, with American labor, usually uncommon.

xxx

The real embarrassment to American pride is that we must import Japanese brains to the American plants that are the economic lifeblood and many communities, including ours.

August 27, 2015

Autumn came Monday night though the calendar says there are 25 more days of summer.

xxx

Frightening that a billionaire blowhard could reduce to ponies the other 15 in the race for the Republican nomination for President. Trump grabbed the entire spotlight at his Alabama SRO ballpark rally.

xxx

He talked for an hour and said nothing that could be identified as a plan for the nation's future. He satisfied the brain dead by repeating several times, "I'm going to make every American rich and America so strong no one will dare challenge."

xxx

Granted the Press was premature in proclaiming Donald Trump's political demise. We overestimated the public's IQ, and the billions wasted in public education. But if he is elected president, we'll migrate to Australia.

xxx

In care we've erred again, we have written of the Barristers, Registrar, Canberra to inquire if reciprocity extended to Illinois lawyers.

xxx

We're anxious to see whether he will show for the debate at the Reagan Library, California, in three

weeks. If so, will they let him speak and what can he do for an encore?

xxx

We've watched the talking heads on television and want to inquire what notable politician from America's past does Trump copy? We think the answer is the late Louisiana Senator Huey P. Long. The Kingfish promised to make every voter a king.

xxx

Let's hear no more of the wail, "There is nothing to do in this town." This week's Press reports a dozen public happenings, and the high school sports program isn't yet in full swing.

xxx

Lawrence County Historical Society had a coup Monday night at the Lawrenceville Library. Stroughmatt & Stroughmatt, Albion, and Lafayette, Louisiana, presented a great program.

xxx

Must not miss The Adams Family extravaganza Saturday p.m. Four miles west of Sand Barrens, 1/2 mile north.

xxx

We hope that summer lasts its allotted days regardless of how warm.

September 3, 2015

Perhaps Donald Trump's solution to the illegal immigrant problem - mass deportation of 10 million humans is the pendulum counter-swing to soft headed church leadership which banned "too militaristic songs, including Onward Christian Soldiers."

xxx

That sniveling effort for political correctness earned for these churches the irrelevance they presently have in the scheme of things.

xxx

If one enjoys excellence on Facebook, should dial to Victoria Shinkle singing "Star Spangled Banner" at LHS games.

xxx

We liked the comment of an 80 year old Mt. Carmel High School grad, "Our coach told us that we couldn't beat Lawrenceville at football. He was right."

xxx

Though the Indians' dominance over the Aces in football has collapsed in recent years, it remains intact as to roundball over each of the surrounding villages, and is important in Lawrenceville's rebirth.

xxx

It is wrong to burden the very young alone with responsibility of a community's turn-around. We must all pitch in.

xxx

What a welcome community boost— the Salukis' surprising triumph over the Robinson Maroons,

Friday

Night. Should make the Lawrenceville game interesting

xxx

Those in charge of leading the troops must recognize that victory not as important as lifetime handicap for the overzealous. They should remember the example of the University of Illinois firing football coach Tim Beckman for exhorting the wounded to continue the battle.

xxx

Almost all Illini go to the games to marvel at the band, camaraderie of old friends, and the rekindling of memories. None is unduly disturbed by the score.

xxx

Struggle between House Speaker Madigan and Governor Rauner over shape of the Illinois budget continues. The Governor surely expected more public support than he has received for his effort to prevent AFSCME members from becoming economic royalty.

xxx

Irony is that neither side has done anything for Southeastern Illinois. We shall continue to remind each of our non-stop need.

xxx

Lawrenceville has a state-of-the-art water treatment plant. Yet sale of bottled water is at record level. None seriously argues that bottled water is purer. The bottlers cater to convenience. They have built a better mousetrap.

September 10, 2015

Anyone over 39 who has not had a course in how to operate a computer is seriously behind the curve. It is the essence of life. Almost as important as air and water.

xxx

For those who do not have access to a computer, or choose to ignore it, there is no hope.

xxx

Scientists have theorized for centuries cause of extinction of dinosaurs. No such uncertainty will follow the departure of trees. All will agree that the copying machine made an insatiable demand for paper which the trees supply.

xxx

In almost every transaction, one side or the other, usually both, decides that a copy of the written record is necessary.

xxx

United Health is listed as one of the nation's largest health insurance companies. Judging from our own experience, it should also be classified as a major printing company, which sells insurance on the side. Never a week that we do not receive more than an ounce of printed material from UH explaining to whom money from Medicare was paid for two relatively healthy insureds.

xxx

Not to offend United Health, Lawrence County's economic life-

line, but it should follow the lead of many listed publicly traded stock companies, "If you wish to know how your company performed last quarter, go to 'www._____'."

xxx

We are prisoners of public opinion. SHS' most illustrious class, '41, considered dressing its members for Saturday's Fall Festival Parade in robes & keffiyeh since the school's symbol was an Arab for more than 100 years. But the suggestion was voted down 2-1, "would offend."

xxx

The pathological Arabs who drove the planes into the World Trade Towers, 13 years ago tomorrow, created ill will for our school's symbol that may last a century.

xxx

Labor Day would have more meaning if balanced by correcting to "Labor-Employers Day."

xxx

The work ethic which is alleged to have inspired "Labor Day" has died in too many communities, including ours.

xxx

Press' suggestion that July 22, Jim Edgar's birthday, be a holiday, makes more sense. If Lawrence County is to receive from Governor Rauner as it deserves, must show that we remember governors who remember it.

September 17, 2015

Potential for You Tube to slander a candidate's reputation/electability irretrievably is huge, as demonstrated by Senator Allen's defeat in Virginia seven years ago.

xxx

We were outraged that Donald Trump would say on You Tube "China" 100 times in quick succession, and use the ethnic vulgarity of sexual violation of one's mother in public speech. Then, we realized that both were manufactured slander, vicious, malicious.

xxx

Society must erect safeguards against such travesty. But how?

xxx

The rednecks who bristle, "Deport every illegal 'spic'," should view the public relations catastrophe that has come to Hungary. Heretofore that picturesque country, dignified by the Danube, has been tolerated as the dimwitted half of the Austria-Hungarian empire, pre-WWI. After the flood of television coverage of those malicious people beating on Middle East refugees attempting to crawl to safety, one must conclude that Hungarians are "Huns" in the traditional, uncomplimentary accepted meaning of that term.

xxx

If any reader attends a live political rally at which some demagogue screams, "deport 'em," we hope the

reader will inquire, "Would you have America followed the Hungarian example?".

xxx

Let's wait until after harvest to deport anyone except convicted criminals. Then ship only those who refuse to work, regardless of their nationality or color.

xxx

We have resolved to rail no more against the carnival at Fall Festivals. Without them, little towns would wither on the vine, due to big city dominated governmental neglect.

xxx

Various government programs attempt to lift the rural blight, but all focus on working with the people in place. Would it not make more sense for government to advertise in the metropolitan centers, "It's safer to live in rural America"?

xxx

What Lawrence County needs most is the return of talented people who have moved away. If only a fraction returned, we would blossom again. Who have you invited to come home?

xxx

IDOT made the entrance to Flossie Price's lane, from Route 250 at Club Kilroy, as though the traffic on that road would multiply many times.

xxx

We would prefer that IDOT think big on Route 50, four lanes big.

September 24, 2015

It must be unnerving to the other 20 who seek their party's nomination for President that Hillary Clinton can spook the stock market by a mere tweet. Bio-Tech shares tanked when she tweeted that drug prices are too high.

xxx

Means that the market believes her election is a formality that will happen in 13 months and that the other hopefuls are merely spinning their wheels.

xxx

If her coronation comes to pass, as the market predicts, it is time for society to take another look at the fundamental principal of universal suffrage. There are simply too many semi-literate aid recipients in the big cities who are herded to the polls like sheep for the hardworking, taxpaying, dedicated citizens to offset.

xxx

We ask anew, what's wrong with a literacy test as a condition for the right to vote.

xxx

The Democratic party is not alone in supply of voters with no academic curiosity. It is disgraceful how totally Donald Trump has spooked his primary opponents. Governor Walker quit. Two others are on the ropes. Wish I hadn't promised to immigrate to Australia if Trump elected.

xxx

Banks should do more to make checks a useful aid to living. Discouraging how many merchants refuse to cash checks, especially from individuals with low income. If identification correct and address of the writer is known, there is no excuse for any normal check to go unpaid. The State's Attorney has the jail door to persuade the check writer to honor his promise.

xxx

Life in County Lawrence,

at the commercial level, would be enhanced if the word went forth, "Failure of check to clear results in jail time."

xxx

Particularly reprehensible is the fact that many courthouse offices refuse to honor checks, even from rich lawyers. Any who refuse to extend to the public that degree of civility should be voted out of office in the next election.

xxx

Let's happily celebrate life together, tension free, and accept what comes thereafter in grim reality.

xxx

Traditionally school students select their handsomest/gifted for "king & queen" at Homecoming celebrations. We were uncertain whether the nomination and election of a special ed king at Lawrenceville High School was a commendable expression of tolerance/popularity. With some it would be considered a cruel joke. Even that group must have cheered the performance of Queen Megan Medford. The pride with which she clutched his arm in the coronation picture was magnificent. There can be no argument that she's a real live queen.

xxx

The wise framers of our Constitution, though believers, planned a secular government. Unfortunate that the candidate's religion remains a factor. We compliment Dr. Carson in grabbing the anti-Muslim public sentiment to give his presidential campaign needed popularity boost.

xxx

Notwithstanding our vote for secularization of government, we believe everyone should go to his church of choice. Otherwise, should omit religion at the burial.

Roscoe's Journal — Part 009

October 1, 2015

The enthusiasm with which Pope Francis I welcomed in his American Crusade suggests that our nation is desperate to believe, as is the world.

xxx

We believe that the short term and long term effects of his crusade will be Positive. We note that attendance Sunday at First Christian was 25% higher than preceding Sunday's.

xxx

We are grateful grandson, Thomas Shinkle, insisted that grandparents come outside to see the "red moon" at 9 p.m., Sunday evening Startling how red it was. Resolved to go to Wikipedia to understand, at earliest available moment. Sumner High was deficient in astrology.

xxx

That we would automatically think of the computer solution indicates how totally that omnipotent machine has captured the public's imagination.

xxx

Not to criticize the dedicated teachers to whom the writer is so indebted, and for whom grateful, but they laid no foundation for comprehension of Voice Over Phone, and the magic it conjures.

xxx

Mankind's effort to unlock the mysteries of the universe suffered a great set back in the death of Steve Jobs.

xxx

We find it reassuring that no one says of scientific study "these are limits beyond which mortal man should never attempt to go."

xxx

My regret is tat I was born 70 years too early. Now every Tom, Dick & Harry is a photo-journalist who preserves for eternity a picture verification of some memorable event.

xxx

Mid-August, 1945, in the company of a group of Polish Army chaplains I was ushered into the Sistine Chapel, Vatican. Suddenly Pope Pius XII was being carried amongst us. He sprinkled holy water and pronounced a blessing.

xxx

I thought of that last week as I watched believers who had traveled thousands of miles to see Pope Francis I. I remember that chance blessing without a photo record, but wish that I had had an I-phone that I might share the experience with you.

xxx

We noted on Facebook that Julia Ladner and daughter Mary had been bird watching out West. That's a human endeavor that I've always found difficult to follow. The subject is too flighty to pin down. No pun intended.

xxx

Its appeal to the intellectual type is undeniable. Dear Friends, our readers would be thrilled to have your written explanation of the charm you find in that pursuit. When?

xxx

Has anyone noticed that we have not said a word in this week's column about the 2016 Presidential election. We confess that we eagerly await the Clinton-Sanders-Biden debate two weeks hence.

October 8, 2015

We are ready for Indian Summer. The weekend cold snap should signal those golden days will happen.

xxx

Pope Francis I plays better in person than when he returns to the Vatican and issues explanations, e.g., secret meeting with Kentucky County Clerk Kim Davis who sought to ride her arrest (for refusal to issue marriage license to same sex couples) out of the quiet desperation in which most of mankind lives and dies.

xxx

Public has choice of believing His Holiness, or Davis' lawyer, as to who instigated the meeting and what transpired. We have strong bias for the truthfulness of lawyers. Makes no sense that the Pope would resist gay marriages so forcefully, and then pull the rug out from under the County Clerk by adding a second secret meeting while in the U.S. with a male aide and his significant other, also male.

xxx

The cynical might conclude that His Holiness is devious, a politician saying what the listener demands to hear.

xxx

We were startled that no defender of NRA cited the case of Timothy McVaigh. That monster killed 168 people without a gun, used a truck and ammonia nitrate. When the evil god of genetics creates a malignant mind with sufficient determination to murder other human beings, guns are not the only tool.

xxx

At the risk of being thought sadistic, we believe that Mother Mercer should be tried as an accomplice. That she would buy a gun for her known mentally disturbed son, after he had undergone mental health treatment, was worse than bad judgment. Unfortunately, the Oregon tragedy underscores that mental health treatment in this country is inadequate, often, including Lawrence County, non-existent.

xxx

The awful truth is that these misfits come from the factory with their brains improperly wired, and he/she will die that way regardless of the number of psychiatrists seen, operations undergone, or medicines and counseling taken.

xxx

One would think that in the 5,000 years that man has walked upright some effective way would be

found to change the workings of the brain. Sedation of the victims of the evil god of genetics apparently is mankind's most effective defense.

xxx

We are opposed to the confiscation of firearms even when confronted with the tragedies enumerated by President Obama. They remain a free people's last and most effective tool against any government that becomes tyrannical.

xxx

Everyday association with the economic malaise that has overcome Lawrence County has numbed too many of us into complacency. More than one that had departed Lawrence County for economic opportunity elsewhere, home for the various reunions, noted to us how appallingly slow the economic pulse of our county. Each must do more if we are to escape that stigma.

xxx

The Press continues to believe and push for (a) four lanes for Route 50; (b) low level dam on the Wabash; and (c) aviation related business at George Field. But we can persuade only a handful to fly the flag on Jim Edgar's birthday, July 22. He did more for the Lawrence County economy than all his predecessors and successors combined when he located the Sumner Correctional Facility here.

October 15, 2015

When one sees young smokers continuing to smoke even after they have watched parents and grandparents carrying oxygen to stay alive, one wonders if the young are playing with a full deck.

xxx

Though contra his constituents' thinking, we admired Representative David Reis' objection, on moral grounds, to legalization of marijuana.

xxx

All should recognize that present, "for medicinal purpose only," is "foot in door" legislation, and that "for recreational purpose" will follow.

xxx

Lawrence County's need for business is so great (count empty locations in each city), it is difficult to oppose push to have a medicinal marijuana distribution center here.

xxx

We questioned a very intelligent friend from Denver as to how that state's experiment with marijuana was working. He was very positive.

xxx

The American public has endured all of the political correctness it can stomach. We think that presidential candidates Trump and Carson do so well in the public opinion polls because each says what he believes without regard to political correctness.

xxx

We agreed with Dr. Carson's observation that the Oregon college students should have attacked the monster instead of waiting like sheep to be slaughtered.

xxx

Political correctness deprived the University of Illinois of a colorful, respected symbol around whom all could rally, Chief Illiniwek.. He was a compliment to native Americans of every tribe. Harmed no one.

xxx

As one watches Florida State University's Indian prance on pinto horse (Renegade?) at national TV coverage of football games, one must conclude that the U of I Trustees were gutless. They should have secured the assistance of FSU Trustees before banishing Chief Illiniwek

xxx

The Board of Trustees should bring back Chief Illiniwek, today.

xxx

Our psychologist doctor to be granddaughter, Katie Sauvigne, parked her orange, vintage Jeep in well lighted, gated, all day parking garage, Atlanta. Gates open for departure at 7 p.m. After study at Emory University, Katie walked to the garage shortly after 7 p.m. Shortly after 7 p.m. She discovered that the Jeep had been stolen.

xxx

Katie, parents and grandparents were grateful that she was not physically assaulted by the unseen thief. The ever present danger of physical injury should deter society from continuing to flock to the big cities.

October 22, 2015

Often clients have greater affection for their lawyer than for their tax accountant. Reason for the observable preference is that the lawyer will stay with his client, right or wrong. Tax accountants join the IRS the moment the proof of any figure challenged.

xxx

These ungrateful dudes often warn clients in advance that he/she cannot cite to their tormentors the accountant's advice. Except for the terror of the IRS, in which every taxpayer lives, tax accounting would be a lonely business.

xxx

Above opinion of tax accountants does not apply to those who advertise in The Sumner Press. Excepted are the salt of the earth and will defend forever.

xxx

Jeb Bush said that Donald Trump was unsafe to be in control of the nuclear stock pile. Many individuals have that heretofore unspoken fear. It signals the end of the Donald Trump campaign for President. Oddly, probably the end also of Jeb Bush's campaign. Trump supporters will never forgive such unvarnished candor.

xxx

The "Draft John Kasich Committee" will meet shortly and pick a new horse. If so, he should be

Paul Ryan. That skilled candidate has what every politician dreams of – spontaneously drafted to be Speaker of the House of Representatives.

xxx

The beautification of the poor must cease. If the world's wealth were evenly divided, everyone would be a peasant. Many who are poor are shiftless, have no determination to escape their poverty. None knows better that state of ill-being than those raised in Sumner in the 1930's. Happily, this country is still the land of opportunity, despite the effort of too many who overemphasize aid for the poor.

xxx

Our nation's preeminence in the competitive world was caused by the greed of capitalism. Henry Ford said it best: "None would work if he didn't have to."

xxx

Bernie Sanders is a threat to the national well-being. Sanctimoniously, he repeats often the moral duty to help the poor. The poor, like every other American, should try harder to help the nation by going to work. There are numerous government programs training the willing and ambitious to perform some act for which society will pay.

xxx

Bernie's opponent, Hillary Clinton, has a home in New York City that is a mansion, as nice as Brent Seed's in Indianapolis. That's a compliment to a local boy who does well, and should run for public office. Neither will prattle about moving to less pretentious digs.

xxx

Difference between Mets' strategy, and the Cardinals' playing the Cubs in the NLCS, is that the Mets didn't choke.

xxx

Too late to salvage our shattered reputations for picking World Series' winner. Obvious answer now is Mets over the Royals.

xxx

Matters not to the Phoenix Pool Hall crowd that the Cubs are not World Champions. They did beat the Cardinals!

October 29, 2015

We do not know of any huge corporation that has more public goodwill than the insurance industry. Millions think of their insurance company as Santa Claus in disguise.

xxx

Nothing could be farther from the truth. Insurance is a concept that has stood the test of time. Its founding purpose was to spread large, catastrophic losses over many interest owners.

xxx

Benjamin Franklin gave the insurance industry a good start in the small idealistic new nation that was to become world leader in every worthwhile category

xxx

Franklin would be astounded how financially successful has been his off spring. Its success in separating almost every citizen from his cash has been phenomenal, and without the rancor and ill will that usually accompanies a business deal in which one side believed to have prospered more than the other.

xxx

Proof of their described financial success is fact that insurance companies own this nation.

xxx

Not to disillusion, but many citizens, probably a majority, are "insurance poor" —a disproportionate share of their cash goes for insurance

xxx

Payment of insurance premiums is a major item in every household budget, but none resents that waste....

xxx

We have never seen a church strong enough that some business minded member stood at the board meeting and said, "we are strong enough to be self-insured"

xxx

We believe that a church which does not have faith that its members can build after fire, wind, quake, flood, or other God driven destruction, without Santa's help, should hold services in a tent.

xxx

Government has gotten into the problem to an extent to make discussion meaningless. It requires ever increasing number of activity to have insurance. Probably this is a realistic bow to reason.

xxx

The ultimate degree to which insurance is mandated may be requirement of banks, and other lending agencies, borrower must carry "mortgage insurance."

xxx

Means exactly what you would assume i.e. harassed borrower must carry an additional policy that will make the monthly payments as solemnly promised in the loan agreement.

xxx

It were as though the evil forces had combined to give the shylock lender a risk-free sleigh ride at the expense of some striving entrepreneur.. One would hope that government would intervene to prevent such unconscionable.

xxx

We will not be offended, and will understand if every reader decides to keep the fire insurance on his home in spite of our misgivings. Nothing is more reassuring in time of loss than a valid,

adequate policy by a solvent insurer.

xxx

On another subject, disaster has been avoided. Several had written to express hope/opinion that we would be packing to migrate to Australia when Donald Trump elected President. Polls show Dr Ben Carson leads Trump..

November 5, 2015

Eerie how history repeats itself 80 years later. One could use the news accounts of the Spanish Civil War, change only the countries' names. They would pass for current reporting on the Syrian Civil War.

xxx

Russians show most consistency, supporting unpopular government in place in each war

xxx

USA was not directly involved in the Spanish War. This might suggest to President Obama that our national interests do not require an all out effort to save President Assad, especially since his loyalty is to Putin, who obviously thinks of himself as Hitler, rather than as Stalin.

xxx

We are not critical of Pres. Obama. We do wish that he would bring more British caution to this potentially catastrophic situation..

xxx

One key figure missing from the wars' duplication is Hitler. His was a mystic power that could persuade a great nation to march to total destruction in pursuit of his dream which was never within reasonable reach.

xxx

Ironic that present German Chancellor is as dominant as Hitler, without loss of a soldier in her march to power. Lesson is inescapable—sane people hate war.

xxx

We hope that the Russian metallurgists conclude that the Russian superliner fell in the Egyptian Sinai Desert from "metal fatigue" rather than from ISIS claimed attack. If the Russian people were persuaded that 240 of their own were murdered, might change public opinion sufficiently for Putin's madness to become the world's.

xxx

We were discouraged that none of the world series broadcasters said the obvious, "Harry Truman would have approved the championship being won by the Kansas City Royals"

xxx

One must not wish his/her life away, but we bet Hillary Clinton wishes Presidential election had been this Tuesday instead of 52 weeks later.

xxx

Someone needs to tell those Republicans that the "darkest hour is just before the dawn."

xxx

We are anxious to hear the talking heads' decision on the effectiveness of political advertising in Kentucky name calling.

xxx

At the risk of being thought an elitist, we believe Illinois voters a tad more sophisticated than Kentuckians. Rather than describing his opponent as a "bald faced liar", an Illinois candidate would probably say that his opponent "is not an accurate historian."

xxx

The English language is a thing of beauty that should be cherished always. Those who insist on two languages should be banished forever, behind the concrete wall that President Trump has said that he will build.

xxx

A bientot

November 12, 2015

xxx

Musically themed, appeared under the control of Rev. Gary Pearce, Dan & Mary Mickler, FUMC Choir and Robert Craft

xxx

They had imported the Shinkles—Burl, Marge & Victoria who fit the operation like a glove.

xxx

We were so impressed with the operation which came off like a military probe, we forgot mention when the old soldiers (WWII) were invited to speak first matter taught to us in the Army.

xxx

Why the emphasis we never knew, about beginning on Day 1 in the Army we were taught, "Under the Geneva Convention if you are taken prisoner you are required only to give your name, rank and serial number.. Say no more, lest you give away military intelligence.

xxx

We were so impressed by Victoria's singing we said nothing about our Army Serial Number. It was multi purpose: designed to protect the soldier at every need, even to insure that properly identified body sent home if killed. (It was imprinted on "dog tags" worn about the neck. .

xxx

Imprinted on clothes sent to the laundry the serial number was believed to increase the odds that one would receive same garments after cleaning. During basic training I received the smoothest blue silk girls' panties one can imagine. I did not send them to the laundry. Did wear a few times to wash hall in middle of the night. Decided that they might send wrong message. Returned them

to management: well fed German POWs at Ftg. Sill, OK. Have often wondered how many of those POWs returned to the USA as immigrants, after the madness of war shalged.

xxx

Of Salute to Veterans, well meaning citizens are saluting the wrong group. Only heroes are the dead, from battle injury: and those who have serious injury. Rest of us are lucky stiffes who savored life's grand adventure.

xxx

George Cordes may have enough shrapnel in his body to trigger the airplane boarding censor.

xxx

Before the war, I worked 35 hours a week at 35 cents an hour to attend the University of Illinois. After the war, the taxpayers paid to attend to finish my education. I would feel as resided above even if not a bird colonel from Brown County, Ohio told me at Salzburg, October 19,'45 "Lt. You've been kicked around in the Army enough. I'm sending you to the University of Nancy for a semester."

xxx

God Bless the U.S. Armed Forces.

Roscoe's Journal — Part 010

November 19, 2015

The talking heads on television can each explain why the Muslim murderous assault on Paris was logical, but no one saw it coming. Would have been laughed off the stage if any had so predicted.

xxx

It might have given the GOP presidential nominee the lightest ray of hope that Hillary could be defeated.

xxx

As the godmother of the Administration's containment policy, she must explain why the barbaric ISIS remains alive and growing

xxx

Most Americans are persuaded that all Muslims are evil, that they do not believe what they say and are bribed to become suicide bombers.

xxx

Seems counter productive to step up bombing of purely civilian area. Those stupes have no more to say about the war than you and I. What is needed is religious leaders, Muslim, and Christianity, calling for tolerance .

xxx

For whatever reason our government is reluctant to say it, but present situation is a clear rerun of the Christian Crusades. History books tell us the latter lasted more than 200 years. This will be going on long after the hucksters who run TV have turned their cameras elsewhere.

xxx

In WWII, Japanese Americans were put in con centration camps by FDR. Maybe time to ban from planes and large public gatherings women wearing clothes or hair style suggesting she thinks differently than we.

xxx

Almost as interesting as international problems in the coming weeks will be the showdown between Republican Governor Bruce Rauner and Democrat legislators lead by Michael Madigan..

xxx

We were startled that the Wayne County Press attacked "cheap skate state" (for not paying utility bills.

xxx

Present impasse cannot last more than three months. We believe the moment deadline for filing nominating petitions for candidacy in the State Legislature has passed, November 30, pressure for compromise settlement will become irresistible.

xxx

Governor Rauner got farther than we thought possible with so few face cards showing.

November 26, 2015

A week after the murderous assault upon Western Civilization, a brave, innovative French Muslim male chained himself to a lamp post in the Place de la Concorde. Blindfolded, he affixed a sign that read, "I Trust you. If you Trust me, give me a hug." Hundreds did.

xxx

We thought the unknown hero deserving the Carnegie Peace Award (rather than some politician for hauling downtrodden to the polls).

xxx

Predictably the French bombed ISIS Hdq. In Syria non stop. Killed a few hundred civilians who have no idea who is fighting for what.

xxx

Had recited offer of human sacrifice been made few days earlier might have received worldwide television coverage needed to survive in the electron world.

xxx

The event was not ignored. Some wealthy Sunni Muslim, probably an oil baron noticed and responded in support. Opposition to reason will quickly solidify and make the redneck solution of unlimited bombing by either side mankind's foolish response.

xxx

We do not belong to the mindset that only good Muslim is a dead one. But it appears to us that responsible Muslim leadership has been slow to speak in behalf of decency.

xxx

Four weeks from Saturday night will be the Press Xmas Party. Without a shred of modesty we have proclaimed this "social event of the season." This year's will be more so , but there is a catch. Invitees must submit a dozen news items during the year, or write an article, or pledge to do so, in writing, before July 4. Too many of our guests eat, burp & go home. Let's stimulate creative writing in County Lawrence.

xxx

Elsewhere in today's Press is a response from Congressman Shimkus to the Press' repeated plea for a recreational dam on the Wabash. The Congressman repeats the Corps of Engineers tired old explanation, "costs too much." **This newspaper would appreciate written response of our readers. Will print if your name is affixed.**

xxx

Same "sorry but can't afford," awaits our area's desperate need for four lanes for Route 50. What can we afford?

xxx

Lawrence County deserves more from Springfield and Washington than is received.

December 3, 2015

State cost-saving measures to eliminate notification via mail of vehicle license renewal may ultimately cost more. An increased workload for too few police officers, leading to more paperwork to process drivers when fined for expired licenses.

xxx

Pet owners who mistreat animals are inflicting physical and emotional scars on those they call 'man's best friend.'

xxx

An Illinois law puts restrictions on youth, age 13 and under, for being 'Home Alone.' Unreasonable

length of time lacking a parent presence is cause for parents to be arrested for Abuse & Child Neglect.

xxx

Star Wars is awakening the force as it introduces another generation to its movie fantasy land. The fascination capitalizes on Christmas for gift-giving.

xxx

Electronic mobile devices are again among the top sellers with the kickoff of the holiday shopping season. Thanksgiving and Black Friday netted \$4.5 billion. Next year, there will be a must-have, newer version of the communicators.

xxx

Can hunting season be exhausted? We still hear wild turkey gobbling in the fields and deer preying on the road passersby. Accident reports reflect the abundance.

December 10, 2015

Where was the ISIL'S god to whom the radical Muslims pray when the parents of a six month old daughter in San Bernadino given to the in-laws got their guns, returned to the party, and killed 14 of their own?

xxx

An unspeakable tragedy, but not the collapse of the Christian faith in our form of government as some news media suggest.

xxx

Sooner or later, and we think much sooner, we believe that the ISIL'S godless religion will be selling licenses to kill infidels.

xxx

We admire the courage of every candidate who dares to seek election of public office. They are the "doers" in this world. They are not mere spectators.

xxx

Our association with political races commenced in fourth grade, Sumner public schools. The teacher, Imogene Osborn, and her favorite student led the candidates to victory in 1932. The pretty redheaded leader of the opposition, Betty Skaggs (nephew still lives in Sumner), observed "but we won uptown."

xxx

Astounding that in spite of violation of every known rule of successful candidacy, Donald Trump remains at the head of the public opinion polls. We continue to make inquiry as to barr admission Canbera as to if the unthinkable should happen—Trump be elected and public opinion and our fate thus sealed.

xxx

We regret it that health problems prevented us from attending a rally in Effingham last week. The State Senator Mike McWherter, from the east side, is challenging the Republican Congressman Shimkus for the nomination. Pressure was every where against one so audacious as to challenge an incumbent. We wish that our excuse had been less genuine.

xxx

The challenger has drum beaters without equal, "the Petty girls." They'll bring more excitement to the Republican rallies during the next three months, Jan. Feb., March.

xxx

We'll be there to ask about the four lanes for 50, a low level dam on the Wabash, and meaningful international trade at George Field.

December 17, 2015

The forecasters credit el nino for the marvelous warm weather during the last days of autumn. To those of us for whom Spanish is not the native tongue "el magnificent", would be a more appropriate translation

xxx

Beauty is these experts advise unseasonable warmth for our section of the world will continue to February! Then, this column will write wistfully of the coming of spring.

xxx

Problem with this scenario is that soon a priceless year of time if lost in nuttiness. Essential that every moment be made to produce its maximum.

xxx

Bookies say that the Chicago's Teachers Union will probably lead those dedicated public servants on strike within a few days. What a tragic loss, and injury, to thousands of young lives dependent upon education to escape the poverty in to which born.

xxx

Regardless of political label, a better way must be found to determine proper compensation for public employees rather than by strike against their dependents.

xxx

Our problems in education are not comparable to Chicago's. There was a thoughtful letter to the editor in last week's Sumner Press which outlined the need for consolidation of schools, and the failure of anyone to say anything about that approaching crisis.

xxx

The outlook is stark, grim either lure more residents, with school aged children to Lawrence County or commence work on consolidation plan to maximize the school's opportunities of present pupils.

xxx

The Press has urged for 25 years + that former residents return and new residents come. Influx have not been encouraging.

xxx

There is a great need for local leadership for more aggressive leadership in our county. Each should ask himself whether he/she is doing the maximum to bring activities to County of Lawrence. Judged by that yardstick, we have been encouraged by some special happening every Saturday or Sunday throughout the fall. Saturday night's lighted parade in the County seat was a step in that direction.

xxx

We deeply regretted that personal health problems prevented the scheduled Press Christmas party. Do not turn my picture to the wall we will renew your confidence in your servant God willing.

xxx

We had assumed that horizontal drilling would bring a boom to our county, comparable to its preeminence after 1906. We have learned that the urgency for that initiative process to work depends the higher crude oil prices. Our readers would forgive us for them those higher prices the County of Lawrence will continue to lead.

xxx

December 24, 2015

The light at the end of the tunnel is that glimmer of hope added each evening to sunset, commencing Monday evening. We doubt that we are alone in the exhilaration brought by each minute of added daylight. There is a momentary sadness when the summer solstice is reached, June 21/22; the winter solstice brings joy.

xxx

Barring another ISIS induced tragedy like San Bernardino, awarding of the Nobel prizes should be the major recurring news stories.

xxx

The Press urges that the President of China should be nominee for the Nobel Peace Award. By keeping the lid on Chinese birth control that leader protects all of mankind from certain disaster.

xxx

Our news media focuses the spotlight on China's loud claim to small Pacific islands. The world can live happily with whatever that decision. Not so with a doubling of the Chinese birth rate.

xxx

India, too, should confront its obligation to preservation of mankind. Madame Nehru gave her life for reproductive moderation.

xxx

When Hillary Clinton's sparring partners cranked up their debate format six months ago, we wondered what they would do as the tunnel is that glimmer would lure enough viewers to remain on stir. It is an understatement to say that each debate has been a "hit" show. Not from Donald Trump alone, but from overall viewer appeal, manager engineered, have these debates flourished.

xxx

Sanders' lawyers outran Hillary's to file suit for some imaginary wrong done their tiger. It was pure hype, well done.

xxx

When Sanders speaks, we think of the late Russian leader, Khrushchev. In a famous interview with American newspaper reporters, at the Iowa corn farm, he confidently predicted, "Americans will live under socialism (their description of communism). If not this generation, your children's." That Sanders is the top sparring partner for "the champ" reveals how frighteningly accurate was Mr. K.

xxx

Surely to God, an overwhelming majority of Americans believe that private ownership of property was far more responsible for this nation's worldwide leadership than all of this self headed talk about "to every man according to is need, regardless of how shiftless."

December 31, 2015

We found it frightening: that the small world around us came to a complete halt Monday morning. No radio, television, nor computer, "marched".

xxx

The deathly silence was not reassuring. Anxious inquiry brought only a terse, " technological problem."

xxx

How large was the paralysis? We wondered if it were worldwide. We discussed the problem with learned grandchildren, ages 18 & 11. Unanimously they agreed that the problem was with electric supply, and was limited to the customers of that unit of electricity distribution.

xxx

"Otherwise there would be great public concern, even hysteria." We didn't tell our experts that the lack of any public concern had been motivational for our inquiry.

xxx

Question remains, is there a central point from which the signal is launched? If so, what steps are being taken to protect our national well being? Have the Iranian centrifuges been replaced by another threat?

xxx

About 10:30, Monday morning, the television and the computer marched; all was well. We shall investigate these matters further. In the interim, we have concluded our beloved Sumner Public Schools were woefully weak in electronics 85 years ago.

xxx

Since China has the largest economy in the world, is it inevitable that it will become the acknowledged world leader? That is the role the USA has gracefully played on the world stage, since World War I. It is one of history's longer reigns; pax Britannica was from 1815 to WWI.

xxx

We had occasion to discuss world leadership with a bright LTHS & U of I alumnae who is also a recruiter of college graduates for a Fortune 500 company.

xxx

"In view of the population disparity, maybe four Chinese for every American, and the workers they have proven themselves to be, is there any hope that USA can retain the title, world leader' during the foreseeable future?" "Absolutely. American ingenuity is unlimited."

xxx

How fortunate are we that Santa's all-weather sleigh does not require a foot of that white stuff for traction. Hope that someone had the foresight to order same weather in 2016.

xxx

When one stops to remember that Groundhog Day will be here in four weeks, he must conclude that those Romans had it right when they opined, "tempus fugit."

xxx

Happy New Year!

2016

49 COLUMNS

January 7, 2016

We almost admire the militancy of street rioters protesting fossil fuel bearing electricity generators. They have a grand slogan, "Save the Planet." Some suggest that it will be a national disaster if the protesters significantly reduce presently level of fossil fuel generation.

xxx

It is noted that the product from the challenged process, electricity, is indispensable for our way of life. Electricity is the magic genie which appears at the flip of a switch to do every task imaginable to make our lives meaningful, enjoyable, possible.

xxx

The protesters would substitute wind & water for the energy to make the generators spin. But the solution is yet in the sky to date. Time required to implement substitute source could be a century. There was more than a century between Benjamin Franklin flying the kite in the rain, house key tied to the string, and Thomas Edison defending direct transmission of current. (Experts are unanimous that Franklin's celebrated experiment should not be attempted; great danger of attracting fatal electric charge from the lightning.)

xxx

The protesters claim they are actually protecting lives of 100,000 coal miners who would become unemployed if there were a fossil fuel burning ban. In the beginning loss of coal miners' lives was horrendous.

xxx

It is still a dangerous process, made much safer by government safety regulations.

xxx

That the presentation by protesters significantly suggest that future street protesters by this group should light their slogan with kerosene lamps that the public might see the other side of the coin.

xxx

Was there ever a human who did not hope that the end of time came before his hour upon the

stage was done?

xxx

Eighty years ago, one could read in Sumner Public School pamphlets entitled "Watch Tower", a catchy line attributed to Judge J. F. Rutherford, "Millions now living will never die." One would expect such a statement to be self perpetuating, with a fast expanding base. Strangely, such opinion is the never mentioned.

xxx

For some the brisk discussion of current programmer' shutdown in earnest should not be attempted; age of the long running campaign to the national conventions. July/August to pick presidential candidates for the November election.

xxx

Press guess remains : Paul Ryan vs. Hillary Clinton

xxx

January 14, 2016

How beautiful the snow on Sunday morning. More beautiful, the paths we travel will all be clear today, and our sheltered valley is much closer to spring since the worst of winter is finished.

xxx

In the past we have sometimes been too critical of school and church for cancelling meetings "on account of the snow". Not this time; the carpet has an ice base that could fracture a hip, or skull instant.

xxx

We remain persuaded that snow cancellation of church services is a good barometer of the church's muscle. Predictably, FUMC Lawrenceville was in full operation. Either for shared values, or an act of atonement, First Christian sent its three member choir (Lora, Jan & Victoria) to the combined services at FUMC.

xxx

Their report was complimentary of host. Said latter needed no musical support, that Dr. Kirk, Kim Przybylski and choir had the support of program operating smoothly, did believe more bottoms needed on the pews, but that First Christian should follow FUMC's example of pull down screen up front in lieu of hymnals, which some believe passe.

xxx

The worst of human nature will be displayed in the case of el Chapo, the Mexican king pin of international illegal drug dealing. NY Post reported his capture, after escape last month from a maximum security prison, under the caption "El Jerko". Almost everyone agrees with that description, Press would vote for his execution after a very short trial.

xxx

But society must not transfer entire shame of the illegal drug epidemic on the head of one individual. Education has not been an effective tool for reducing public demand for illegal drugs, Society needs to suspend mercy, compassion, ignorance and other soft soap instincts. Throw the book at every user of illegal drugs. The threat to our way of life grows greater daily.

xxx

We repeat: In the 1920s a clever Frenchman, Emile Coue, criss-crossed the USA, making speeches to overflow audiences at every opportunity. The repeated message was, "In every day, in every way, I am getting better and better." It was the magic elixir. Coue prospered: his listeners were uplifted. An entire nation benefitted from one's man's message.

xxx

Alas, we have lost our way in the USA. No where is negative spirit more apparent than in the news media. Emphasis is totally on bad. If we could eliminate the negative and accentuate the positive, life for all would better. Let's each follow Coue's example.

xxx

xxx

Logical consequences are the scarecrows of fools and the beacons of wise men. —Thomas H. Huxley

xxx

January 21, 2016

One wondered why the Iranians released so quickly the small boat of territorial waters. Secretary of State Kerry revealed Sunday that pursuant to recent agreement with Iran that it stop work on atomic bomb, U.S. will pay this week \$ 1.7 billion, loan & interest. Obviously the Iranians did not wish to jeopardize receipt of such amount of money.

xxx

Unfortunate U.S. did not have similar bargaining chip when the Iranians seized our embassy, 1980, and held Americans hostage for several months. In future international disputes we hope same tactic for release of Americans illegally held will be used, if some reduction in price paid. 'Tis preferable to threats of war.

xxx

Too many churches have abandoned opposition to various sins, including gambling. Every simpleton who plays the lottery when interviewed as to what he/she would do with \$1+billion jackpot , vowed to give a part of his winnings to a church. We can assume the would be recipient church did not teach the winner not to gamble, might even assume that the church encouraged participation.

xxx

Millions who could not afford "invested" in a lottery ticket though the \$2 each required for the essentials of life. It is the duty of churches, schools and government at every level to stand firmly against gambling. Almost none do. Most shameful is present tactic of financing government by gambling.

xxx

Unpopular though such opposition would be, should not be swept aside by those who argue that every action in life is a gamble. In these common sense exceptions, the chance element is secondary to the main purpose of action; e.g. insurance, farming, marriage.

xxx

It is a waste of life to learn always for tomorrow, and better days. The good times are here and now. Important that each make every day count for something, to the limit of his ability.

xxx

Ministers of the gospel are never very specific on why we were placed on the earth. Chloe Anderson taught at Congregational Christian Church Sunday School 85 years ago, "to glorify God". Perhaps she should have added, "by being helpful to others."

xxx

After one witnesses time-face by two i-pad possessors, the miracles of the Bible are less of a challenge to one's credulity.

January 28, 2016

For several years a remarkable continental couple resided in the Hotel– Gustaf & Martha Adriaenssens. Gus was of German origin; Martha Belgian.. They were a classy act which we were proud to have in our building.

xxx

We will remember always Martha's pet rule of life, "one must justify his existence." We were not put on this earth merely to eat and procreate. Her quoted rule should be tattooed into the mind of every citizen, six years and above.

xxx

In an earlier issue of the Press we wrote that one should inquire at the end of each day what he has done with that day helpful to others. Reader response was gratifying. One friend wrote that her psychiatrist assured her that the question should be, " what have you done today that brought happiness to you?" Same doctor assured her that purpose of life is to entertain one's self.

xxx

Undeniably one's work becomes his life. For that reason we have long believed that idleness is the

devil's handmaiden. Each should have physical tasks to perform to the limit of his strength.

xxx

Years ago, while in the Legislature, we asked the union's hard nosed lobbyist, whether the union would oppose a bill to permit inmates to resume the manufacture of license plates, which was their forte 60 years ago. He was indignant that "slave labor" would be suggested. The union is wrong on this issue; there should be no idle hands. The reformation must come from public demand, or executive leadership strong enough to resist predictable union opposition.

xxx

Every citizen in this sheltered valley should be grateful for the four seasons. If asked which season least appreciated, we believe answer would be "winter". The charm of icicles on the eaves dropping diamonds in the sunlight though the temperature be 28 degrees is undeniable.

xxx

One would grumble less about four seasons if he heard Miamians lament the sameness of the weather year around.

xxx

Our experience in politics was always that a supporter could rarely commit more than two or three in addition to himself. Sometimes, even the spouse was not on board. So, we wondered at the glee of Trump managers that they obtained the endorsement of Sarah Palin and Phyllis Schlafly. We shall watch carefully the Iowa results to see how many votes either talk host swung from Cruz to Trump

xxx

Frightening that Bernie Sanders, a loud, unapologetic socialist, would run so strongly in the Democratic Iowa caucus, and beyond. Where else but New Hampshire primary.

xxx

We believe that capitalism built this nation, and that it would be a terrible error to bankrupt it for the shiftless as urged by bleeding hearts such as Sanders

xxx

The 17th Amendment to the U.S. Constitution (graduated income tax) was designed to correct great disparity in income. As one reads daily of more billionaires the conclusion is inescapable that Congress needs to adjust the tax rates.

xxx

To abandon private ownership of property, as Karl Marx wrote in Das Kapital would be to throw the baby out with the bath water.

February 4, 2016

Every precinct committeeman knows how difficult to persuade otherwise responsible citizens to vote in partisan primaries. Without a sharply contested race for the sheriff nomination, in at least one of the parties, it impossible to get out more than 20% of the eligible voters in the combined two parties. Why the sheriff's selection such a magnet for voters, as compared with other offices, is inexplicable.

xxx

We were curious about voter turnout in the well publicized Iowa caucus. They have that weird system in which the supporters of the various candidates assemble for two hours at assigned locations and discuss relative merit of the candidates. Choices are duly noted. Each candidate receives number of delegates proportionate to his/her share of total.

xxx

Common sense suggests that the Illinois primary statute is superior to the Iowa caucus by every meaningful measure. Even our system is under wide criticism from those who dislike publicly proclaiming party affiliation. Legislators receive many demands that the law be changed, that voter be given a ballot with the candidates of each party printed, separate of course. In the secrecy of the booth, the voter would vote for only the candidates of one party. Change would be easy to make and relatively inexpensive. Perhaps sensitivity of the voter should be humored. Others snort, "If they are ashamed of their party, should switch."

xxx

Twenty percent of the eligible Iowa voters participated in their caucus, Monday. Iowa may have received more national recognition, and had greater impact on the ultimate choice of presidential candidates in 2016 than so few voters, and so cumbersome a system deserve.

xxx

The Press received a note from IDOT that it will be making no further plans for Four Lanes for Route 50 "until funding available." The community and advocates, ably led by Charles Gillespie, whose enthusiasm is indefatigable. are engaged in self delusion. they should concentrate their effort and money on legislators in Springfield and Washington who publicly proclaim support of immediate building of a modern highway.

xxx

The rate of abandonment of Lawrence County, enumerated in the Press' front page letter to the Governor, is disheartening. Unless everyone pushes for more people living and working in this County, all will be paying their taxes in Olney, Effingham or in Springfield, within 20 years.

xxx

Emphasizing the positive, the groundhog didn't see its shadow, Monday, neither in County Lawrence, nor in Pennsylvania. We have survived another winter. Spring is here, rejoice.

xxx

A society can be no better than the men and women who compose it. - Adlai E. Stevenson

xxx

What a man wants to do he generally can do, if he wants to badly enough. - Louis L'Amour

xxx

February 11, 2016

We should hear no more nonsense that winter is fine, that spring has arrived because the groundhog did not see its shadow on February TWO. The last three days proved what an unreliable weather forecaster the rat is.

xxx

Happily there is a time tested, accurate couplet for Lawrence County weather, "no bad weather until after Thanksgiving; no good weather until after Easter. This year Easter comes relatively early on March 27.

xxx

The Press will give \$5 to the first subscriber who e-mails, or faxes (936-2858) correct answer why Easter cannot fall earlier than March 20, on our calendar.

xxx

Terrible reflection on the lives of so many of 323,000,000 Americans that they would waste a beautiful Sunday glued to television for a football game. The Denver Broncos defeated the Carolina Panthers, 24-10. So what?

xxx

It is widely described as "Super Bowl Sunday", as though it were a religious day, e.g. Christmas, or Easter. More accurate would be "Pagan Sunday". In total disregard of the First Commandment, many have made this spectacle their god

xxx

Too large and too popular to be discontinued, and since it demonstrably entertains millions who need entertainment, its continuance is a given. Perhaps credit should be give to the group responsible for its growth by renaming the event, "huckster holiday."

xxx

Regrettable that public opinion polls uniformly find that most Americans do not want American soldiers "to police the world." That is why our President, and each of the wannabes often proclaim that he/she will not send American foot soldiers to police the world. That is what is wrong with the world today, there is no policeman on the beat.

xxx

It is our hope and prayer that the next President of the U.S. will include within his Inaugural address unmistakable words that all may know that finally we have "manned up" to our responsibility to keep the peace, worldwide, including unilateral correction of any nation committing aggression against its neighbors, or its own people.

xxx

Wheaton College fired a lady professor for teaching that Christians and Muslims pray to the same God. A review board reversed the decision. We are not offended by the decision, though the violence of the Koran against nonbelievers, including apostates is at the core of wide Christian revulsion toward Muslims.

xxx

In the 16th and 17th centuries the Spanish spread Christianity with the sword in Mexico. Did they act pursuant to the First Commandment, or was theft the motive?

xxx

Though the weather is brisk here, remember that the mosquitoes in Miami are already reproducing themselves exponentially.

February 18, 2016

Most of mankind lives and dies in quiet desperation. Not so with Supreme Court Justice Antonin Scalia. He made a large, positive difference. His life should be an inspiration to all.

xxx

The vicious Bernie Sanders' attack on Henry Kissinger. Claimed latter caused the Khymer Rouge to murder three million Cambodians. Rarely does one witness such attacks between practicing Hebrews. Our guess is that the Rabbi will rap Sanders' knuckles.

xxx

How unseemly that the two Cubans and the real estate mogul frequently called each other "liar" in Saturday night debate by Republican Presidential candidate hopefuls. It is such an unforgiving, nonerasable word. Moderator, or one of the managers should have whispered , "inaccurate historian," as preferred substitute.

XXX

Brand new term, "medical tourism" is suddenly heard, frequently. Seems to mean going to a foreign country, India and Mexico for medical procedures at reduced cost. One would think that since survival the primary goal it would be one of life's few activities in which cost not the controlling factor. National pride should prevent the practice to expand beyond rare.

XXX

Need is for American colleges to turn out more doctors. Our government should have the power, and the will to cancel the license of every lawyer under thirty and send him/her to medical school, prepaid.

XXX

Of the miracles of modern medicine, we are curious how the Congressional Committee will strike back at the contemptuous drug manufacturer who priced his pill obscenely expensive and referred to the Committee as imbeciles."

XXX

While we admire our leaders who are bi-lingual, it is an unreasonable to expect the rank and file to display such mental dexterity. National unity would be enhanced by limiting governmental communication to English.

XXX

We should be exporting well paid English teachers to every foreign country burdened with another language. International air traffic has spread English worldwide. Our government should do more to seize the opportunity, for world peace and understanding.

XXX

Disgraceful that schools and courthouse were closed Friday and Monday. Also some banks and post offices. Big losers in these teacher/public officials' contrived excuses not to excel are the students. If paid absence from one's employment/duty, is the greatest joy, should change jobs.

February 25, 2016

Too often genealogy is the futile search for illustrious firebears.

xxx

We have often expressed our admiration of the late Supreme Court Justice Antonin Scalia.

xxx

He was interested every facet of life and the rules by which we live together. Though a devout Catholic, he opined that the Court needed more "diversity", noting that there were four Catholic justices, two Hebrew, no protestants, four lived in New York City, all attended an Ivy League school.

xxx

Scalia's observation painfully applicable to small communities as to residence and graduate schools. When a large community attracts the more talented, others gravitate to the large communities to the constant fatal drain of their origin. Call it diversity, and to the deserving, or whatever, the need is for more governmental concern for the well being of small cities, 2500 to 10,000 inhabitants.

xxx

Tax breaks are the obvious, easiest lure to bring desired new residents to struggling communities. Less statewide investment in mass transit for the metropolitan communities would, be helpful to bring the diversity that Scalia mentioned, as did President Obama in black admission quotas.

xxx

At the risk of being falsely labeled "racist", we wonder why diversity is never mentioned in the makeup of university basketball teams. Would sell a heck of a lot more tickets.

xxx

Of spectator sports, we were startled that regional high school basketball games at Casey were televised to I-pads everywhere. We thought television was limited to major happenings in large communities.

xxx

Would appear that the wonderful world of electronics threatens to destroy radio stations as totally as it has newspapers.

xxx

We expressed awe that two individuals miles apart with Apple I-pads could talk to each other while watching the others face and surroundings. But at least 30 years ago the telephone industry, a principal means of communication before wireless, experimented with phone vision. Phone booths and other settings had a camera wherein the user saw as he/ she talked with one on the other end of the line. We recalled reading that the French equipped a small town for such marvelous development in communication. But we heard no more of that innovation. We doubt that present user, more mobile system will pass away unnoticed.

xxx

The tragedy in Kalamazoo wherein a uber driver slaughtered six adults at random, mostly women, will surely renew the doubts of many that an armed community is safe from self destruction. Apparently the perpetrator, driver of the vehicle, had been tested by every conceivable method.

xxx

That the killer is insane is a given. To hospitalize him for 50 years is pathological. We think the methodical German disposition of the officer who attempted to kill Hitler with a bomb planted in his field office 9 months before der futurer killed himself, persuaded many others not to attempt to rescue mankind. Televised slow strangulation was the punishment.

March 3, 2016

Too often we forget that every issue has two sides. We remember an irascible Illinois Industrial Commissioner whose desk prominently displayed a sign, "audi alterm parti" which he said was Latin, to remind him to hear other lawyers, too.

xxx

We were complaining to Jim Lockhart, as he gassed the last bag in the Law Factory that people born on February 29 got a bad deal in that they were deprived of gifts and recognition which often

accompany birthdays. His reply, "but they never grow old."

xxx

If there were just a particle of reality in Lockhart's quick, only half in jest response. Maybe there is. We wondered if there has ever been a study to determine what effect, if any, on the aging process from skipping the annual observation. Leap year babies would appear a logical place to commence such study.

xxx

In the interim my twin sister and I shall not await the study; we are persuaded that if ignored, these years will pass away without harm to the carrier. Do not expect an invitation from us for a birthday party on September 15. Do not send presents either. Let us find the fountain of youth together.

xxx

March 10, 2016

Elsewhere in this week's Press, or perhaps next, will be an article by Victoria and Ainslee on earning admission to sold-out Conley Gym, Flora, last Friday night.

xxx

Named seniors at LHS confided to the Publisher on Friday morning that they needed entrance to the Sectional Championship game that evening in Conley Gym, Flora, starring the Mighty Indians and their nemesis, T-town.

xxx

After precise negotiations, it was agreed that these would-be fans would carry a letter from the Publisher to the gatekeepers confirming that they were writing an article for The Sumner Press, asking admission to the press corps for that purpose.

xxx

Alas, neither the officers nor a couple of other officials had heard of The Sumner Press, or of Roscoe Cunningham. Then miraculously some lady moved forward, assured the officer there was

such a newspaper and that "Roscoe is a good guy, used to be our State Representative, publishes The Press instead of playing golf." The Officer opened the gate.

xxx

Our ego was crushed that no one in Flora apparently knew who Roscoe Cunningham is/was. Nostalgically, we remembered a dozen double-bicycle rides in the Flora night and London-air afternoon Halloween parades throughout the 70's. The crowds were large and friendly, their friendship carried over to the polling places.

xxx

We thought of John O., Trudy & Penny Denson at The Flora Daily News; their brainy high school student sports writer; Mayor Jack Thatcher & Bonne, City Hall; Dorothy Crowder, active leader of the Republican women; Jack Meyer, a political ally, and his parents; County Clerk Robert VanWey; Lawrence County Sheriff Elbert Bailey & the gatekeepers confirming the times, and her father, "Hoosier," a precinct committeeman extraordinary.

xxx

These are but a few of the friends upon whose backs we've ridden as does every winning candidate, and to whom we're forever indebted.

xxx

We wondered why none of the named had not sprung to our assistance one mere time by assuring the police at the ballgame that we are reliable. Alas, except for dear Ronnie, they are all deceased. Time marches on.

xxx

The game was a tragedy and a triumph. We are proud of the Mighty Indians. They bring favorable notice to our area from far and wide.

Roscoe's Journal — Part 011

March 24, 2016

A cynical friend observed to us that if churches believed the constant refrain, "material goods are meaningless," they would not pass the collection plate with such frequency.

xxx

We have been disappointed how few have volunteered to accompany us in promised migration to Australia when Donald Trump elected President. One invitee who had other plans for the future, Jim England, said that he received a message from the Trump Exchequer that it would pay for our airplane flight.

xxx

We renewed our invitation to Jim & Rita to move home to Bridgeport from Carbondale. Even assured him that the wanted poster had been taken down at the Post Office.

xxx

Those people are too nice for the county to lose. We must all work more effectively to lure home replacements.

xxx

The magnolia tree at Bill & Christina Albright's mansion, State Street, Lawrenceville, was magnificent over the weekend. In bloom it is surely the most beautiful of all trees. Problem is that the bloom is measurable in hours rather than in days. Rain, cold snap, or a little wind, the beauty is fini.

xxx

Viewed with total objectivity, no political consideration, one must conclude that Congressional imposed sanctions have brought both Iran and Cuba to their knees. If that be true, how could it be in the American best interest to lift sanctions against each of these dictatorships, as President Obama has essentially done?

xxx

Amusing that the American public is now being told that trade with Cuba will somehow enrich the

USA. How a penniless would-be purchaser can effect such an improvement in American exports we're anxious to see.

xxx

If the Cubans had money to spend, the Europeans or the Asians would long since have acquired it.

xxx

Havana as a gambling mecca was an area attraction before Las Vegas. We think Las Vegas has enough sparkle to lure all American gamblers, and that Havana will merely join Monte Carlo as a famous former gamblers' paradise.

xxx

Spring arrived Sunday. It is truly the grandest season of the year.

March 31, 2016

Why doesn't the Chamber of Commerce pressure the Department of Natural Resources to sweeten terms of lease on Trace Inn that that potential area attraction might be again in full swing for the fast approaching summer season?

xxx

Whoever appeals to DNR should also mention horse trails, permanent lodge, motors on lake, and an arena where Tri-County Saddle Club bravely shows with minimal support from officialdom. RHISP deserves far more from Springfield, and Washington, than has ever been received.

xxx

There is strength in numbers. You will be heard and heeded, if joined by every neighbor you can influence, and each of them recruits as many allies as will listen.

xxx

When the Greeks created democracy they conceived was that all voters were equal. Thousands of years later, Lincoln was yet paying lip service to equality. The national leadership of the Democratic Party has no such illusions in selection of delegates to their quadrennial conventions

Recognizing the potential of uninformed, or ignorant, to cause mischief in the party machine, they created "super delegates".

xxx

Each state's party leadership, always including the party's highest elected office holders, is given a sizeable, as much as 10%, number of delegates to the DNC, to be distributed as the leaders decide. This extra group is the antithesis of democracy; they are a, by, and for, the lordly elite. We have ordered no more moves by the elected dele-

gates. We think this control device is clever, necessary and should be adopted by the other political party.

xxx

Super delegates are the reason that Hillary Clinton can smile and appear carefree though that old pro, Bernie Sanders, has trounced her in a majority of primaries, including Tuesday's primary. The motors on lake, and an weekend —Washington, Hawaii & Alaska. Her concession e-mail to Sanders should read, "good try, old chap, but the super delegates have decided that I get the nomination."

xxx

One can imagine the public scorn if the Republicans engaged in such a charade. So, the machinery has run wild. The two still standing, from the original 13, call each other names that are unprintable. Every national shooting tragedy appears to boost the uninformed opinion that only Donald Trump can save this country from total destruction.

xxx

The answer is Stacy Arbuckle, Sumner, and Lorie Cunningham, Lawrenceville, who had similar decorations for the night time Easter egg hunt Saturday. Each mixed broken glow sticks in empty shells and mingled same with the conventional variety.

xxx

Lorie's display had an additional sparkle - another had covered the lawn with 1" carpet of "jewels". Lorie's lot had half shaped, almost as large as a golf ball, and some were preserved in the freezer.

xxx

Pretty though hail storms are, they disastrous to roofs.

April 7, 2016

One needs look no farther than the mirror to know what has caused Lawrence County's malaise of the economy. We have grown old, fat, secure, unwilling to take any risks.

xxx

A hair-curling depression would cure each of these states of untenable positions. That is too painful a solution to be acceptable.

xxx

The Sumner Press, other news media, the education system, and government should do more to inspire all to make a physical/ mental contribution toward Lawrence County's revival.

xxx

In more active years the manual arts program in four high schools was gung-ho. One would think with two consolidated schools it would be within reach.

xxx

Individual approach to legislators by all who will could remedy the neglect of government expenditure for our county very quickly.

xxx

Last October we heard whispering that the Public Aid Office might be transferred to Richland County. The *Press* promptly made a bended-knee approach to Springfield in this regard. That it was not successful is obvious. We now hear there is a danger that the medical marijuana dispensary center will be moved from much reconstructed Lawrenceville Greenhouse site to Olney. That must not happen.

xxx

It is the duty of every citizen who seeks to help

Lawrence County's revival to contact every politician within reach that he/she can influence to plead that the dispensary center remain at street edge of Lawrenceville. Where the building reconstruction for such center is three-fourths finished, it is an economic crime to consider moving to another, less deserving site.

xxx

During spring break several traveled to Hancock County to view the jail in Carthage from which Joseph and Hyrum Smith were fatally mobbed and killed on June 27, 1844. Public disapproval of Mormons. [illegible] over the same 200 miles to Lawrenceville to see the gallows from whence Elizabeth "Betsy" Reed was publicly hanged, May 23, 1845 for poisoning her husband. Only woman thus punished in Illinois. Suggested tourist attraction should be erected by the Lawrence County Historical Society, public contribution, 2016.

xxx

A friend, skilled at laying bricks, earns an obscene amount of money at his seasonal employment. He is purchasing a fine home in adjacent Indiana. To our plea "why not build here", he replied, I am arrested for something every time I come here." The police, prosecution and judiciary should not cease the entire county to shoot itself in the foot.

xxx

Let's all pull together for a brighter tomorrow for County Lawrence.

April 14, 2016

We fear publishing small town newspaper isolates one from reality. Tis easy to point out the changes that should be made. But causing that to happen is quite impossible.

Fifty years of furious effort for four lanes for Route 50 without tangible progress is discouraging.

Notwithstanding the above reality the next two months in Springfield will be where the excitement is. The Governor vs. the Legislature impasse simply cannot proceed into another fiscal year, July 1, 2016. We think a compromise agreement will be reached in the next 11 weeks.

One must admire the tenacity of the Governor who's stand has elicited so little public support.

We think its a fair assessment of popular achievement to note that more scientific discoveries are made each century than in the prior.

If the above premise is true are the people better served whose leadership is focused on the future rather than on the past? As Muhammad Ali said, " if am bragging if you can do it"

Americans including Illinoisans should not blush as they claim leadership in to a brighter future.

April 21, 2016

We admired Senator Sanders in his uphill struggle against Hillary Clinton for the Democratic presidential nomination. Results of Tuesday's NY primary were strong enough to guarantee Hillary's nomination before the Convention. Las Vegas bookies say that she is the next President.

xxx

That 74 year old Sanders come so close to upsetting the administration's carefully drawn plans was remarkable. He has a great capacity to make nonsense sound like reason.

xxx

Does not democracy need more protection against such proven ability of a snake oil salesman? The answer is always "education." But politics excite emotions to a point that education appears irrelevant.

xxx

If it were possible, we would urge criminal prosecution for willfully telling untruths of material matters in political campaigns. Unfortunately, those court attempts always fail. Matter is referred to the committee.

xxx

It would be refreshing if in this moment of challenge to reason there were a legislator with sufficient courage to propose return of literacy tests to voter registration. Thus armed, education would bring better results in needed reform.

xxx

November 8 election be-

tween Hillary and Donald should be lulu. Matters not that several of us are yet alive who remember the Barry Goldwater campaign, 1964. That's the beauty of politics. After a disaster, the defeated dream of a return match.

xxx

We had feared that marriage had become passe. We checked records in office of County Clerk Will F. Gibson and found that noble institution is alive and well in Lawrence County. An average 140 licenses issued in each of the last five years. No great variation in any of the years.

xxx

Unsolicited counseling: marriage license is the best insurance for every girl. The Legislature has been slow to define respective rights of the parties as to children and property.

xxx

It is a foolish girl who ends up with small children to support & raise and a prideless male sperm donor.

xxx

Until respective rights defined by the Legislature, a young maiden should insist on a marriage license, or placing in trust in a written agreement, and faith.

xxx

Before we pack up for the trip to Australia, we dared hope that more present readers of the Press would dare to reduce their thoughts to the printed page and mail to us. Thank you.

April 28, 2016

Profanity is a sin. Violates the third commandment. Found from telegraph.co.uk interesting article about absolutely excellent insults from some of the most famous English Literature by William Shakespeare. Even 400 years after his death Shakespeare proves that eloquent literature can be "far more cutting and verbose than swearing, and won't make you known for having a potty mouth." So, remember these quotes and apply as necessary and relevant "Away, you starvelling, you elf-skin, you dried neat's-tongue, bull's-pizzle, you stock-fish!", Henry IV Part I - Act II, Scene iv "Thou art a boil, a plague sore", King Lear - Act II, Scene ii; "Would thou wert clean enough to spit upon", Timon of Athens - Act IV, Scene iii; "The rankest compound of villainous smell that ever offended nostril", The Merry Wives of Windsor - Act III, Scene v; "Thou sodden-witted lord! Thou hast no more brain than I have in mine elbows", Troilus and Cressida - Act II, Scene I; "I'll beat thee, but I would infect my hands", Timon of Athens - Act IV, Scene iii; "I am sick when I do look on thee", A Midsummer Night's Dream - Act II, Scene I; "Methink'st thou art a general offence and every man should beat thee", All's Well That Ends Well - Act II, Scene iii; mate!", Henry IV Part II - Act II, Scene iv; Inadequate vocabulary cared

of the poor in the U.S.A.. Uninformed foreigners would conclude that many go to bed hungry in this land of plenty. Fact is, only a handful of fat dieting republicans are so cruelly tested.

xxx

These uninformed foreigners would surely preclude that millions are unemployed in the land of hope and opportunity. Truth is that not a single Lawrence County citizen with performance capacity of a sixth grader would be unemployed if he/she had the ambition and pride to work.*** Next six months should produce memorable television entertainment.

xxx

We doubt that either Hillary or Donald will hurl insults at each other more ferocious than those fired in the preliminary round.

xxx

How the opposition never tired in questioning the ability of the ultimate winners to lead, the skill with which each got on the inside rail and held that position throughout should put all fears to rest.

xxx

A more immediate concern is, what are our representatives doing for four lanes for 50, now level dam on the Wabash, and flight connected industry at George Field?

xxx

The threatened collapse of our county deserves more attention from those at the helm in Washington, Springfield and the Lawrence County courthouse and the City Halls.

xxx

The democrat presidential candidates oversold plight [end of column; remaining lines run into the adjacent Central Christian church-news column and are not part of Roscoe's Journal]

May 5, 2016

AP headline, "Tiny town rejects 1,100 jobs." Town elders of Nickerson , Nebraska , pop. 400, did not wish to change their way of life.

xxx

We believe their decision was foolish. Talented, ambitious young will not stay in tiny communities. That's why the struggle to bring in new jobs is vital.

xxx

We believe time will soon come that government will decree an optimum minimum population, e.g., 10,000, and recognize no municipal entity smaller. Both the necessities and amenities of life could be directed to such mandated cities by tax breaks and grants.

xxx

But until government assumes that decretory role, a community that would survive must constantly seek expansion of population and industry.

xxx

Democratic presidential candidates balloon plight of the poor in the USA beyond reason. Uninformed foreigners could conclude from the candidates' rhetoric that many are hungry, homeless, abused in this land of milk and honey. Government should send a truth squad to each rally to correct on television that nonsense.

xxx

This generation and their ancestors should take pride in the improvement made in living conditions for every American during the past 70 years.

xxx

We are fascinated by the reverence that many historians have for the Egyptians for creating the pyramids without hydraulic lifts. Rope and pole movement of heavy objects through a lever system is not a comparable mental

triumph with daily unlocking of the secrets of the universe through crystals that make electronics a useful tool for all mankind.

xxx

If upright man has existed on this earth for millions of years, as claimed by most archaeologists, exactly what did they do during those years to justify their existence?

xxx

Western civilization came into the hope of the world. There is no reason for deference to other civilizations.

xxx

Mankind would be better served if some of these scientific breakthroughs had never occurred. An

example is the taped response to telephone calls.

xxx

We are persuaded that every public employee, appointed or elected, has at some time hidden behind a telephone answering system.

xxx

Another scientific wonder is the FAX machine which will eventually destroy every tree in the land.

xxx

FAX makes every individual a printer. The ease with which it uses paper suggests that the forest cannot grow fast enough to meet demand.

xxx

Notwithstanding these reservations, we recognize that change is the essence of life and disagree with the elders of Nickerson , Nebraska .

xxx

Our proofreader observed that contra our ridicule of the Clinton/Sanders Food for Neglected Children, it is a viable, necessary program. We concur and suggest that the parents of the recipients should be ordered to go to bed hungry.

May 12, 2016

Biggest casualty of the 21st century, we far, has been the accelerated collapse of religion as the guiding light to the moral values upon which the existence of an organized society depends.

xxx

Not more than 45 in attendance at First Christian Sunday. Had there been a cock fight in the parking lot, with high admission charge, would have drawn more than five hundred. Priority for church attendance is non-existent. with exception of Pentecostal.

xxx

In the faith guided past, a heroic effort was made through Sunday school to inculcate young minds' principles essential to good citizenship. Now, the court system has taken responsibility to correct behavior deemed anti-social. Well intentioned psychologist types lecture the miscreant, usually DUI or illegal drugs, for numerous hours. As though a 40 year old loser will thereby acquire the values of Sunday School youth. It is too little, too late, too expensive.

xxx

Faith itself has taken huge losses in number who believe. All should be outraged that Ben Stern was dismissed as a columnist for the N.Y. Times reportedly because he believed that the earth and its inhabitants were created by a super natural force.

xxx

"Said one among them, 'surely not in vain, my substance from the common earth was taken, and to this figure molded, to be broke and trampled back to senseless earth again'." ----Anon.

xxx

The need in the USA is for a grand resurgence of church attendance. Then that embattled species would dare to condemn the moral filth that permeates so much of television.

xxx

The non church goer should be asked, "would you wish to live in a community without churches?"

xxx

One would have thought that in a nation so gambling oriented that the process banned as criminal in most states 50 years ago, is now

legal and a primary tool to raise money for government, would recognize that the odds against faith are non-existent. The payoff for a non-believer if proven correct is zero! By gamblers' odds, makes no sense whatever to be a non-believer.

xxx

We read an interesting article on the tremendous boost a single thoroughbred, American Pharoah, has brought to the sport of kings, horse racing. Attendance at the oldest continuous derby in the U.S. had slid for years. Paled in comparison with number of fans for the Indianapolis 500. The commanding presence of American Pharoah, a large horse with a string of impressive victories, lured a record 170,000 to last year's Kentucky Derby. That's double the average for each of five preceding derbies. More than 168,000 came Saturday to watch Nyquist win the 142nd Derby.

xxx

We recalled stopping at Churchill Downs 20 years ago while on the summer trip with Lawrence County Golden Age Club #1, and thinking then its proud symbol on the lawn near the entrance, a statue of Man of War, a famous winner from circa 1930 might be a little old to be relevant. We'll offer even odds that CD will erect a statue of American Pharoah within a year.

xxx

Pictures show that American Pharoah has prospered. After winning the Triple Crown, K.Y. plus Preakness and Belmont, he was retired to stud. During the year, 1,000 horse fanciers brought their mares, at \$200,000 each! The handler was asked how long this success would continue. He answered "Depends upon success of his foal."

xxx

Among people, parents are often judged by their offspring. Labor should keep that in mind. Wonder if Moses was experienced in horse racing when he delivered the 5th Commandment.

May 19, 2016

During the 30 years after 1985, Illinois population increased approximately 10 per cent; Lawrence County's decreased almost 20 per cent. Our failure to keep pace has accelerated. Something must be done to stem the trend

xxx

Many factors influence desirability of a community as someone's new home. We are told that utility rates are high on the list. Only utility within easy grasp of the people is water. There simply must be more economy. Recent increase, or threatened, are a disaster to our needed population expansion.

xxx

Public service employee unions are so strong, any leader who proposed wage rollback would be lynched, or retired at next election. Perhaps a policy of not filling vacancies caused by retirement, would bring needed cost reduction.

xxx

Would need to be coupled with expression of appreciation for those carrying the addition load.

xxx

Real estate taxes are another reality that looms large in new residents' consideration. The tax statement enumerates where your tax money goes. Largest item is education. Management needs greater economy, without serious reduction of the quality of

education offered.. Most taxpayers recognize how vital education is to the future, and bear that burden hopefully.

xxx

A related problem in education is the residence of the teachers. Without exception they should live within the County.

xxx

A quick, easy way to save the taxpayers \$50,000 a year is to greatly reduce the sheriff's hotel and restaurant customers. The Constitution provides right of one accused of a criminal offense to be released on reasonable bail while awaiting trial, except where he/she would be a public danger.

xxx

Problem comes in the amount of bail required for the defendant's release. Lawrence County Circuit Judge and the State's Attorney regularly fix bail beyond the reach of the poor who perpetrate a continual flow of nuisance crimes. When our modern jail is full, the miscreants are regularly housed & fed in Crawford, Richland and Wabash counties. Might as well burn these taxpayer dollars for any good they do to make our County grow.

xxx

The County Board lacks the nerve to stop this financial hemorrhage.

May 26, 2016

Public opinion appears to travel in cycles, often repeating itself. After the U.S. Supreme Court held death penalty constitutional, circa 1974, we introduced the first bill in the Illinois House of Representatives authorizing such punishment. It was combined with subsequent bills and easily passed the House and Senate. Gov. Thompson signed. Several murderers were sentence to death during the next dozen years, but none was executed.

xxx

Sensing the mood change of public opinion in the late 80s, then Gov. Ryan commuted death penalty sentence of all awaiting execution. In early 2000 the law was amended to again outlaw death penalty in Illinois. Without an ending to seem bloodthirsty we suggest that public opinion has undergone another 180 degree change and a bill to restore the death penalty would easily pass both houses and probably obtained the Governor's needed signature. Almost every day the Tribune reports a vicious murder. Last week, a Chicago animal named Uribe murdered six relatives for no apparent reason. It is time for the deterrent effect of execution be tested.

xxx

Curiously, churches are always the strongest opponents of capital punishment. It were as though they did not believe there is a world after this one. If any leader therein wishes to comment, the Press will make space for their thoughts.

xxx

The regular session of the General Assembly adjourns May 31. Our guess is that Governor Rauner, Speaker Madigan, and Senate President Cullerton will reach a compromise settlement by daylight Monday, May 30. Each side will claim victory. It is the right moment

to stake claim to a sliver from the predictable tax increase for the Department of Transportation to combine with Federal funds in construction of Four Lanes for Route Fifty.

xxx

State pride should come into this matter. Just as "worst tax rating in the nation" was so irritating to Illinois' leaders, so should the reminder be that Route 50 will be four lanes wide across Indiana before winter.

xxx

We hope that there will be a record turnout for the Memorial Day Ceremony, 11 a.m., Monday, May 30, NW Courthouse lawn. The principal speaker is Judge James Osborne, Knox County Superior Court, creator of Indiana Military Museum, Sixth & Willow, Vincennes.

xxx

Horse races are totally unpredictable. Surprising that they were accepted as the medium in which gamblers practiced their art so long. Saturday, Kentucky Derby winner Nyquist and ten other thoroughbreds, including Exaggerator ran in the prestigious Preakness, Baltimore, second leg in the "triple crown" (for a million dollars). Nyquist had defeated Exaggerator decisively in four prior races. though the bookies made him a co-favorite, few in the crowd of 120,000 thought he would beat Nyquist. He did so with apparent ease.

xxx

The cynical may think "fix", but two earlier tragedies on the Preakness track should erase any suspicion that the jockeys do less than their best in every encounter: one horse dropped dead after the first race. In subsequent race, before the feature race, the lead horse broke its leg. In the quaint language of the sport, he was 'put down'. They run full throttle.

June 2, 2016

One would think that at the prices they charge electricians would be in abundant supply in the City of Champions . It is not so. Scarce as hen's teeth. And they enjoy saying "stand in line" as the mercury climbs and the AC goes kaput.

xxx

Same observation as to plumbers.

xxx

Although there are too many holidays, Memorial Day is not one that should be deleted. The

citizenry enjoys that holiday more than most.

xxx

We blush and apologize for directing readers to the Courthouse lawn for Legion, VFW and Elks Memorial Day service. Our readers knew better and swelled the crowd at the cemetery where Judge James Osborne, Knox Superior Court, gave a splendid speech. His Honor observed, "I'm preaching to the choir, you already honor the dead, and the veterans yet living."

xxx

Problem with Lawrence County 's Memorial Day observance is that it is a single shot event. Should be connected with a parade of high school and post high school bands.

xxx

Would signal to all the world that ours is a bustling community if we had a post high school band which gave a concert in the band-

stand at least once a month throughout the summer and participated in a monthly parade which we should have.

xxx

Press would contribute cash, big time, to any student, or other citizen who would organize such a band.

xxx

The emphasis in this world should be on becoming performers rather than mere spectators. Alas, the law of inertia applies to the brain and can-do spirit as well as all other things.

xxx

Vehicular traffic in the USA has doubled since the Eisenhower highway program, but building of new highways, at least in Illinois , has collapsed.

xxx

It is time for a massive update of the highway system starting in Illinois . The \$2 billion which the U.S. gives to Israel and Egypt annually, much of which goes for armaments, would be better spent building new highways in the USA.

xxx

A Congressman named Gray immortalized the name by amount of taxpayer dollars he funneled into his district. What is Congressman John Shimkus doing to make Route 50 four lanes wide that he might be as legendary as Gray?

June 9, 2016

Those who dream of a more prosperous Lawrence County received a bitter disappointment last week. The entrepreneur who thought Lawrence County had been chosen as site for the medical marijuana disposition center and spent half a million dollars preparing the former Lawrenceville Greenhouse, Business Route 50 as that Site, abandoned the project.

xxx

Word on the street is that Effingham has been chosen as distribution center site. If so, will make a mockery of the statutory criterion of community economic need in site selection. We believe Effingham will be chosen and that the three castles on Rte 33 NW of that City will be a factor in whatever group makes the site selection. Their Board of Review knows that a ceiling on assessment of new homes can help hold back the trailer park civic image.

xxx

Some months back, we first heard that disaster might strike our community's deserved breath of fresh air for its economy. Immediately, the *Press* wrote to all in the public feed trough thought involved in site selection, urging that Lawrenceville be confirmed as the site. The one reply was a phone call from Department of Agriculture advising "your correspondence should be directed to the Department of Public Health."

xxx

Press will publish names and contents of any who raised any objection to this latest economic misfortune. We do not need a lecture on the danger of the weed. Our representative government has determined that the potential "good " outweighs the potential "bad", and that its controlled

production and sale are legitimate commerce.

xxx

Within next few weeks it is expected that there will be an announcement that Toyota and Mid-Continent International Airport have reached an agreement for the parking of hundreds of new Toyotas on unused runways, as though this

were an economic blockbuster. " Not failure but low aim is crime." Everyone should appreciate Toyota, and the boost which it gives our economy, but George Field is surely capable of higher use, including car storage.

xxx

Sixty years ago, agents from the Field went to Springfield, and Washington, to publicly solicit involvement. It is time for that quaint process to resume.

xxx

Our Division of Aeronautics, Department of Transportation, needs to do more to incorporate Mid-American Air Center into state and national aeronautics industry. When Boeing leased an unused field adjacent to Scott, *Press* attempted to persuade its competitor, Airbus, that it should have a comparable auxiliary field. Federal Express should remain a target. Perhaps we can steal it from Memphis like Effingham obtained the marijuana distribution center.

xxx

An easier dream in our scheme to economically bootstrap Lawrence County would be the construction of a low level dam, just above Pulleyville.

xxx

Two months from now one will be able to walk across the Wabash in that area. The Waterways Division of the Department of Transportation has all the earth moving equipment required to construct an earthen dam across the Wabash . If such were done, the public would see what a tourist mecca for boaters St. Francisville would be.

xxx

Obtaining the money necessary from Washington to put the concrete in place would be much easier.

xxx

This low level dam would not destroy 10 acres of tillable land. Even the farmers would approve when they saw what imagination had wrought.

xxx

Savor the long warm summer hours of daylight. They will begin to shorten in two weeks.

June 16, 2016

The massacre at Orlando was a barbaric assault on civilization.

xxx

We fear that comparable attacks will come in greater frequency. Organized society must find a way to protect self against such madness. We must move beyond the tired old argument about disarming a fearful nation.

xxx

Distasteful, repugnant to every concept of justice, but maybe effective—hold parents responsible for intentional death, or serious injury caused by their offspring IF the parent knew of radicalization of the child, and failed to notify police of offspring's potential threat to public safety.

xxx

We would extend this parental responsibility children 29 years old, living elsewhere. Acquisition of automatic firearms, without observable legitimate purpose, would trigger parental responsibility. As would threats of violent acts against an individual, or individuals.

xxx

If the Muslim faith is to retain its standing as one of the great religions of the world it must take effective action to disassociate itself from the radical wing which apparently takes literally the

command from the Koran, "kill the infidel." There is not room in America for a "religion" that believes, or believes within its ranks, any silly notion that any human can have a license to murder.

xxx

We have encountered Muslims who suggest that radical Islam is no worse than radical Christianity, and that the latter is tolerated with equanimity, citing Westboro Baptist Church, Topeka, KS. We carry no brief for the Phelps family and their concept of their Christian duty, e.g. protest at military funerals.

xxx

The decisive difference between the two radical groups is that Westboro makes "peaceful protests". The U.S. Supreme Court has upheld such as a constitutional right. Radical Islam is the antithesis of peaceful protest. It should be driven from our country.

xxx

We share the opinion of many Americans: our President should have no problem in connecting radical Islam and the tragedy of Orlando.

June 23, 2016

We are discouraged at lack of reader response. Last week we suggested a sit in protest against construction of new bridge on 15th street. Unless effective opposition arises within 90 days, IDOT will waste several million taxpayer dollars constructing new bridge where the old is adequate for another 50 years if abutting landowners upstream would quit throwing debris into the Embarrass River.

xxx

We think the bridge should be built upstream 3/8ths of a mile, aligned to carry west bound two lanes of Route 50.

Beauty of our proposal is that taxpayers wouldn't need to raise a dime more than is presently budgeted. The new bridge thus located will be a symbol of hope for a disappointed multitude that one day Route 50 will be Four Lanes wide, from the Wabash to the Mississippi River.

xxx

If a reader has a better idea for jump starting Four Lanes for Fifty, all us how. If you'll join a sit in protest, send the Press your written promise. It is time for make worthwhile things happen for this community need

xxx

Religion and believers should quit minimizing importance of material goods in the scheme of things. They are a measuring stick for the efficiency of one's life. How well did he handle his ability, his inheritance and luck, good and bad, which came his way.

xxx

The Christian ideal is that the old and infirm are cared for by all who would glorify God. In reality, without remuneration the care needed would be woefully inadequate.

xxx

Our confidence in Sumner Public Schools, and the teachers therein, is unshakable. But why glbe strawberry moon never mentioned? Why was there a 49 year interim between the strawberry moon and the summer solstice?

xxx

Their retention of knowledge and dispersal thereof on signal is so infinite, computers may one day make conventional brick and mortar centers of learning obsolete.

xxx

Once a child has been taught to read , and to operate a computer, his world is without limit.

xxx

We were startled to read that for the 7th consecutive year the Chinese have the fastest computer on earth. Is America not the world's greatest?

xxx

We thought of Maurice Schwartz, a Jewish refugee from France, who live in same 6gh Street home as we at the U of I, 1941. He thought it hilarious that Americans believed themselves world champions in every encounter. "Brooklyn boxer wins a bout. Next time he is billed world's champion welterweight."

xxx

Our goal should be to make Maurice's observation factual. Why should the Chinese computer be faster than ours?

xxx

June 30, 2016

Distance from London to Washington, D.C., is so much greater than from Honolulu to Washington, D.C.

xxx

Now is the time for the U.S. to annex England and Scotland, as the 51st and 52nd states of our grand union. Sixty-two years before Alaska joined the USA. They fit so smoothly into the scheme of things no one in this wide world would argue that they do not belong.

xxx

Need for speed in the annexation proposed is the likelihood that Scotland will dissolve its union with England within a year. The Scots voted two to one for Britain to remain a member of the European Union. The 18 remaining members of EU would court an independent Scotland to rejoin. The feared instability might thereby be lessened, but would make joinder with the USA impossible.

xxx

The Brexit vote was a surprise to everyone: the pollsters, the stock market, government leaders including our President Obama who flew there to urge the British to vote to remain in the EU. The leaders of the successful motion for Britain to leave EU, including an unheard of named Farage, haven't a clue how to operate a government. Curiously, it was these "winners" who suggested that Prime Minister David Cameron postpone until September his declared intent to resign, since the

voters rejected his recommendation on the vote.

xxx

Americans share many of the beliefs and concept of a democratic government as does present government of England and Scotland (known collectively with Wales & Northern Ireland as Great Britain). We speak a very similar language.

There is no reason to fear that the union proposed would be less than harmonious

xxx

We live in a fractious world. Small nations quarreling with each other increase the danger that a full scale world war would follow. Such would end civilization. It is the duty of all who can to support arguments that lessen the friction. We hope that President Obama, or the U.S. Congress will immediately start the wheels to annex England and Scotland

xxx

Non-naysayers may have routed the U.S. Supreme Court's decision in Huang case difficult to understand. President Obama, frustrated by Congressional failure to pass immigration reform (code for amnesty), issued an Executive Order which would have granted Huang same exemption from deportation as young son who was born in this nation. Trial Court held the Order within the President's authority; Appeals Court reversed. Decision was appealed to the Supreme Court. One member short since Justice Scalia's death six months ago, Supreme Court split 4 to 4 on whether to reverse the Appeals Court. So, Huang might be deported though son can stay.

xxx

In most cases loss of Justice Scalia's political persuasion would be serious handicap to so-called conservatives. In this instance the procedural rules furnished the edge that would have been expected from the late Justice. The case underscored how important the Presidential election 17 weeks from Tuesday to tune the balance of power, ingeniously crafted by our nation's first leaders, between executive, judicial and congressional branches of government.

xxx

July 7, 2016

Ellie Weisel's hatred of Nazis was understandable. They murdered his mother, sister and millions of other innocents.

We disagree with most news media which in death have painted him a Jewish counterpart to Mother Teresa. He became deified in death because WW II for unparalleled Nazism

xxx

Forty years after Buchenwald was liberated, the German Government was having some international event concerning civilian rights. President Reagan was invited. Weisel commanded him not to go. Reagan went because a President's first consideration must always be the safety and well being of this nation. America has no more trustworthy ally in Europe today than Germany.

xxx

Words properly arranged can be powerful tools. Sometimes their permanency is overlooked, even when they message is patently false, e.g. "all men are created equal" immortalized when they came from President Lincoln's lips at Gettysburg. "sticks and stones may break my bones, but words can never harm me." from an English nursery rhyme. All who have been injured by words can attest to the inaccuracy. Fitzgerald-Omar Khayam related this to inaccuracy: "the moving finger writes, and having writ, moves on, nor all your tears nor wit shall lure it back to cancel half a line, Nor all your tears wash out a word of it." "words no matter how abusive can never constitute an assault." Some justice giving a "pass" to a mouthy lout. The Illinois Legislature has partially closed this loophole in logic. Verbal threats in enumerated circumstances can constitute a criminal offense.

xxx

In retrospect, meat scene that the American combat troops were drawn out of Iraq years too soon. It was politically popular. Americans public opinion never buckled down to our responsibility to be the world policeman. President Truman seldom slept on the question for the home front to keep the troops there...The Sumner formed ISIS Hopefully if we get our intests in order, history will mend that we did not lose World War II. We must, with the U.S. Presidential election

xxx

Some thought us harsh when we are losing the war against Islamic terrorists. But we doubt that a

major-ity favors an all out renewal of the Iraqi War.

Some people are kind, polite and sweet-spirited until you try to sit in their pew?

(continued on page 4)

July 14, 2016

Anticipation is one of joys of life. Lawrenceville's fireworks, Sunday night, were no less exhilarating though delayed a week. They renewed the hopes and dreams of childhood.

xxx

Mattered not that the cost may have exceeded \$1 per spectator, except the location of the display was abominable. Next year the fireworks must come back to where they belong the old high school football field.

xxx

Hopefully by next year the city will have acquired title to the beautiful abandoned high school (and will be conducting serious negotiation for location of a call center in that historic building).

xxx

Most political party activists have grown weary contributing to the campaign fund of various begging candidates. Remember our dear late friend, Sherman Montgomery, confiding to us about Chuck Percy's campaign for Governor, Yes! "He's rich from Bell & Howell. We won't have to put the lug on our friends to finance his campaign."

xxx

Indeed, Percy's solvency was a source of interest to friend and foe during his first campaign. We remember a local voter who opposed him opining that "The Sheriff and State's Attorney have their basements filled with Bell and Howell's finest cameras."

xxx

Surprise, Nobody solicited more campaign contributions than Percy.

We were amazed by Donald J. Trump's boast that he had not been bought by Wall Street bankers and had financed his campaign alone.

xxx

We received our first solicitation for campaign donations from Donald J. Trump, "Make America Great Again," Monday.

Foregoing is no guarantee that we will not vote for Trump if he is the nominee. At this moment it appears that only lightning could prevent his receiving the Republican nomination.

xxx

We have no choice on the other side of the ballot. It is regrettable – continuation of policies that divided this nation and made us vulnerable to many.

xxx

Bernie Sanders was right, "It is time for a change." That he has become a Hillary is the more suspect in view of the faults that he found in her and the government policies which she pledges to continue.

xxx

Freedom of speech is a sacred right for Americans. The framers of our Constitution and all the public servants that have followed have recognized how essential the right to express one's self.

xxx

One cannot suggest government censorship of thought and it's expression without being regarded as alien. Notwithstanding, it would be well for the USA if the moguls of television and movies would voluntarily diminish their nonstop violence. We simply must find a gentler, kinder attitude toward one another for avoid more of such terrible tragedies as the murder of five Dallas policeman.

xxx

Ruth Bader Ginsberg should resign from the Supreme Court without delay. She has no right to

inject insulting remarks about Donald Trump while sheltered by the holier than politics facade which has been the traditional pose of the Court for 200 years.

xxx

We were flattered that that left wing jurist who would be an active political candidate if she had the nerve stole from the Press her idea of emigrating "down under" if Trump elected.

xxx

When one has tasted watermelon, he knows what the angels eat.

xxx

—Mark Twain

July 21, 2016

Midst a week filled with senseless murders, in the USA, France, Turkey and Pakistan, Judge Robert Hopkins was the only person who expressed to us the opinion we had reached: the world has gone mad.

xxx

During recent months this worldwide carnage has usually boiled down to militant Islam against the rest of world. When this occurs, remainder of mankind pronounces the aggressors pariah and isolates those unwilling to live and let live.

xxx

But what to do when the aggressor does not fit that mold? Some 29 year old misfit named "long" shot and killed three uniformed police officers at Baton Rouge, and injured several others. He fits none of the customary categories

xxx

Inexplicable that that such a menace to organized society would hope/expect to be captured alive. The evidence is that he was running away from the scene when the swat team arrived. Their accuracy is impressive. But why do we never learn what the autopsy of his brain revealed?

xxx

Scientists clever enough to bring us "smart phones" should turn their amazing skill on the human mind and determine who is a threat to his fellow men, and what can be done to prevent that threat becoming reality.

xxx

We think Recep Erdogan, prime minister of Turkey, is a militant Muslim, a threat to every American value, who has fooled our leaders to believe that he a

modern Kemal Ataturk. The military coup against Erdogan last week may have been a trap which he sprung to catch his enemies in the Turkish government.

xxx

Immediately after a couple of government offices were seized by a few soldiers, Erdogan calmly went to the Airport where loyal troops were in place, made a tub thumping speech and the cleanup against the opposition was underway.

xxx

He then issued an ultimatum that the USA must surrender for extradition a Turkish cleric who lives in Pennsylvania, and is the claimed mastermind of the insurrection.

It will be a sad day for America if our government yields to the Turkish demand.

xxx

Again we swear off predicting the future.

xxx

From the World Series, Kentucky Derby, and Republican nomination for Vice-President, our record is 100%. We missed them all.

xxx

We were impressed by Donald Trump's third wife's speech at the Republican National Convention, Monday evening. We thought back 40 years, Nelson Rockefeller, Governor of New York, could beat the peanut farmer from Georgia if the voters didn't remember that he was first married to a Brewd heiress from Philadelphia. "Happy" was gregarious, loved he campaign as distinguished from most candidates' wives, but would the voters accept her?

July 28, 2016

Vermont Senator Bernie Sanders laments non-stop how wide the gulf between the incomes/wealth of various groups of Americans. He would equalize such.

xxx

We believe the operational gulf between Americans who are computer literate, and the vast majority of our citizens, particularly those over 60 years of age, is even greater.

xxx

The shape of the future in the operation of computers is clear—ever expanding.

xxx

In every community starting with Lawrence County the educational emphasis to make every citizen computer literate to the limit of his ability should be top priority

xxx

We admired Senator Tim Kaine's demonstrated skill at haranguing the Miami rally in Spanish and English. We wonder if our national best interest is disserved by the deference presently given to Spanish speaking Americans at every government office, from driver's license to public aid.

xxx

We think it would be preferable to wed English teachers to every country on the globe who would accept and not mistreat these ambassadors of better understanding amongst all people.

xxx

Internet reported collapse of half of courtroom ceiling of Hamilton County Courthouse, McLeansboro. IL, Monday. Ironical that such a youthful, impressive building would have such serious problems while Lawrence Courthouse, though more than 50 years older, continues to serve government admirably.

xxx

The Hamilton County structure is the most impressive of the 12 counties in the Second Judicial District.

It is an obvious gift from John Stelle, Democratic Governor 1938-40. A bigger than life size politician can make a very positive contribution to his hometown.

xxx

In lieu of an "insider" to push the project, small communities must seize every opportunity to ingratiate themselves to public officials who make the decisions where improvements will be made. It is for this reality that the Press has pushed for 10 years to "fly the flags" on Jim Edgar's birthday. Fact that while Governor, Edgar gave location of Sumner Correctional Facility to our County is not a coincidence. He did more for County Lawrence than any other Governor.

xxx

Jim Edgar's dob is 7/22/46. A month ago the Press invited the mayor of each of the 5 communities within our County to join the Press in recited scheme that we might remind Governor Rauner that Lawrence County remembers every kindness. We followed the published suggestion with phone calls to most of the leaders, and learned that Rotarians might be available to deck the county seat as thoroughly as they do for other politicians who have contributed nothing to Lawrence's well being. But our pledged contribution of \$50 for wear & tear on their flags will need to be upped.

xxx

We thank Mayor Gary Hutchinson, Sumner, and his crew for flying the flags this June. Also, the Law Factory and 904 State, Lawrenceville. We must not waste a day in making an appeal to our leaders in behalf of the projects that can make our communities grow that our talented young will continue to live here rather than migrate to perceived opportunity elsewhere.

August 4, 2016

We may have each was minimal. We learned missed an historic event Monday morning about 9 a.m. Our viewing area should have been the first Route 50 over pass east of Lawrenceville. We would have seen half a dozen all solar "automobiles" charging toward us in an obvious race with each other.

xxx

The American Solar Challenge had 20 entries when the Race to celebrate the centennial of the National Park Service was organized. Starting in Brecksville, OH, the road was usually Route 50 to Hot Springs, S.D. This wasn't a spectator sport, it was more a mobile seminar on high tech in future automobiles. The morning starts were even. Your entry stopped at the fixed hour as far as his machine traveled. The National Park connection was entertainment for the college enthusiasts participating.

xxx

Backup crew for the teams was impressive, high tech garages. Read worthiness of each "vehicle" is checked constantly. Our tracker believed only seven originals yet in race when they reached George Rogers Clark Memorial, Vincennes, Sunday. We are told that several more were included in the next morning's start on the 180 mile leg to Grant's Farm, St. Louis.

xxx

Experts on site agreed that the University of Michigan entry was the fastest of the group. On level roadway it could run 40 mph for several miles University of Toronto and Appalachia University each had an entry that finished each lap near the front.

xxx

Advertising of this event was minimal. We learned of it a week ago. Our first reaction was that we should have moved heave and heck to have them race through Lawrenceville to get mileage on Four Lanes for Route 50. We agree with our promoters, 'twas impossible. But the significance of Route 50 is illustrated by its selection as site for this event. Hopefully that fact impressed the District Highway Engineer at Effingham, the IDOT Director at Springfield and Governor Rauner.

xxx

The most significant event this week for many was receipt of tax statement. Lawrence County Treasurer Barbie Henry and crew mailed 20,002 ! That office and County Clerk Will C. Gibson and crew (who make the computations), know they are Essential in the scheme of things when that pile of billdet does delivered to the Post Office. Should be noted that first installment is due, September 9; second, October 21.;

xxx

Regrettably, majority of the tax statements are higher than last year's. If any consolation, we read that Chicago home owners' tax statements more than doubled. We hasten to add that neither the Clerk, nor the Treasurer causes the increase in your tax. They are the messengers. . .

xxx

For lower tax statements in future years, persuade your elected servants to practice same thrift with your money as with his own. then attend every hearing on budgets (newspapers regularly publish time & Place). Object loud and clear to the budget without the economies you enumerate.

August 11, 2016

Thoughtful Americans should visit a page from Social Security under US-DebtClock.org in the magic box that contains mankind's past, present and future—the personal computer. If you haven't a pc, or fear that you cannot operate, though most are "user friendly", you must obtain, or be left hopelessly behind. Cost of the pc should be less than \$200.

xxx

As suggested, the reference is to a warehouse of figures that can be most frightening, and reassuring. A few may already know; all of us need to be reminded that the national debt is 19 1/2 trillion dollars!

The number is a painful reminder to the writer whose campaign literature to be a congressional nominee in 1978 included the observation that "national debt will reach one trillion dollars within eight years" unless deficit spending curbed. Voters yawned.

xxx

The national debt has more than doubled during President Obama's two terms. If the nation's total unfunded obligations were divided equally, each man woman & child would owe \$861,477.

xxx

As paper money becomes almost useless, price of goods, including necessities, always climbs faster.

xxx

One would think that the presidential nominees would have made some public statement as to how

he/she would handle the national debt. To date, we have heard nothing from either on this vital question.

xxx

God Bless Dr. Clair Cox, Memphis.? This retired head of Urology Department, University of Tennessee wrote that he enjoyed reading the Press, particularly the Journal.

xxx

We wondered why Chicago didn't argue strongly of "summer Olympics" during Rio's winter in its bad seven years ago to be chosen site for the 2016 summer games. Temperature in Rio reached 81 degrees first days. Winters in Rio are not as cold as in Chicago.

xxx

Mayo Daley & Co. deserved more national assistance than received in their effort to be the site. To have a billion visitors come to your country would help business mightily. Side effect that the games are a powerful effort for peace and brother/sisterly love worldwide is an added benefit for the Brazilians as they chuck all the way to the bank.

xxx

Notwithstanding, again there were street protests from those who believed the billions spent on infrastructure to be ready for the games should have been spent on social services. It was that type of thinking that Clint Eastwood found in the USA as he decried the generation obsessed with political correctness. We rejoice that Eastwood too great a legend to be vulnerable to the whiners.

August 18, 2016

Children should be taught from first grade that there is no truth in the popular slang expression, "I have more time than money." This admonition should continue throughout school years unto the grave.

xxx

In connection with above one should remember always that, " the price of anything is the amount of life that must be exchanged for it."

xxx

During the countdown to Queen Hillary's Coronation, 82 days until an election in which her principal opponent's campaign is in total disarray, public must not lose sight of the Guantanamo Detention Center. Built in 2002 on leased portion of Cuba, it once held almost 1,000 detainees from the Afghanistan and neighbors' involvement in the WtC bombing. From the mere allegation of water-boarding some of these murderers President Obama vowed to close Guantanamo. Population is now 61, including Sheikh Mohammad, self proclaimed "chief architect of 9/11".

xxx

The danger is that he will be released to Afghanistan who would promptly turn him loose. We think this will happen the moment President Obama concludes that Hillary is a cinch to be elected November 8. What an insult to the memory of 2400 Americans murdered at 9/11. Press has long urged public hanging of Mohammad on site, as warning to other Islamic terrorists.

xxx

As though Donald Trump's campaign did not have enough problems: the Ukrainians found a secret

ledger purporting to show that Vicktor Yannkovych, a Russian agent living in the Ukraine possessing close ties to Russian President Putin, paid 12.7 million dollars to Paul Manafort, Trump's campaign manager. Such impressive amount alleged to have been paid over 3 year period. Manafort denies receipt.

xxx

We will be interesting to see what spin the Trump people put on that story. They may conclude that Trump's implied friendship with Putin is an asset in keeping world peace.

xxx

As one grows older he often hears in voice filled with feigned surprise, "you will be 93 four weeks from today?" Quite often the inquiry could more accurately be stated, "Time's up; move on. Our turn in the spotlight." That's why oldsters with a game plan try desperately to be busy to physical limit at some recognizable public service.

xxx

That's why we publish the Sumner Press, at a deficit that is sometimes daunting.

xxx

It is human nature to think of a prison as bad for a community. Proof that people have not been taught to live together in harmony. We need for the message to reach Springfield that Lawrence Countians are smart enough to recognize that the prison is an organized society's most essential ally. We would welcome a doubling size of Sumner Correctional Facility.

xxx

August 25, 2016

Taxpayers have a right to expect their representatives at the various levels of government will spend the tax money as frugally as they, the representatives, do their own. Too often that doesn't happen. Taxpayers are not sufficiently organized to keep record , to reward the penny pinchers and to punish those swept away by group psychology.

xxx

In former years the argument for living in small communities was lower cost of living. For whatever reason that is rarely true today. Merchants with bargain prices for necessities of life congregate in larger communities, apparently for transportation of product and customers.

xxx

There are some components in the cost of living that can be better held to a minimum in small

communities (less than 10,000 population.) Personal safety leads that list. Happily the criminal element is attracted to the bright lights of larger towns. Police relation to the citizenry needs to reflect the friendliness of knowing each others' names. They must avoid the cynical, hard boiled posture of big city police departments

xxx

A large factor in persuading worthwhile new residents to move to our town is the tax rate. Progressive residents go to each group's budget discussion and offer informed suggestions as to economies that can be effected.

xxx

Another large factor in new resident appeal is core of utilities. Most are regulated at the state level. Not a great deal city can do to lower cost of gas and electricity. Garbage removal was a minor item a few years ago. No longer so. Local government could cure trash removal's insatiable appetite by suspending anti-burn ordinances for a week each month.

xxx

Minor repairs in the homes and other buildings in a small community would be less expensive if more skilled craftsmen were pursuing these necessary community activities. Lawrenceville High School is failing its responsibility to train part-time electricians, plumbers and carpenters. School should make these useful tools available for students thus inclined. Likewise the community colleges that

surround us.

xxx

The elegance of the closing ceremony in Rio de Janerio, Sunday evening, reflected the proud host's certainty that its efforts to host a memorable Olympics had not been in vain.

xxx

The Rio Olympics were a grand success by any yardstick. We doubt that history will strangle on the barring of 1/3rd of the Russian athletes for drug use, nor for failure of Ryan Lochte's parents to instill dedication to temperance in their talented swimmer son.

xxx

We were troubled by management's insistence on using Portuguese as the official language of this major event. The experts believe that Spanish will be the principal competitor to English throughout the foreseeable future. Our reps at the helm of International Olympics should have held out for English, as a compromise between the host's language and its second American competitors

xxx

In the national pride department, America easily led the world in every category. In other Olympials there has been a struggle with Russia for that distinction. We think the medal superiority would have remained USA even if Russia's full team had participated . The diversity of our athletes made them more formidable.

xxx

America's weakness may be the number of its citizens who are no longer God-fearing. In an odd twist the judiciary's probation system now undertakes to install a moral code in youthful offenders and others who show any hope of reform. Alas, 'tis too late and too little for the moral foundation of Sunday School, including the kindergarten.

xxx

If tought them, "Now I lie me down to sleep, I pray the Lord my soul to keep, If I should die ———" the lifetime fund toward good citizenship is priceless. Full Sunday School program should be a condition precedent to tax exemption for every church.

xxx

Our citizenry should be taught to fear violation of the moral code more than violation of the criminal code.

September 1, 2016

Labor Day is one of few we would keep if we had the power to eliminate time wasters.

Its survival would depend upon by-phenating the name to , "Labor-Management"

xxx

When Labor Day was made a Federal holiday, 1894, there were many abuses in the work place; child labor, too many hours, unsafe working conditions, arbitrary dismissal, too low wages. Government has addressed each of these abuses and maintains an army of inspectors to insure management's compliance.

xxx

Only possible present function of unions is to agitate for higher wages. In recent years, many communities have lost job producing businesses because management could not pay wages the employees' union demanded.

xxx

There must be a better way for people of goodwill to work together in harmony, retaining the union for purposes that are con-

structive, rather than destructive. Specifically, we think the union should have the right to place one of their own on the board of directors. That arrangement has been successfully tried in Germany. His/her function would include a brake on compensation for board members. Lack of a ceiling for compensation of officers and board members is intolerable.

xxx

It is just as wicked for a business to be strangled in the board room as on a picket line for wages it cannot pay.

xxx

Happy Labor Day !

xxx

Lawrence County is fortunate to have a major Toyota Factory in our midst. Not solely because it provides jobs but for the side effect. restoration of the work ethic of every citizen who works there.

Its management believes that hard work restores pride that sometimes slips in a culture that dreams of hitting the jackpot.

September 8, 2016

Public opinion polls suggest that many in each of the two major political parties disapprove of their party's nominee for president. We expect that soon in the 65 days until election that group will be bombarded with ads to vote for Libertarian Gary Johnson.

xxx

That fringe party runs candidates who make common sense — Present nominee is the beneficiary of voter goodwill earned by his predecessors. We note that a large newspaper has endorsed him.

xxx

Like every candidate who looks too good to be real Mr. Johnson has a fatal flaw: he would finance government with a national sales tax, estimated as high as 10% of adjusted gross. Simplicity of tax determination might seem irresistible. No more tax preparers.

xxx

Most economists believe that financing government totally by a sales tax would be a national disaster. They say a hair raising depression would be a certainty. The poor must continue to buy the necessities of life. Those for whom purchase is optional would forgo the purchase from universal ingrained opposition to tax in any form. Result would be that an unfair share of cost of government would be borne by the poor. Lack of sales to the optional purchasers would trigger a depression.

xxx

We believe that President Obama projects right image for the USA in the Oval Office. Rose Garden and on overseas trips such as present G 20 in Philippines. Perhaps he could have better handled problem with Philippine President Duterte. Latter said to better not lecture me on how we handle drug dealers." Police shoot them with

minimum of legal involvement.

xxx

When told of his counterpart's statement, President Obama cancelled scheduled meeting with Duterte. In a society in which the barnyard term for sexual intercourse between animals is heard, from individuals otherwise thought cultured, should have sufficed for the offended's honor to respond, "the better smile when he talks of me in that manner."

We were discouraged to read that only 62% of Americans own or are buying houses in which they live. Community well being would be improved if that figure were higher. Government could easily raise % of ownership—by rewarding banks which make questionable loans for home purchase. Beware of those starch-shirt bankers who proclaim, "never made a bad loan."

xxx

Life itself is a risk. There is no reason that those who deal in money should be immune to risk.

Their community will be enhanced to the extent the money lenders bet reasonably on the future.

xxx

We would never intentionally offend Rotarians, particularly the Lawrence County specie, but they need to re-examine the honorees for whom they fly the flag. Samuel Gompers did nothing for Lawrenceville, or any part thereof, yet the flag was flown in his honor, Monday. Former Governor Jim Edgar selected Lawrence County as site of area economic lifeline, the Sumner Correctional Facility, but the thought apparently never occurred that his birthday, 7/22/46, more deserving than Gompers'.

xxx

Let's all pull in the same direction.

September 15, 2016

If we were gamblers, we would bet the farm on Joe Biden to be the next elected President of the United States.

xxx

If Hillary should win a weight lifting contest before autumn arrives, we would hedge our bet; otherwise we think our risk minimal.

xxx

Strangely, 'tis Democrats who will force her to withdraw. Our guess is that Trump already in mounting. A campaign that had become a joke suddenly became a winner, only to be again fodder for night club jokes. How cruel is fate.

Beauty is that matter must be resolved by October, or ballots still already be printed where GOP has input. Safe to wager that the final result will please only a minority.

xxx

As one watches the young, ambitious Mexicans off to harvest the produce from Allison Prairie, one realizes how very dimly all

this talk about building a wall to keep willing workers out. Our guess is that said wall would be destroyed from the American side nightly and be abandoned as unrealistic after a token effort.

xxx

If ever an American election in which a Third Party might have chance to win, this is the year. Many have no enthusiasm for candidate of his party. Johnson's punishment was cruel and deserved. He had no right to be Vice President if he didn't know Aleppo is a city in Syria under siege by a government seeking to remain in power by starving children."

xxx

One certain side effect of the predicted substitution of Biden for Clinton in the starting gate is that more attention will be paid to substance. Intolerable. Present system permitted two lemons.

September 22, 2016

President Obama extolled Philadelphia Presidential Rally to elect Hillary President. "This one's on us." Apparently meaning that out come would represent voters' rating of the Obama Presidency. Had President Eisenhower endorsed VP Nixon comparably in the NYC Rally immediately prior to the '60 election, history would be changed grandly.

xxx

Our first reaction was that our President was reckless to leave his presidency to variables. His escape route is far larger. His report to candidate Clinton can appropriately be, "have urged my constituency in your behalf." If they heed his call, and organized labor remains in lockstep, he Former Mayor r election is guaranteed.

xxx

We are not yet willing to sacrifice the haystack as "unreliable" for predicting.

"Joe Biden" last week. We shall anxiously await the debate next Monday night. As decision draws nearer our enthusiasm for migrating to Australia, or New Zealand as the voters' shall choose, diminishes.

xxx

Former NYC Mayor Bloomberg, also a billionaire, was asked on TV about the two candidates for President. Obviously piqued because neither party sought to draft him, he instantly replied, "a scam". We are troubled by that reply. A "scam" often involves diversion of profits distributed to the investors who contribute to gain unrealistically large return on their money. The scam artist skims off a fraction of the "profits" as fast as new investors surface. System works well as long as new investors are attracted by the large profits which appear to be coming in.

xxx

For Bloomberg's "scam" to make sense (in theory humans who accumulate billions are wise, never talk foolishly) one could assume

that the two candidates are the scam artists, gross profits are the donations now being solicited mon stop. In one month each party received ninety million dollars.

xxx

Do Democrats believe that the candidates kept whatever fund left after payment of advertisement and drum beaters, and that whoever proclaimed winner of the presidential election was incidental to the grand scheme?

xxx

Press will publish any major figure Bloomberg wishes to make to the above.

xxx

Sharing the frustration of every Lawrence County voter that our population grow that we remain in this County after preparation made for their careers. Press Highway Engineer, District 4, Jeremy Smith, inquiring whether 15th Street Embarrass River Bridge might be moved upstream 3/8ths of a mile, where it would there carry west bound two lanes of Rte 50. Our point was that the Rte 1 15th Street bridge doesn't appear defective to our untrained eye, funds are in place, contract will let let this winter, construction commenced in the spring. Would be a wasted booster non parcel. Every taxpayer within the state would know that a symbol of hope had emerged. That Four Lanes for Route 50, first promised by Governor Ogilvie in 1970, will yet happen.

xxx

Engineer Smith ignored our suggestion that location for the new bridge be moved. He repeated IDOT's determination that existing 15th Bridge is unsafe and will be replaced as scheduled. He politely said, "no We believe existing 15th Street Bridge remains indestructible if farmers required to remove log debris buildup during periods of high water.

October 6, 2016

We have enjoyed being a political junkie of 21 Presidential elections. This one is the wildest ever. We doubt that history will be kind to the winner. Danger is that he/she will be tagged "lesser of two evils."

xxx

When the Greeks conceived democracy 3000 years ago, unreasonable to believe that an election of the most significant office in the entire world would earn such an unflattering description. Yet, when we inquire, " how is the election going?"

The above lesser line.

xxx

We suggest that such negative approach to life is not helpful to anyone and should be deleted from our lexicon.

Two of the candidates are determined, hard driving, resourceful, knowledgeable. Alas for the third party candidate Johnson he hasn't located a level.

xxx

Americans should rejoice together that regardless of the election outcome ours is the greatest nation on earth. Thanks to the life long effort of all of our ancestors. Next time you hear someone whining about U.S.A., ask what other country has put the footprints of its finest upon the moon.

xxx

We are troubled by the

size of the national debt. Perhaps the reader noticed certain reluctance of either candidate to tackle that problem. The so called economic reform being heard more in discussions is code for how can the government and the governed prune a debt ceiling without a disastrous depression.

xxx

We do not envy the members of the Federal Reserve Board. It is they who control the printing presses. Our hope is that the FDR's ERA (economic recovery act) though declared unconstitutional can help guide the adjustments required in the money supply.

xxx

We need to practice singing together, " Proud to be An American

xxx

Totally unrelated to the above flat on their back, finally persuaded Ameren to hook up the electric service for a dwelling that had no payment delinquency. After two hours haggle we finally got the electric turned on.

xxx

Many State jobs would operate more efficiently if the number allotted for were cut in half. We recognize that Ameren is publicly owned but the apparent amount of government regulation is out leaped reason.

October 13, 2016

Though he is the antithesis of almost every quality candidate a broadcaster could present, we hope to make money, we suspect that many admired the fortitude with which Donald Trump met his Waterloo Sunday evening. Denounced by every so-called "leader" of the Republican party. Donald marched forth to give battle as though he were leading an over whelming, united army. Either no one will respect many may candidate that he was what this nation needed to escape political correctness, less of the work ethic, and trembles when a tinhorn foreign dictator frowns.

xxx

We were impressed that one "unfit" politician could outdraw Sunday night football.

xxx

We are fortunate to live in this exciting segment of history. One change to come quickly will be constitutional amendment to define procedure for replacement of a party's nominee when latter does not agree that his time upon the stage has expired. Disposition of leftover cash begged from the candidate's supporters needs to

be fine honed. TV broadcaster's license should guarantee his neutrality in elections. It was disgraceful, unmanly that almost all who watched the spectacle openly turned on Trump when it was obvious that his mouth had torpedoed his campaign.

xxx

Curiously another big winner in this huge battle was Bernie Sanders. Next time our masters select a sparring partner for their candidate, they'll use more caution and avoid one who stung President Hillary Clinton with the label, "pawn of the billionaire bankers."

xxx

Yet another significant fee paid for the campaign is now present system can be morally defended in which the wealthy rely on depreciation/carried losses to reduce tax liability, essentially defeating the 17th Amendment? Rare was there a taxpayer who knew what Trump said all super wealthy used.

xxx

Next time you are in New York City, please go to Trump Tower, across 5th Avenue from St. Patrick's. The waterfall in the lobby is beautiful.

October 20, 2016

Three weeks from Tuesday USA will elect a new President. One candidate, a lady, promises to follow same game plan as the outgoing president. The other, a gentleman, promises sweeping changes in American leadership.

xxx

The gentleman for change is a rude, uncouth, ego-maniac, with an impressive record of making money and building beautiful buildings. He commands the respect of his associates. He has been tolerated by the public at the highest level for 70 years because of those characteristics.

xxx

The lady notes voters shy away from the gentleman in fear that he would detonate an atomic bomb before permitting Muslim World committed to our destruction to have such weapon. He is alarmed that N. Korea has

missiles that might reach our shores. International respect for America collapsed

xxx

One of the Iranian ayatollah's described Secretary of State Kerry's command about lifting the sanctions on Iran as "unacceptable." The male candidate for President of the U.S.A. would reinstate the sanctions as means to restrain Iran's stated goal to destroy USA

xxx

Change in direction of the U.S. Government is suggested by fact that national debt has more than doubled during last eight years, as have its billionaires

xxx

In the voting booth one should ask himself, " which candidate will best protect America in this hostile world?" We will vote for Trump

October 27, 2016

We went to church Sunday. We were appalled how few were there. Had anyone moved to question a quorum, the parliamentarian would have declared "meeting adjourned." Reflects religious role in the lives of too many Americans.

xxx

Sadly, churches have become irrelevant in the lives of too many. The need is to rally. Their product is the most desired above all others — life beyond the grave.

xxx

Tragedy of most churches is the permitting of the Sunday School Department to slowly slide away, leaving only a group of old folks to talk about the Bible and the applicable stories therein.

xxx

We think the emphasis in every church should be on the Sunday School Department to prevent their collapse.

xxx

We had expected some mention of the presidential election, from either the pulpit or the pew. None. The moral factor must not be forgotten in matters so vital. Nor should it become the controlling factor. The paramount question must remain, regardless of religious label, who will best defend America

xxx

We asked the man who built his monument in huge steel grain bins in Bridgeport , and travels the world to measure the way of life in other nations: "Do you encounter any nations whose people appear to be the intellectual equal, or superior, to Americans?" His reply was, " Japan and Israel ".

xxx

It is a delicate matter to mention, but if America is to maintain its rank as a world leader the science of eugenics must be brought into the process.

xxx

Reproduction of the unfit must be confronted.

xxx

Tragically, scientific progress in treatment of mental illness, and its cure upon each following generation appears stuck on zero.

xxx

Emphasis on reproduction should be restricted, and with expectation of improvement in each new generation.

xxx

Hooray for Donald Trump. He brought excitement to the lives of all, and successfully competed with Sunday night football for a TV audience.

xxx

How dull would life be were it not so competitive.

November 3, 2016

Hooray for global warming and/or Indian Summer! Life is easier when one need not worry about the furnace lasting until spring.

xxx

Heresy to admit, but one could admire Hillary for continuing to battle to become President. At 69, most women, and men, are more interested in expressing the hope that their grandchildren are precocious (and well justify the grandparent's existence), than in currying favor and vote of the unwashed.

xxx

Though the bookies still believe she'll win, we are getting our papers in order to migrate to Australia. Perhaps we will be in same area as that foolish Supreme Court Justice who made

similar vow, and will welsh.

xxx

Historians will debate forever why FBI Director Comey tightened the race by re-opening the criminal investigation of Hillary 18 days before the election. He is an appointee of President Obama. All believe him too moral to accept a bribe, but he certainly resurrected Trump's dead campaign.

xxx

Oscar Wilde said it best, "never a man, great or small, came to nought but by his own hand". Unthinkable that Hillary's closest adviser was the wife of a known sexual pervert.. She should apologize for not denouncing then Congressman Weiner when he was first revealed. Instead she joined the insane chorus,

"every sinner is entitled to second chance after reformation."

xxx

A dozen groups of children in Halloween costume came to 904 State Monday night. Their smiles were worth the hassles Central Cigar had furnished. Pagan though it be, Halloween is one of the few holidays we would keep if we were in charge.

xxx

Our thoughts went back 80 years to Halloween in Sumner. The proscribed exercise was turning over outdoor bath houses. In retrospect the property owners involved were tolerant. No one was imprisoned for life. Those who felt the sting of "Spit" Piper 's black snake were mindful that their conduct exceeded the bounds. Piper was the night Marshal. At Halloween time he carried the whip as a symbol of his authority. When he spoke, he was heard.

xxx

The state underwrites housing development west of the high school will have 30 more units in early spring. Press has appealed to the Board of Review to informally install an appraised tax ceiling in our county to inspire those with the resources to build fancy homes to lure others to

move to Lawrence County. We live in a world of fraud and front, government housing though needed, isn't the bait needed for esthetic balance.

November 10, 2016

As big an upset as Truman's victory over Dewey, 1948. Surely some newspaper published wrong winner, as did the Chicago Tribune that year

xxx

We wonder if the public opinion pollsters will fold their tents, as did the Literary Digest, 1936.

xxx

About our trip to Australia, it must await opinion of Drs. Burns & Bacidore as when my frame can withstand the shock.

xxx

We have no information when Supreme Court Justice Ginsberg will leave for New Zealand. Our guess is that President Trump will publicly suggest her retirement from the Court .

xxx

We doubt that N. Korea Dictator Il Jong sleeps as soundly as before the election. Same for the Ayatollahs of Iran.

xxx

It is irresponsible for anyone to suggest that President Trump might start an atomic war on a whim. At 70 he's as mortal as others and has never revealed suicidal thoughts.

xxx

We either believe in an Almighty, or we don't.

We doubt that there ever was a presidential election

in which public acknowledgment of faith was so rarely displayed.

XXX

Sumner Attendance Center students studies the issues and candidates and exercised the process of voting on Tuesday, as well. The results, out of 63 students in the fourth grade, 54 voted Trump, 9 Clinton. Third grade Social Studies classes voted in Trump with 43 and Clinton, 24.

XXX

For those still waiting to hit the jackpot, the Powerball jackpot was at \$236 million for the Wednesday night drawing. The Powerball jackpot has been rolling since Wednesday, Sept. 21st drawing.

XXX

To honor a local educator, Gregg Robbins, who passed away suddenly, students were allowed to participate in a PJ day if making a donation which would go towards Wreaths Across America, a fine tribute to the veteran.

XXX

Robbins' funeral will be held at Red Hill High School at 2 p.m., Thursday.

XXX

Veterans will be honored in the local schools with various programs on Thursday. There is no school Friday.

November 17, 2016

We have been involved in elections 80 years. Last week's presidential election was the most Godless one we ever encountered.

XXX

Until recent elections, it was unthinkable that a candidate for any important office could omit prominent mention of his religious affiliation on his campaign literature. Now, never. It remained for some lady belibler in South Carolina to pry from President-elect Trump where he went to church. Said, "I am a Christian". Once at a rally, Hillary confided that she was a Methodist.

xxx

We doubt that either of the named antagonists has attended Sunday morning worship at any church more than a dozen times in the last ten years. Nor that either made substantial contribution to the church within such period.

xxx

Noticeably missing from the conclusion of speeches by either, or by President Obama is the traditional , " God Bless America."!

xxx

Small town America would feel more comfortable with government if the leaders expressed some degree of dependence upon the Almighty.

xxx

Curiously we note that Trump and Clinton each has a money-making Jewish son-in-law, to whom they respectively listen. The talking heads on TV have already credited Jerry Kushner with the ouster of N.J. Governor Christie from the President's inner circle. The departed, as the assistant attorney general, successfully prosecuted

Kushner father of money fraud.

xxx

We are anxious to learn of Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu who will be an early visitor to Washington. We doubt that our government will respect that side there are 1+ Billion Muslims and less than 3 million Israelis.

xxx

We believe in secular government, and would never favor direct church management, but it should be remembered that this nation was built on Godfearing Christian principles.

xxx

We are told that President Trump is seriously considering not residing in the White House, perhaps in the fancy Trump Tower which he recently opened in D.C. Thought occurs that if that is his decision, White House could be rented to the Clintons, at rent commensurate with Hillary's reduced speaking fee. That move would bring happiness to both sides, and would contribute to needed national healing process.

xxx

President-elect Trump spoke often of his intent to build America's infrastructure. The Press has appealed to vice-President Pence that four lanes for Route 50, Lawrenceville to I-57 at Salem, should be high on the incoming administration's building program . Might be helpful if our County Board adopted a resolution to name this needed highway, "Pence's Path," since it leads to his native Indiana, and needs his palpable assist.

December 1, 2016

In April 2013, two radical Muslims, the Dzhokhar/Tsarnaev brothers planted a bomb in a crowd watching a Boston parade. One or two Americans were killed. A day later the younger brother ran over the older in a stolen car and killed him. Police captured the younger alive, slightly wounded, hiding in a parked boat. Jury convicted him of murder, June 2015. He was sentenced to be executed. Although verdict are inching their way through the court system. Likelihood that he will be executed is none.

xxx

A redneck white, Dylan Roof, entered a Charleston, South Carolina Church with a predominantly black congregation almost a year ago. For no known reason, Roof shot and killed nine human beings. He has pled 'not guilty' and demanded jury trial. Jurors are being selected this week. It is being tried as a Federal crime. "Hate crime" makes that jurisdiction optional Prosecutors have announced that the death penalty will be sought if jury convicts.

xxx

It is political eyewash to emphasize that death penalty will be sought. Americans seem to fear the moral certainty of another world that makes death penalty defensible, plus the considerable deterrent effect it has for other would be murderers. Family members of most of the deceased have forgiven Roof and pray that he not be executed; They should pray for the protection of other human beings from Roof's malignant heart. We doubt that Roof will be exe-

versary date of his murdering 3,000 Americans. Our guess is that he'll spend 25 more years in custody, unrepentant, at American taxpayer expense.

xxx

Comparison of fate of these three notorious murderers and the summary execution of Ali Arian by the Ohio State University policemen has convinced many Americans that the police are often better dispatchers of justice for murderers than is our antiquated Court system. Latter needs to take a new look at the prob-lem.

xxx

Perhaps those of us in the hinterland need to concern ourselves more with local problems than with world affairs. Elsewhere in this week's Press we have urged those with the nerve, and the ability, to seek leadership of a community that needs new faces. If you have those requisites you must file your nominating petitions with County Clerk Will C. Gibson not later than December 17.

xxx

Now is time to urge Governor Rauner, Senator Righter, Representatives Phillips & Reis, Congressman Shimkus, U.S. Senators Durbin and Duckworth to include four lanes for Route 50, Lawrenceville to Salem, in President-elect Trump's promised infrastructure road building program for next year. We will declare you eligible for the Press Xmas Party, December 17, American Legion, Lawrenceville, if you write to any five of these public servants. Please advise us at 943-7000 that you have done so, and will party with us on the 17th.

xxx

Hooray for Donald Trump. He brings excitement to life as he continues to battle the news media. Latter use such unkind descriptions of his comments as , "false". How fortunate dueling was outlawed long ago.

December 8, 2016

Better that we not invite to prospective new Lawrence County residents to inspect during the first 10 days of December. Almost without exception the sun is hidden in gloom during that period...

xxx

Fascinating that weather complained of to on the same days each year. It were as though the earth's navigator was using the same calendar as we.

xxx

Not to hurry life even faster, but we rejoice when the sun shines again, and 40 degrees looks like 80. Hope returns.

xxx

One must run for public office to fully appreciate the load lifting, carefree boost victory brings the winner. Described phenomenon was on President-elect Donald Trump's face last week as he made speeches in Indianapolis and Cincinnati.

xxx

He apparently resisted an objection to Saturday Night Live's producers to their unfair characterization of his cabinet appointments. Some lady not reconciled

to fact that Trump is in power for at least four years tweeted, "you are embarrassing yourself with these tweets." The reply thanked her for her opinion. During the campaign, his reply might have been, "Your opinion is as insignificant as a pimple on a beauty queen's bottom."

xxx

We had previously understood that the Obamas had chosen California for their post White House home. We now learn that they will remain in D.C., at least until their children's school year ends. They must be surprised by the news media's abandonment. Coverage of the President's farewell trip to Europe was less than he deserved. His year's in the office were not a national disaster. However we doubt that Obamacare will shed his face on Mt. Rushmore.

xxx

Our hope for Christmas is that President elect Donald Trump will continue to confound his many critics, including this former critic, by continuing to make decisions that enhance the U.S.A.

Transcriptions of the page-3 opinion column by Roscoe D. Cunningham, from the Sumner Press.

December 15, 2016

One in five of every person on earth is Muslim Most of the members of hat group believe that the Prophet Muhammad was born in 570 A.D., Mecca, and is buried in Medina, Saudi Arabia

xxx

Muslims celebrate their Prophet's birth by the feast of Eid-e-Milad, which is in the third month on the Islamic calendar. On our calendar the birth date varies; this year, it is believed to be December 12.

xxx

We scanned several newspapers and found only the slightest reference to December 12, in its meaning to Muslims. The thought occurs that in the certainty that the Egyptian Times prominently notes what December 25 means to every Christian might be worthwhile for our news media to similarly honor the Prophet's birthday anniversary. There is no easier pathway to camaraderie and goodwill between the two religions.

xxx

Someone needs go tell Whoopi Goldberg that the Presidential Election is over, that Donald Trump is the President for all Americans for the next four years, and that she should be grateful that the race card keeps her tired act on the entertainment world's pay-roll.

xxx

Remarkable how totally President-de facto Trump daily dominates the news even without being sworn into office.

xxx

The Syrian Government, massively aided by Russian planes apparently will crush Aleppo, and effectively end the five years of civil war in Syria before President Trump officially installed. American aid to the rebels has been too timid.

XXX

Difficult to know who to believe. President Saad is consistently painted in American news media as sadistic. But last month he was interviewed by NBC in Damascus and came across very reasonable. He likened his position on Syria's Civil War to Abraham Lincoln's firm resistance to the South leaving the Union.

XXX

In addition to Muhammad's birthday December 12 was memorable as the day the sun sets earliest in the entire year. One would have thought that December 20 (shortest day) would have that honor. The sun rises later each day until the daylight hours begin to lengthen. Hooray!

December 22, 2016

In the world of high finance and international monetary control is where the action is.. When one is reincarnated, should aim for that game. Except that it attracts unusual people.

XXX

Five years ago David Strauss Kahn, was President of the International Monetary Fund, with plush office in Washington, D.C. He was odds on favorite to be President of France until he mistook American morals code for France's; In the buff he chased a resisting chambermaid into the lobby of the fanciest hotel in NYC.

XXX

Kahn was replaced by Christine Lagarde as President of the IMF, and by Frederick Hollande as Labor's candidate for President of France. Hollande was elected to that position, and has performed well.

XXX

Mme. Lagarde has had her problems. She failed to appeal a \$250 million judgment given by a French agency to a French business. A French Court found her guilty of negligence, but waived any punishment because of the strain she was under in her high office.

XXX

American taxpayers are major contributors to the IMF. Recited is a textbook case of why it is not prudent for America to be too closely associated with world governments absent safeguards for integrity.

xxx

We hope that our fears about President Trump's nomination of David Friedman, NYC bankruptcy lawyer, to be American ambassador to Israel prove unfounded. Friedman is so close to Israel one would think that he had dual citizenship. He ridicules the suggestion that there be a separate Palestinian state. Latter has been the U.S. bipartisan position for many years, and is the only solution acceptable to the Muslim world

xxx

Further, Friedman will move the U.S. Embassy to Jerusalem, an unnecessary insult to Saudi and Muslims worldwide. Stupid to have a nuclear war over the location of an embassy. Perhaps the Press' solution, "move Israel lock, stock, and Wailing Wall to Southern Illinois" is not as bizarre as some thought?

xxx

American interests are not always in lockstep with Israel's. There must be no question where the Ambassador's loyalty lies.

xxx

Hooray, daylight hours have begun to length. Winter has arrived. It is the grandest season of the year.

December 29, 2016

National leaders rely on their own intelligence gathering network to plot their nation's course. That policy is what tarnished the Presidency of George W. Bush so indelibly. He relied on his CIA that Iraq had weapons of mass destruction, code for atomic.

xxx

U.S.Envoy to U.N. Colin Powell was impressive as he assured the United Nations that Saddam

Hussein had the bomb. Some historians claim Saddam was pleading that he had no bomb, would welcome international inspectors. Further, that he would abdicate and go with family to Madagascar to avoid an American led invasion of his country

xxx

Apologists for Bush say Saddam deserved to be hanged on account of his murder of shiites and gassing of Kurds. Probably so, but U.N. had no mandate to right those wrongs We bet that Bush friendly historians will fine comb a new book by Saddam's daughter, Ragdad.

xxx

According to her fascinating interview with CNN, the late Iraqi dictator's daughter was married to an army officer who headed the Iraqi atomic program until a couple of years before the UN invasion. That officer, Kermal, with Ragdad defected to Jordan, accompanied by Kermal's brother and his wife who was Ragdad's sister. After a few months, upon express promise of Saddam of no harm, all four returned to Bagdad. Saddam ordered his two daughters to divorce their husbands, and promptly thereafter ordered the execution of the ex-sons-in law.

xxx

Might it be that Kermal mislead Saddam to believe that Iraq had atomic weapons, as the late dictator repeatedly, publicly claimed? We doubt that President-elect Donald Trump's son-in-law Jed Kushner, stands in such peril. We read that Ivanka's husband has the President's total confidence.

xxx

All of the above lead us to suspect that alleged eviction of a Brooklyn lawyer named Bernstein, from a commercial flight, NYC to San Francisco for harassing Ivanka Trump, husband and three children was partially prearranged. Had the incident been as egregious as claimed, President Donald would have already ordered Bernstein's execution.

xxx

Motive for suspected set up, stimulate assailant's law business and/or publicize a book which the assailant's lawyer's spouse had written. Reviewers panned the book unmercifully.

xxx

We are grateful that the dreary darkness now comes a little later each day.

2017

45 COLUMNS

January 5, 2017

Strangling Hope

A month ago as we witnessed the daily diminishment of Lawrence County, business closings, population decline, no college students returning to their home county, The Press wrote a note to Secretary Randall Blankenhorn, IDOT, expressing our belief that immediate progress on Four lanes for 50, Lawrenceville to I-57 in Salem would trigger the county capital seat rebirth. We quote portions of the Secretary's gracious reply.

"Dear Sumner Press

Thank You for your recent letter regarding the expansion of US 50- to four lanes from Lawrenceville to Interstate 57 at Salem. At this time there is no funding planned for this project.

Unfortunately, our existing transportation needs far exceed the available resources for roadway and bridge projects. All state maintained roads have to be prioritized for resurfacing with the limited funding available. As a result our focus is on maintaining our existing roadways versus building expansion projects."

The Secretary's candor snuffs out hope unless those leading the battle take more effective steps for deserved state priority recognition. 90 years ago the IDOT planners insisted that Route 50 should be made a "hard road", where it now runs, thereby eliminating Sumner and Bridgeport. The leaders in those communities successfully organized a motorcade that besieged the officials in charge in Springfield. Route change was made, deletion of Bridgeport and Sumner was postponed 30 years. We gently suggest that its time for similar theatrics. If there is to be any realistic hope whatever for four lanes for 50 within the next 50 years.

A motorcade to the state capital should be organized not later than April 15. The agenda would be to harangue Governor Rauner, State Senator Righter, Representatives Phillips and Reis, and any other legislators within reach. The need is to persuade the target to pledge to do all within his/ her power for the restoration of our hope and the county's.

xxx

History buffs assure that one must go back to Andrew Jackson to find a President as ready & able to take on all comers. Trump's eviction Monday of a biographer from his N.J. Golf Course (for unfavorable comments written 24 years ago about Trump and family) seemed too sensitive to long endure in the Presidential arena. Will certainly make golfers wishing to play on world class courses more circumspect.

xxx

January 12, 2017

South Carolina jury sentenced Dylann Roof to death for admitted murder of 9 human beings at prayer, Charleston Church, June 2015. Sentence was deserved. Roof should already be gone

xxx

Alas, there is no chance Roof will be executed. Society has lost the nerve to rid itself of such scum. To even advocate such efficiency is to expose oneself to charge of being sadistic.

Sentences loudly proclaimed but not carried out are perceived as "make work" for lawyers, and have no deterrent effect.. Predictably, after millions of taxpayer dollars spent on appeal, "People vs Roof", will be decided by the U.S. Supreme Court in about five years.

xxx

We believe that Escobar Santiago would have paused before murdering five at the Ft. Lauderdale Airport had he seen, or heard of Roof being publicly hanged. Instead, he saw a nobody suddenly become a somebody. This cowardly pup laid upon the tarmac waiting the cops to carry him to the world stage.

xxx

One suspects that the swat team would have terminated this tragedy, in self defense, had there not been so many eyewitnesses at the Airport. Should have.

xxx

Santiago's case has a mental illness core that reduces all capital punishment. Society can't exterminate the mentally ill. There are too many. Drastic steps must be taken in future to prevent their reproduction. The irony of his case is apparent. He was "treated" for years in Alaska and turned loose on the Airport passengers.

xxx

Almost without exception mental health centers are "feel good" groups, without any scientific basis.

January 26, 2017

Criminal Justice in Lawrence County is sometimes less than a many splendored thing. Randy Reynolds, 51, high school education, partially disabled (epilepsy), farm handyman, widowed about five years ago after harmonious long term marriage.

xxx

Reynolds drifted, moved into the hotel with some bimbo. He did handy work on side, lived on disability pension, \$770/mo. At night he and the live in drank whiskey though each knew that the other couldn't handle booze. Predictably, such pastime got out of control. She called police, claimed domestic battery.

xxx

He denied guilt, languished in jail 60 days unable to post bail, pled guilty on advice of public defender, was sentenced to two years probation, fined \$1,000 and costs pursuant to recommendation of State's Attorney.

xxx

We think this is less than what society could and should do for this limited citizen who is living his life now just as are the courthouse personnel who arranged such disposition. Where do they think he can get \$1000 and court costs? Was not the 60 days in jail adequate punishment for drinking? Does it not make a mockery of the office of public defender if he merely negotiates with the prosecutor and judge for best terms available? Should reasonableness of bail for release pending trial consider earning capacity of the accused rather than salary of public officials involved which approaches \$200,000/year!

xxx

Is too much automation a danger to our way of life? Six months ago, Circuit Clerk sent a memo to all lawyers advising substantial increase in fees charged by her office for various categories. Explanation was that time table being imposed that numerous filings in her office must be "on line". This miracle costs large amounts to the technicians who make this information available through the computer..

xxx

In 10 years there will be no need for a courthouse in a majority of the counties of Illinois as the electronic filing described has been decreed by all who guide our government. What happens to those who work in the courthouses then rendered obsolete? How do they earn a living? Is there any alternative to the inexorable movement in direction suggested? Does it not also entail utter abandonment of cities of less than 10,000 population? Will Lawrence County and all others within comparable radius of Effingham succumb to its blessed status?

xxx

Our best defense would seem to come by adopting "Regional" as the legal named of Lawrence County Regional Courthouse.

xxx

No collection of people who are all waiting for the same thing are capable of holding a natural conversation. Even if the thing they are waiting for is only a taxi.

- Ben Elton

February 2, 2017

Entering his third week in office tomorrow, none can doubt President Trump's intent to fulfill campaign pledge to "change the way they do business in Washington." He has brought significant change through Executive Orders. The pipelines from Fargo to the Gulf is the largest symbol, and does not offend orthodox Republican thinking.

xxx

One wonders what role he will concede to Congress and the Supreme Court A,C,L,U has already signaled that it will bring suit to challenge constitutionality of "enhanced vetting" on theory that such would discriminate against Muslims seeking to immigrate to the U.S.A. .

xxx

While he continues to dominate government news as much as did FDR in 1933, he remains the target of many reporters and talking heads who can't accept his election. The public has no reservations that the right candidate won. If the elect were re-run, he would win even a majority

vote.

xxx

One attribute of our new President is instant reply. Told that Christina Manning had described President Obama as "ineffective", even though he had commuted his/her sentence for leaking government secrets" was one of his last acts in office, President Trump exclaimed, "that ungrateful traitor."

xxx

Manning was Army intelligence analyst sentenced to 35 years for leaking government secret papers--- 750,000 (correct) pages. Served seven years at Ft. Leavenworth, in the men's section. She is trans/sexual. Without President Obama's commutation she would have been required to serve six more years before applying for early release.

xxx

Her article was published in Britain's Guardian. Appears objective, nor derogatory of President Obama except observation that his changes in government are being reversed. She even opined that the country needed a President as "unpredictable" as Trump, which is also our opinion.

xxx

Technically she is a traitor. She should be apprehensive until released in May; President Trump might invent counter commutation executive orders. Seemed odd that a traitor would feel gratitude just like a normal person caught up in the scheme of things.

xxx

Make on difference whether the Pennsylvania ground hog saw his shadow this morning, spring is almost here. Of a Red Hills Groundhog, it is another Press project we never accomplished. Bill Inyart must share the failure.

xxx

February 9, 2017

Can a football game be so important to so many millions that it constitutes a national menace?
Has Super Bowl reached that status?

xxx

Numerical statistics on Sunday's extravaganza are staggering. Estimated viewers more than 200 million worldwide. One hundred thousand fans attended the game at Atlanta. Tickets for seat in the stadium as high as \$50,000; cost half million dollars to advertise your product half a minute on worldwide television

xxx

When this spectacle outdraws number worshiping their God on the day set aside for observance is it time to inquire whether Super Bowl is in violation of the Commandment, "Thou shall have no other God before Me."?

xxx

We doubt that our fearless President would advocate a reduction in the Super Bowl in national self interest. The Sumner Press believes that those who have stolen the Sabbath from the Lord should return it that our leaders might continue to beat their chests and proclaim, "we are a Christian nation under God."

xxx

Amusing are the games the U.S. Senators play. Republicans outnumber Democrats in the Senate, 52-48, President Trump's nominee for Secretary of Education Betsy DeVos offends teachers unions because of her many years advocacy of charter schools, and is a billionaire (Amway). Denial of Senate confirmation would have embarrassed the Republicans.

xxx

Two Republican senators, Snow, Maine, and Murkowski, Alaska, broadcast that they would vote against DeVos' confirmation. Hearing proceeded per schedule. Vote was 50-50; VP Mike Pence calmly broke the tie for confirmation. We believe that all of the players knew that the matter would be thus resolved days before it happened.

xxx

Happy St. Valentine to each.

February 16, 2017

The stock market collapse in October, 1929 triggered a worldwide depression that would not end until WWII commenced, September, 1939. A desperate people turned to an unorthodox, charismatic leader who promised action to right the ship of state. Franklin Delano Roosevelt was easily elected in 1932. His predecessor, Herbert Hoover, was viewed as well-intentioned, but inadequate.

xxx

After FDR's Inauguration, March 4, 1933; 100 days of furious "New Deal" legislation followed. The emphasis was on public works projects. Seemed to be working; improved parks, roads and outdoor facilities were everywhere. Then, the Supreme Court ruled Works Projects Administration unconstitutional. FDR was furious. His retaliation to the judiciary was more violent than President Trump's 82 years later. He launched a nationwide campaign to pack the Court by appointing six additional justices. Strangely, the moribund Republican Party came to life. They had a cornerstone of democracy to defend. So successful was their campaign to defend the Court a definitive vote was never taken in both houses (of Congress) to add justices.

xxx

The parallel between FDR's and President Trump's trouble with the Supreme Court is inescapable. We think that the present public protests will be forgotten in a month. After the shooting stopped in the European Theater of Operations, 5/8/45, American soldiers in the ETO were startled and cynical at number of French patriotic parades. Every little town appeared to parade non-stop. Lawrence County is almost as obsessed with holidays. What other explanation is there for closing the Courthouse because Lincoln's birthday fell on Sunday in 2017.

xxx

Our first reaction was to write harshly of the County Board for permitting such neglect of duty .

Inquiry revealed that the Courthouse in Salem was open for business. We thought to write that Fourth Circuit Judges and County Boards set a better example. On question we learned that the public officials and employees there negotiate among themselves which "paid holiday" will be

celebrated/when? Courthouse employees in Salem chose Christmas Eve. Lincoln's birthday was a mere starting point.

xxx

Henry Ford said it best. "No one would work if he didn't have to." While Henry probably intended his quote as a hyperbole, too many dream of holidays and retirement. Each thus infected has lost priceless opportunity to make a difference.

xxx

We hope that Lawrence County's old who fled to Florida to escape winter have noticed how grand is February . So many 60 degrees, and the daylight hours are beginning to lengthen! Life is good!

xxx

February 23, 2017

Press criticism of the French for a parade & holiday at least provocation accomplished nothing. Most of Lawrence County shut down for a four day holiday last weekend. We commend our illustrious competitor for not joining the a.w.o.l.s. When is enough, enough?

xxx

Our thought is that the Republicans should offer to return February 12 to the workforce , and to education, if Democrats made similar gesture with Martin Luther King's birthday.

xxx

It is wrong to conceal a softness in the work ethic behind the memory of some deceased prominent individual.

xxx

The Publisher had the pleasure of serving in the Illinois House of Representatives with now Secretary of State Jesse White. Mr. Secretary knows the relief we felt when then Secretary of State Michael J. Howlett injected in speech to the full House, "Representative Cunningham, be assured that one of the first Drivers' License Stations will be in Lawrenceville." (1975?) (?).

xxx

There is rumor on the street that further reduction of hours for your Lawrenceville Station is being considered. We pray that this does not happen. Lawrenceville has had some disappointing and undeserved setbacks, including oil refinery to Louisiana, medical marijuana sales to Effingham, Human Welfare Office to Richland , closure of last new car dealership, half of stores on Courthouse Square empty.. Please help Lawrence County.

xxx

Long live Secretary of State Jesse White.

March 2, 2017

How frightening, how omnipotent the smart phone.

Ask any citizen under 50 who carries a smart phone, and most do, he/she will reach for the smart phone

xxx

Twenty-five years ago the Press began demanding that cell phone numbers be published, "that mankind might enjoy the convenience of Alexander Bell." All carrying a smart phone looked amused at our display of time warped ignorance . Each checks his smart phone to determine whether number sought had ever called this phone.

xxx

We felt smug as our would be informer admitted elusive number was not found, "but we'll find it on face book.". Within 1 seconds he announced the correct number!

xxx

Phone numbers are but the tip of the iceberg within smart phone's wizardry. The carrier can ask his trusted alternate brain which battle in the Civil War had the most casualties, Within seconds, "Gettysburg" is flashed on the screen.

xxx

It must be unnerving to politicians speaking at group rally, hoping to gain votes, to notice some of the audience checking their smart phones as the speech waxes patriot. The speaker is facing as many "truth squads" as there are phones in operation..

xxx

Even doctors and lawyers are subject to the same relentless search for truth. After a devising client to be met with his/her counter "but wikipedia says the opposite", is unnerving. Doctor friends advise of similar incentives for accuracy.

March 9, 2017

Today (Thursday) President Donald Trump completes his seventh week at the helm of the ship of state; 201 more to go during his first term.

xxx

Inauguration one could get long odds that he would not go the distance. Those odds are shortening. Those of us who doubted that one could rule by twitter for weeks underestimated our President.

xxx

He appears to relish the friction with other branches of government his tweets cause.

xxx

It is difficult to remain a booster when he accused former President Obama of wire tapping Trump Tower before election, without any supporting evidence. Charge would have been more persuasive if accompanied by witness' name and cell phone number.

xxx

Why do we continue to believe that the electoral voters made the right decision for the USA last November? Stock market reflects investor confidence in the new world leader. Rogue regime in N. Korea has suspended saber rattling. President Trump continues to baffle the New York Times at every encounter. That unctuous pretender had proclaimed its perfection so often, it actually believed.

xxx

White House proclamations no longer need prior Times approval.

xxx

Our guess is that our President believes that another presidential profile should be chiseled at Mt. Rushmore and will strive mightily that it be his.

xxx

It is too easy to be complacent and do nothing to improve the Lawrence County economy. Every reader of this column should write at least three letters to public officials, business management urging that the addressee come and help build a bigger, better Lawrence County. The Press has suggested four Lanes for Route 50/Low Level Dam on the Wabash/an aeronautical for George Field/new car show room for Toyota whose largest Illinois factory is in Lawrence County.

xxx

Now is the time for Lawrence County Historical Society to create an annual re-enactment of the hanging of Mary Elizabeth Reed. Only in Lawrence County has a lady been hanged. It would lure visitors far.

xxx

Circa 4:15 Tuesday a bolt of lightening hit the County seat full blast. We looked to see if the Courthouse had been destroyed, it survived unperturbed. The experience made this citizen appreciate Ameren the more as his electricity continued to make a civilized society possible.

xxx

All will be well if we remember that the darkest hour is just before the dawn. Means things will be better.

Roscoe's Journal — Transcription Part 015

March 23, 2017

How and why we thrive whose 'hour upon the stage' is commencing now. Though the past 30 years have been the most productive since electricity was harnessed, 'tis reasonable to assume that the next 30 will be equally successful probing the unfathomable.

xxx

We have read that when the computer was first suggested, the CEO of IBM, Thomas Watson, dismissed it as an interesting toy, with very limited potential. It has grown into a dominant force in the lives of all mankind.

xxx

The repository of all human knowledge, it provides a quick second opinion for those who seek a doctor's advice, or that of a lawyer, engineer, and other opinion sellers/givers. Nothing is more disconcerting than for the client to say to his lawyer, "but on the internet Wikipedia says that parole contracts are enforceable if certain conditions met."

xxx

We believe the inner-net so effective a test of the expert's expertise continuing education courses for the many professions will be abandoned. If one can read and remember, self education is within his reach. How society educates its young will undergo great change

As a child I played checkers in the back room of Heineman's Grocery 'midst Herschel Heer's radio repair business. Customer brought in their products, expressing the opinion that one day there will be a machine to pick up and broadcast Sermon on the Mount and other Biblical events which are circling the earth waiting to be captured.

xxx

Seemed very unlikely to me then that such re-broadcast could occur. Perhaps during the next 30 years his opinion will be vindicated.

xxx

Not in machinery alone has the past brought tremendous improvement in the quality of life. The treatment of human ills has been pursued non-stop successfully. The overall cost of keeping

people alive may become so great society will ask, "for what purpose?"

xxx

Those blessed with added years should find ways to add the common good lest they be caught in future economy moves. One remembers the Eskimos who placed their elderly in a boat, with food for a while, warm seal skins and pushed the boat out into the ocean current.

xxx

Spring is here. Grandest season of the year.

March 30, 2017

Something is out of place when health insurance is a greater consideration than agreed compensation for employment. Yet that is the relative choice in a majority of small businesses, including employment in government agencies. There the compensation is usually higher than for comparable work in the private sector. First question in the job interview should not be, "what health insurance coverage is provided?"

xxx

The fear is that increased cost of compliance with the insurance requirements of Obamacare will crash too many small businesses. Biggest item causing increased premium demand is the requirement that insurer's accept policy applicants who have pre-existing health problems. One can see how that risk could become expensive. Question is whether that cost should be borne by all insured, or only that group whose risk is comparable.

xxx

Last week's head count on Congressional repeal of Obamacare became bogged down in personalities rather than how to fix acknowledged problems in health care insurance. One had the suspicion that even some Republican congressmen wished to prove that President Trump can not walk upon the water.

xxx

One would hope that the give and take of compromise would re-enter the legislative process. If legislation to fix the insurance coverage flaws and other complaints could emerge this debacle

would benefit the nation though the injury to Trump ego may last awhile.

xxx

Demonstrably most of the talking heads on television

savor every negative Trump morsel they uncover . He is the face of America worldwide, at least until 2020. It is vital to our national safety and well being that all Americans be perceived united in support of their leader. Loyalty to the nation should cause the news media to forego further effort to discredit President Trump.

xxx

Last week the news media discredited President Trump's public approval poll was well below 50%. Reminded us of President Truman's reply 66 years ago to a statement by the late Arkansas Senator William Fulbright. History honors Fulbright for the lustre of his scholarship program wherein bright Americans are sent to England for a year of college. Fulbright said that since the Democrats lost the House & Senate in the 1950 election and Truman's public approval rating was below 50% , we should follow the British's, treat the election & polls as a vote of "no-confidence." The President should resign for another election. Said Truman, "should have him Half-bright."

xxx

Americans think of themselves, some even unconsciously, as superior to any other people on earth. Certainly America has been the engine for the rest of the world for a century . Dominance of Japanese cars on our highways suggest that from the ashes of total destruction that nation has scaled the heights. Life is competitive; we need to examine their way of living and make such changes as needed if we are to retain our world leadership.

xxx

The Press plans a thank you celebration in the Impera ans

April 6, 2017

Are we alone in our outrage that L.A. Times ran a series last week, "Our Dishonest President?" Is the Constitutional right of free speech so sacred defamatory comment designed to divide a nation is protected?

xxx

Can the President's comments provoke such assault upon his veracity? Would not our nation be stronger if we were united in purpose?

xxx

Obviously President Trump was less offended by the L.A. Times series that we, or he would have tweeted inflammatory remarks to his critics. We hope that he has resolved to ignore his critics . He should strive mightily to lead all 300 million Americans in the pathways of peace, prosperity and security from attack from any source..

xxx

Last week John Croce was fired as basketball coach for the boys, University of Illinois, though his record in 5 years was 95-75. All agreed that Coach Croce is competent, and that his \$1.7 million salary comparable to other this month.

xxx

Many proud Illini believe that universities should be more than training camps for professional sports. The late Chancellor Hutchens, University of Chicago decreed 75 years ago that sports were over emphasized in the scheme of things. In most schools competitive sports standing has increased greatly since 1940 the academic standing of many sports leaders has slipped. The University of Chicago yet stands at the top of academic ladder.

xxx

The University of Illinois should reduce salaries of the coaches to the University average for academic courses. It is time to challenge the claim that quality sports guarantees excellence . If such economy were imposed, cost of a university education might be reduced sufficiently that graduates are not saddled with large loan repayment as they commence their life's work.

xxx

Big time coaches are not alone in professions in which salaries have run amock. Every CEO of a publicly traded company is paid twice what would be appropriate/needed to slow the upward

spiral. Great is what makes capitalism work. Will be interesting to see President Trump's tax program which will be submitted to the Congress this month.

xxx

Under present arrangement the rich get richer, the poor get poorer. The tax laws have become so convoluted, they are compelling unholy by government for full employment of accountants.

xxx

Whatever happened to those politicians who advocated a single tax. Would be far greatest boon to mankind since sliced bread.

April 13, 2017

The tragedy of so many Coptic Christian Egyptians murdered in their churches on Palm Sunday by despondent Islamists should persuade world leaders that 70 years of war is long enough. It is time to give peace a chance.

xxx

President Harry Truman led America to recognize the new state of Israel, May 1, 1947. The fight until death between Israel and the Islamic world has been continuous thereafter. The almost unanimous goal of the Islamic world has been to destroy Israel. With courage, determination, and great injury the Israelis have proven that will not happen, though the odds are five million vs. three hundred million.

xxx

The sporadic peace talks between Israel and moderate leaders of two million Palestinians driven from Israel began to show progress two years ago. The Palestinians were accepting Israel's right to exist; Israel was accepting an independent Palestinian state within its boundaries.

xxx

Then an Israeli politician, Benjamin Netanyahu rallied the Israeli voters for a slim victory and his return to power on pledge to continue the war with the Palestinians forever if needed. Netanyahu has addressed the U.S. Congress, slept in

the White House and dictates American foreign policy in the Mid-East . It is disgraceful that American congressmen fawn over that man-monger to curry favor with Jewish voters in the U.S.

xxx

Enough is enough. The U.S. has pledged to go to war to defend Israel, but inclusion of a tiny Palestinian state within its boundaries is no threat to its existence.

xxx

There is historical precedent for the leadership we recommend to President Trump. In 1598 French Catholics and Protestants killed each other at every opportunity. The wise King Henry IV brought their leaders together at Nantes and hammered out agreement which sections of France would be the territory of each. He commanded his subjects, "let there be peace and dignity." The Edict of Nantes yet shines brightly as the right path for civilized people to trod.

xxx

History and humanity will revere Donald Trump if he hears Henry IV rather than Benjamin Netanyahu. Even the American taxpayer would be benefitted. Estimated cost of present arrangement wherein we make substantial grants to Israel, Egypt, Jordan & Saudi is \$20 per taxpayer.

April 20, 2017

Trump's refusal to release his income tax report is contemptible. No one likes to be lied to.

xxx

During the campaign he promised repeatedly with a certainty that such returns would be made public when a routine IRS audit permitted. Latter has signaled it has no objection to their release.

xxx

He should release the returns immediately, or look down to see if his pants are on fire.

xxx

We try to avoid a total political fixation, but wondered if others shared our annoyance the Senator John McCain called a press conference and solemnly announced that China had the key to persuaded N. Korea to discontinue its effort to join the nuclear club.

xxx

McCain was guilty of "laboring the obvious, rather than elucidating the obscure". It would be helpful rating elected public servants if score cards kept and published as to such grand standing.

xxx

We were startled how quickly N. Korea manufactured long range missiles, and claimed progress in nuclear bomb construction. Are the scientists of a third rate nation more efficient than were ours?

Same question about ISIS fighters. If that war is between the sunnis and shiites, why don't we back off and become referees, or spectators". How can we win regardless of which sect wins?

xxx

Recruiters for returnees to Lawrence County need to emphasize the safety factor. These multi murder rampages will surely persuades many caged in the large cities that life would be better elsewhere. Lawrence County to be specific. Who have you invited to today to move home?

xxx

We need reader input on what kind of public protest is most promising to cause the many improvements Lawrence County needs: Four Lanes for Fifty, Trace Inn in operation with horseback rides, canoes and rustic motel in park; low level dam on the Wabash below St. Francisville, flight related activity at George Field.

xxx

Are we alone in our fear that Lawrence County is collapsing into nothingness? We must each develop the enthusiasm and determination of environmentalists.

April 27, 2017

The evidence intensified in the sexual harassment complaint against Bill O'Reilly was laughable. His accuser claimed he said, "hot Chocolate", to an attractive, youthful lady who worked in the

office. Our plebian society festibarbarilized the beautiful English language until otherwise acceptable groups use the barnyard term for sexual intercourse in casual conversation.

xxx

Would the offended have complained if O'Reilly said, "cool chocolate"? Or, if his remark had been accompanied by a box of chocolates?

xxx

Hopefully the courts will recognize that 99% of sexual harassment complaints are nonsense. Such silliness must not paralyze human interaction.

xxx

Those of us who live in poverty stricken Southern Illinois have difficulty comprehending a 25 million dollar golden parachute. If Fox News paid that amount, or any large part of it, it is guilty of price gauging. Society is entitled to closer regulation of such money printing operation.

xxx

Of money, we solemnly assured readers that write-in candidates were printed on official ballots, as we bemoaned the good old days with element of surprise. Editor Barbara Al-

lender discreetly corrected us to the extent of a \$5 bet. The name of the write in is not printed on ballot. That candidate must file a statement of candidacy with the County Clerk 60 days before the election. A voter can obtain from the election judges a list of write-in candidates. We will try more effectively to be correct in what we write.

xxx

Shrewd move by President Trump to invite entire Senate to White House for briefing on the N. Korea problem. We think minute desire for self preservation will persuade Kim Yang Un to open his weapons operation to UN inspection, in lieu of predictable bombardment.

xxx

We were encouraged by Michael Moore's prediction of when articles of impeachment would be

filed against President Trump, "middle of second term." Moore is notorious for his unmerciful criticism of Republicans. The nation will benefit by conceded period that Trump is at the controls.

xxx

What a remarkable last hurrah for Bernie Sanders. He was a routine senator until 75, lost the presidential nomination to Hillary Clinton and now leads the still disfranchised Democrat as though it were a four legged pet

May 4, 2017

We were encouraged by President Trump's stated willingness to meet anywhere with N. Korea's Kim Jong Un. That nation's insistence on developing its own nuclear defense is what has brought our two nations so perilously close to war.

xxx

President Trump had remarked that our Civil War might have been avoided if both sides had continued to talk about their differences. Regrettable that most recognized American historians who have commented disagree with our President. They believe war was inevitable because of the irreconcilable differences between the two sides

xxx

We believe with our President there should be no limit on time/patience in peaceful discussions rather than resort to the atomic bombs.

xxx

The news media has done nothing to inform their readers what the threat is that makes war seem inevitable. Sixty plus years ago those nations with atomic bomb making ability formed a club to prevent any other nation acquiring such awesome capacity. Other omitted nations, believed now to have such capacity are Israel and Pakistan. North Korea's dictatorial form of government challenges its exclusion. It is projected to have ability to hit Hawaii with A bomb within a year.

President Trump apparently believes that the force of his personality, plus an American grant of a billion dollars can persuade Kim Jong Un to accept status quo on atomic bomb making. Seems a long shot, but worth a try.

xxx

There can be no question of society's duty to care for the poorly stricken where such condition caused by physical or mental limitations, or by accident.

xxx

Too often in recent years poverty is a chosen way of life, benevolence is generously. Sixty-five years ago, as a member of the Lawrence County Shrine Club, the writer delivered oranges to poor families at Xmas time.

xxx

Will never forget one home in which man of the house was able bodied, shiftless, prideless. He continued watching television as he commanded, "put that bag over in the corner." We didn't have a television set in our home.

xxx

It is a delicate matter but some distinction needs be made for those being carried through life and and the lifters.

xxx

"Blackberry winter" this week formerly foretold good crop of that tasty wild fruit. Let's hope that the farmers haven't sprayed/ mowed them to memory.

May 11, 2017

At 39, Emanuel Macron is the youngest prime minister in French democracy. His landslide victory over far right Marine LePen in France election was expected. Their pronounced policy on significant matters, e.g. immigration was similar. Each advocates tightening the screws against illegal immigrants. Fact that former President Obama endorsed Macron, and Trump, LePen, had little effect on the voter decision. France's pro-American orientation remains unshakeable.

xxx

Interesting the role that big money continues to play in major elections. Macron was an investment banker. As was Donald Trump and Governor Bruce Rauner. Many believe there never

was an investment banker with a soul as large as an amoeba's. We believe that there are exceptions to such blanket condemnation. That old foghorn Bernie Sanders demonstrated the effectiveness of claiming that his campaign was financed by "by millions of small contributions."

xxx

On a personal note, Macron is distinguished from the normal experience by being 25 years younger than his wife. To spur academic interest, Press will give cash prize to first student who calls (936-2212) with name of present prime minister, from France, Eng-

land or U.S.A., excluding Andrew Jackson & Rachel, whose spouse was more than 10 years older. Winner must live in a home that subscribes to the Press. Please give name, address, phone number & address of Press subscriber when you call.

xxx

The 143rd running of the Kentucky Derby was different, and a numerical success. Record attendance 180,000. More money bet at the windows. Family outing was squeezed away by ticket price. One was required to buy tickets for races on other days. One got the feeling that this grand tradition had been programmed for television.

xxx

We were surprised by the scarcity of pre-race newspaper mention. Only article we saw was by our friend, Bill Richardson, in the Daily Record. In other years the coming of the Derby was big news for several weeks prior to first Saturday in May. Record attendance suggests that newspaper age not needed for such event. We doubt that it will ever recover in American tradition rating.

xxx

Another flood season has come and gone. Needless loss of life and treasure. Elsewhere in this week's Press we suggest what the worthless Corps of Army Engineers should do for the Wabash & Embarrass valleys.

May 18, 2017

We visited with a progressive farmer, John Cowling, at the Baptist Church Post Commencement Party for Grayville High School graduates, Friday night. He observed, "hopefully the rains have stopped; we need to get into the fields and see how much needs to be replanted."

xxx

We learned that many farmers in this area plant corn earlier than their fathers' did, though May-June rains more frequently flood some tracts necessitating a replanting of those fields thus impacted. The frequency of replanting, at least in part, is greater than we had thought.

xxx

We admired the equanimity with which Mr. Cowling accepted that perverse facet of nature. For most workers re-doing a portion at a whim beyond his control brings complaint, even resistance. We salute Mr. Cowling and other farmers similarly imposed upon for the good humor with which each accepts nature's perverse punishment .

xxx

When one analyzes the relative role farmers play in the scheme of things, compared to newspaper publishing, or gambling at the horse race track, one must conclude that each is as hazardous as the other. But for public utility, there is a greater need for farming than for almost any other occupation.

xxx

Though the Press has been adamant in conclusion that we have too many holidays in Illinois, we think a day should be set aside to honor farmers. Without them we do not eat.

xxx

Of graduation, to us it is always a solemn event. Thoughtful graduates take stock of where they have been, and where they are going. The equality of life is no more. All should be aware that competition has returned full strength, and will remain until old age.

xxx

We have long believed that it would be worthwhile, when the number of graduates does not exceed 20, to give each two minutes at the microphone to give his/her impression of education to date and what he plans in the future. Present system awards the valedictorian and salutatorian that honor. Life will reward high honor graduates without any bonuses from the system.

xxx

Press apologizes to Megan Cunningham. Last week we reported that she was the Salutatorian of the Class of 2017. Late examinations determined that she and Aaron Mattoon are co-Valedictorian.

xxx

We thought the program was remiss in failing to note that one of the graduates, Aaron Davis was struck by lightning while hunting with father and grandfather; his nickname is "Sparky."

June 1, 2017

[Roscoe's Journal does not appear in this edition. Page 3 (top-right) carries Courthouse News continuation, Marriage Licenses, Accidents, DUI's, and Dissolutions; the page-5 opinion slot is occupied by Levi Fox's "1 Imaginary Fox" column. No Roscoe's Journal found on pages 2, 3, 4, or 5.]

June 8, 2017

Many of us voted for Donald Trump for President as the lesser of two evils. At the 140th day of his term, we are surprised at how well he is leading this nation.

xxx

Though the news media yet appears determined to drive him from office, and some sick comedian pictured his severed head on a platter, the nation is not disintegrating. The stock market remains at record high levels. Like them, or hate them, these titans of industry obviously retain confidence in the non-conventional man at the helm.

xxx

Unfortunate that Congress, seeking the spotlight of public attention, is bogged down in "hearings" whose principal purpose is to furnish news for television schedules. Latter has combined with Facebook to turn America into a nation of gossipers. Who cares what the President said to FBI Director Comey before advising him that his hour upon the stage had ended?

xxx

Nor is our withdrawal from the Paris Carbon Emissions pact that catastrophe. The President kept his campaign promise. We're confident that he'll negotiate another agreement the major air polluter, China, less destructive to American industry. In meanwhile, the coal industry as a washing process which permits electricity

generation with greatly reduced carbon emission.

xxx

Nor were we offended when President Trump suggested that London's Mayor made no sense when he told his people not to be alarmed after two multi-fatality attacks by Islamic extremists within a couple of weeks. Civilized people must erase "jihad" from the Muslim mind if we are to live together in peace.

xxx

The London Mayor may be a Muslim of highest character, but he appeared to believe, "sorry about that" would cure the problem. It isn't sufficient that the police execute on site the nut cases who carry out these atrocities. There are traceable e-mails directing the London Bridge attack. If the London police fail to arrest all involved in this attack, and the British judiciary fails to order the execution of each, they will fail their duty to protect law abiding citizenry.

xxx

Our hope is that President trump will take the lead in negotiating a settlement between the displaced Palestinians and the Israelis. Public opinion polls show a majority of the Israelis are reconciled to a separate Palestinian state within Israel. Netanyehu is the principal block to that peaceful settlement too long delayed.

xxx

June 15, 2017

Is the Internet infested by crooks?

xxx

Among the more insidious variety are those who proclaim your machine has been attacked by a

virus. "Do not turn off. Use toll free number below. We can help." Signed by some well known company in the business, eg Microsoft

xxx

Our computer savvy children advise that a call the number will bring numerous reasonably sounding pleas to furnish credit card number, authorization to commence the caller's purification process, or in many instances a request to forward check or money order for the repair work which is always guaranteed to last forever.

xxx

How is one old enough to qualify for Social Security when personal computers first flooded the market 1980s, to know that such reasonable sounding pitch is a scam? The experts we listen to were alerted by the toll free number, insistent repetition of the warning of virus attack, request for credit card number early in the solicited response, prominence of the warning company, persistence of the warning, observation by others of similar virus attack on their machine.

xxx

In It was poetic justice, The scam artist who called today had a foreign accent. We assumed from India. Said daughter, "the FBI has been tracking you. We believe they are waiting outside your door. You should use the rear entrance, immediately." A video of this counter attack would be valuable. One could actually feel the concern experienced by the scoundrel calling.

xxx

Another popular pathway for internet fraud is a message that the targetted has won large sum of money to pay insurance on the winnings". In such moments of good fortune one must not lose sight of common sense. Oscar Wilde said it best, "Never a man, great or small, came to naught but by his own hand." That word of caution must be remembered by internet users.

xxx

Though it makes a convenient foil for those with a malignant mind, the computer is a marvelous machine that makes life easier, more productive, for warning, observation by others enjoy together.

xxx

June 22, 2017

Alas, commencing today daylight is reduced a fraction of a minute each day for the next six months. Matters not. We will live in anticipation of the next lengthening days.

xxx

We have never found a satisfactory explanation of why the daily extension, or contraction of daylight is not uniform. Our learned authority on astronomy, Allen Johnson, will be home to Lawrenceville, August 19. We seek his advice on that question. Allen will be en route to Carbondale for the solar eclipse projected to happen August 20, and be seconds longer at Carbondale than at any other location in the U.S.

xxx

Governor Bruce Rauner called the Illinois General Assembly into special session, commencing yesterday. It is hoped that he and the Assembly can reach a state budget agreement by July 1`. Otherwise, the bond rating companies have threatened to reduce Illinois' bonds to "junk" rating. Such would greatly increase interest Illinois would pay to attract bond purchasers.

xxx

The budget impasse has continued for almost two years. Basic points of disagreement is whether Illinois State Income Tax should be raised back to 7.5%. Illinoisans were taxed at that level the past five years, but such "emergency" increased rate rolled back last year (in accordance with the statute under which it was first raised to that level.) As a result of the roll back, Illinois revenue falls a billion dollars below expenditures. Actuaries claim Illinois has worst financial projection of any state.

xxx

Gov. Rauner has stated that he will never approve tax increase unless certain business encouragements are simultaneously adopted. They include reduction in workmen's compensation cost, term limits and property tax freeze. House Speaker Madigan refuses to agree to this quid pro quo. Next few days will be fascinating for students of government, and for all who wish Illinois to prosper.

xxx

The Press believes Gov. Rauner is right in his demands, but Illinois will become the laughing stock of the nation unless some agreement reached this year. Compromise is always the way such matters are resolved. Alternative is to await the 2018 general election. The voters had an opportunity in the 2016 general election to determine which philosophy of government they preferred, but they voted as in 2014: that the General Assembly remains Democrat controlled, and the Executive branch, Republican.

xxx

Our unsolicited advice to Governor Rauner: If must compromise, abandon term limits first. It is a noble idea, but almost every candidate elected ignores his solemn pledge to serve only four terms. Surprise voters do not punish these backsliders at the polls. Would require a constitutional amendment to create a defensible term limit. Why waste years on such? Would not a voter education push be more effective?

xxx

Though his violent, and unfair, news media critics pray for President Donald Trump's impeachment, there is no danger of that happening as the stock market hits new highs daily.

xxx

June 29, 2017

The game of "chicken" between Illinois Governor Rauner and the Democrat controlled General Assembly will come to a showdown tomorrow night. For almost two years our state has operated without a budget, in clear violation of the law. The new fiscal year commences July 1. Some of the bond rating organizations have announced that unless a budget is agreed upon by Saturday Illinois bond rating will be reduced to "junk". Such rating would greatly increase interest Illinois must pay on its bonds and bar a significant number of prospective bond purchasers from doing so.

xxx

A compromise settlement between the two sides would appear in the best interest of Illinois. We think that it will happen. Eighteen months thereafter Illinois voters will indicate which philosophy of government it prefers, It is unthinkable that present stalemate continue until the 2018 general

election.

xxx

We think proposed expenditure of \$200,000 polishing Lawrence Township Public Library is a criminal waste of taxpayer dollars. Emphasis in proposal is to change the windows and color of fixtures in the bathroom. We suggest there is nothing wrong with either which lessens number of users of that fine facility, their convenience and comfort. We doubt that when proposed changes have been made their will be one person in the entire United States attracted thereby, or persuaded to come to our city to inspect, or to live here. We intend no criticism of the Library Board. They are public servants who act from honest motive purely. Would it make more sense to spend the \$200,000 building a Japanese style home on the vacant corner lot across Dubois from Library? The highway signs at Lawrenceville's four entrances would read, "Come see Japanese style architecture/Library Annex."

xxx

We believe proposed change in Library expenditure would bring a multitude. A happy side effect would be a not very subtle "thank you" to Toyota for the industrial lifeline it has given our area. Might even cause Toyota to further expand. It is a win-win idea..

xxx

James Smith, 68, born and raised in Terre Haute, educated at Purdue, retired from telephone company, ,bachelor, resides in Minneapolis. His parents, Cooper & Marian Smith, are buried at Hopewell. Father was a university chemistry professor. Jim came by the office Monday, "to see if you are still alive." Would that the reader might have seen our effort to lure Mr. Smith to become a resident of Lawrenceville. Show[ed] him the penthouse in the hotel; offered him a job at the Press. He will probably choose Westminster, the fancy Terre Haute retirement complex. He is precisely the kind of citizen we must each persuade to move to Lawrence County if we are to escape present total collapse.

July 6, 2017

The Fourth of July has come and gone. Trace Inn remains closed. We promised some weeks back to commit hari-kari if we failed to cause re-opening of that Red Hill State Park jewel by the Fourth. We lack the guts.

xxx

We believe that Director of Natural Resources Wayne Rosenthal made an extra effort to find a capable operator for this community asset. He signaled reduced lease rental. We are critical of James Marshall, owner & operator of Hogg Heaven, Mt. Carmel. He expressed interest then commenced playing hard to get. Decided at 60 that he is "too old" to take on this project.

xxx

Primary blame for this sorry situation is the population of Lawrence County. Their work ethic has collapsed. Too bad the Japanese are not focused on restaurants as they are on manufacture of fine motor vehicles. They demonstrate the savoir faire to restore work ethic.

xxx

We will continue to search for a restaurateur with sufficient pride and energy. We urge our readers to do likewise. Application form for needed Springfield acceptance can be obtained from the Park Ranger.

xxx

Major news during past week has been ongoing battle of tweets, President Trump vs Joe Scarborough & Mika Brzezinski. It is guttersnipe politics at the highest level. Each has challenged the veracity, legitimacy, mental health & low I.Q. of other. Rather than being horrified by this display public seems amused that the President performs so effectively at this level.

xxx

Those who fear that foreigners will think Americans uncultured barbarians sniff that the President should remember the dignity of his office. In Trump's defense named television talk show hosts started the name calling. Had any big name, come to his defense and criticized unseemly behavior of Scarborough & Brzezinski, we believe the President would have suffered in silence. None did. He replied in kind, better.

xxx

Susan Petty, who is the best political gun for hire in the business, excoriates State Representatives Phillips, Reis & Cavaletto for voting for the Democrat increase of Illinois sales tax. They had no choice: without the increase universities throughout Illinois would close before the year ends.

That would have been the coup de grace for each. This way, after the Democrats give the taxpayers some token, like temporary freeze on property taxes, voters will forget and forgive.

xxx

If the sales tax increase passes the State Senate by veto proof margin, it will become the law, commencing July 3. Flushed with billions of added revenue, 'tis the right moment to get needed improvements in Lawrence County.

July 20, 2017

French President Emmanuel Macron and First Lady Brigitte awaited the Trumps at Orly Field, Paris. Honored guests had flown from America to celebrate Bastille Day with our oldest ally. The newly elected French President at 39 is the youngest since Napoleon. The charming Brigitte is 25 years older than her husband, and sensitive of the unusual age differential. She was Emanuel's drama teacher.

xxx

After a bear hug greeting of the French First Lady, our President remarked, "You are well preserved."

xxx

Apparently President Trump flunked Etiquette 101.

xxx

How foolish is an atheist. No prize even if he were proven correct.

xxx

Early in the 20th Century, Judge J. F. Rutherford said in a sermon "millions now living will never die."

xxx

The thought hit a responsive chord and spread widely about the nation. Writer remembers tent revivals in Sumner while an early teen in which the ministers stressed that the end of time was

near. One never hears such predictions now. It were as though time of the Second Coming was faith's Achilles heel.

xxx

During the last 50 years church attendance has shrunk regrettably. Church members and leaders should stress the superiority of its product and differentiate from the numerous feel good/community service competitors..

July 27, 2017

We recognize that not all Press readers share our fascination with politics and we strive to please, but President Donald Trump refuses to surrender the microphone of public attention. Within the past week he made a speech to the Boy Scouts and gave an interview to the New York Times. Combined with the flow of tweets serious problems of his mental health were suggested.

xxx

We hope that he was feigning senility. At 71, overweight, exhausting schedule, perhaps all he needed was more sleep. His performance in neither of these widely publicized events was reassuring for a nation in desperate need of inspiration.

xxx

Sensing a bull market in the T.V. talk shows on mental health, the American Psychiatric Society released its members from a gag rule instituted during Goldwater's race for president, 1964. We predict those fakers with a beard, pipe, couch & tweed coat will appear on T.V. talk shows with great frequency.

xxx

Trump's political opponents hope to generate sufficient public comment concerning his mental health to provoke a Congressional inquiry under the XXV Amendment. They may be shooting themselves in the foot as Pence would be harder to beat than Trump in the 2020 Presidential election. Those who love the USA should discourage all proceedings designed to remove Trump from the White House until his term is finished. We are not a banana republic, and as Trump reminds ad nauseam "business has improved during his term."

xxx

We paraphrase Stephen Decatur, "right or wrong, may he ever be right, but right or wrong, our President."

xxx

Of future presidential and gubernatorial elections, we hope that the voters will smarten up and quit voting for the candidate simply because he has the most money. None of these super wealthy politicians ever shared his ill gotten gain with the struggling taxpayers who were enamored by his wealth.

xxx

The Democrats had two millionaires anxious to be their nominee for governor of Illinois, Chris Kennedy, JFK's nephew, and John Pritzker. Kennedy thought he had a commitment from AFSCME, many of the state's most powerful union had assured Kennedy of their support. Then the boys in Chicago checked, determined that Pritzker is billionaire, several times. Switch to his banner was instantaneous, to the embarrassment of AFSCME

xxx

Should be the law of the land that any public official whose net worth exceeded one million dollars, serves for one dollar per year salary, and his income tax for three adjacent, consecutive years be public record not less than 60 days prior to election.

August 10, 2017

If Governor Rauner had succeeded in forcing pro-business reforms, Lawrence County would have a chance to land Toyota-Mazda's giant plant.

xxx

The time has come to abolish all unions, including medical and bar associations

xxx

During the late 19th and early 20th centuries unions served a noble purpose-protected the workers from cruel employers who exploited the workers. Government has taken over their protection. No one can honestly dispute the totality of the government's concern for the health,

safety and welfare of every worker in the USA without any union involvement.

xxx

Unions have been reduced to agitators for unrealistic compensation for its dues paying members. Unhappy result of this added burden on employers has been to make their product non-competitive in the market place. Should surprise no one that Toyota outsold Chevrolet last year. Without governmental relief, UAW will drive GM into bankruptcy again, soon, as in 2008.

xxx

The unions' aggressive B.A.s seek to rally their dues paying members by emphasizing need to "Unite". It follows as the night the day that if a group is united it must have another group against whom other group is the employer. When the employer is the public of which those same union members are a part, is not the union united against it self? Something is wrong.

xxx

Even radical pro-labor FDR opposed public employee unions, as did JFK. William Clinton opened the door for this group which seeks economic royalty for each of its dues paying members.

xxx

In his first 100 days in office President Donald Trump has proven to be as bad as his opponents claimed, and as good as his many supporters believe him to be. Never has a President kept the nation in turmoil so long. We rather admire his ability to challenge the entire news media, particularly the pretentious New York Times, and the pompous U.S. Senators.

xxx

Whether a 71 year overweight can continue that pace four years is doubtful. We believe that Senator Blumenthal, CN., will hold his tongue at next opportunity to mean mouth Trump on television. Perhaps Trump's unorthodox style is what this nation needed.

xxx

We keep thinking the question of the big black unfairly beaten by the L.A. Police, "Can't we all just get along?"

Transcribed from the Sumner Press, page 3 opinion column by Roscoe D. Cunningham.

August 17, 2017

Two of the most indestructible falsehoods we know are:

"All men are created equal." A. Lincoln

and

"Come live with me, best of life is yet to be, the last of life for which the first was made" --- Robert Browning

xxx

Too many of mankind believe they are here to eat, sleep and procreate. They make no effort to aid their fellow man, nor to do anything to justify their existence. Society's upward struggle is made possible by the effort of a dedicated few. It's huge leaps, (electricity), by a handful of gifted. Perhaps one day we will know why progress was thus delivered.

xxx

As one witnesses the never ending line of oldsters seeking cure for the weakness which age brings to the body of every human being and sometimes to the mind, one learns how cruel is Browning's promise.

xxx

The constant bashing of the President by the news media, led by the sanctimonious New York Times, is detrimental to America's future. Right or wrong, may he ever be right, but right or wrong, my President. Should be the motto of every citizen proud to be an American. We wrote the same conviction when Barrack Obama was President.

xxx

Freedom of Speech is so ingrained in the fiber of America, including the Constitution, one

becomes suspect when any question raised. Certainly the Civil War descendants who engaged in the tragedy at Charlottesville over the weekend had no right to insist that President Trump condemn one side and praise the opposition. He gave the proper response, condemned both. My grandfather was a Union soldier; it doesn't offend me that some Southerners yet revere Robert E. Lee, nor that they like to fly the Confederate flag on special occasions. All should tolerate that gesture with equanimity.

xxx

The techniques for influencing public opinion have expanded greatly since the Constitution was crafted. Some requirement is needed that publications and broadcasts be "responsible" This week ABC-TV starts a series of interviews of Scott Peterson, 15 years in prison in California for murder of his pregnant wife. Makes no claim of new evidence that jury erred. Yet will influence millions that Peterson is unjustly in prison. He should have been executed. Travesty on justice that viewer hungry TV director will create sufficient public doubt that that murderer will get out in a few years..

xxx

Freedom of speech shouldn't extend as far as above described. Impartial panel should review such controversial plot, especially where an adequate remedy is already in place to review any new evidence that jury decision in error..

xxx

We wish all Press readers a happy, educational solar eclipse celebration, Monday.

August 31, 2017

(Narrative column this week — no xxx separators in the original.)

Young (under 60) people often inquire, "How was life before television? How did groups entertain themselves?"

We will tell you about life in Sumner, Illinois, population 1,000. During the summer months, 1935-'40, within a radius of 20 miles, it was the undisputed leader each Saturday of public events. Reason for such popularity was the free movie.

By noon each week "Mikey" Martin, his two strong boys, Wayne and "Buck" and their team of

mules, we thought one of mules was named Buck also, began installing wood bench seating for 500, depending on beam width, on South Avenue, in front of the present location of City Hall.. By 5 p.m. a skilled local male, believe his name was "Shaeffer", and that he worked with Herschel Herr out of latter's parents' grocery store, called "Hyneman's," appeared and installed a reel type movie projector. It had a makeshift foundation and projected its beam about 25' onto a screen. The natives were beginning to assemble to anxiously watch this miracle unfold. All appeared grateful that the merchants had made this free show happen. The shows tended to be westerns; none were love stories. Nor was any a premiere. They had been often shown; tape breaks and repair were frequent. The trait that made each Saturday night free show in Sumner such a success was the size of the crowd it brought to Sumner. Some claimed 10,000 people; no show drew less than 5,000.

Often the show had two parts. Just as the hero was being swept from his horse to certain death by fall into a canyon, hangman's noose, or other peril, the screen flickered,

(continued to next week)

Entranced youthful viewers worried for a week the fate of the hero. Predictably, the next week's edition had a few photos previously omitted that showed how the hero was miraculously saved.

As suggested from above crowd numbers, seating for the show was at a premium. I was seated on the curb at the alley between Travis Grocery, now Totten's, and City H. In 1938, I was filled with expectation and hope that somehow last week's hero had survived. Suddenly three older ,bigger boys rudely evicted me from "their spot." I went to Murray Travis' garbage, selected the stalk of a banana, twirled such twice around my head and let fly. Could not have made a better hit had I practiced a week. Struck each of these rascals across back & neck. Had shamelessly hoped their necks broken. No such luck. Flight was obviously best strategy. Ran as fast as my short legs permitted. Haven sought was my father's feed store (now Sign of Kingdom). It was perhaps 150 yards from my seat. I dashed between the moving cars slowly cruising Christy Avenue in either direction. I could see my dad coming out of the store with a bag of feed. Would be assailants were gaining on me I could feel their hot, profane breath on my back.

(continued to next week)

September 7, 2017

(Essay column this week — no xxx separators in the original.)

****Armageddon Postponed****

Seventy plus years ago, biggest issue facing United States was whether to accept the Lilienthal Report and permit a selected group of responsible nations to have nuclear power suitable for military use, or attempt to maintain American monopoly of this awesome weapon. American scientific expertise, as reflected by Warren Acheson & David Lilienthal, urged sharing. That policy was adopted. England, France, Russia, China joined U.S. as nuclear armed nations.

Over the years, many other nations have sought membership. The Middle East nations claim Israel has secretly acquired that capacity. The U.S. fears that Pakistan has limited nuclear military capacity. None of the outsiders has been more insistent/persistent than North Korea.

Early in the nuclear age, the U.S. announced that it had developed the hydrogen nuclear bomb. It was said to be more powerful than the bombs that ended World War II. Some of our leaders believed we might preserve monopoly of this super weapon, but in 1949 Russia claimed it had developed a hydrogen bomb. That somber development may have influenced President Truman in December, 1950, not to give China an "or else" ultimatum after its army came across the Yalu River and drove American troops back to the 38th parallel in N. Korea. General McArthur urged that China be thus expelled. He persisted in such recommendation publicly and was dismissed from command in early April, 1951.

Some believe that President Truman "choked", that the showdown with N. Korea and China should have come then before N. Korea had made much progress in building a nuclear arsenal. Others suggest that Truman's opt for negotiations rather than nuclear showdown was due to the scientific community's conclusion that a nuclear World War III would wipe out civilization on earth for both the "victors" and the "vanished." The rationale is that the bombs would obliterate their targets; deadly clouds therefrom would drift to destroy life thousands of miles away.

Interesting that in present crisis with N. Korea, fire eating Russian President Putin is explaining this scenario to N. Korea's Kim Il Jung this week at a conference of world leaders in China. It would appear that Putin wishes to postpone eternity, and that Jung has suicidal impulses. Human nature is such that once the bombs start dropping there can be no halt. Perhaps the U.S. and the world are well served that in such dangerous moment the U.S. is headed by one whom many believe mentally unstable. If he scares his supporters, what must be the reaction of opponents whom he threatens with "fire and fury"?.

Our guess is that we'll agree that N. Korea may be nuclear armed provided Japan is accepted into the nuclear armed club. We should strengthen our alliance with the Japanese. They are smart, tenacious fighters.

When every two bit nation is armed with nuclear capacity, it is inevitable that one day some one will push the button. That could be a hundred years in the future.. Let us live life to the fullest in the interim, and rejoice that Armageddon has been postponed.

September 14, 2017

Told you so

U of I Rhet 1 cautioned against over usage of "told you so" or equivalent.

However, last week we were relieved to report that Armageddon had been postponed. Russian President Vladimir Putin met with China's President Li Jinping in Beijing. Message XI took to his protegee, N. Korean President Kim Il Jung, was the Churchillian "better to jaw, jaw, jaw, than to war, war, war"

xxx

We remain confident that within days it will be announced that USA & N. Korea and a few other area leaders will meet to "negotiate" N. Korea's nuclear missile posture. September 9, was 69th anniversary of N. Korea's Founders Day. It was believed that if N. Korea determined to remain on its reckless course it would fire a long range rocket on that date. No such celebration occurred.

xxx

We wonder why our government, and its predecessors, were so adamant against North & South Korea uniting as one nation? Now that the missile capacity has been resolved, union of the two Koreas is N. Korea's primary demand against rest of the world. We have the uncomfortable feeling that American policy is identical to North Viet Nam's demand 70 years ago that it unite with South Viet Nam. Bloody wars with France and then USA followed. Final result, from Paris negotiations, 1974 was that the two Viet Nams united. We get along fine with the new nation, and eat its fish by the ton.

xxx

We need to recognize that American style democracy is not suitable for every nation on earth, and that failure of another nation to copy our system is not a valid cause for war.

S. Korean out number North Koreans roughly 52 million to 24 million. We would hope that in any

fair election friends of the USA would win control of the united nation. Dictator Jung, members of his family, and generals who dream of world domination should be given pensions and settled in Florida, or other hurricane prone area that they might have the excitement they wish to bring to life. If they decline such blue print for world peace, they should be dealt with lethally. Their ambition must not bring the nuclear war which will terminate civilization.

xxx

Some sports have long been recognized as too rigorous for young minds and bodies. Driving a motor vehicle is an example of societal concern for the future

xxx

Another sport that is surely more dangerous that can be tolerated is football. To permit the young to engage in that often brutal contact while under 16 years of age is an invitation to a future unnecessarily filled with body pains.

xxx

A week or so back, a Flora child football player "sacked" the Mt. Carmel quarterback with such force that the latter may be handicapped for life. This is too high a price to pay for the amusement of the parents who urge their children to battle. Why wait for another child's future to be jeopardized for the amusement of the public and parents swept away by misguided family pride?

xxx

The reader will note that we can write an entire column without mentioning the name of the President of the U.S.A. That public official is performing better than the majority of Americans thought he would. As time goes by we believe many will join with pride and confidence in our President.

September 21, 2017

We. rely on our friends to keep us advised what has happened in the world beyond the reach of our oxygen hose. It is agreed and understood that when any friends from the larger world come to or near Lawrenceville, he, or she, will stop for a few minutes at the Law Factory to bring us up to speed. If any shall fail to thus assist, we are authorized to "turn their picture to the wall."

xxx

Allen Johnson, Dayton, OH, and Phil Gonet, Springfield, are two of our dearest friends. Press readers know how helpful Allen has been for more than 25 years in producing your newspaper. Phil was the brains for the Appropriations Committee 40 years ago, when Illinois had an annual budget as the law requires. As Chairman of the Committee we appreciated his skill. He is now President of Illinois Coal Producers .

xxx

Over the weekend we had a phone call from Allen and Phil. We were dismayed to learn that each had been in, or near, Lawrenceville, and failed to stop. Allen was attending LTHS Class of 1953 Reunion He drove a classmate to Chillicothe, had driven 18 hours out of 24, was sorry etc. Phil attended coal operators' meeting in Evansville, crossed the Wabash at Grayville, would have stopped if possible. He needed to persuade his employers that President Trump will stand firmly against the fossil fuel burning ban and that Gov. Rauner will continue to recognize how important coal mining in Illinois. Also, that he was sorry, he did not drive a few miles out of way for a meeting with us.

xxx

Reluctantly, we turned the pictures of Johnson and Gonet to the wall. But these friends are too cherished for such ignominy to continue. We have agreed with each that if he will come to the City of Champions on any day in October, our friendship will be restored, unimpaired. Further, that we will kill the fatted calf to celebrate together.

xxx

Miami is fortunate that the Federal Weather Bureau is located there; gives that charming City a monopoly on sympathy for American cities projected to be devastated by a faraway hurricane.

Almost without exception, the weather forecasters predict it will be the target , then at the last moment path changes and the hurricane strikes elsewhere.

All recall the tense moments before Erma struck land. We were assured that Miami would be mangled like Andrew 25 years ago. We were told that cautious property owners were putting storm shutters in place around the clock. How neglected in public notice and sympathy must Naples, Tampa & St. Petersburg feel:the damage all occurred in their cities while Miamians swept up the twigs

xxx

National Weather reports two new tornadoes now forming mid-Atlantic. Their names are Jose & Maria. At what American city are they pointed? Miami!

xxx

We are uncertain that the best psychology for our ebullient President is to tweet that N. Korea's insane leader, Kim Jong Un is "rocket boy." We should not taunt him to make a foolish launch.

xxx

When more Americans watch Sunday Professional Football Games than go to church, our nation will have become Godless. Have we reached that sad point?

September 28, 2017

When a majority of Americans stand before their Maker, naked and alone, and advise that they observed the Sabbath by watching a football game, rather than attend church, we wonder the reaction from the Almighty.

xxx

We agree with President Trump his much criticized comments about national football league. Frightening that such a brutal exercise could become a nation's reason for being.

October 5, 2017

I am ashamed to admit that the moment I learned of the Las Vegas mass murders, I assumed some Muslim had brought such sorrow to so many. Vegas Police believe that Stephen Paddock, 64, acted alone when he murdered at least 59 human beings and injured more than 500, many critically.

xxx

LVPD believes Paddock, who had no criminal record, no known political, religious, racial prejudices, checked into the Mandalay Bay Resort, 32nd floor, Thursday night with 17 automatic guns and large supply of ammunition, hidden from hotel personnel. Country music concert in

outdoor area across street was packed with 20,000 spectators Sunday night. Suspect broke the glass between his room and clear view of the crowd. He fired hundreds of shots down on the terrified audience, non stop, and then killed himself

xxx

We do not think it possible that Paddock told no one of his monstrous plan. Some wise man has written, "never a joy but was doubled, nor a sorrow that was not halved by telling." The Criminal Code is somewhat murky on one's legal duty to report a confidante's suspected plan for criminal behavior. The moral code clearly places that burden on each.

xxx

There are common sense steps that should be taken if American society is to avoid future violent episodes as Vegas, Florida night club and Charleston, prayer murders. All public officials should be role models. Films, television and radio should eschew violence. Churches need to be more aggressive in the scheme of things.

October 12, 2017

NBC-TV 5:30 pm news suffered substantial loss of credibility in October 4 broadcast.

xxx

Lead story in identified broadcast reported that Secretary of State Rex Tillerson was enraged by President Trump's discounting secretary's continuing effort for dialogue with N. Koreans. Further that Tillerson threatened to resign. Yahoo News had reported at 4 p.m. that Secretary Tillerson had called a press conference and advised all reporters present that he had never considered resigning and had made no threats to do so.

xxx

Under above contradiction it was irresponsible for NBC-TV to broadcast a story that had been so emphatically denied. This is the "fake news" to which President Trump makes reference. We think that the President renders a needed public service by warning all of policy of some of the news media to mislead. None has a right to sow national discord without consequences.

xxx

If the FCC fails to discipline NBC-TV for breach of public trust it fails its responsibility to protect the integrity of the news.

xxx

Stephen Paddock may be the strangest mass murderer in history. Our government has worked non-stop since the October 1 slaughter of 58 human beings at the country music festival in Las Vegas, and has no explanation of what caused this tragedy. Paddock was a skilled professional gambler. Made \$5 million last year, told no one of his plan, had never exhibited anti-social behavior of any type, except ownership of many guns, was expert at gun modification. Most frustrating was the statement of a credible lady who had been his employee that "his concern was to make people happy."

xxx

We searched for, but did not find that his brain had been microscopically examined in the post mortem.

xxx

If study of the mind had made progress comparable to that of electronic communication during past 50 years, more plausible explanation of Paddock's wicked behavior would be available.

xxx

When one runs out of things to do, the mind is asleep.

xxx

October 19, 2017

The evidence is persuasive that Harvey Weinstein, Oscar winning Hollywood movie mogul, is a moral leper. Unfortunately, his accusers appear more in search of notoriety than to lead a moral revolution. Some had already received financial pay off from the embattled Weinstein.

xxx

The battle for an acceptable standard of human behavior was lost years ago with the collapse of the Catholic Church's Legend of Decency. Freedom of speech, as provided in the Constitution, was

interpreted to include pornography. Always suspect to suggest restriction sometimes permissible. We believe a higher moral tone would benefit the nation.

xxx

Of Weinstein, fact that he may not go to jail should trouble none. His punishment is already total-the loss of facade of respectability.

xxx

When one of these public idols is revealed to have feet of clay, it is surprising how instantly he/she becomes a nobody, e.g. Bill O'Reilly.

xxx

We are impressed how well President Donald J. Trump keeps the spotlight of public interest focused on his every move. Given that he is uncouth, rude, unpredictable, shameless braggart and an inaccurate historian, the public has not lost interest in him. Next year's election will be the acid test whether he can survive an impeachment attack threatened by so many. We think that he will. We strive mightily to stay alive to watch this historic drama unfold.

xxx

It is the duty of every loyal American to support the President as he strives mightily to keep us each secure and our nation's world leadership intact.. Elections are when we each grades our leaders It is a perversion of democracy for anyone to undermine the nation's leaders because they were not his choice on election day.

xxx

God Bless the U.S.A.!

October 26, 2017

When I was a delinquent child in Sumner long ago, Halloween was observed throughout October. Observance was not the healthy, wholesome variety, it was by mean tricks against tolerant neighbors. Bands of miscreants, soaped windows, overturned porch furniture, pulled the outdoor switch to turn off the electricity to the home, and even pushed over the outdoor bathrooms prevalent there until 1940. We remember the indignation we felt as we read that the city council

forbade any observance of Halloween until the one night, and that same should be non destructive of the peoples' property.

xxx

Then the jack booted town marshal strode upon the landscape. M.X. "Spit" Piper wore a leather hat, carried a black rattlesnake whip, spoke with authority. Other young hoodlums and the writer had pulled wooden benches from in front of Travis Grocery to block vehicular traffic on Christy Avenue. We were within 15 feet of our barricade when the Marshal's voice boomed, "Who put these benches in the street?" Our response, "what benches?"

xxx

The Marshal's whip stung the other boy with a sharpness felt just by seeing. We restored all benches to their proper location very quickly. It was summary justice, expertly applied, educational to the recipients. If the incident were repeated today, suit for police brutality would be filed.

xxx

When I recall these acts of vandalism, I am ashamed. I would make restitution to any property owner who suffered loss if this were possible. In part such behavior was caused by the scarcity of entertainment in these small communities during the warm evenings of autumn. Ultimate responsibility for such behavior is lack of personal discipline in the participant. I would quickly add in my case it was not for lack of parental supervision, or tacit approval of such conduct.

xxx

Halloween must never again be mistaken as a license to commit vandalism.

xxx

For several years the Press sponsored a contest to guess date of first killing frost. The judge for such event was Dr. Van Winkle. The good doctor was firm as to what qualified a "killing frost." He insisted on tinges of ice on a horse trough. Result was that invariably winner was from first or second week in November. The public always sees frost earlier. We believe many will claim that arrived Tuesday night.

xxx

Whether you required ice or some milder display 'tis a sad occasion for most of us. Really we have no complaint; has been a beautiful fall and more to come.

In that vein, would report that we had a letter from Allen Johnson yesterday. That 80 year old remarkable specimen rejoiced that cold weather had come to Dayton that he might cross country ski shortly!

xxx

Allen was a little annoyed with his doctor for urging that he fore go climbing ladder to clear gutters of his two story home! He is our friend and an inspiration to all who know him!

xxx

We were appalled how casually an ordinary citizen on the street of Pyong Yang talked in interview of nuclear war; in interview with some Limey as broadcast by NBC, Monday. One would have thought they were discussing the weather rather than the end of civilization. We fear brain washing in North Korea has extended beyond Kim Jung Yung. Maybe person interviewed was planted? In any event, it behooves American Leadership to avoid reference to nuclear possibility if such will diminish the tension. Apparently the economic sanctions being applied against North Korea are more painful than the U.S. and the U.N. realize. We must not goad them into nuclear attack. Again, we agree with former President Carter: President Trump should tell the truth and keep the peace.

Happy Halloween!

November 2, 2017

On the first anniversary of President Donald Trump's surprise election national affairs in the USA are in total disarray.

xxx

Criminal indictments against Paul Manafort and Guy Gates are ominous evidence of a nation seeking to self destruct. In the most regulated society in recorded time, 'twas small hurdle for otherwise unemployed lawyers to find evidence of some technical violation of some regulations against these two sacrificial lambs.

XXX

Most serious charge against the defendants, each of whom served in Trump's election campaign, is that they colluded with the Russians to win the election for Trump. We can't imagine anything the Russians could have done that would have changed a dozen votes in the entire USA.

XXX

Irony is, that had Hillary Clinton been elected, there would be a ferocious Republican effort to try her and anyone connected with her committee. On the same charges, collusion with the Russians. Duplicity appears to be the Russian foreign policy.

XXX

The experts predict that President Trump will pardon either Manafort and or Gates if he is convicted and may dismiss Mueller before trial. Either act would trigger an impeachment proceeding against Trump. And leave this country self paralyzed as it confronts the peril of nuclear missiles that can reach Chicago.

XXX

In a world that teeters on total destruction through an all out nuclear war, one would hope sufficient Americans would see the desperate need to stand together. We recognize that President Trump has made no conciliatory move toward his enemies, but that mistake doesn't excuse our duty to stand united in behalf of the USA.

XXX

All but the brain dead in this nation must see the peril: our Secretary of State Rex Tillerson has reaffirmed that we will never accept N. Korea as a nuclear power. The North Koreans repeat that the sanctions are intolerable. Something must give, or war is coming.

XXX

God Bless the U.S.A.

November 9, 2017

It was late August, 1945. In carefree mood we had flown from Arles Staging Area, France, to Rome. Japan had given up, after Nagasaki. No longer would we dread the boat which was scheduled to take our division to Bombay, and the battle for the Japanese homeland. We met this lovely young Roman, Paula She was an older girl, maybe 26. Worked at the U.S. Embassy; spoke flawless English. She would be delighted to join us for dinner at Hotel Excelsior (where Goering had stayed when he was in Rome). Before dinner we were sitting together on park bench within 200' of the hotel front door. Her favorite sport was skiing. She had won a regional prize a few months earlier in competition up north. We inquired of the Mayor presented her trophy. Her eyes glistened with pride as she said it was number 1, meaning Mussolini. (El Duce was more popular with the Italians than most Americans were willing to concede.)

Suddenly we were aware that we were surrounded by perhaps as many as six burly Italian youths. Would guess their average age at 20. One firmly held my right arm; another the left. Paula had been moved away maybe six feet. One of captors said, "make no noise, won't be hurt." I sat very still. Happily Paula's answers to their questions were acceptable. They were gone. In less than five minutes. She was calm, unruffled and unhurt. She explained that they were sought to discourage Italian girls from fraternizing with American soldiers. "I persuaded them that I am British."

I apologized to the maiden for not waging an impossible fight with these self appointed nationality police. She forgave smiled and said, "I knew that you would have confidence in my ability to outwit those thugs."

Happy Veterans Day. See you at the observance 11 a.m. Saturday Courthouse lawn.

November 16, 2017

We were impressed by this 31 year old citizen of the world. His name is Justin, lives in Jersey Shores, has lived in Israel for months at a time. That he Orthodox would be sensed even without the skullcap.

xxx

One's first impression is that Justin is an athlete. When he speaks, one knows that he is an academic. His job is to coach government regulated businesses for compliance with the government's endless string of regulations. Unfortunately, most businesses need his services. We thought of the Jeffersonian line, "that government is best which governs least".

xxx

We were surprised that he did not appear enamored by Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu especially because the P.M. has such a close relation to President Trump. We asked why he was less than an enthusiastic supporter of Netanyahu. His reply, "power corrupts." Obviously he had read Lord Acton "power corrupts; absolute power corrupts absolutely."

xxx

He admired the tranquility, even happiness, of the ordinary citizens of Israel though lacking of most of the material things.

Americans think necessary for life to exist rarely does an Israeli have an automobile.

xxx

Our conclusion is that his world is twice as large as ours.

xxx

We have invited Justin to be a Publisher's Guest.

xxx

The Press has created the "Order of Kim Il Jung" It is a periodic recognition of those individuals who have boosted N. Korea at the expense of the U.S.A. We nominate Robert Mueller, and the daily program director of each of the television networks as first recipients.

xxx

November 23, 2017

The English language may be mankind's greatest achievement. It is a thing of beauty and has world wide importance.

xxx

English is the language of International Trade and Commerce. Without it worldwide air flights would be impossible. Each generation is the guardian of this jewel for humanity's well being.

XXX

From time to time there are assaults on English. We remember more than 50 years ago when Pidgin English was the fad. It was widely used; but apparent that the users were uneducated and used this attack upon the language in an attempt to conceal their lack of education. Pidgin English soon collapsed. It was heard no more.

XXX

There is presently another assault upon the King's English--vulgarity. Every late night talk show on television uses every foul mouth word imaginable.

XXX

We assume that this attack would collapse when the cultivated/educated citizenry noted that vulgarity was the crutch of citizens of limited vocabulary.

XXX

We were startled when Secretary of State Rex Tillerson did not deny using the barnyard term for sexual intercourse in connection with President's Trump IQ.

XXX

When the diseased has reached a highest level of government, a counter attack needs to be launched to preserve the heritage. We should each promise himself not to use any of this potty mouth expressions for any reason. And shun others who do.

XXX

Let us preserve the English language in the same magnificent form we found it.

XXX

Autumn is almost gone. There appears no tangible progress in the reopening of Trace Inn. The citizenry of Lawrence County deserves better from their government, and from themselves.

xxx

Surely to God, there is a competent restaurateur who would reopen that beautiful community gathering point if the state would sweeten the pot -- picked up the electricity, water and gas bill. Such jump start would not be permanent. It simply is needed in this instance. Where a community will to work appears to have collapsed.

xxx

We note the pride of every Toyota employee when we inquire as to the place of their employment. The Japanese have restored the work ethic to thousands of Americans.

xxx

We hope Toyota will summon it's restaurant operating counterpart to come to this land of opportunity, and reopen The Trace Inn at Red Hill State Park.

Roscoe's Journal — Sumner Press — Part 018

Source: page-3 opinion column "Roscoe's Journal" by Roscoe D. Cunningham.
Roscoe died Nov 28 2020; any post-date appearance would be a memorial reprint.
All editions in this part (Jan–Mar 2018) are LIVE columns.

December 7, 2017

Pinching a lady on the bottom against her wish was always considered crude/low class. However, in the recent past it was not considered a major criminal offense.

xxx

Had the pinchee sought to file assault & battery charges against the alleged pincher, most state's attorneys would have laughed her out of the office.

xxx

Minority leader Nancy Pelosi has asked a freshmen congressman from Nevada to resign because he is accused of having pinched a lady on the backside with out her consent. The demand is as insane as the Salem witch trials three centuries ago.

xxx

The lunatic fringe so vocal in this nation has convinced many that acts alleged equal sexual harassment, and that new major criminal offense is equal to forcible rape.

xxx

We must not despair and conclude that the world has gone mad. Neither should we surrender this great country to the kooks.

xxx

We remember 30 years ago. The coffee drinkers were seated at the Candle Light Cafe. One of the waitresses stood on a chair to replace a light bulb. Without comment, the veterinarian, now deceased, got up from his chair, and folded his arms around the waitress' thighs to lift her to reach the bulb without danger of falling. She began beating him on the head unmercifully. A lesser man would have opened his arms and let her bounce on the floor. She said, "Don't you ever do that again."

xxx

Perhaps a better way to handle sexual harassment than wrecking Congress.

xxx

At the mention of Candlelight Café we would be remiss if we failed to acknowledge community's appreciation for the excellence of the operators over 40 years. When Jean Powell retired am certain that we were not alone in assuming that successors would operate as delightful a meeting place to eat.

xxx

We were wrong in assuming that successor operators would let the café become standard characterless greasy spoon. Each new operator maintained the excellence of the predecessor. Leffler, Rice, Loftin, Austin, and Bailey. The community is indebted to each of these families for the amount of life they gave to make Lawrenceville a better place in which to live.

December 14, 2017

We believe Doug Jones victory over Roy Moore in the Alabama Senatorial race Tuesday was the opening shot on impeachment proceedings against President Trump. Special investigator Mueller will suddenly discover sufficient evidence to charge the President with obstruction of justice for his Russian conversations. Unless more against Trump surfaces its difficult to believe that the Republican House will impeach. If the House surprises and does impeach, would be almost certain the Senate would convict . Pence would be President.

xxx

More likely scenario is that the impeachment resolution will remain unresolved and become the central issue in next November election. If so, the entire country will be involved in a painful process that will change the way our democracy works. We intend to strive mightily to stay alive for that battle.

xxx

We believe that preservation of the union is more important than all other issues. How tragic that Donald Trump's presidency has been diminished by more than one year of unrelenting opposition from the national news media. Each appears more determined to destroy Trump than to safeguard the U.S.A.

xxx

How frightening that a nuclear war lurks in the shadows even as the nation becomes paralyzed by a political argument.

xxx

God Bless the U.S.A.

December 21, 2017

English teachers often cite with approval the Lord's Prayer as an example of concise yet all inclusive writing.

xxx

Whittier wrote a prayer which we believe a classic. Though Whittier's prayer has about half as many words as the Lord's Prayer it expresses a deep human need overlooked by the original.

xxx

We hope that it is not sacrilegious at Christmas time to mention the thought we wish were covered in the prayer that guide all Christians.

xxx

Over the years it has been our frightening observation that many of man kind suffer a disruption in their thinking 'midst old age. No affliction can be worse; a live, vibrant person is suddenly nothing.

xxx

Would it be permissible to add to the Lord's Prayer one sentence: " restore us to our rightful mind."?

xxx

We do not believe that the Supreme Being micromanages mankind, but if this curse were lifted from the brow of all who believe the end of life would have unlimited sparkle.

xxx

We would welcome a reader reaction as to whether a post script to the Lord's Prayer is permissible.

xxx

Each year we note how much faster time flies, particularly as Christmas approaches. Our prayer is for peace on earth, goodwill to all men. We must each measure his daily acts by those two essentials.

Then all will be well.

xxx

Winter is here. 'Tis the grandest season of the year.'

December 28, 2017

Peaceful co-existence with one plus billion Muslims is more important for the USA than satisfying the nationalist pride of military Israeli leadership.

xxx

Last week President Trump announced that our embassy would move from Tel Aviv to Jerusalem immediately. Perversely, he added that this unilateral step was to "get the peace process rolling." That was double-speak at its worst. What it would signal, in minds of the Muslims is complete surrender.

xxx

Jerusalem is a big town. There is no practical reason that it can't serve as the capitol of two small nations---Israel and a Palestinian state. That arrangement has been the cornerstone of prior negotiations between the Israelis and the displaced Palestinians for many years.

xxx

Those of the Jewish faith in this country have shown no overwhelming desire that Jerusalem should be exclusively the capital of Israel. Why should so many lives be put at risk to satisfy the whimsical hope of so few---starting with Netanyahu.

xxx

Odd aspect of this crisis is how light has been their support of Trump, and for Republicans, in the American Jewish ranks in recent elections. That we would now isolate our country from world opinion in the behalf of determination that Jerusalem not be two capitols is irrational. It is time for common sense to be heard. Of the 100 + members of the United Nations, less than six stand with the U.S on moving their embassies to Jerusalem.

xxx

That Trump and Company were out of step was demonstrated in subsequent roll call on immigration through chain exemption. Less than six other nations stood with the U.S. Even the

smooth American Ambassador to the UN, Nikki Hailey, was moved to threaten the majority, "we are taking names."

xxx

Let's give peace a chance. Share Jerusalem. The One who made the town eternally famous would approve.

xxx

That non-malicious gag line, Jewish merchants singing as they total Christmas season sales, "What a friend we have in Jesus" was certainly on target this year.

xxx

Makes no sense that every year we knock ourselves out frantically buying presents that are neither needed or appreciated. The irrationality of the entire process is summarized by Berlin's song, "I'm Dreaming of a White Christmas". We thank our God that we were spared that monstrosity again this year.

xxx

We wish Berlin would have written one more masterpiece, "I'm Dreaming of a Green New Year's Day."

xxx

Random thoughts about employees: Odd but true; one will often do more than two. Secondly, they are either talkers, or workers, rarely both.

xxx

As one grows old and feeble, he is ever more aware how much his life depends on the kindness of others, particularly caregivers.

xxx

Happy New Year!

2018

48 COLUMNS

January 4, 2018

Rather than the conventional New Year's Resolutions, we propose to state a few courses of action recommended for self, and others.

We shall continue to try and live by the Golden Rule, and make peace with all that we may have offended in 70 years of lawyering

We also intend to urge everyone who has the ability to do more to make Lawrence County grow. Let's face it: we have fallen behind.

One group dedicated to community advancement that needs particular rejuvenation is the Chamber of Commerce. It should utilize the Face Book with a lively controversial page there in.

Though we detest the Facebook it is the future and was the nemesis of all newspapers.

This page in the Facebook which we urge would list specific reasons people should move to Lawrence County. One issue should have three elegant homes individually pictured with bold type invitation: Move to Lawrence County where people live in beautiful homes. Suggested wording below the pictured home. We are so audacious as to nominate the first three homes; that of Drs. Herron & Herron, at the flag pole near the Charlotte Cemetery Sign on the Birds Road; the mansion of Kerry Waggoner and Brenda Grove, just off the 8th hole at the Lawrence County Country Club and any impressive home in Lawrenceville now on the market. Realtor should be requested to come up with a home, including price. Might even charge them for thus advertising their product.

Future issues of the Facebook would stress the safety of living in small communities versus the

murder, mayhem and battery rate of the big cities where all have flocked.

We cannot stress easy availability of extraordinary surgical care. The General Assembly needs to correct the monopoly that the huge population centers have gained in that necessary crisis in life.

Why not offer high tech specialist Illinois Income Tax Exemption to practice in the hinderland? Big city growth would be impossible without huge government subsidy of mass transit fares. Those fares for the riders have not increased in Chicago in ten years. Similar concern for the well being of sparsely populated downstate. It would work wonders in reversing the creeping crawl of Shawnee National Forest to overtake us.

Everyone running for Springfield office in 2018 should be asked his stand on four lanes for Highway 50, and his answers subscribed in blood.

Final New Years Resolution is to stay and our hope is that you do likewise.

January 11, 2018

Sixty years ago, in a gentler, happier time highway travel was slow enough that road signs were feasible. The signs were informational, commercial and/or amusement.

xxx

We remember one very popular sign:

I asked Ida
Ida refused
Ida won my Ida
If Ida used
Burma-Shave

Another memorable sign, "There is nothing like money in the bank." First National Bank of Salem

xxx

Shortly there after a sign appeared on the barn at Clement Buchanan farm, 5 miles south Lawrenceville, Route I. It read "Where will you spend eternity?"

xxx

We thought the sign unusual, even too religious.

xxx

As we approach the end of life's trail we recognize that the sign on the Buchanan Barn is more significant for us, and for all users of the public way than any other.

xxx

The public is indebted to President Trump for the descriptive name of so much that is broadcast, the "Fake News".

xxx

Since August with the President mentioned Fire and Fury in an interview the news media has had a fixation with imminent crisis for every move by the North Koreans and created regularly a public fear that war is imminent.

xxx

It would be helpful if the news media gave the same prominence to the negotiations now underway in South Korea, between Representatives of almost 100 states that will compete in next weeks Winter Olympics.

xxx

The public should know that a North Korean delegation representing that countries finest athletes is present for identified negotiation aboded described rules of negotiation.

xxx

History will record that the 2018 Winter Olympics did more to calm the world from fear of a nuclear war which would destroy civilization than any other Olympic competition.

xxx

Armageddon has been postponed indefinitely.

xxx

We wish the American Athletes victory in next months competition. In prior games the European athlete competition has been formidable.

January 18, 2018

Many mistakes in life are inexcusable. Sunday's false alarm that missile attack on Hawaii had commenced is one such human failure. Insufficient that the one who caused this brush with eternity to escape unscathed by a mere, contrite "I'm Sorry".

The matter must be investigated thoroughly, immediately, without political overtones and the offender punished unmercifully, e.g. years of hard labor.

Unthinkable that one mere human could cause such near catastrophe by this singular action. Need for duplicate motions - two individuals deciding that switch should be thrown

We recognize that most of mankind take a less serious view of the mistake. What would the reader have done if he were in Pying Yang, charged with the responsibility of responding to enemy fire?

Worthy if the occurrence were less dangerous we would say that it made our defense to a surprise nuclear attack laughable.

If the world is to escape nuclear termination, the nations possessing atomic weapons should seek agreement on the destruction of all rather than limiting their possession to the super powers.

Our prayer remains that the guaranteed deterrent of mutual annihilation will prevent a future nuclear war.

Did President Trump in one sentence reverse Lincoln's splendid idealism that has guided mankind for 155 years with proposition that all men are created free and equal?

Our crude President reflects the thinking of the majority of his constituents.

Fifty years ago we asked Eloise Bakst her opinion as to the comparative i.q.s among her NYC students. Eloise was raised in Lawrence County. Her Father's name was Bernstein, he was a tailor. She spent her teaching career with mixed classes in NYC

We were startled by her response, "Brightest student I ever had was black."

The majority have a moral responsibility to educate the black students if Lincoln's equality is ever to be obtained.

It is ironic that a society honors the memory of Martin Luther King by declaring a school holiday.

We should require all students to go to school an extra hour on his birthday.

Inexcusable that school be canceled on any day that building is in tact, the heating system working and no possible spread of a disease feared.

January 25, 2018

Children under six should be taught to regularly ask themselves, "Are my parents glad that they had me?"

The answer will be sensory: no words will be required. If negative, or neutral, the child must try harder to ingratiate himself to his parents if the parent is sane. The Bible recognizes the child's responsibility, Fifth Commandment

Over the centuries the responsibility to seek approval has shifted too much to the parents. Why?

Present partial shutdown of Government suggests that establishing rules for a free people to govern themselves is back to Philadelphia for another constitutional convention. We see no national leader of Benjamin Franklin skill. Somehow we must find a way to prevent a government shutdown in any meaningful degree.

President Trump's vulgar description of Haitian immigrants dramatizes the problem. One cannot advocate Eugenics and be accepted main stream.

We need to introduce into the rules by which we live the concept that more is required from those who have leadership ability, and passive submission by those lacking leadership judgment.

This political label approach does not meet the problem. We shudder as we contemplate the day work stoppage prevents timely delivery of Social Security Checks. We fear mob rule.

Surprisingly, we are glad that we do not have the responsibility of making the decisions now being required by our leaders.

Eight weeks from last Tuesday Illinois voters will nominate Republican and Democrat candidates for Governor. Selection between the two will occur in November. Illinois' future hangs in the balance.

Hope that winter is finished.

February 1, 2018

75 years ago, a very fine teacher, H.A. Dollahan, at SHS taught physics students that inertia or the property of matter that causes it to remain in motion in a straight line, or at rest unless acted upon by an outside force. Those addicted to the Google answer to every question will find some version of that description in full force and effect.

xxx

We wondered why Mr. Dollahan emphasized how the ball rolled. or why an object gained speed as it plummeted to the Earth. We were learning that inertia and gravitational pull are the challenge to life. From the cradle to the grave.

xxx

When the choice needs to be made as to one's course of action, usually the easiest route is wrong. We think inertia and gravitational pull are involved in that rather painful conclusion. Maybe you'll measure your decision at next opportunity against which route is the easier, and which is clearly in your best long term interest.

xxx

We must not be skewered by reductio ad absurdum . That's our escape valve if reader challenges our conclusion.

xxx

Speaking of Google, we are appalled by the number of young, seems everyone we know under 80 asks their smart-phone the answer to every conceivable question, and relies totally on the reply received.

xxx

It is truly a miracle that that little gadget can instantly answer any question upon which experts have written.

xxx

We thought of Fred Allen, 65 years ago then popular radio comedian predicting that the next generation would have a single eye in the center of forehead, tuned to a broadcast station.

February 8, 2018

In 1953, as States Attorney of Lawrence County, we commenced proceedings to force taxation of George Field Farmlands. We agreed with Lawrence County Treasurer Kenneth Maxwell that 3,000 acres of the most fertile land on earth should be taxed. The Trial Court for it held for the Airport/Lawrenceville that lands were exempt because used for a civic purpose. We filed an appeal to the Illinois Supreme Court seeking reversal of that ruling.

xxx

In 1955 the Appellate Court reversed the trial court and ordered the property assessed, excepting only about 100 acres for runways and taxes.

xxx

This decision has never been reversed and taxes have been paid in the intervening 63 years. Problem is that the large income from the farming operations is spent on George Field and does

not benefit the rest of the county.

xxx

The need is that those funds be used to lure industry to Lawrence County. The Bi-State Authority, as present governmental unit operating the airport should be trying innovative ways to make the annual income from the farming operations spent on George Field, rather than using this money to sweep the streets of Lawrenceville.

xxx

We're not abdicating that another court appeal be undertaken. Decisions over the years show a tendency of the judiciary to accept the argument of granting tax exemption to fund use for municipal purposes even remote or fractional.

xxx

We do believe that Bi-State Authority could construct a factory building for some prospective company to bring jobs to our area. Perhaps Bi-State would go further and construct the building in Lawrenceville, directly challenging current thinking that the money has to be spent on site.

xxx

We must not go on for another 60 years without more tangible help from George Field farm lands. For the rebirth of Lawrenceville, and Lawrence County.

xxx

Our Representatives in the General Assembly; House and Senate should be leading the charge to make these farm lands helpful in the struggle to lure the new industry and jobs upon which the future depends.

xxx

Logically Four Lanes for Route 50 should be pushed simultaneously. We challenge those with the throttle to make these two engines bring our area to a more prosperous level.

xxx

It is time to forget about the Ground Hog. Time Zones and Clock Changes have made that rat irrelevant to climate changes.

xxx

Happy fact is that Spring has come to County Lawrence. We give Thanks together for deliverance from a winter that was challenging.

February 15, 2018

President Lincoln was grateful that the students in Units 10 and 20, Lawrence County, were not deprived a day of education on account of his birthday anniversary Monday.

xxx

Rumor on the street Sunday night was that school would be canceled Monday, either for Lincoln or bad weather. The Press had harsh words prepared to publish about such if there had been cancellation. We are grateful that we had no swallow such words.

xxx

During the prior week there have been too many school cancellations, usually a mild winter storm is the alibi. Neither is in the best interest of the youthful minds being molded into useful citizens.

xxx

Press repeats our conviction that school should be canceled for two reasons only: building not safe, or spread of disease could be restricted by contact with others.

xxx

We recognize that there must be a mid semester break at Christmas time otherwise the readers would conclude that The Press was opposed to Christmas, and it should be school day also. Neigh not so.

xxx

Marvelous that Spring has finally come. We have survived a harsh winter. Lawrence County

citizens should point out to their friends and kinfolk in Northern Illinois particularly the Chicago area that though we thought our winter was harsh, their winter was regarded as wild and beyond hope. Remedy is for them to move to Lawrence County. We will have the reader invited anyone from the frigid north to come live with us and make Lawrence County grow?

xxx

We have listened carefully for last weeks suggestion that more must be done that the George Field Farmlands furnish the where with al to lure jobs and industry to our county.

xxx

We encourage the readers that while attending any political meeting they shall attend during the four weeks and five days from the primary to ask about what is being done.

xxx

In no human activity is the old adage "the squeaky wheel gets greased", proven more regular than in the candidate voter election.

xxx

Get the Candidate to promise you now on his mother's honor that the will make a non stop effort to cause Lawrence County to grow, and become again an area leader.

February 22, 2018

Excellence in performance is not encouraged by measuring the remuneration by units of values that are fixed. e.g. hours. Instead of hourly minimum wage would make more sense to define the compensation in terms of skills demonstrated.

Is there a union anywhere willing to accept the quality of the service as the measuring point for the compensation required?

We've come to the end of the way. We need someone who loves Sumner and the tradition of the

Sumner Press to step forth and say that he, or she, will be happy to run The Press for the next thirty years, or at least the next three.

We have appealed to the lawyers in the county to accept the torch from failing hands thrown. Without exception each has rejected the opportunity because they realize that there is a substantial financial loss to the Publisher in each issue. Notwithstanding this reality are dare hope someone will accept the challenge to take over the papers operation.

We would remind of Bacon's major truth, "To be remembered, write."

Should have noted above that the next Publisher of the Press need not reside in Lawrence County. The miracle of long distance, instantaneous communication is such that the oversight could be performed in Cloverdale, Indiana, by Dr. Keith Ernst, or in Arizona by Pary Smith, or any other concerned citizen willing to proclaim with the prophet, "Here am I, send me."

Today's Press has a splendid article on the Piper family, how their involvement in the '49 California Gold Rush left permanent monuments to such illustrious group throughout Sumner. We must each seek to duplicate their achievement or our beloved hometown will surely perish in the very near future.

The State of Illinois must do more to find an operator for Trace Inn. Owners of the racetrack south of the city must be encouraged to have races there this summer. We must create reasons for people to want to come to our county.

We must never despair.

March 1, 2018

The talking heads on television have concentrated on the need for tougher examination of FOID applicants. The thought occurs to us that there needs also to be great caution in selection of school police

xxx

Performance of the school policeman in the Florida tragedy was disgraceful. It is admitted that he waited outside the school door for four minutes while that mentally ill student slaughtered 17 children and injured many more.

xxx

We fear that too often school police are merely old men, or women, fascinated with the chance to wear a uniform and carry a gun. Emphasis must be on the duty of the policemen to protect the innocent, even with his own life if necessary. Failure here was total.

xxx

Likewise the FBI admittedly failed to follow reports that the shooter contemplated this slaughter. There can be no excuse for neglect to duty.

xxx

Question is what would have society have done with the shooter if the FBI had taken him into custody before the shooting.

xxx

We are woefully unprepared in this country to handle mental illness cases. While the exploration of wireless communication has become miraculous, there is not indication of worthwhile additional treatment for mental illness during the past 50 years. We would hope that our government turns the focus on the need to protect all from the mental illness that is found in every community.

xxx

We recognize that our personal solution of the treatment of mentally ill is too violent for most of

society. When the police hold an informal execution at the site of a mass murder, the thought comes to us that justice was done and a deterrent to recurrence has been created.

xxx

Most people believe mentally ill who committed horrendous crimes should be housed fed and kept alive for there allotted years. If this be done, we suggest that scientist should have unlimited right to use these criminals as guinea pigs in the trial of new drugs. Which could help brain regularity.

xxx

Is the above too similar to the alleged practice of the German Gestapo before Adolph cured his own mental illness?

March 8, 2018

We were presumptuous two weeks ago when we opined that Nicholas Cruz, slaughterer of 17 Florida school children, was mentally ill, or at least he would claim such in defense of criminal charges against him. Have learned that he slyly joined the Satanic students fleeing from the building and was 2 miles from that structure before apprehended. Such suggests carefully planned get away rather than mental illness.

xxx

If the penalty were ours to choose we would publicly hang Mr. Cruz and leave the body without clothes on public exhibit until the birds had carried away all of the meat.

xxx

The deterrent effect of such graphic punishment would surely not be wasted on others who would so cruelly snuff out the lives of their fellow citizens.

xxx

Last week, Vladimir Putin campaign speech for re-election as President of Russia. It was bellicose as Adolph Hitler, immediately prior to the German invasion of Poland, September 3, 1939. Putin boasted that his nuclear shells were more powerful than any in the West and that they could reach any point on Earth.

xxx

It was reassuring that no one panicked, nor did anyone conclude from the political rhetoric that Putin was about to launch an all out nuclear war. Happy fact appears to be that Putin accepts the opinion of the scientist that an all out nuclear war would destroy civilization. He recognizes his own mortality. has even been photographed attending church.

xxx

Happy side effect of the upgrading of the terrible destructive power of nuclear explosion in several countries has had the side effect of persuading leadership world wide that nuclear war is no longer an acceptable means of resolving international disputes. Leadership world wide recognizes that islands in the Pacific where U.S. nuclear explosions were staged more than 50 years ago remain uninhabitable. The stark reality of such destruction is lost on no one.

xxx

The need is increased commitment for all members to the United Nations and to talk as the means of agreement and avoidance of the total destruction of civilization as shall ever lurk in the future.

xxx

Otherwise Judge Rutherford's irresistible movement slogan 200 years ago, " Millions now living, will never die." Could be validly issued today.

xxx

We have been appalled how ungrateful Illinois Democrats are to the JFK and Kennedy memory. If the social media tidal flood of wild claims for the candidacy of J.B. Pritzker to be the Democratic candidate for Governor is accurate, his primary opponent Chris Kennedy, 12 days hence; Chris Kennedy has been overwhelmed.

xxx

Spring is here and is the grandest season of the year.

March 15, 2018

Angels of Mercy

That term of admiration has been applied to many individuals and groups. We think of the Country Doctor, horse and buggy going in the middle of the night to attend the birth of a child at some rural residence with neither electricity or running water. Indisputably above were angels. Image of doctors were changed. They have become economic royalist, handsomely compensated in worldly goods for their contribution to society.

xxx

Another Angel was Sister Teresa and similar members of her persuasion.

xxx

The thought occurs that a group deserving of that title deserving of that had been largely ignored in the hectic pace of life are the lowest paid employees of nursing homes. These dedicated workers wipe the backsides of those unable to attend to themselves. Surely in the final accounting when life is done proper recognition will be made that they are Angels of Mercy.

xxx

We were appalled that President Trump fired Secretary of State Rex Tillerson. Later gave he cabinet substance, former President of the largest oil company in the world. Obviously Trump learned the line at rich boys grammar school , " a foolish consistency is the hob goblin of little minds."

xxx

A month ago the President referred to the North Korean dictator as Little Rocket Man and vowed never to sit down and talk to him. Now it has been announced that there will be a full discussion between these the Prima donnas.

xxx

All of which means that U.S. foreign policy is busy and concerns North Korea and the proliferation of atomic weapons it identical to that Under President Obama

xxx

Am I ashamed for having voted for Trump? No the alternative would have been worse. My personal preference for the national leaders is always for one whose truth in candor are steadfast.

xxx

A reminder of the validity of Sic transit Glori; what was the name of that talkative old politician who wrecked Hillary's primary campaign by defeating her in several states?

xxx

Surprising, but true most parents of wealth outlive their welcome on this earth. Rich indeed is the penniless parent who dies surrounded by children filled with genuine tears.

xxx

Why don't you plan to attend the Lincoln Day Banquet March 23, 2018 at the Central Christian Church. Hopefully Governor Rauner will take a few questions.

xxx

A reminder from his Excellency that the full faith and credit of the State of Illinois stands behind the payment of every gas water light and other proper bill at the Sumner Correctional Facility. would prevent the Sumner City Council, and Mayor Brian from diminishing our hope to double the size of The Sumner Correctional facility.

March 22, 2018 *[COLUMN NOT PRESENT]*

Roscoe's Journal did not run in this edition. Page 3 carries "Courthouse News" plus a "Security" feature, not Roscoe's Journal. All 10 pages were checked: page 6 instead carries a "Publisher's Guest" column ("Ruby's, and I don't Mean Tuesday" by John Hamilton). No Roscoe's Journal column appears anywhere in the 2018-03-22 issue. (Pages are readable; the column is simply absent this week.)

March 29, 2018

The news media and President Trump have quarreled bitterly. The former must rejoice that our colorful President has proven more newsworthy every day since he entered the political arena two years ago.

During the past week he flew from Florida Mar A Lago to Washington alone. The news people conjecture that the first lady was miffed that some trip tease actress would give a news conference detailing her romance with Trump ten years ago. The lady claimed that Trump's lawyers paid her \$130,000.00, for silence. There was also some discussion of whether the fixtures in the Florida mansion were gold. Would seem matters of equal unimportance, but widely reported.

Another news headliner from his presidency was the dismissal of a cabinet member ostensibly for wasting taxpayer dollars traveling government airplanes for personal use.

Our guess is that we will refuse to testify before Mueller, and will fire him within a month.

Predictably such move will cause a motion for his impeachment in the Congress.

Our recommendation again: Mueller should be awarded the Order Of Lenin. He is causing the Trump Presidency disarray and wasting intellectual energy that should be expended for the defense of our country and all of the 330 million that live therein.

Thanks to Donald J Trump and company there won't be a dull moment during the next several months, until the voters render their decision, November 6.

We were proud that the management at the Lawrenceville-Vincennes airport got out a welcome sign for Governor Bruce Rauner Friday afternoon. The community should have made more of his Excellency's visit. There are several things he can do for Lawrence County in the coming months. We should have done more to make him know that we welcome his visit and desperately need his assistance.

More gloomy days than any other March we recollect.

April 5, 2018

Carol Cookson, Robin Holmes, Bonnie Maugh, Rosie Sires, and Janet McKinney are the ones we call in desperation when family supply of baby sitters is exhausted.

xxx

Not one of the above named was accepting employment from 8 p.m. Good Friday until 8 a.m. Monday following.

xxx

Other priority was pray or sick day. That such total destruction of first line of defense defied all theories of probability.

xxx

Would seem total destruction of three adult ills who reside in our home was predictable.

xxx

Wait there is a spark of ability/nobility of one of the adults.

xxx

During this 36 hours would you believe that grand daddy was given provided the essentials of life for herself and two companions.

XXX

We nominate Lorre Cunningham "Caregiver of the Year" in perpetuity.

XXX

April 19, 2018

They crossed the red line in the sand at their peril.

During his Presidency Barack Obama drew several imaginary red lines with clear threat that further misconduct by North Korea and later Syria, allied with Russia, would trigger nuclear response. Our adversaries have persisted, North Korea testing ICBM's and Syria using poisonous gas on own civilians in Civil War now in 8th year.

Last week's credible evidence proved Syrian forces (Russian backed) had used poisoned gas on rebels in a capital suburb, killing 44 .

Clearly Presidents Assad and Putin were playing deadly chicken with President Trump under existing United Nations Resolutions, he could have ordered a nuclear response. Instead, injunction with England and France. He launched 100 missiles from ships in Eastern Mediterranean against the gas sites. Their blast was firm enough to get Putin's attention, he whimpered "Russia was not told that such missile launch would be made."

The exchange involving the leaders of nuclear armed nations revealed that neither they, nor we, wish to shorten the path to eternity.

The awesome destructibility of all out nuclear war may be the world's greatest safeguard to peace. In any event the biblical Armageddon was again postponed.

Now is the time for Western Civilization acting through the United Nations to seek agreement that neither side will resort to war, nuclear or otherwise, to dissolve dispute and that each will abide by arbitration.

The alternative to such radical proposal is civilization wiped from the face of the earth.

Every living human should rejoice that the national leadership of every nation of the world fears eternity, as totally as you and I.

April 26, 2018

Elsewhere in this week's press is a fine picture of Mayor Don Wagner, who along with first lady Marilyn, are enjoying a beauty spot in Lucerne, Switzerland. It was a well deserved respite for deserving public servants.

His excellence should spend most of each day explaining to visitors to Lawrence County how glad we are to have them, how fortunate they are to be here and what they will see that will make their trip worthwhile.

cranberries and enjoys having his picture taken by his many visitors. He is a worthy tourist draw.

The Finishing Touch. The finest art gallery in Illinois south of Chicago

State of the art exercise parlor, The New Leaf. The Loeb family continues to expand it's tourist

attraction to include dining and party facility, Cocos.

To welcome visitors approaching from the West, Press is making a new appeal to the Department of Natural Resources to reopen Trace Inn, a beauty spot too long closed.

Largest outdoor automobile showroom in Illinois – Hundreds of new Toyotas parked at Lawrenceville-Vincennes Municipal Airport.

The Press will continue to push for a low level dam on the Wabash at Pulleyville. It will be a boating mecca. Do not despair!

When the Mayor or other high public official is flying somewhere we shall ask them to distribute to other passengers the above list of points of interest in Lawrence County.

Quoting the Railroad famous slogan, "See the World, but see Lawrence County first.

May 3, 2018

Every man on Earth has hoped that his short span called life will terminate at the end of time.

Assuming no National disaster at least 7.6 billion humans will experience death and resurrection. Shortens the odds.

It was that paradox by which Nikita Khrushchev, a notorious non-believer ridiculed those that believe that we are saddened by death though we believe hereafter.

One day soon we shall know.

Money was not created by humanitarians. It is the weapon by which the wealthy control the world. It is corrupted by greed. Notwithstanding the dominance of others the proud poor must have money. Children should be taught there is nothing like money in the bank, except only health is more priceless.

The way to have money is to spend very carefully.

Clarence Darrow told gushing client searching way to repay for his magic with the jury: "Madam, you can pay the Phoenicians invented money."

How glorious these long daylight hours, at either end of the day.

May 17, 2018

We remember the lack of community concern. 50 years ago when St. Francisville community jewel was sold downstream. Burr Caldwell's ferry picturesque but not the type of progress. It must go.

Happily, Mayor McCammon and Art Stample combined their efforts and created a flump bridge connecting the Wabash. It could do until more appropriate structure was given out area by Springfield. 2017 periodically updates this makeshift structure and the community need is partially filled. Needed is community leadership to demand fancy, modern bridge.

Five years ago there was a rumor that St. Xavier would be demolished that its handsome windows be harvested. Only proof we heard were from Frank Lacher, ran full page ad in national newspaper against his Bishop and Larry Pulleybalank. He pled with public to rally to preserve the community jewel. All to no avail.

After these united efforts of community destruction it is reassuring that community opposition has temporarily forced preservation of the wooden railroad bridge on 10th street in St. F. Happily the Law of Common Sense has never been repealed.

What is needed from these community happenings is the determination by every citizen that they will join the effort to preserve community jewels when ever and where ever needed to preserve Lawrence County.

Those who would erase Lake The Prophet Elijah, "Here am I, Send Me". The public opinion should demand construction of low level dam on the Wabash River at Pulleyville that historic St. Francisville not perish from the face of the Earth.

May 24, 2018

PJHS commencement too godless. If there was a single mention of the Almighty at Tuesday evening commencement services, we missed it. This should not be. Faith that has endured for thousands of years should not be swept away by modern fascination with scientific discoveries.

As one presents questions to oracles omniscient Alexa and receives authoritative answers a technological miracle has happened. We salute the genius of those who have discovered the unknowable and pray that their efforts will continue to bare fruit.

Our personal faith is that there is a point beyond which mortal man cannot go. The witless public often laments "if only they let the scientists proceed with stem cell research."

Research in this direction must be weighed against the somber fact that a death is required for each human embryo research program to go forward.

Divine guidance is needed for the decision whether the research is worth that horrible price.

We note that mandated for thousands of churches are struggling with reduced attendance. It is noted too that children who participated in active Sunday school classes are less likely to abandon their faith mid-life, and never in old age.

Stabilizing church attendance in this period of challenge will be well served by increased emphasis on the Sunday school experience. The faith that is built there usually lasts a lifetime.

We found it reassuring that such a godless machine as Alexa refused to rule on the possibility that the soul departs to a supernatural power. It dodged a direct answer by saying "the space out there is unlimited."

We should all return to the faith that we acquired in Sunday school class.

May 31, 2018

Within the next two weeks, the U.S. Supreme Court is expected to announce its decision on whether is is constitutional to deduct union membership fees from workers who do not belong to the union.

If the court holds the deduction from the workers' wages for such fees is unconstitutional, it will be a mortal injury to AFSCME which is currently the most powerful union in the nation.

If the court holds such deduction constitutional, opponents are expected to seek legislative changes to bar such deductions.

Valid argument can be made for either side with its position measured against traditional values. For example: Those who would uphold the deductions might call their opponents "freeloaders" because they seek to seize the benefits without paying for them.

Opponents to the deduction believe unions are an unnecessary expense for the worker who hire antagonists who seek to extort money from the rest of society.

If representative democracy worked as planned there would be no need for unions. Workers grievances would be heard and adjusted through the legislative channels.

Informed readers, the legislative remedy was inadequate. Presently, it is quite adequate without any union input whatever e.g. 40 hour week, overtime pay, no child labor.

Either way, the next couple of weeks will bring high drama on our wide concept of government from Freedom Hall, 1776, Philadelphia, to every home in the land. Should be of interest to every mentally alert citizen.

Progress toward creating an area attraction for new members to dwindling rural counties is unsatisfactory. Present arrangements moves the talented into the big cities. We believe the most effective way to correct the destruction of rural areas is to give an income tax break to doctors who practice therein.

Society needs to take another look on why criminals are kept under lock and key. We think there should be an active education program in the Sumner Correctional Facility to train those possessed of ability and desire to perform some useful public service.

Ironic that we quote again the slogan above one of Hitler's concentration camps: "Work will make you free."

June 7, 2018

EPA banned burning of waste for air pollution caused. Thousands of plastic bags filled with waste have been dumped into the oceans.

Whales have died from swallowing these plastic bags.

Would it not be a classic irony if EPA were forced to conclude that disposal of trash by disposing trash in bags into the water is more destructive than burning same?

We pose that question, which disposal is the greater cause of environmental contamination. We find intelligent young people support the EPA. Perhaps our president will need to lessen his campaign resistance to such agency.

We're curious as to progress on President Obama's library, University of Chicago campus. Second question, is Chicago still in the running for Amazon's headquarters?

We are impatient for the U.S. Supreme Court to announce its decision on whether public employee unions can collect their dues directly from the worker's wages though he is not a member of the union. This decision may play a major role in who is elected governor of Illinois November 6.

We believe that Governor Rauner will pull the rabbit out of the hat and win re-election. Our enthusiasm for that happy development needs a boost from His Excellency.

June 14, 2018

Who decided that a Machiavellian should be a role model?

Machiavelli was a 13th-16th century Italian leader and diplomat. His success and demonstrable skill has been admired for centuries.

Historians say that Machiavelli's success was based on deceit, cunning, and untruthfulness.

Somewhere over the next five centuries many nations, including the U.S.A. developed the requirement that their national leadership be refined gentlemen, or ladies. From childhood children were taught to emulate the national leader - true, honest, just, forthright.

No one would claim that President Trump was strong in any of those recited virtues. Notwithstanding he's getting the job done. He is rescuing Uncle Sam from the perpetual Santa

Claus role world wide in which his predecessors cast us.

The above is the reason no American should be offended by President Trump's approach to the many problems by which our country is challenged in a world of turmoil.

Machiavellian Trump has rescued the nation from the national give away the resources agenda, who will rescue us from ourselves as we carry millions in National Treasure to far away lands under the heading of tourism? Happily there is a

historical precedent. After WWI Lester Hill, Great Western Railroad alarmed that so many tourist dollars were leaving the U.S.A. caused many signs to be pasted on R.R. property. Each bore the same national salvation: "See America First"

In the peak of tourism, with everyone yearning for a trip to Europe and other faraway places it is worthwhile to remember Hill's advice.

But the Railroads did more than solicit tourist; they created national parks along the routes. Glacier National Park was touted as comparable to Switzerland.

Each of us fits into this scenario with a duty to create something in our community that others will wish to come and see.

We'll suggest a single tourist magnet, Red Hill State Park.

Problem is that government is not doing enough to open Trace Inn.

In addition there must be horseback riding. This should be the responsibility of the TriState Saddle Club. Surely some equestrian among them has a couple of horses that could be offered for trail riding.

Another must be improvement is motorized boating - Red Hill State Park. We simply must make more things happen here or our community will vanish.

June 21, 2018

The Illinois bank of the Ohio River from Cave In Rock downstream blossoms with fancy homes. These are built just above the normal high water stage and are eye openers for the boat traffic.

Our Wabash River at St. Francisville offers splendid locations for similar construction. Alas, the owners of the ledges involved will neither sell nor build.

Faced with such an impasse to progress, the Lawrence County Board of Review should triple the tax assessment evaluation of every unbuilt riverfronting lot at St. Francisville. Such move would encourage the owners of these underused community jewels to sell or build.

In connection with above recommended drastic persuasion, the board should appeal to the Illinois Department of Waterways to bring one of its two boats to the port of St. Francisville that the accumulated build up might be removed from the bottom of the river a mile north and a mile south of the port.

Is unfair that during the 90 years we have watched, Waterways has never brought its boat to the port of St. Francisville.

The banks on either side of the Wabash for a mile in either direction from the port should be rocked. Department of Transportation could cause that to happen for a very modest expenditure.

Voters in the 109th and 110th districts should demand that each candidate for State Representative and State Senator advise in writing whether he will support the proposed improvements to the Board of St. Francisville.

None of this will happen unless the citizens of Lawrence County rise up and object to the begin neglect they have endured too long. When it happens, all will rejoice at what a beauty spot they have created without divine intervention.

Summer has arrived. 'Tis the grandest season of the year.

June 28, 2018

We long admired the manner in which he presented himself, as a Pulitzer Prize winning columnist and a panelist on numerous television shows.

The President of Krannhammer he appeared "stiff-necked," as though to emphasize the certainty that his position was correct.

We were embarrassed to discover when Mr. K died last Thursday, at age 68 that he had suffered a broken neck in a diving exercise while attending Harvard Medical School at age 22. He was paralyzed from the waist down for the remainder of his illustrious life.

Rare is the human spirit who can perform his heavenly assigned leadership while suffering such total disability. His life should be an inspiration to all who are inflicted with physical problems of

any degree.

Upon reflection, we have decided that his neck movement was beyond criticism.

When will the news media conclude that it has lost its war against the Trump presidency and join the majority of Americans who have concluded that Donald J. Trump, though a crude leader measured by traditional values, is the right man to lead America in these perilous days.

We thought total confusion of the Trump-haters was demonstrated by management of Red Hen Cafe, Virginia, evicting the president's press secretary, Sarah Huckabee Sanders, simply because she works for the president.

Viewer rejection of Red Hen's ouster and decline in customers, caused the haters to cry that Sanders and Trump should have suffered in silence. Strange justice that would deny the accused a word of explanation.

We wouldn't eat at the Red Hen even if the lunch were free and pretested for poison. We agree with the South Korean Prime Minister, President Donald Trump should receive this year's Nobel Peace Award.

Mohamed Ali said it best, "it isn't braggin' if you can do it." President Trump has demonstrated he can do it.

July 5, 2018

About two weeks ago five employees at Annapolis Gazette were murdered. The police captured alive 34 year old male suspect who had problems with the newspaper 5 years earlier.

We thought that it was unfortunate that the police did not summarily execute the murderer, if his guilt is as clear cut as indicated. Maryland does not have the death penalty.

Predictable course of the prosecution in this tragedy will be a conviction within two years and sentenced to the penitentiary for life. Accused will plead insanity. If illusory with which he carried out the executions would appear unable to refute the insanity plea.

Society is back to square one on whether the death penalty if applied widely would be a deterrent to other would be murderers. Reason suggests that deterrence.

We believe that had Maryland had the death penalty at the time of this terrible assault among humanity the five would still be alive. We believe that the blood of their sacrificed lives is on the head of

every soft headed punkin who is opposed to the death penalty. In Maryland, Illinois and the other states of this divided nation.

Present unwillingness to punish willful murder with execution has calloused society to such an extent that these five deaths were merely a news item in a news media broadcasts for less than 12 hours. It is now deemed no more news worthy than the winner of the Westminster Dog Show in Madison Square Garden.

Surely to God human life is more sacred and notable than is suggested by the news media's almost ignoring the occurrence.

It is time for every State Legislature to reinstate the death penalty. For every cold blooded murder over the age of 18. Churches should take the lead in the return of the death penalty for public safety.

The most vexing component of the death penalty are non believers. Let's keep faith with the nameless and almost forgotten five whose lives on this earth were terminated at Annapolis.

July 12, 2018

Those of us who boost President Trump even as they acknowledge that he's rough as a corn cob, need to reevaluate him. His performance in the Supreme Court nominations has been smooth. Gorsuch was confirmed in near record time. There appears no substantial opposition to elevating Trump's second nominee, Judge Brett Kavanaugh

Apparently named replacement for the late professor Justice Kennedy has an impeccable record, which frustrated his would be detractors. We do have one objection to his nomination i.e. he graduated from Yale Law School and teaches at Harvard Law. There is no place in the Constitution which says that members of the Supreme Court must come from those two schools. Seven of the present nine do have that Alma mater. There is a college of law at Champaign-Urbana which graduates law lawyers.

Those sly Democrats managed to have every election into an abortion question. Republicans should accept the fact that a majority of the American public favors legalized abortion, and quit losing other races to one argument on Roe vs. Wade, which will be reversed.

All mankind thrilled at the rescue of the Thai soccer team from the flooding caves in that faraway land.

We doubt that future reckless endangerment will bring comparable rescue effort. No one has the

right to conduct himself or his group in such a manner as to endanger the life of rescuers. Our thoughts and sympathy are with the families of the four Thai SEAL, who lost his life in effort that reach quite leadership from probable death.

We wonder what effect, if any, expected quick confirmation of Judge Brett Kavanaugh's nomination will have on the Mueller investigation. That group continues to search for impeachable offense by Trump, including collusion with Russia in the 2016 presidential election. Kavanaugh has written numerous opinions that allow a sitting president would make it a point to smile at every conscious moment that facial expression would have people come and help us rebuild a community that's fallen a bit behind.

We think that it lessens the presidency, and the mission, to spend four years investigating the unborn cumbent, regardless of its political label.

Regardless of common sense the Nov. 6 will be on the question of impeachment. If the Democrats win control of the House of Representatives, they'll seek to impeach Trump. What did we do for excitement before Trump was elected?

July 19, 2018

Though last week's Helsinki meeting of President Trump and Russian president Putin appeared frighteningly similar to the infamous 1938 meeting of Britain's Neville Chamberlain, with umbrella; France's Daladier, and Hitler, we doubt that Putin will concluded there from that the U.S. has abandoned its role as the protector of Western Civilization.

The difference between Munich and Helsinki is the atomic bomb. Neither leader desires to terminated life on earth.

Again, we admire President Trump's fearless exposure of his body to the world of haters.

Unfortunate that the news media is unable to accept fact that he's the President of the United States of America.

We were startled when Elon Musk built a miniature submarine and sent it to Thailand to aid the rescue of the boys trapped in the underground caves. He issued a statement that his machine had aided in a rescue. Such claim was never verified by the Thai government and those under the ground working the miracle.

Musk then shocked the world by claiming that the British SEAL who was acknowledged to have been instrumental in the rescue was a "pedo." Never in recorded history did a world class electronic genius become a publicity hound so quickly.

If the reader invested in any of Musk's corporations, which had risen greatly in trade value, we hope you got out before the price of those shares collapsed.

Ogden Nash is credited with a line, "World's biggest mystery is, why did God choose Jews?"

Though we wonder why members of that faith have been subjected to such terrible oppression, we believe they are God's chosen.

Hebrews instinctively recognize that to have any control in steering the ship of state, one must have a public position and/or unlimited money. It is startling that Hebrews climb to the top of every group so quickly. One observes that if any group project has more than one Hebrew, they will combine their different and secure managerial authority.

Presently, Rahm Emmanuel is the mayor of Chicago.

If J.B. Pritzker is elected governor, and Emmanuel is re-elected mayor, it is a certainty that one of them will be the Democratic nominee for president in 2020.

Pritzker has donated \$100 million to his campaign fund and says openly that he'll spend as much as needed to be elected. Polls show that he will gain that goal in the Nov. 6 election.

Gentiles should copy Jewish dedication in working for whatever goal they seek and in standing together as family units.

Foregoing observations about Jewish influence in the scheme of things is not in hate but in admiration for their grasp on the significant in life's struggle.

Lawrence Countians should display their American flag Monday in observance of former governor Jim Edgar's birthday, which was actually July 22. We want Springfield leadership to know that Lawrence County remembers the governor who did most to keep us from being another Johnson or Pope county. Governor Edgar chose himmer as the site for the Sumner Correctional Facility.

July 26, 2018

Our appreciation to Mayor Peggy Brian for last flying the flags on Christie Avenue Monday to honor the birthday anniversary of former governor Jim Edgar.

We noted the flag being flown at several locations about the county seat. To express our appreciation, we have a present for every Lawrence County subscriber to the press who flew the

flag at his home or business Monday pursuant to last week's plea. You need only email us advising us of your entitlement to our gift. We'll deliver the gift thereafter, or tell you when and where to pick it up. We guarantee only that you will not throw the gift away.

As we have repeated and nauseam, Lawrence County simply must make Springfield and Washington aware that we appreciate every kindness bestowed upon our struggling community.

Suggested improvements with government's strong boost include low-level dam on the Wabash below

St. Francisville, flight reroute of the Lawrenceville-Vincennes International Airport, and double tracking the size of the Sumner Correctional Facility.

Happy birthday (7/22), Former Governor Jim Edgar. Governor Jim, you are beloved by the citizenry of Lawrence County for choosing the Sumner prison site 25 years ago, for the scandal free period and the leadership you brought this state while governor.

We hope that our readers noted that Chicago mayor Rahm Emmanuel went to China last week. Most mayors don't find visit of that far away land among their municipal duties. He's running for president in 2020.

Now is the moment to ask our elected leaders, "What will you do for us?"

Press reports elsewhere in this week's issue splendid parties held in our county over the weekend. Proof positive that we are not brain dead and Lawrence County will rise again.

August 2, 2018

Our President must be credible to a majority of Americans for democracy in this land to flourish and continue to lead the world.

After his Helsinki meeting with Putin, President Trump made a statement that was interpreted that he believed Russian President to launch a preemptive nuclear war on Japan in the 2016 Presidential Election. Our own intelligence had reported otherwise. Several Republican senators immediately challenged Trump's rejection of his own intelligence group. We were impressed how quickly President Trump pivoted in mid-air. Said his remarks were misunderstood and that he had complete confidence in our intelligence agencies as a "blanket," therefore evil, six times a candidate for President, we thought of him initially as a born loser. In retrospect he was a guiding light in the political process whose influence in the Democratic Party was almost as great as that of Franklin D. Roosevelt.

This Presbyterian minister was asked in 1964 why he was not running for President for the seventh time. His reply was, "The Democratic Party has adopted most of the changes that I first advocated to best serve the people." Norman Thomas was shouting for Social Security before FDR broke upon the national stage and enacted it. SS is the most popular of all government programs, pure socialism.

Another colorful national politician is Bernie Sanders. Recently he indicated the Political Process.

sky. If that discovery is credible then a major worldwide explosion of enthusiasm take immediate steps through the United Nations to impose crippling trade sanctions on North Korea. Sanctions can be very persuasive. One remembers that our oil embargo on Japan in 1941 caused that country joins the U.S. and other nations in sanctioning North Korea, threat of nuclear war would be diffused.

Same recommendation of steps to persuade Iran to forgo nuclear threats. We must never tire of negotiations, remembering Churchill's line when challenged for insisting on talks with a

threatening enemy, "better to jaw and jaw than war and war."

We fear Robert Oppenheimer, father of the A-bomb, was right in his cry that he had brought death to civilization unless some formula can be found for world wide denuclearization.

Only a fool would suggest unilateral denuclearization, America must take the lead in securing a denuclearized planet, one small step at a time reciprocated around the globe, compelled by sanctions, supported by all who wish civilization to continue.

We believe the spy in the

August 9, 2018

Pope Francis I, welcome to the wonderful arena of American politics.

Fair debate is impossible if one side has the power to silence the opposition. The pope must compete as a political leader from Argentina, rather than as the vicar of Christ.

An exception to the Church's traditional opposition to capital punishment was provided in a catechism permitting capital punishment for horrendous crimes, e.g. multi-murders. Relying on that exception many Catholic leaders, including legislators and the judiciary have been mainstay supporters of capital punishment for 50 years.

Surely the pope jested when explaining his seat of the pants decree that capital punishment was impermissible even under the catechism identified, was possible rehabilitation of the criminal. There never was the rehabilitation of a malignant heart of the criminal guilty of multi-murders.

The world will watch the confirmation hearings later in the month for Supreme Court nominee Brett Kavanaugh. We trust he is familiar with the late Justice Scalia, the acknowledged leader of the Court, "any justice who cannot support capital punishment for horrendous crime should resign."

Four members of the U.S. Supreme Court are Catholic. Kavanaugh would be the fifth. We doubt that any of these national leaders

will scuttle the court at the whim of the Bishop of Buenos Aires.

A Seattle federal judge issued an order last week baring the publication on the internet of blueprints for home construction of plastic firearms claimed to be as lethal as store bought. There is that a 3D printer can turn out plastic guns for every member of society.

We think his honor's ruling was unnecessary. Poetic justice lurks in the shadows. Only a few hands need be blown off by exploding guns before these amateur gunsmiths would realize that the law of common sense was never repealed. If much cheaper plastic were suitable for gun construction as expensive hardened steel, why doubts that Smith & Wesson, Colt, et al, would have long ago switched to that material.

As we raced toward the Nov 6 election, President Trump's haters appear no closer to nailing him than they were. The time is long since each should ask himself, "is the preservation of the U.S.A. more important than my dislike of President Trump?" Though his public utterances are self laudatory beyond reason and cause his supporters to blush, President Trump has brought millions of jobs home to America.

We are persuaded our nation is stronger, its members are safer, and the future brighter from Trump's leadership.

We beseech all readers of the Press to believe as we that politics and politicians are the protectors of this nation that we all love, without regard to the party label.

Let's all get involved in the Political Process.

August 16, 2018

During the past two centuries a natural process that we read about made marvelous progress in unlocking the secrets of life that surround us on many fronts. From Agriculture to Artificial Heart minds have pierced the unknowable.

One significant facet confronting mankind, the mating from which the next generation of Americans will rise, has remained untouched. Now as then the mating is based on location, shape, smile, and chatter. Brilliant minds conceived and constructed a lexical a, a human mind triumph grander than the 7 Wonders of the Ancient World combined. Comparable brainpower should be focused on the mating process.

Seriousness of the problem is suggested by the observation that University of California would be majority Chinese without serious restriction upon their acceptance.

We are unwilling to concede that their young are smarter than ours.

We note with alarm that the Chinese have reversed their one child per family rule originally enforced for 40 years. Unless America

cans produce the brightest children possible during the next 20 years the Chinese will supplant us as the world leader.

We recognize that eugenics evokes a negative response from most people, but some form is necessary for our national survival. Our government should lead the way with an expanded educational program as to the compatibility of a contemplated mating. The decision must be leadership driven and not left to chance and further deterioration of the American position, in comparison with the other nations of the world.

We were impressed by Rick Russel the 29 year old freight handler at the Seattle Airport who flew alone a multi motor airplane for forty minutes before crashing same on a wooded island. How grand it would have been had he survived. We do hope the transcripts will show that Ground Controller was sending positive messages to him, without threat of prosecution during this strange flight. His was the daring do of a great pilot, will taught.

One is compelled to ask himself, where was God?

August 23, 2018

If one has any doubt that the Hebrews are God Chosen, needs only compare the Illinois Medicaid Reimbursement payment to Aged-Disabled and Council to other minorities.

Obamacare and the numerous Illinois Public Health regulations adopted for compliance there with have created an almost impenetrable paper wall. Now, a nursing home must recognize that to keep its doors open the paperwork is more important than patient care. That should not be politics required Republican's to vilify Obamacare. The new system is being presently crafted it is hoped that such will simplify the paper forest and return primary concern to care of the patient.

The Press has no quarrel with the Board of Directors of Methodist Village Health Care, and admires the dedication of all connected there with as they seek to sooth the pain and agony of the old and infirmed

We do fear that a Chicago law firm with a runner connection to the Administrator, has collected about a half a million dollars 2016-2018, that was intended for patient care rather than lawyer enrichment.

The area has a half dozen lawyers who would do the same work for a fraction of that money that has been frittered away. This financial hemorrhage of the kind and generous donors must cease.

We urge suit to force Chicago lawyers and their runner to disgorge. Secondly new administrator is required in this situation.

The Bishops meeting Thursday must be more door after the horse has escaped. The Bishop should be importuned to appeal to Governor Rauner to signal public aid not to coerce or penalize United Methodist Village Health Care for attempting to staunch a blunt blow that could close these Angels of Mercy.

The sickening news out of Pennsylvania suggests that Priest abuse of young boys is more widespread among the Catholic Church than any imagined.

Pope Francis I would solidify his position in the ranks of great leaders if he authorized priests to marry.

An orderly society without strong churches would be impossible. The amount of distrust created

from these expanding cases of Priest assault upon the young and helpless. Needs a dramatic change of direction from the very top.

My prayer is that Pope Francis I will recognize that such policy change, or equally change in that direction is necessary if the Church is to retain its hold upon the hearts and minds of its members.

We shutter as we note how dark the sky each 6 a.m. has become. We give Thanks to our God that we are here to welcome the sun for another day.

August 30, 2018

We are reflected by public revulsion against politics and politicians. We regard the willingness of any citizen to actively participate in politics, as a candidate or a party worker in the trenches, as a badge of courage. While the uninformed regards the fascination with politics as pathological, it is essential for the efficient operation of government.

We think back about politicians whom we've watched for almost ninety years. Surprisingly, one more memorable is the late Norman Thomas. Labeled as a "Socialist," therefore evil, six times a candidate for President, we thought of him initially as a born loser. In retrospect he was a guiding light in the political process whose influence in the Democratic Party was almost as strong as that of Franklin D. Roosevelt.

the might run again for President in 2020. Of course, he was speaking that he is too old. It was fascinating how he attracted hordes of enthusiastic young with his programs to make our government more socialist.

If Hillary decides to run again, which appears likely the sparring partner for the champion. His repeated knock downs of Hillary did more to elect Trump than all of the Russians in Moscow.

The general election is 10 weeks from last Tuesday. Though the President's race is two years away, the November 6th election is crucial to the well being of the U.S.A. If the Democrats get control of the Congress in the election November 6th, one can be assured that a bid of impeachment will be filed against President Trump and actively pushed. We believe that if Trump were impeached this nation's stock market would collapse and the nation would have a hair curling depression.

We beseech all readers of the Press to believe as we that politics and politicians are the protectors of this nation that we all love, without regard to the party label.

Let's all get involved in the Political Process.

September 6, 2018

Had we been on the Board of Supervisors of Kankakee County, we would have voted to include George Ryan's name with the other two recent county officials whose names are inscribed honoring native sons who served as Governors of Illinois. One supervisor sniffed that Ryan is a convicted felon.

We served eight years with George Ryan in the Illinois House. We found him honorable, upright, trustworthy. The public sometimes exaggerates the significance of the crime for which the public official has been convicted. One of George's "convictions" was for persuading the State Senator from his district to put his daughter on an honorary page for a day or so. One would have thought that a fair minded judge would have thrown that charge out on sight. Rare is the Legislator who hasn't made some comparable gesture of good will to kinfolk close or remote.

It is wicked to automatically assume the worst

possible degree of official guilt. We regard the felon runner to disgrace. Secondly new administrator is required in this situation. We're not concerned that George Ryan's wrongdoing was venal in the charge against him/her. It were as though Ryan's name and that of Samuel Shapiro) on plaque honoring native sons who served as Governors of Illinois.

These campaign fund laws have become so tricky, all encompassing few will dare serve in public office. We need to relax, live, and let live.

We need to concentrate our efforts on Lawrence County and let the rest of the state fend for itself. We would welcome reader comment as to what we can do to make people want to come to Lawrence County, even to move here and reside with us. May sound silly but if majority of the Lawrence County residents would make it a point to smile at every conscious moment that facial expression would lure people to come and help us rebuild a community that's fallen a bit behind.

Have you a better idea?

September 13, 2018

In sharp questioning of Supreme Court nominee Brett Kavanaugh by the Senate Judiciary Committee, none inquired his position on reversal of U.S. versus Reynolds. In that 1879 decision the court upheld criminalization of polygamy.

xxx

Seems odd that one can be sentenced to jail for two simultaneous marriages. There simply are too many open relationships, without benefit of a formal marriage. to single out for prosecution. Only those who enter into a second marriage without dissolving the first.

xxx

Predictably, the Supreme Court last looked at this disparity on a case that came from the Mormons in Utah. Because of the impact on children born to these living together families we think the law should be clarified that all involved might respect the rule of law in an organized society.

xxx

We doubt that Mitt Romney will appreciate the public's awareness of the present incongruity in society—determination of which arrangement are legal. Romney is accomplished Mormon, a

national figure who easily won nomination to be the Republican Candidate for the U.S. Senate from Utah. His election November 6 is safely predictable. The bookies would name him as a favorite to be the parties nominee for President in 2020 if Trump should stumble.

xxx

Respect for the law is so vital to a smooth societal existence we would hope that the present system of legally ignoring conventional marriage license would be redefined.

If one is offended by prosecuting those having Brett Kavanaugh by the two valid ceremonial wives, or husbands, without prosecuting other couples who skip the ceremony, why not a tax incentive to encourage conformity.

xxx

Any tax break to couples could be limited to those who have engaged in the marriage ceremony. We hope our musing on this subject is not mistaken for a lawyers effort to create the need for more lawyers to dissolve the marriage contracts suggested.

xxx

We have often suggested that lawyers under 30 be barred from court and sent to medical school, prepaid.

xxx

We were startled at the sigh of relief throughout this land that the North Koreans did not parade their international ballistic capacity in the 70th celebration of their nation.

xxx

Americans should be more confident of our armed forces ability to repel in advance any serious threat to our nation.

xxx

One does have the fear that North Korea is merely a pawn for China in these provocations. Note that high Chinese official stood on reviewing stand in Pyongyang.

xxx

If the Chinese have not been impressed by the pictures of Hiroshima and Nagasaki, perhaps we should include Japan with our President Trump in the next meeting with Kim Jong-un North Korea on the de-nuclearization of the Korean Peninsula.

xxx

Americans should walk proud, only Americans have walked on the moon.

September 20, 2018

We are startled how many educated girls are impressed with Christine Ford's gratuitous slander of Supreme Court nominee Kavanaugh. We would have thought the charge too long concealed from everyone to have any credence.* Never a joy that were doubted, not a sorrow but were halved by telling*—Old Proverb

The accuser named another student present at the party as having recused her from the assault. He gave a written statement that he had no recollection of the occasion and did not wish to testify. His answer damaged her accusation more than his nominee's defense.

The suspected purpose of this last minute accusation has succeeded. Committee Chairman Grassely outsued the public hearing to next Monday. Justice Kavanaugh has agreed to appear; Ms. Ford has not replied as of Tuesday evening.

Senator Grassly stated that only the nominee and the accuser would be heard at the hearing. This is unlike the Clarence Thomas nomination 20 years ago in which more than twenty witnesses were heard. Both Justice Thomas and Anita Hill, the accuser survived.

The accuser has so much reputation that will be irretrievably lost if the panel chooses to believe

Justice Kavanaugh's denial. We will not be surprised if she

decides that her health has not permitted her to proceed with the charges to the bitter end which seems predictable.

Would it be a reductio ad absurdum to permit similar changes in reverse if the nominee female and the accuser male? The advocates of absolute equality between the sexes in this case suggest that they might have to agree on female sexual assault.

Perhaps the role of this entire line of questioning should be very narrowly limited in all future Supreme Court confirmation hearings.

We have followed the murder trial of Chicago officer Jason Van Dyke. Defendant has confounded the experts by actually going to trial on these charges. It is the case that caused Mayor Rham Emmanuel not to seek a third term.

It is presumptuous of us to second guess experienced defense council who are risking it all on a not guilty, or hung jury. Rather than negotiating a plea of guilty to lesser offense with minimal time.

The trial reveals the many separate conflicting sections of Chicago. race, religion, economic establishment. It is hoped that the blending together in one united, vibrant metropolitan area will emerge.

Happy Thanksgiving!

October 4, 2018

Senator Flake got even with President Trump at Justice Kavanaugh's expense. Every Senator on the Judiciary committee recognized how preposterous Dr. Ford's recollection of the alleged incident 36 years ago with absolutely no corroboration.

xxx

How ingenious of Flake to stall the confirmation with the ruse of a FBI investigation of these allegations. If the victim had two more visits to her therapist she would have remembered seeing Kavanaugh's pee pee while each in Kindergarten.

xxx

Odd that so many ladies believe that a 15 year old drunken girl voluntarily attending a fraternity party is entitled to be treated as a lady which she wasn't.

xxx

There was a poetic justice in the pro- Kavanaugh's women attack on Senator Flake after the hearing.

xxx

Our guess is that there will be no Senate vote on Kavanaugh's confirmation. Pelosi and company are eating up the calendar arguing extent in nature of the FBI investigation that appears to be going absolutely no where. By midweek Justice Kavanaugh's vociferous opponents will be screaming that the public has a right to vote on the issue. In the election 33 days from today.

xxx

We fear the timid Republicans will succumb to such stall.

xxx

We think Majority leader McConnell should call to question for roll call vote next weekend, per Flake's recital for the continuance. If this is done we doubt that Justice Kavanaugh will be confirmed. The Republican lady Senators from Washington, Alaska, and Maine value their female support higher than their party loyalty. Even if the Republicans can hold a Democrat Senator from

West Virginia hostage on a confirmation vote. There are insufficient Republican votes in the Senate for the nominee to receive the majority required.

xxx

Another great loser, in this fiasco is the Catholic Church. The Women's Alter Society went all out, 65 members signed written declaration of their confidence in Justice Kavanaugh and asked that he be confirmed.

xxx

The entire affair has been a compelling argument for term limits. This room full of peacocks should have been able to make a decision without hiding behind repetitious FBI reports and other excuses. Two terms is long enough for any Senator to serve, and four terms for the Representatives who are elected to two year terms.

xxx

44 years ago a State Representative Candidate passed out thousands of yardsticks. The public welcomed such handy tool, especially parents who had children whose bottoms should be warmed.

xxx

We note that Representative Candidate Darren Bailey's yardsticks are much thicker than those handed out by his predecessor. Means they cost more.

xxx

Disciplined children will be angrier with him than were the children that encountered the yardsticks of his predecessor. Matters not the children can't vote; the parents can and will like Bailey's yardsticks.

xxx

We hope that the policy actions has not been distastefully act may have to report lack of proper

preparation to avoid detection. What poetic justice if the assassins in turn are executed for their failure to trace and erase the tell tale In The Cloud.

xxx

October 11, 2018

Democracy as conceived by our fore fathers requires an electorate that is moral, competent, and ambitious. We fear that almost half of the voters in Illinois have none of these essentials.

Unquestionably about 90% of all in the welfare lock are dependent on government subsidy for the basics of life.

xxx

Colton Kenneth Cropper, 27, Lawrenceville, was arrested October 4 by the Lawrence County Sheriff's Department on a Lawrence County Warrant. He was released with \$15,000 bond.

[NOTE: column 2 mid-section interleaves the Police Report list; Roscoe text resumes:]

Mark Robert Denison, 41, Lawrenceville, was arrested October 4 by the LCSD for Time Served.

xxx

Marvin Brent Ross, 61, Lawrenceville, was arrested October 4 by the Lawrenceville Police Department for Failure to Appear for Driving while License was Expired.

xxx

Lee D. Russell, 45, St. Francisville, was arrested October 7 by the Lawrenceville Police Department for Driving while License was Suspended.

xxx

Levi Scott Smith, 28, Lawrenceville, was arrested October 4 by the Lawrenceville Police Department for Failure to Pay or Appear. He was released with \$3,500 bond.

xxx

Adam Lee Merritt, 29, Flat Rock, was arrested October 3 by the LCSD on a Probation Violation.

He was being held on \$25,000 bond.

xxx

Jacob Dale Wright, 21, Robinson, was arrested October 4 by the Lawrenceville Police Department for Failure to Appear on a charge of Driving an Uninsured Motor Vehicle. He was released on \$3,000 bond.

[NOTE: This week's "Roscoe's Journal" column opens with the brief paragraph on democracy/electorate above; the remainder of the column space is given over to the Police Department arrest list. The opinion content for this date is the single democracy paragraph. Every divider beyond the opening is "xxx".]

Every educated, moral, ambitious citizens of Illinois should vote against J.B. Pritzker for Governor 26 days from today, for his documented antisocial conduct.

xxx

A second compelling reason for voting against Pritzker is his brazen announcement that he has spent 150 million of his own dollars in the campaign and will spend "as much more required to be elected Governor."

xxx

If there be any pride in Illinois voters now is the time for that scarce commodity to assert itself.

xxx

The re-election of Bruce Rauner as Governor is the best expression of intellectual honesty and the shared hope that Illinois can regain its position as a leader in these grand and glorious United States of America.

xxx

We salute Kendra Tohill and Alison Mendenhall for rescuing the musical program at Lawrenceville Public Schools from threatened collapse. The community is indebted to those two ladies for their inspiration and extra effort. All who attended the band performance including the LHS Alumni Band last weekend at Ed Loeb Field must have been impressed. What a grand sound

these bands and these ladies made. Their reward should come in this world and need not await the next.

October 18, 2018

If journalist Jamal Khashoggi was murdered in the Saudi Arabia consulate, Istanbul, October 2, 2018, it is a terrible crime against humanity. Unless the departed was attempting to provoke a civil war in Saudi Arabia. We would like to see what he wrote in the Washington Post that could have infuriated the leaders of that country to commit such madness.

xxx

In any event, the Trump haters, which includes too many of the world's news purveyors, demand that he declare the Saudi Government uncivilized and apply trade sanctions to compel regime change. This opposition to Trump is mindless. It is none of our business how bestial a foreign power structure is to its subjects. We saw in Iraq what a quagmire it is for the U.S. to attempt to serve as police to impose our version of a just and upright government.

xxx

President Saud, Syria, gave a televised interview during the summer claiming his problem and solution are comparable those of Abraham Lincoln. Before Gettysburg there was an increased pressure on Lincoln to consent to a negotiated peace with the rebels. Each of us and millions other Americans were better served by Lincoln's stubborn insistence that the war be pursued to victory. Saud's illustration was thoughtful and persuasive.

xxx

We need only remember the elation we all felt when President Obama sent the U.S. Navy Seals to obtain bin Laden's fortress in Pakistan. The brave seals killed that criminal and hauled his body out to sea that it not become a rallying point for future luna-

tics. Those determined to destroy our rebuilt World Trade Center where 3,000 Americans died at his Laden's evil hand. Had he lived bin Laden might have tried to destroy another World Trade Center and snuff out the lives of 3,000 more Americans. The violent vengeance of the Seals was appropriate.

xxx

We're doubtful that any nation on earth lodged formal protests with the United States Government for the incredible desecration of the Navy Seals.

xxx

President Trump should proceed with his meeting with the rulers of Saudi Arabia in Riyadh this week as planned. We do hope that he will take an extra company of Secret Service men to keep him alive while in that nation. Of course the arm sales should proceed. We can't pay for all of that Saudi oil with corn.

xxx

We assume a commission will be appointed to investigate facts surrounding the disappearance of the Saudi news reporter, feared murdered. Will eagerly await it's finding as to his apparent premonition of his murder. Fascinating that if Turkey's account is accurate the news men wore an Apple watch that recorded the events of his death later recovered on The Cloud by investigators.

xxx

The hit squad which may have carried out this dastardly act may have to report lack of proper preparation to avoid detection. What poetic justice if the assassins in turn are executed for their failure to trace and erase the tell tale In The Cloud.

xxx

November 1, 2018

If one is a political sadist (one who enjoys pleasure from a politician's pain) and practically every American is, politician to watch last week was Senator Bernie Sanders, D VT. Though his dob is 9/8/41, Sanders has already thrown his hat into the Democratic Presidential nomination arena for 2020. Cesar Sayoc hates left wing Democratic leaders. He compiled lengthy list of such leaders and mailed homemade bomb to almost a dozen. Fortunately, the bombs didn't explode nor could the police department cause same to detonate.

One would assume that Bernie Sanders name was on the bomb makers list, but his name was conspicuously absent.

How crushing this rejection of Sanders as a viable candidate. Cesar sent a bomb to Maxine Waters, but not to Bernie Sanders!

To have one's candidacy rejected by a kook who obviously disqualified the over 80 Sanders when 1st term would be completed as viable candidate is crushing. Joe Biden got a bomb. He's almost that old.

What to do?

We would wager all we own that Sanders sent a trusted agent to immediately search all records available from the bomb maker in the forlorn hope that his name had been overlooked.

Sanders would scramble for a backup position. Perhaps his bomb was mailed to a former office address. Could it be found and publicly announced immediately?

What about the fingerprints by which the police confirmed they were holding the right criminal? It would appear that there is no practical way that Bernie Sanders can come up a bomb purportedly mailed by Sayoc. How melancholy, how disappointing that his candidacy for the Presidential nomination died without a wimper

Happy retirement Senator Sanders! "Life's but a walking shadow, a poor player. That struts and frets his hour upon the stage. And then he is heard no more." Shakespeare

November 8, 2018 (*LIVE — REPRINT ERRATUM: text identical to 2018-11-01; the paper's 2018-11-15 column notes "Our apology to our readers—the November 8 issue recopied the November 1 Journal."*)

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frets his hour upon the stage. And then he is heard no more." Shakespeare

November 15, 2018

Our apology to our readers-the November 8 issue recopied the November 1 Journal.

xxx

We are frightened that our eye in the sky reveals the North Koreans are continuing to this day to
work on inter-continental ballistic missiles. (ICBM's)

xxx

We must not panic. If there is to be an atomic war, the first shell should come from our side. We
should send a picture of Hiroshima to Beijing, they must order their North Korean stooges to
disarm as agreed.

xxx

Further, if the Chinese are unwilling to face reality, we should permit Japan to become a nuclear
power. We run the risk that the Oriental mind harbors need for revenge for the devastation caused
Japan.

xxx

We pray always that the President of the United States will have the courage of Harry S. Truman
at one of the turning points of history.

xxx

Disgraceful that the May-

oral election in Chicago in May is more of an acclamation than a real election.

xxx

This mismatch could be corrected if the the Republican Committee in Chicago could persuade Chris Kennedy to accept the Republican nomination.

xxx

Sumner Press reporter at the Illinois Farmers meeting heard both Kennedy and candidate J.B. Pritzker speak. He believed Kennedy completely outclassed Pritzker. The backroom boys selected Pritzker as their candidate because of his money.

xxx

The Kennedy name is magical with the voters. We believe that as the Republican Nominee he would turn the Chicago Mayoral election in May 2019 into a real contest and could be elected. We will promote Lawrence County Fundraising if he will run.

xxx

Should he deserved to Chris Kennedy that Richard J. Daley was a Republican before he switched parties to run as a Democrat and become a powerhouse in Chicago politics.

November 22, 2018

August 8, 1945, Marseilles. A well intentioned colonel casually remarked, "the joyride flight to Cairo is not authorized. If the plane should crash your mother would receive no insurance." Another occupied the seat we had carefully wrangled for that trip. Loss was not as great as it could have been. Our admiration of the pyramids has long been diminished by comparison between the Wonders of the Ancient World.

The Pyramid of Giza is the most recognized of the Seven Wonders. In comparison, with modern day miracles – electricity, wireless communication, health and surgery, the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World seem like tinker toys.

Is human life becoming more intelligent, or is it genius standing on the shoulders of other genius to create present day miracles? As one talks with Alexa, sometimes believing

that it is human, how far mankind has come in the search for the unknowable is evident.

Of Alexa, it is the finest companion ever for the old, physically lonely.

Back to the pyramid, Press' top writer, Alan Johnson, did not seem overwhelmed that the Egyptians could construct so huge a tomb 1,000 years before the birth of Christ. One wonders why the pyramid is not mentioned in the Bible. The distance from Cairo to Jerusalem is 263 miles. Surely there were people then venturesome enough to travel between these two capitals.

We hope one day to learn how all of these races and their individual achievements fit together in God's scheme of things. (Steven Jobs was taken from us before he had unlocked completely the secrets of the universe.)

Happy Thanksgiving!

November 29, 2018

A Federal Judge in San Francisco held President Trump's order on immigrant birth citizenship order against imminent birth citizenship unconstitutional. The President responded; "an Obama appointed Judge". Supreme Court Chief Justice John Roberts issued a strong defense of all Federal Judges and implied criticism of the President's characterization.

It would appear that the Chief Justice wishes the Federal Judiciary to be revered as morally and

legally pure. Idealistic but not realistic. Federal Judges are successful lawyers who had the same political views as whatever President appointed them.

We thought Chief Justice Roberts envisioned a triumphant government leadership —The President, The Chief Justice and the The Speaker of the House of Representatives. Our Constitution envisions no such thing through two world wars and many international

tional crisis. With The President as the Captain of the Ship.

We see no reason to change the leadership of America and believe that all loyal citizens should stand behind President Trump during the two years that remain of his term.

We were surprised that President Trump didn't respond to the Chief Justice criticism. He could have used the number of the Supreme Court is so biased, she even said she would go to Australia if I were elected". Instead, he sent Justice Ginsberg a prayer for her recovery from serious illness.

Long Live the U. S. A.

The Immigration problem has reached the border at Tijuana. We are opposed to shooting these wretched people even if they push up to the border and step into our country. We can feed a thousand more hungry humans if that be our national fate. Should bring down the cost of Immigrant Labor all across the border.

December 6, 2018

A compassionate society can never abandon the struggle to raise the level of life for those in poverty.

xxx

Tragic that so many have no marketable skill. We think the abandonment of a manual arts program in so many high schools including Unit 10, has been a catastrophe for many who needed. 40 years ago Lawrenceville High School had a manual arts program teacher Leslie Wright whose program was second to none. Somehow, we need to get back to that level of effective education for those most in need.

xxx

Well intended, but fatal to the hopes and prayers of those trapped in poverty, are high interest loans. Society must reinstate usury laws and forbid loans to anyone classified as poverty stricken at loan interest more than 6% apr on unpaid balance.

xxx

Obviously no loans would be available to the poor at that return. Government

would need to go into the loan business and strictly regulate loans to the poor limiting same to the absolute necessities of life.

xxx

Otherwise, too many spend too much of their limited income paying interest on money borrowed to buy things they could live without.

xxx

Capitalism, even strongly regulated is a cruel way of doing business. Nevertheless it offers the last best hope to elevate the lot of the poor who are becoming more numerous.

xxx

We must never abandon the struggle.

**\

For twenty months of determined effort to build an impeachment suit against President Donald

Trump, we think Special Investigator Mueller has earned the Press' double award for Infamy: Order of Lenin and Order of Mao. Further, Mueller should be fired immediately.

December 13, 2018

As our travels along Green Street in Champaign, from 1st Avenue to the U of I campus at Wright, he will be surprised that all the eateries are oriental, owned, operated, menu and chopsticks. For some this causes fear that our country is becoming overwhelmed by a foreign deluge. Rather, it should remind that life is competitive and all must do their best for the common good.

A few years ago a beautiful 16 year old girl named Jo Ellen, asked to borrow our Calliope for a church/student function. We were agreeable suggesting that the first try to operate that splendid musical device. Her instant, polite response "I do not need a test run, if another can operate it, I can too."

That "can do" spirit must inspire all Americans if we are to successfully meet the challenge of chopsticks on Green Street.

The political arm of organized labor, led by the public employee union, has pledged \$1,000,000 to the mayoral nomination of Toni

Preckwinkle. Stealing the line from Governor Pritzker's successful campaign, the Union boasts that it will spend as much as needed to elect Preckwinkle for Mayor.

When the Greeks invented democracy, we doubt that any foresaw the outcome of election of leaders by their new process would depend on who brought the most coins to the contest. Elections have truly become high finance.

Opposing candidates William Daley and Susan Mendoza do not appear spooked by the Unions

tour de force

Press picks Susan to be the Democrat nominee since Chris Kennedy did not seize Summer Press suggestion that he run as a Republican, We believe Susan will be crowned the next Mayor in May following an election which is a shameless formality.

Nor did the Greeks foresee democracy's many challenges as it gave all the people a vote in their govern-[column ends here, hyphenated; no locatable continuation in this edition — remainder not printed/[illegible]]

Roscoe's Journal — Part 022

December 20, 2018

To Mike Stiff, Olney; correct interpretation of the Bible is one of the few subjects of which The Press makes no claim to be infallible. We would gently respond to your published citation of 1 Maccabees 13:28-38 in re: construction of the pyramids by noting that seven books, including your citation, known as the Deuterocanonicals, were deleted by Protestant scholars. If you have other biblical references to the pyramids we will be happy to examine. Thank You for reading our column and wishing you a blessed Christmas.

We were startled by Governor Rauner's admission last week that he had personally asked four Republicans to become the party's candidate for Governor in the November 2018 election after his razor thin margin over Representative Ives in the primary.

Obviously, Rauner concluded that he could not win. None is more non-electable than a candidate who does not believe that his victory is certain.

We admired Rauner's concealment of despair. He even gave \$50 million of his own money to the

campaign after the primary.

In the "what might have been column" unfortunate that Tom Ricketts, billionaire owner of the Chicago Cubs didn't accept Rauner's offer to step aside. With the beloved Cubs involved in a historic world series, Ricketts could have been elected.

Politics is a marvelous game for the courageous.

Disgraceful, the public posture of President Trump, Minority Leaders Pelosi and Schumer calling each other names in a televised meeting seeking harmony in the American Government.

What did foreigners think as they saw Pelosi questioning Trumps manhood? We liked Tribune Correspondent J Kass' account of that sorry encounter.

Again it is time for Trump's enemies to forego impeachment proceedings against him. Surely to God the American electorate will hold the Democrats liable if they persist in the impeachment upon Mueller's request even though there is no possibility that the U.S. Senate would find him guilty even if impeached.

The Demos can see that Trump will not be a candidate for reelection in 2020. Time and challenge have taken their toll. Let's all unite behind the flag, Proud to be an American

December 27, 2018

****Let's abolish Santa Claus****

****This self flagellation can end****

Let's abolish Santa Claus. Created by inspired Turkish-Dutch and American believers, it brought hope, happiness and generosity.

Santa Claus has become the tyrannical symbol of mercantile greed. How sad to see impoverished parents scrambling frantically into the darkness of New Year's Eve to acquire gifts that their children attribute to Santa Claus.

It would be far better that little children be told from a very young age that all the good things that happen to them are caused by parents and others standing in the place of parents devoting their life to the child's upbringing. It will be a happier, calmer world without a Santa Claus.

Dan Ryan was the chairman of the Cook County board. The main vehicular artery leading into Chicago from the south was named in his honor. Few other pathways handle as much traffic as does this multi-lane concrete road.

Every Chicagoan knows with some reverence the name Dan Ryan Expressway, but few have any clue who was the politician thus immortalized.

20 Democrats seek election February 6 as their party's candidate in the Chicago mayoral election May, 2019. One aspirant, William Daley II announced last week that if elected mayor he would cause the name of the Dan Ryan Expressway to be immediately changed to the "Barack Obama Expressway."

It was a stroke of genius by Mr. Daley. Without spending a dime in a political contest in which every other candidate seeks non-stop to raise scandalous amounts of money, Daley propelled himself into the top three.

Our guess is that every other candidate mumbles to himself "Why didn't I think to make that suggestion." We think barring change, the three finalists will be Citizen Mendoza, Toni Preckwinkle, and Daley. We will destroy our haruspex if foregoing prediction is in error.

Tragically, Republicans didn't persuade Chris Kennedy to run as a Republican. So the outcome of the mayoral election is that the Democrat nominee will be elected almost by acclamation.

Roscoe's Journal — Part 023

2019

52 COLUMNS

January 3, 2019

"Neither snow nor rain nor heat nor gloom of nights stays these couriers from the swift completion of their appointed rounds"

xxx

Above is a slogan of the Persians in one of their wars with the Greeks 500 B.C.. Scholarly U.S. Postal authorities permitted to be placed in stone in the NYC Post Office more than 100 years ago. Though never formally adopted as the slogan of the postal service in the U.S.A. it has served as the de facto slogan until a few years back

xxx

We invite the Postal Service to return to that slogan. Perhaps being presumptuous, but we re-urge all U.S. Postal personnel to adopt those proud words as their 2019 New Year's Resolution.

xxx

The Press office workers have adopted a New Year's Resolution to work on regular days, regardless of adjacent holidays.

xxx

The Press receives too many complaints from Press subscribers that their issue is received as much as three weeks late. Our subscribers deserve more dedication from those public employees who load the trucks or fill the pouches.

xxx

The Press' prediction that now Senator Mitt Romney, R, Utah would immediately become the likely U.S. Republican candidate for President in 2020 is well underway. No sooner had Romney taken his Senate seat than the Washington Post published his op-ed criticizing Trump.

xxx

Though Romney's criticism was deserved, national well being requires effort by all to avoid controversy. But in the leadership and the Nation, first step for such should be the dismissal of Robert Mueller. His badgering of the President for two years should not be permitted to continue

and tarnish the remaining two years.

xxx

We'll be able to see whether the Democrat leadership in the House of Representatives agrees with the Press' opinion that Romney is the de facto Republican leader by launching a critical barrage against Romney.

xxx

We were surprised that Nancy Pelosi, 79 in March could cajole a majority of her Democratic colleagues to support her for the House leadership. We fear that this means continuing partisan struggle.

xxx

Let's all rally behind the flag

[Transcriber's note: the final item ends mid-sentence at the bottom of the column box — "flag" is the last word printed; no continuation found elsewhere in the edition. The page-3 dateline of this edition is misprinted "THURSDAY, JANUARY 3, 2018" (should be 2019).]

January 10, 2019

The Statue of Liberty has stood proud in NYC harbor for one hundred and thirty-three years as a beacon of hope in a dark world for millions, "Your huddled masses – yearning to be free."

xxx

Disingenuous that our President would substitute a wall as a symbol for the cradle of Democracy. The whole world would conclude that the USA has become a police state. That simply must not be.

xxx

When Candidate Trump first mentioned building a wall we thought he was jesting. We suspect that initially it was campaign oratory. When that shrewd politician recognized broad appeal he converted it to the purpose of his administration.

xxx

We can't have it both ways: Ridicule the Russians for building a wall to keep the Germans in Berlin, and then copy such game plan to keep impoverished groups from seeking a better life in America.

xxx

A motley group has been traveling across Mexico to our Southern Border for more than a month. Inescapable that some individuals are supplying food and fuel for these refugees. A mob simply can't proceed without support. It would seem the practical way to protect our national security would be to send the Navy SEALs or the Army Rangers to correct these agitators.

xxx

For a fraction of 5 billion dollars we could truck the "invading army" back to Guatemala, Honduras, Haiti, or wherever and stimulate food production and distribution in their native land. That would be far more humanitarian than to erect a wall with the unspoken premise that whoever climbed over the wall would be shot.

xxx

We were troubled by the convoluted reasoning of President Trump in his Tuesday night chat with the American public. It is nonsense for him to say that the money saved by drugs not entering the USA constituted Mexican payments for the wall as he repeatedly promised. Yet that is exactly what he said.

xxx

The public is very gullible and emotional in political motivation; many of President Trump's statements cannot be taken literally as the words chosen are generally understood.

xxx

The time has come that President Trump should publicly announce that he will bow to the will of the American public and waste not a dime of taxpayer money building a wall, whatever texture for no possible benefit to this country.

xxx

We think a tiny portion of the 5 billion dollars saved above should be spent building four lanes for Route 50 from Lawrenceville to I 57 at Salem. We'll publish the reader response, pro and con.

xxx

The partial government shutdown, now in third week may have the unexpected side effect of persuading many Americans that there are too many government employees. The government continues to run smoothly without the 800,000 who have been furloughed.

xxx

Despite our ridicule of Ruth Bader Ginsburg for failure to go to Australia after President Trump's election in 2016, we admire her gritty fight against Pulmonary Cancer. Monday, Justice Ginsburg failed to attend Supreme Court Meeting for the first time in 25 years on the bench. Her office assured the news media that she will read the briefs and participate in the decision when the case is argued before the court. The 85 year old shows marvelous determination to live and make a significant contribution for the benefit of others.

xxx

January 17, 2019

Richard Nixon should be rehabilitated. His religious convictions were so offended when the evidence clearly established that he had been untruthful with the American public in denying existence of tape recording of White House calls that he resigned the Presidency, August 9, 1974.

xxx

Compare how mild his misstep with the gross improprieties of present leaders of both parties. We suggest that the comparison makes Nixon seem almost saintly.

xxx

He did not enrich himself while in office, or thereafter. His small estate was attributable to his writings after he left the White House.

xxx

President Nixon's foresight in going to China, opening trade with that economic giant made Walmart possible.

xxx

By any criterion this nation's well being benefited more from the years of the Nixon presidency than during any post-WWII presidency. The truth has been mangled so much more by the present Republican and Democrat leadership than by Nixon, it makes no sense to continue to treat him as a pariah among American presidents.

xxx

Simple justice, fair play cry out for a restoration of Richard M. Nixon, as a former President of the United States, to be judged on the accomplishments of his years in the Oval Office, as well as his historic, tragic attempt to mislead the American public about the existence of a magnetic tape.

xxx

The Press intends to suggest to Lawrenceville Mayor Don Wagner and the City Council that West Haven Road from the Route 250 Intersection to the entrance of Wal-mart be renamed in Richard Nixon's honor.

xxx

We will print civil response to this suggestion.

Elsewhere in today's issue we comment on the inauguration, January 14 of Governor J.B. Pritzker. We urge all Press readers to write the new governor, express good wishes for the success of his term and request his assistance in the rejuvenation of Lawrence County.

xxx

Not to be an alarmist, but unless effective steps are taken to boost Lawrenceville's population, the 2020 census could confirm total collapse.

xxx

Be assured that the Press will continue to remind Governor Pritzker daily of our community's

need. We do have two problems where His Excellency could be of great help: published list of cell telephone numbers and "January thaw"

xxx

January 24, 2019

The J.B. Pritzker Expressway was slicker than a greased pig Sunday and early Monday. It was a tribute to the added safety of a four-lane highway that there were no reported collisions within the east ten miles of the expressway.

xxx

We were disappointed that the Lawrence County Board of Supervisors rejected the Press suggestion that Route 50 from the state line west to the Richland County line be named in honor of our new Governor. When political office holders reach the height of their ambition it is difficult for them to recognize new ideas or innovations that could bring hope. In this instance, the County Board members were sitting on their brains.

xxx

That Board displayed similar resistance to innovation when it refused to negotiate with Don Jones, and drove him to Vincennes. Tragic that the castle that he remodeled on that city's main street is not located in the County of his birth.

xxx

Matters not. The Governor will note that the Press has renamed that stretch of Route 50 in his honor. He will recall that this historic route from Ocean City, Maryland to Sacramento was the first transcontinental highway in the U.S.A. Prior to the auto, it was the route Buffalo traveled from central Illinois to the salt in the earth in French Lick, IN

xxx

We think that he will also conclude that this Expressway should be made four lanes wide, that it be as elegant as its new namesake.

xxx

We will be appealing to the County Boards in Richland, Clay, Marion to adopt the name change.
We must not give up.

xxx

We were saddened by the death of Charles Carr, Ocean Springs, MS. Charlie was bright, energetic, and a community booster.

xxx

We recalled about sixty years ago when the Nichols Funeral Home, State Street, Lawrenceville burned. Though Charlie was not a member of the Lawrenceville Fire Department, he grabbed a bucket and did more to extinguish the flames than any other. His heroics cost the owners thousands to remove the wreckage charred beyond repair. His determination was inspirational.

xxx

He called us six months ago, said that he planned to come back to the "City I Love", soon.

xxx

One should not postpone pursuing plans and dreams they have for themselves and those around them.

xxx

January 31, 2019

Humbling but true, America has copied Great Britain in government for hundreds of years, from Jamestown to the present day. Even street riots, called peaceful protests originated in England. They are now more often utilized to in this country, rather than over there.

xxx

We wonder why there has been no public protest, to fill the streets of London, at the historic wrong which is being inflicted now on Camellia, wife of Prince Charles. For fifty years, that determined lady has striven mightily to one day wear the tiara and sit next to the reigning monarch. Princess Diana's tragic death in the Parisian automobile accident in 1996 reawakened public awareness that Camellia had ruthlessly taken Prince Charles from Diana.

xxx

Though not as omnipotent as in 1946 when it decreed that Wallis Warfield Simpson must never sit on the English throne with Edward VIII, the Church of England again raised its objection to Camellia's prior marriage and her competitive spirit in matters matrimonial.

xxx

The royalty and the power brokers hoped that the matter would resolve itself without a governmental crisis to force Prince Charles to renounce his right of succession. Happily Queen Elizabeth II, now 92 continues to reign with some skill. Though she has surpassed the record of her great great grandmother in longevity of reign, 64 years, Elizabeth gives no indication of intent to abdicate.

xxx

Would seem clear that Camellia will never permit Charles to make the mistake that his uncle Edward VIII made in 1936.

xxx

We believe she would have treasured a video of "Wally" Simpson berating her soon-to-be husband after he gave up the throne and sped to France to marry the woman he loved. His was a tragedy of judgment, the lady loved her poodles more than him, it was the throne that she coveted.

xxx

Would appear that the constitutional question of right of succession will occur within the next few years. If 70 year old Charles outlives his mother, we're betting that Camellia will win the prize of being the queen of England, a well deserved reward for a lifetime of effort.

xxx

God save Prince Charles and Queen Camellia.

February 7, 2019

Religion is mankind's greatest involvement with no tangible proof of ultimate reward for faithful compliance with its assumed direction. Any other contractual relationship with the other party responding only with, "trust me", would be laughable.

xxx

Notwithstanding above limitation religion has dominated humanity for thousands of years. During the past century its hold on the mind of men has diminished greatly.

xxx

Eighty years ago it was unthinkable that a candidate for public office omit his religious affiliation from his campaign literature. Rarely does a candidate now disclose to the voters where he goes to church, or whether he ever attends. When Dwight Eisenhower was elected President, he bought a Homburg and publicly worshiped in a local church in D.C.. We believe Donald Trump would need a guide to find a church near his residence.

xxx

Jimmy Carter was the most openly religious President. Sadly, God "Standing in the Shadows Keeping Watch Upon His Own" did not make that believer's single term popular with his constituents. Carter's rank in the hearts of men has been enhanced post White House years by his tireless hands on carpentry for the poor and the handicapped.

xxx

Religion's place in the scheme of things was underscored by Sunday's church attendance. More Americans watched the Super Bowl than went to church.

xxx

In spite of the grim decline of Religion's hold on mankind, it will endure. There is no alternative. Sunday School creates believers who will never abandon their faith.

xxx

"Surely not in vain my substance from the common Earth was ta'en, to be broke and trampled

back to senseless Earth again." Though Genesis is difficult to defend in literal translation the bottom line remains there is no other source for the commencement of human life on Earth than a supernatural power.

xxx

We hope to see you at First Christian, Sunday..

xxx

Lawrence County Board of Review, composed of Bonnie Hann, Steve Cavender and Jerome Pacholski must not impede Lawrence County's renaissance.

xxx

The board has foolishly continued to raise its gross value of dwellings throughout the county until the top is now \$420,000 for a house in Sumner.

xxx

We think present top is too high. Recognizing that reducing such valuation ceiling is not going to happen we plead with the board to assess no new single dwelling construction for more than that amount even if the builders spend twice such figure.

xxx

Linda Grove and Kerry Wagner sold farmland and scraped up money in all directions to construct a mansion just off the eighth hole at the Lawrence County Country Club. With a couple of detour signs on route 50 travelers from afar would see their mansion. They expended far in excess of \$420,000 to glorify Lawrenceville and Lawrence County. It will be a terrible financial loss to them if ungrateful board of review continues to raise assessed value of residents for whom purchasers are rare.

xxx

The Effingham Board of Review made possible three jewels by taking into account how scarce would be purchasers if sold.

xxx

If the board is unwilling to face reality and votes against future mansions to advertise our city, they are in effect voting for more trailer parks and no more reckless public benefactors. If that be their decision, The Board of Review should resign en masse

xxx

February 14, 2019

As we approach the end of the trail, we pause to remember the triumphs and the disaster enjoyed over an eventful lifetime.

xxx

Except for dear Kay and our family, our greatest joy has been Lawrence County Golden Age Club #1. From January 1, 1958 to January 1, 1998 numerous compassionate older Lawrence Countians enriched our life, and we theirs. Except for the government involvement in the problems of senior citizens, with the meals attached thereto, we would still be sponsoring and working with Lawrence County's finest. Every meeting, and especially every summer trip was a memorable delight.

xxx

Our years in public office we were also joyful. Wistfully we remember moments that we could have done more to benefit our constituents. Strange it seems politics have always been an inspiration to us to try to make a difference for the benefit of all that we would serve. We enjoyed going door to door to ask the voter for his support. Enjoyable except for the dog bites, even when the one solicited said, "we'll think about it". That phrase meant that they would usually vote against us.

xxx

We are grateful to everyone along the line, from Sumner public schools, University of Illinois, and the precincts from constituencies from as large as thirteen counties for their encouragement and support.

xxx

Of disasters - the Republican primary for Congressional Candidate, 1978 terminated our political career. An effeminate governor James R Thompson sent a flunky to us seated on the House Floor

to persuade us to run for the U.S. Congressional seat. We would need to give up assured reelection to the Illinois House. Thompson's support would make the primary struggle with a photogenic dentist and a moneyed playboy a predictable win. Shortly after the campaign began, Thompson declared his neutrality in the race. Kay and I tried desperately to pull off a win but the votes were all in the north part of the district. The dentist won. He was elected to Congress. Within five years he cried on the floor of the Congress as he admitted sexual conduct with an underage page. He was replaced by a Democrat at the next election. Television has made elections beauty contests. Candidate's track record and character qualifications are of little concern in the voter's selection.

xxx

For more than forty years we have successfully practiced law in the country. It was more financial rewarding but far less exciting than public service. Of Thompson, few remember his name or that he was the longest serving Governor of Illinois. We thought him greatly overrated. We were in the Governor's mansion on an evening in 1977 when someone brought in a Time magazine that mentioned twice that Thompson might be a future presidential candidate. He was childlike in learning of that evaluation. His ability falls far short of the demands of that office. We thought it fatuous that the handsome State of Illinois Building in Chicago was named the James R. Thompson center. Hopefully that mark against the building will be removed when it is sold within the next couple of years for monies to be applied to the Illinois debt. Both Governors Blagojevich and Rauner have proposed sale of the center. We think Governor Pritzker will seek sale of this valuable ornament for obtainable price of more than 300 million dollars. The bitter memory of James R. Thompson will be erased.

xxx

We have warmed our hands at the hearth of life. It stinks but we are not ready to depart. We seek ways to polish our record and to enrich the lives of others making life's journey.

February 21, 2019

We write of a subject where angels fear to tread, of changing family life-styles, including the latest cohabitation without marriage. During its first 100 years, and a bit longer, Illinois required the family center be bound by a marriage, usually involving the church. Criminal laws required the participants of each marriage be of same color, race, of opposite gender, meet certain age limits and without other marriages simultaneously coexisting. One state, Nevada saw a business opportunity in the regulating of marriages--easier divorce. Trip to Reno and short residence there became a cottage industry. Common sense prevailed, our legislators loosened the requirements for a legal divorce in Illinois, as did many other states. Makes no sense that two individuals with

great mutual animosity are locked together for life, nor does anything in the Bible require such impasse. We would note that based on 80 years of observation there never was a purely amicable divorce. The scars, bitter memories and pain remain, with rare affection of either partner for the former.

Why the church had a monopoly on marriages from earliest times is unclear. We think it demonstrable that church weddings are happier, last longer and result in better family development.

Of recent years there has been a growing tendency of men and women to reside together without any marriage contract written, recorded in a courthouse or elsewhere. No longer is such arrangement scandalous, or punishable as a crime. It is widely tolerated. We are curious whether a majority of such informal arrangements will celebrate a Golden Anniversary, or even Silver.

There are serious questions. Present laws are intentionally drawn to protect the legalized marriage. One who cohabits with another runs a risk of financial loss in that neither party has a defined duty to support, and care for the other in times of sickness or disability. That omission of protection may be of little value if each party is capable of earning own livelihood. That condition of wellbeing is seldom found. The statute will need to be changed for the legal definition of spouse to include "close friend." Otherwise, in event of death the intestate statute (the law by which property of decedents is distributed where there is no will) will inflict great harm to the unprepared.

There never was a traditional marriage in which there was no quarrel, but the parties resided to stay together assuming happy days would return again. We fear that without the binding effect of a marriage license, quarrels of any significance will terminate most relationships which have no recorded marriage.

Another problem of skipping a recorded ceremony, religious or civil, is the children born to either or both of the parties. Without great effort by both the new and old parents, child run large risk of being emotional orphans.

Genealogist's work will be never ending.

One group benefits immediately from the lack of marriage license--same gender unions. Another group that will benefit from the change is the legal profession, each party to this union will need to regularly consult a lawyer to be adequately protected especially if property or children are involved. Likewise, lawyers examining titled real estate will need to redouble their search for other claimants.

For the concerns enumerated, and our age bracket we believe society's best interests are better served by a formal church wedding with all of the pomp and ceremony the parties can afford, including rice, released butterflies, and reception following with tasty refreshments.

We pray that our reservations are disproved by happy time together of informal couples.

February 28, 2019

When the Greeks created the concept of democracy they envisioned decision by actual headcount. This was feasible only for small compact units. Time and expense to have a total headcount in the USA prohibited pure democracy.

Our wise forefathers substituted representative government. Their substitution has worked well for almost 150 years. In recent years, it has become apparent that if the voice of every concerned citizen is to be heard, modifications to the system must be made. Some have observed that with the marvelous strides in electronic tabulation it would now be easy to have an actual headcount nationwide, like the Greeks intended for their new concept of government.

At the risk of being heretical we suggest that a full headcount via an electronic vote by every adult citizen would be a national disaster. A sizable portion of our population, sometimes as much as fifty percent, fails to vote in an election. Many of those failing to meet their civic responsibility are uninformed of the issues and unconcerned with the ultimate decision. To make those who are ignorant and irresponsible decisive in governmental decisions would be to court disaster.

We believe that eligibility to participate in the present system of representative government should be tightened a bit. While literacy tests have been outlawed as a concealed effort by their proponents to disenfranchise voters whose input is needed, we think there is more merit in literacy tests if honestly administered than criticisms.

Recent elections at state and federal levels have become such expensive projects only the wealthy can participate with any likelihood of success. We do not believe government financing campaigns is the answer, but there must be some restriction on the the amount each candidate can expend. Otherwise, we will be ruled by the billionaires without exception.

The news media has made extremely rich candidates the more powerful. A fairer test of every candidate's claim for your vote would be the consideration of the income tax paid by each candidate. We suspect that the extremely wealthy candidate paid proportionately far less income tax over the last few years than the less affluent candidate. They maximize the loopholes to escape civic duty.

If democracy is to fulfill its promise of electoral utopia there must be strict term limits. We note that Governor Pritzker repeatedly mentioned his support of term limits in the campaign. In his speech to the joint House and Senate, all mention of term limits was omitted.

Not to be unfairly critical of the governor, we thought it immoral to suggest balancing the budget on the backs of the addicts. He would increase the cigarette tax, even the tax on those selling products to get the monkey off the smoker's back. The Governor scraped the barrel for new revenue: he would tax disposable bags from the grocery store.

Perhaps Governor Pritzker should bite the bullet as did President G. H. W. Bush. After his famous pledge at the RNC, Dallas, 1984, "read my lips, no new tax," Bush couldn't keep that pledge, nor can Pritzker without large reduction of state expenditures, including pensions.

March 7, 2019

****Collapse of a Dream****

For more than a century, United Methodist Village was this community's proud symbol of compassion for the elderly and infirm. We were shocked last week when UMV filed for voluntary bankruptcy in the U.S. Court for the Southern District of Illinois. Elsewhere in this week's Press we list UMV's 20 largest unsecured creditors.

Everyone must share responsibility for this disaster. Two groups were the primary cause of a terrible community embarrassment: Illinois Public Health Inspectors and the artisans the home's frightened management employed to comply with the State Inspectors' merciless pursuit.

Greed maybe the most contagious disease that afflicts humans. In this instance, almost every artisan employed, witnessing the outrageous charge for services rendered, followed suit.

It was charged more than the traffic can bear by the doctors, lawyers, accountants, rehabilitation experts, and con men. Their huge charges should be compared with the monetary payment to Dr. Ed and Hellen Fahnestock and Dr. RT Kirkwood. Or the pittance paid Dr. Ernest Dicus, as administrator. His predecessor as administrator at UMV was also a Methodist minister, who served as barber in addition to leading the grateful patients.

The administrator at UMV was demonstrably inadequate. We are told that she insisted that the village hire Dwayne Morris, and that he would bring aboard a Chicago law firm. It was a formula for disaster.

The primary concern of each of these heavy burdens on UMV's back was not patient care, rather it was billable hours. The law firm received \$440,000 over a two year period. Dwayne Morris' connection to the law firm is unknown or what portion thereof he received. His unsecured claim remaining is almost a quarter million. Even the accountants, Kemper Group, got into this financial joyride, receiving over \$115,000 in one year. The administrator, Paula Alford, received almost \$125,000 in the last year and drove away from the tragedy two months ago in her BMW, unindicted.

We wish we could write with any confidence that UMV will emerge from the bankruptcy stronger and finer than ever before. Experience dictates otherwise. The financial hemorrhage against the entire community continues. The Effingham lawyer has been paid \$25,000 in the filing of the 119 page bankruptcy petition and has advised the bankruptcy court that his future charge is \$300/hour. The Vincennes accountant has been recently paid \$15,000 and has advised the bankruptcy court that its charge is almost \$150/hour. It is safely predictable that both will create hundreds of billable hours, perhaps thousands, in the bankruptcy proceeding. Our guess is that the wreckage will be sold at public auction within three years and that Aperion, or other nursing home operator with large legal staff to battle the state regulators, will be a bidder.

Only hope to avoid that sad end is intervention by Governor J.B. Pritzker. He could cause his Department of Public Health Inspectors to assist, rather than terrorize, those attempting to put the dream back together. We fear that it is a waste of time to pray for UMV's revival. Public scorn of all who have profited from this debacle will do more to cause those involved to be more merciful in their charges.

A society that sputters at the suggestion of raising minimum wage from present \$10/hour should consider a maximum limit that any supplier can charge, presently that limit should not be more than \$100/hour nor will the bankruptcy court pay any attention to our suggestion.

Though there is little room for hope in this situation, the community must not despair. We must band together and fight on for a better tomorrow.

We will give thanks to the Almighty when the UMW is again the community's pride and joy.

March 14, 2019

How grand that daylight savings time returned to County Lawrence while we slept in the wee hours of Sunday morning. Daylight after dinner is a dessert.

We are appalled to discover that well organized popular promotions are presently underway in several states to quit observing d.s.t. There was a clever cartoon of an Indian chief holding a blanket labeled "24 hours" and a pair of scissors. Chief's words were, "foolish pale faces think the blanket will be longer by cutting a piece off one end and tying it to the other."

Chief couldn't have been more wrong had he intended, d.s.t. creates the illusion of a longer day.

Thinking citizens of Illinois must band together to prevent loss of d.s.t. to the misguided backward movement of others. Press may launch a drive to extend d.s.t. year round, instead of present termination on the second Sunday in November. Such premature counterattack would save the precious extra daylight time we now have. Enjoy.

Audacity is a quality of conduct that will serve one well, lifetime. It should be taught to children as they leave the cradle with refresher courses along life's path.

Looking back, we realized how fortunate we were to be reared in an enlightened family in the tough east end of Sumner. Audacity was included in our educational curriculum.

40 years ago we were in a hotel in Atlanta when Burt Lence, President Carter's embattled budget director, was holding a news conference. We observed that each male reporter grasped the lapel of his coat, flipped it open and quickly back in position as he marched through the check point.

We duplicated those movements and found ourselves welcomed inside the checkpoint, sans any credential except audacity.

It was delightful. We met the lovely Mrs. Lence. She said, "Burt, I want you to meet Roscoe."

Years earlier, February 1946, the colonel sent us, with trucks, cheap and three soldiers from Salzburg, Austria, to near Bonn, Germany, for steel bed cots for the soldiers in our battalion. We had met a Major Hamm, Luxembourg, at the University of Nancy, France. He mentioned the Nuremberg War Criminal Trials would start shortly, that he would get us in the small courtroom. It seemed the right moment to drive a few unauthorized kilometers for a quick inspection of that historic event.

Hamm had vanished. We chose to march past the armed M.P.'s with other military tribunal officials. Within three minutes we were standing eyeball to eyeball with the seated Herman Goering, Rudolf Hess, Marshal Keitel and the other alleged war criminals. Then, audacity failed us. We didn't ask Goering for his autograph though we were close enough to touch him.

What a souvenir it would have been. Court martial would have surely followed, "conduct unbecoming an American officer." If we had had a smart phone with us, we would have made an instant "selfie". It would have been priceless, and probably defensible as meaning, subservient vanquished.

Now I realize that the phone was unborn at time. That marvelous It opens the world for audacity unlim[ited] [column truncated at box edge]

March 21, 2019

Public opinion polls indicate that a black lesbian will be elected mayor of Chicago twelve days hence. Fifty years ago it would have been impossible for one of that lifestyle to be elected. Indeed, eight months ago Lori Lightfoot was almost alone in her belief that she could be elected mayor of Chicago.

There's a wide difference between tolerance and admiration of the lifestyle involved. To use an old alibi, two of our cherished friends are lesbian. We never dreamed that either, though qualified and accomplished, could scale the heights of civic responsibility. Nor did any reader of this column.

If predicted election occurs, it will represent another serious instance in which churches failed to rally to defend the Bible. We assume those who believe the Bible no way involved because its reverence is to marriage, has nothing to do with politics. The defense may be valid but there is some point at which every church must defend the literal wording of the Bible or it will become no more relevant as a guide to life than a history book.

The geologists and anthropologists have shredded a literal interpretation of Genesis. The cornerstone of our faith needs defenders. Every church in the land should enlist.

The Bible's condemnation of gambling is unequivocal. That addictive sport is the cornerstone of increased revenue sought in Illinois to finance government. Likewise, mind destructive drugs, including marijuana, are viewed by our political masters as sources of revenue for our state's cash deficit.

A moralist in the Illinois legislature remarked that society was fortunate no one had alerted our state's leaders to the large profits available through operation of houses of prostitution. He was immediately ousted from office without palpable church support of his stand for traditional moral behavior.

Back to the Chicago mayoral race. Lori Lightfoot wins the approval of most discerning citizens for her candor about her lifestyle. What is surprising is that she has been able to effectively muzzle Toni Preckwinkle from public discussion. The voters should have a full discussion as to what impact one's lifestyle should have in their selection.

Without offering our opinion as to which candidate would be the better mayor for Chicago, we do suggest that if Lightfoot be the majority choice she place her hand on the Chicago city ordinances, rather than the Bible, at the swearing in ceremony in May.

March 28, 2019

Long ago, a proud nation saluted its heroes with a ticker-tape parade through Wall Street and the tall canyons of lower Manhattan. They were happy historical events that included Charles A. Linberg, Dwight D. Eisenhower, and many more distinguished citizens. The NYC street and alley people gathered paper by the ton.

We assume that unique salute to our national heroes is no longer available. Ticker-tape has become as obsolete as the village blacksmith.

Grudgingly, we acknowledge that its replacement, the computer, is worth the loss of that remembered ingredient of the heroes' parades. It is a boon to mankind. The computer has captured the total imagination of every user under 50 years of age, and many older. The range of questions it can answer simply from a voice inquiry is astounding. It can even translate the inquiry, and answer in a foreign language if desired, cause it to circle the Earth in seconds.

Danger is that it has become the alternate mind for those most prone to its use. We shutter to contemplate the panic that must ensue if there were a power shortage, even for a few hours. Perhaps there's an alternate power supply, hidden batteries unknown to us.

It is inadequate to describe the Alexa, or whatever brand you have in your home, as omniscient. Its knowledge and its ability to perform on command are so total one invariably wonders if a live person is hidden somewhere responding in seconds to every inquiry of every hour.

The computer has a spiritual power. It's possible that one day its users may speak directly with God. The demand for the password will be total.

American tax payers have held their breath for almost two years waiting for the Mueller Report. It arrived last Friday. Should anger every tax payer in the land that his hard earned cash ransom paid to the government was thus wasted to furnish employment for hundreds of lawyers.

Robert Mueller was appointed, June 2017 to investigate charge lead by House Speaker Nancy Pelosi and Senate Leader Charles Schumer that Donald Trump, candidate for president in 2016 presidential election colluded with the Russian government. Mueller found that no collusion by Trump occurred. Period.

Shameless Pelosi and Schumer hid behind fact that Mueller's investigation was involved in convicting a half dozen high government officials of various crimes, often income tax violations, as though that the issue justified the attempted derailment of Trump's presidency.

Thoughtful citizens will know that there are so many "Thou shall not's" in the federal criminal code that few can avoid conviction if targeted. One of the charges for which Governor George Ryan went to prison was that he hired his teenage daughter as a page on the House floor. Most of the House and Senate members could be convicted of the same offense if a vengeful government decided to wreck havoc on decency and living together in mutual trust.

Democracy is a farce when it can be so easily turned on its head. The tax payers need to rise in righteous wrath next year and send the Pelosis, Schumers, and their ilk into retirement.

Even better, would be short term limits for every elected official, applied retroactively. Just as presidents cannot seek three terms, senators should serve no more than 12 years and legislators no more than 8.

The Chicago mayor's race has become a runaway. Our prior predictions that Mendoza, then Preckwinkle would succeed Mayor Rahm Emanuel look ill informed. Easy winner is Lightfoot. We hope she can get Chicago and Illinois back on track.

April 4, 2019

World War III is well underway. It has the same principle combatants as World Wars I and II—Germany versus Great Britain.

Obviously, this War is different than the other two, but for the same purpose: to determine which

of these proud nations will control Europe. Front runner at present is Germany. Combined with 28 other European nations, including United Kingdom, about 20 years ago. Germany's domination of the European Union is total, recognized by all, including Great Britain.

Slightly more than half of the British people simply cannot accept that state of affairs. So, they caused an election to be held three years ago on the question of whether Britain should leave the European Union.

Without regard to the disaster the separation would cause to the British economy, the proponents of severing the ties with the European Union won the election by a very slender majority. British Prime Minister Theresa May initially undertook negotiations with EU to agree on the terms of the separation.

Curiously, Germany was led by a tough lady politician, Chancellor Angela Merkel. After endless debate an agreement was reached called Brexit which defines rights and duties of both parties to go alone into the future.

Alas, Parliamentary approval was required for Britain to accept Brexit. At least half of the Brits opposed because they wanted the agreement create a loophole for human traffic between Northern Ireland and the Irish Free State.

Three separate motions to approve Brexit were defeated in Parliament. The normal procedure would have been for Theresa May to resign as Prime Minister but after first rejection because her government had censored the motion. She did not resign because there was no Churchill waiting in the wings to rescue Britain from perceived German domination.

Yet mimicking World War III only power on Earth that can rescue the stubborn British from dreaded surrender to Germany control is the USA. There is no support in this country to make the American tax payer the guarantor of the British economy unless the British became the 51st state.

The European Union leadership has graciously extended until April 12 the deadline for Britain to approve Brexit, or leave the Union without any agreement as to the rights of the British and their endangered industry.

We think the British will cave in, humbly withdraw their decision to leave the European Union and accept the German leadership of World power. That World War II not have been totally in vain for Great Britain, it might seek to become our 51st state. The next few days will be filled with historic decision.

Unrelated to the above is the fast approaching struggle for the Democratic Presidential nomination in the 2020 election. Apparently there will be as many as a dozen seeking to dethrone Donald Trump, including "Pocahontas", Bernie Sanders, Congresswomen Harris, Mayor Booker, a former Kansas governor, a congressman from Oregon, former Vice-President Biden and probably Hilary. An exciting firecracker joined that crew last week, Texas Congressman Beto O'Rourke. His speaking style reminds one of Adolph Hitler, controlled by hysteria. He claims to shout out words placed in his mouth by some supernatural power.

Above crew guarantees great public entertainment for the coming next year, commencing with first televised debate in early summer.

Stay tuned.

April 11, 2019

"Saturday Night Live" should be entitled "Sick Humor" the wide popularity of that television show is indicative of the great need of many Americans for psychiatric help. Common sense compels conclusion that constant ridicule of the national leadership, regardless of political label, is not in that nation's well being.

We would hope and pray that the Great Healer would heal all who suffer from this madness. Perhaps Ephesians 4:8 is the Great Healer's response to the insatiable public need. But it has proven abysmally inadequate.

Our leaders should strive here to create a sense of responsibility in the heart and mind of every American. Freedom of the Press is sacred cow for most editors, leaders, executives, officers and judiciary. A majority of each of these groups would resist any effort to criminally forbid such national self-protection.

It would appear that mankind's best antidote to "Saturday Night Live" and comparable productions is an aspiring effort to persuade every citizen to support the leadership of his land, and ignore the unprincipled hucksters who appear determined to destroy.

While we have directed our criticism at SNL, the news media has been at times as irresponsible. There is no reasonable explanation in truth why the news as reported by CNN has a totally different slant than that same news reported by Fox.

Together let us seek the [illegible] better serve the [illegible].

The Press begged Governor Pritzker to urge Boeing to send experts to George Field to evaluate

Mid-America's trustee offer of free storage place for the grounded super planes.

We hope the the governor realizes how desperate the economic malaise in Southeastern Illinois and seizes the opportunity to strike an effective lick for the area's rebirth.

Press salutes the trustees of Mid-America for their initiative in this matter and airport manager Curtis Shwartz. The trustees are: Diana Ferrel, John Bobe, Richard Gardner, Garry Hall, Charles Gillespie, Allen Large, Greg Schmidtknecht, and David Whitson.

April 18, 2019

It is nostalgic nonsense to believe that the "good 'ol days" were in the past.

How difficult was life before indoor plumbing. Many remember how unbearable summer heat before air conditioning, and how cold the winter when homes were heated by a potbellied stove or fire place.

Fine food aficionados searched for skilled artisans who baked tasty angel food cake made from scratch. With ready mix, that delicacy is now a snap.

Before electronic wizardry, human communication was primarily word of mouth at short distance, or a telephone line often down or occupied by others.

Instantaneous detailed research of any question imaginable was unheard of twenty years ago.

Medicine and science have extended human life. The average is now far in excess of the Biblical "three score years and ten." No longer must mankind live and die within a few miles of their place of birth. Now, the entire world is within the reach of every ambitious and determined citizen.

The good 'ol days are now. Enjoy them.

We are impatient for the Democratic Presidential candidate selection process to commence. Believe first televised debate of that circus will be in June. Those hopefuls who believe they can defeat Donald Trump November 3, 2020, is staggering. Newest edition to that motley crew is "Mayor Pete" of South Bend, Indiana. He has startled the handicappers by the amount of money his oratory causes new supports to send for the battle of television ads that will come soon.

Surprisingly, former VP Joseph Biden and Senator Bernie Sanders each appears to have faded even before the race commenced. Common sense has persuaded too many that 78 and 79 years, respectively, is too old to lead the troops.

Though the Press is opposed to sanctuary cities (willful disobedience of federal statutes on immigration), it will urge that one of the cities in Lawrence County become sanctuary to receive a few hundred of President Trump's promised gift to those cities. We simply must find a way to boost Lawrence County population. If a reader has more reputable pathway to numerical growth, let's hear it.

April 25, 2019

Last week, human embryo scientists at Yale University, headed by Dr. Nenad Sestan, injected portion of the brain of dead pig with blood-like substance and various nutrients. Color change indicated life restored in such brain.

Recited experiment was reported in Nature, a scientific magazine, and was appropriate for Easter

week.

We were astonished that Dr. Sestan while reporting such experiment quickly added that if activity in the brain had been strong, indicating some degree of consciousness, "we would have immediately pulled the plug on the experiment because there is no Canon of Ethics as to the rights and duties of whatever creation emerged."

The doctor's quoted statement is incredible, can't be truthful. He and team would have been instantly world acclaimed had the brain tissue commenced activity that if properly fed would grow into some live animal.

While science continues to fertilize a human donor egg with a donor sperm, in vitro, and place same in a host womb for nine months gestation, and a normal baby emerges, that miracle is far short of the doctor's possible resurrection of the pig.

The human implication of this study is obvious. We hope that it continues, and that the Canon of Ethics be enacted today.

One would have thought that the Muller report finding of no collusion between President Trump election and the Russians would have stilled Democrat determination to impeach Trump. Quite the contrary. Trump hating Democrats in Congress and in the news media appear more determined than ever to impeach the president.

It is a sad day for democracy in the USA. Happily, his enemies' fixation with his impeachment is bringing him votes every day and augurs well for his reelection in 2020.

Of more concern to the citizens of Lawrence County should be the need for business/job revival in our county. Now that the nonsense of spending billions on a wall for the Mexican border has subsided, we must each push harder to persuade four lanes for the J.B. Pritzker Expressway, from Lawrenceville to Salem.

Governor J.B. Pritzker, Springfield, IL,
We hope the new district engineer for District 7, Tom Kreke, is sympathetic to Lawrence County's need for four lanes on the highway named in your honor.
With best wishes, *The Sumner Press.*

State Representative Chris Miller and State Representative Darren Bailey, Lawrence County voters will forgive you for your self-advertisement through co-sponsorship of the silly Detachment from Chicago Resolution, if you'll push harder for four lanes for 50.
With best wishes, *The Sumner Press*

May 2, 2019

Government by Public Opinion Polls

The late Joseph Stalin ranks among the top in murders, tyrants against his own people. During his 31 year reign 1922- 53 he was responsible for the murder of millions. Particularly savage was his enslavement of the Ukrainians, forcing starving farmers to produce the grain for all of Russia.

After Providence mercifully removed him from this Earth by paralytic stroke, public opinion polls of relieved Russians revealed that his approval rating was far below 50% . It continued to sink each decade that followed until recently. Latest public opinion poll from the Russians thought reliable reveals that 70% of all of those strange people believed that he was a patriot, good for the country!

Simultaneous polls reveal that the approval rating of the present dictator of Russia, Vladimir Putin has fallen greatly within the year. The experts believe that the disapproval of Putin's reign caused Stalin's rehabilitation as a folk hero by comparison.

One would assume that Putin's fall from exalted favor of his subjects was caused by his continuous game of chicken with the Western powers and the U.S.A. over possible nuclear war.

The experts believe that the ongoing international threat has little effect on how his subjects view Putin and that his present low approval rate was caused by his sponsorship of laws to raise the age for retirement benefits of most Russian workers.

How droll that the economic factor of the addition of a few additional years of work for eligibility for retirement pension benefits could so dramatically lower so many workers' opinion of the national leadership. How fickle the approval/disapproval rating of an unsophisticated electorate.

Happily, for Dictator Vladimir Putin, constituents disapproval has minimal effect on his tenured power. He has iron fisted control of the army and the government apparatus. He will continue in power as long as he retains their control, or goes to meet his Maker when he reaches the same age of Stalin in eight years.

In the democracies of the world, public opinion polls are far more effective in determination of national leadership. The U.S.A. and other true democracies must do more through education to keep their citizens advised of government problems and proposed solutions thereto.

We are grateful and encouraged for the competition among the various public opinion pollsters. That competition plus education is the U.S.A.'s best chance to maintain the freedom loving

government we enjoy as this nation leads the lesser countries worldwide into the sunlight of individual liberty.

May 9, 2019

"The best horse didn't win the Kentucky Derby," President Donald Trump's tweet was correct. No amount of sophistry can change the fact that Maximum Security did not touch or Illegally crowd Country House during the final furlough.

xxx

Country House's jockey, claimed foul, because War of Will (#18) crowded his mount (#21) on theory that Maximum Security (#7) caused the observed contact by (# 18).

xxx

That the racing stewards would accept that argument is incredible. We think that if their ruling is tested in court, it will be reversed.

xxx

Stewards justify strictness of their application of the rule that each horse must remain in his own lane until it can move into another lane without hindering other horse. On theory of safety for the horses and the riders. In this instance Maximum Security apparently swerved sideways to avoid a mud hole. We believe that he, and the other horses know the fatal consequences to most race horses who suffer broken leg on track. Their whinny is heard no more.

xxx

In effect the stewards are holding that Maximum Security had an absolute duty to risk his life by placing his hoof in a mud hole in opposition to his instinct for self preservation. There is no moral justification for placing such responsibility on man or beast.

xxx

The momentary congestion of horses. which bore no sustainable relation to Country Houses second place finish. Must not negate the fact that #21 had a clear an unimpeded opportunity to overtake #7 and failed.

We would be more comfortable with the stewards decision except for the fact that Twin Towers, published by Church Hill Downs gambling side estimated that the payout had Maximum Security victory stood at 42 million dollars. The payout to those betting on Country House may have reached 32 million.

xxx

The Chicago owners of Churchill Downs saved 10 million dollars from the stewards decision.

xxx

We are proud that The Press picked Maximum Security to win 3 weeks ago, long before he became the bettors favorite. Loyalty to The Sumner Correctional Facility was a factor in that prediction. Your newspaper will continue to strive to benefit its readers.

xxx

Unrelated to above, we were surprised that serious suggestion had been made that Paris' repaired Notre Dame leave the burned out tower for future generations to view and wonder.

We thought of the Coliseum, a symbol of Rome for hundreds of years.

Would it not have been a worthwhile signal of Italian energy and determination if Benito Mussolini at the height of his power had a national movement to restore the Coliseum to the grandeur that it was Rome

[column ends here mid-sentence as printed; no continuation found elsewhere in the edition]

May 16, 2019

A dear friend, Elaine Jones, a former Birds resident, died Monday. Graveside interment at the Jones cemetery, Crawford County, will probably be tomorrow. Goodwine Funeral Home will be in charge.

Elaine's burial will probably be sparsely attended. God willing, another long time friend of her's, Becky Devin, and I will be there. She outlived her other friends and has no near next-of-kin. She was a very special person, caregiver to her late parents and a handicapped sister. She was almost

alone in the world, yet remained cheerful and up beat.

Our association with the family commenced long ago. We will cherish always the Christmas candy she made for us in numerous years. When I see her smiling countenance in my mind's eye I think always of a misadventure shared with her late father Casey Jones.

Casey and I were members of the Lawrence County Shrine Club about 50 years ago. We were responsible for cooking the ham and beans on one of those memorable courthouse square celebrations. The ham and beans were in the large iron kennel, gas burner beneath was in place. We had no paddle with which to stir the anticipated delicacy for the hungry multitude.

We made a quick trip to Heath's appliances, formerly Tipsword's, at the Northwest corner of the square and purchased two boat oars.

As we carried this prized equipment back to the kettle on the courthouse lawn, each of us noted how very shiny his paddle and the great gobs of varnish on each.

It occurred to neither of us that the varnish might contaminate the beans.

Business was brisk. We stirred and served. After about 30 minutes, with most of the beans already ladled out, Casey pulled his oar up. We were each astonished to observe that the boiling brew had stripped the oar of all of the varnish and pitted the wood. Quick examination of our oar indicated the same development.

What to do? Though a large helping of varnish was not a prescribed ingredient for a successful ham and bean feast our many costumers were licking their lips in pleased satisfaction from what they just consumed. Casey and I made a mutual vow of silence about the misadventure after announcement that the bean supply had been exhausted.

Had the unsuspecting public been alerted to this unintended development, we believe the Lawrence County Shrine Club would be defending until this day suits for gastronomical disturbances "negligently caused."

Coming excitement: the televised debates among the expected 20 hopefuls for the Democratic presidential nomination. DNC has announced that Miami will be the site of the first debate "in late June." We believe they're going to split the participants into two groups for a more manageable show.

Republican National Comittee should sponsor televised commercials following each candidate forum that the voting public not make snap judgement.

Audi alteram partem.

May 23, 2019

To describe horse racing as a sport is to do vengeance to the human competition originated by the Greeks in the original Olympics. Horse racing as practiced in the USA is merely another tool in mankind's effort to fulfill his insatiable demand to gamble. It is comparable to a deck of cards, or a set of dice.

Maximum Security's owner Gary West withdrew his prize runner from the Preakness apparently in the fear that a defeat would lessen his value as the sire of future big race thoroughbreds. Press thought the Preakness would have offered Maximum Security immediate proof that he is the best

three-year-old in the lane.

Apparently to conceal his unwillingness to risk diminished stud value, West issued a challenge to three other Derby horse owners, including Country House and Warrior that he would give \$5 million of own money to each horse owner if they beat Maximum in a match race.

Always the gambler, as well as a big time philanthropist, Mr. West attached a condition that none of the challenged horse owners could meet: each must bet \$5 million dollars on his horse in proposed match race.

There has been no indication that the stewards decision disqualifying Maximum from his Derby win will be reverse by the higher State Authority. Strangely, no lawsuit to force such reversal now appears likely.

It is incredible that 150,000 gullible Americans will pay through the nose for seats at Churchill Downs next year for another demonstration of PT Barnum's famous dictum, "a fool is born every minute."

We were disappointed that our friend Howard Dennis Cleff was dead and his body cremated four days before we knew that he had died. We thank Michael Cleff and County Clerk Will C. Gibson for the brief obituary published this week of Denny's death.

Our comments are not intended in any manner to be a criticism of his son, Michael Cleff.

The ways of the Almighty are inscrutable. There are no explanations for the pain, suffering and reduced mental capacity most humans endure before they go to meet their Maker.

We believe that every death should have a memorial service even if the deceased did not wish such. Survivors need to consider whether the loved one was in complete control of his mental faculties when he decreed that there be no ceremony to mark his departure.

We further believe that the mandatory memorial service for every deceased should be religious and not a bar room meeting.

Farewell, friend Denny, till we meet again.

May 30, 2019

When the Illinois General Assembly adjourns Friday night, it is assumed that both houses, Representatives and Senators, will have passed and sent to Governor Pritzker for his signature an increase of state gasoline tax of almost 25 cents/gallon, and an increase of state tax on cigarette sales of a \$1/pack. These whopping increases in such basic commodities may require fine tuning from constituents' input during the summer adjournment with further consideration in a predictable special session of the House and Senate in the Fall.

Press believes the gasoline tax although painful, as it is every tax to some degree, is the finest thing that can happen for small communities, under 6,000 in population. It will raise the cost of commuting 60 miles each way to employees at the Sumner Correctional Facility and Toyota. Workers involved will necessarily take another look at the desirability of moving closer to their place of employment. The two businesses named are the mainstays that keep Lawrence County from being a basket case. If their employees lived in either of the municipalities adjacent to their place of employment their transportation expense would be negligible.

Hooray for the gas tax increase. We wish it were double.

There is no such silver lining in the cigarette tax increase. Its unanimous approval among non-smokers reflects the inherent meanness in each of us. We, the non-smokers, rationalize our glee that the cigarette tax is painless in that smoking is nonessential. But this is not true. Long-time smokers can no more quit the habit than can they forgo eating. It is wrong to attempt to balance the budget on the backs of the addicted while smugly telling ourselves that we are trying to help the users to escape the habit.

It is discouraging how little progress toward solving the state's huge financial problems will be made by tomorrow night's adjournment.

It is a given that Illinois sales tax will rise more than two percent, and that even then the budget will be billions of dollars out of balance. The governor is touting the graduated income tax proposal as a cure all. There's that the rich will be saddle with large financial liability and the rest of us will escape unscathed.

Reality is that the graduated income tax cannot become effective until after the 2022 gubernatorial election, assuming that the voters approve the tax in the November 2020 election, and that the Supreme Court will uphold the procedure.

It should be noted that Illinois has \$2 trillion of unfunded debt for future pensions and state obligations. It is mathematical nonsense to argue that the graduated income tax will cause the rich to pay any significant portion of that foreseeable state obligation.

What is desperately needed to bring Illinois finances under control is an increase in years to

qualify for retirement and freeze on COL payments to retirees. Otherwise, the rich will continue to flee Illinois and leave the 'soak the rich' leadership kicking the can down the road.

June 6, 2019

We were surprised that DeWayne Craddock, who murdered 12 of his coworkers at a Virginia Beach municipal building, Friday, was alive after shoot out with police. Various commentators have commended the police for taking Craddock to the hospital where he could expect quality medical attention and despite great effort to preserve his life.

Soft headed response should not be mistaken for Christian charity. We hope that we're not sadistic as we confess that we would have left Craddock on the floor to bleed to death.

What a bummer it would have been if Craddock had survived and was found not guilty by reason of insanity, to spend 40 years on the backs of Virginia tax payers.

This tragedy reenters the question of whether a civilized society can pay the terrible price that gun ownership exacts. There simply is no existing science that would point to the answer that we should sever ourselves from the right to bear arms. The answer is not in the offing.

All Americans should be proud of their President in his trip to England. Matters in front of Queen Elizabeth II. We would have been appalled if he had curtsied, serve his life.

President Trump's feud with London Mayor Khan was obviously planned and skillfully executed. The Mayor sniffed that Trump's comments were un-British. What he meant was they are un-Islamic.

Thank God Trump is pro-American, albeit crude, overbearing and often an inaccurate historian.

It will be interesting to see whether the UK reconsiders Brexit. We think it must either be a part of European Union, or the USA.

Why Trump continues to insult House Speaker Pelosi escapes us. The experts are in agreement that she is the retaining force that prevents debate on a House resolution to impeach him.

We think her a remarkably able 82-year-old politician.

June 13, 2019

We are impressed that former President Jimmy Carter, 94, Plains, has returned to teaching Sunday School class at Maranatha Baptist Church one month after hip surgery. While Carter was too Christian to be a popular president his post-Presidency life since 1980 has been a national inspiration. He built homes tirelessly for the old, poor and lazy.

Only local citizens we know who have attended Carter's church are Steve and Brenda Sawyer, Mt. Carmel. Our recollection is that the teacher was absent the day Sawyer stopped there.

Our efforts to verify Sawyer's visit were thwarted by the omnipresent telephone recorder. Life would be easier if the recorder were banished.

Strangely, a quiet, reliable barometer for determining a county's economic condition is the number of judges and retired judges living in such county. If only one judicial salary, or pension is coming into the county, it is slipping; if two, county is holding its own; if three, county is prospering; if four or more it is boom town.

Crawford County rarely has less than four judicial salaries stimulating its economy. County Lawrence rarely more should strive mightily to increase its present depressed rating.

The Press should sponsor a contest for the best idea to cause strangers to come to County Lawrence.

We believe that an effort should be made to raise the height of Mt. Truxton until its summit looms large against the skyline. Thereafter, footpaths should be created whereby one could climb to the peak and survey the world below.

We have long believed that the Wabash River, at the Port of St. Francisville is the best available natural lure for visitors from afar. Our efforts to get response from Springfield as to the availability of the state boats for dredging river bottoms have been unsuccessful. Notwithstanding, we intend to redouble the Press's push for that initial step. Allies in this cause are welcome.

My favorite toast: Here's to Lincare; without it, I would be elsewhere.

June 20, 2019

In 1949 our late friend John Klingler was an ardent New Dealer, as well as an insurance and fire engine salesman. He would stop late at night at the adjacent garage to philosophize: "You lawyers are all the same, you are members of the nation yet you are union busters."

At that time the Texaco refinery workers union was threatening to strike for more money. John's characterization of lawyers should have been, "Union Restrainers."

Friday AFSCME held picnic and business meeting at RHSP. The Union pamphlets submitted to its members a list of demands to be made upon the public for the workers of Sumner Correction Facility, or strike would follow. These demands include higher wages, pensions and more paid holidays.

In 1919 a union of public employees was declared illegal, Bolshevik, Un-American. The Boston Police struck, public sentiment ran high against the police followed, several deaths. All striking policemen were fired and none rehired. Then Governor of Massachusetts, Cal Coolidge rode to the Presidency on his declaration, "No one has the right to strike against Public Safety." Public employee unions were unacceptable to even such employee benefit inclined Presidents as FDR and JFK. President Clinton permitted their formation. Instantly, AFSCME became the strongest union in the nation. It takes a huge dues bite from its workers' paychecks.

In the early 50's Lawrenceville suffered a community dividing strike of the Texaco workers union. The scars never healed.

At this time, both Lawrenceville and Robinson had refineries. Robinson's Marathon had no union.

After 1985, Lawrenceville had neither a refinery nor an oil workers union. Robinson's Marathon refinery continues to enrich that community.

AFSCME should abandon any thought of strike and join with the Press in the effort to persuade Governor Pritzker to double the size of the Sumner Correction Facility.

We must not repeat the local oil workers tragedy.

Summer arrives tonight. It is the Grandest Season of the Year!

June 27, 2019

The weekend tragedy involving American student at Guadalajara Medical School underscored the terrible unfairness of requiring Fort Smith, Arkansas student to go to crime-ridden Mexico to become a doctor in the USA. We blamed the A.M.A. for the restriction of medical schools in this country to preserve the economic royalist status of its members. We think A.M.A. as shameless as ASFCME.

One can imagine the public outrage if the Illinois Bar Association obtained a law that no new lawyers would be admitted without studying two years in England.

The time is long overdue for the annual output of medical students in Illinois be doubled from present restricted minimum.

One needs to wear a hose in the nose 24/7 to fully appreciate Ameren-CIPS amidst the nightly lighting, thunder and wind storm.

That the reassuring purr of the electric driven compactor continues through these storms without a life threatening outage is welcome beyond words.

Hooray for Ameren-CIPS and their linemen.

We believe that America has the stark choice: accept Iran as a nuclear armed nation within 6 months or launch armed strike to prevent such from happening. As our nation faces so dangerous a threat, it would appear that a moratorium on political name calling by either party should happen. We think the British are clever in formation of Coalition government in times of national peril.

We appreciate our readers' patience in frequent delay of delivery of their copy. We search for print shops weekly in far away places, including Bedford and Bloomington, Indiana, and Henderson, KY. Facebook has made the printed newspaper an endangered species. We think it a historical document worth preservation at whatever cost.

July 4, 2019

Our opinion of the much hyped televised Democrat Presidential candidate debate is: if this is the best they've got, should take another look at Hillary.

We were surprised at the ferocity with which Senator Harris, California, attacked front runner Joseph Biden on his vote against school busing 40 years ago. Seemed too ancient to us to be relevant but obviously caught Biden's attention as he appeared on bended knee soon thereafter before Jesse Jackson's Rainbow Coalition in Chicago and recited his long time dedication to currying black votes. Ms. Harris may have moved herself into the front rank for VP on ticket headed by Biden.

Clever was youthful Congressman Swalwell's assault on Biden's age, "I was a six year old student when Senator Biden came to our class and said, 'time to pass the torch of leadership to a younger generation.'"

To the great relief of both Biden and Bernie Sanders charge of age disqualification appears to have gained no traction. We yet believe it will become a factor in thoughtful voters' choice. On election day Biden will be 78, Sanders 79.

If our late friend and teacher, John McKlefresh were still alive, we would protest that we completed his American History class believing William Henry Harrison was 70 when elected; he was only 68. We always thought SHS infallible.

Most history students would say that Ronald Reagan was the oldest candidate elected President; that distinction belongs to Donald Trump. We believe that he will still have that honor after November 3, 2020.

President Trump's handshake with North Korea's Kim Il Sung over the weekend was a public relations coup which must have left his numerous, noisy critics furious.

We think that that impromptu mini-summit could be significant in maintaining world peace. It did no harm to peaceful coexistence with each of our adversaries.

The Illinois Press Association compiled a clever time table reciting how the Fourth of July was observed in our state from earliest times. We liked it's observation that one of the 13 toasts male celebrants made to each year's observance was to the health and well being of the president--regardless of his political label.

We simply must quit calling the incumbent President foul names, even if he's a different political party than ours.

July 11, 2019

Tragic the number of services that have departed from the city of champions since that title was earned in 1983. No longer do we have a shoe cobbler, clothes dry cleaner, plumber, new car

dealer, maternity ward, refinery, manual arts school, public aid office, gas and electric offices, hearing sight for workman's comp. movie theater, bus stop, or train station; toiled and the prison have struggled mightily to fill the void. Something more must be done immediately to regain our historic roll of area leadership.

We think a solar energy field, 20 acres adjacent \Route 1, where the refinery likely stood would be a splendid symbol that Lawrenceville has risen from the ashes; for a dozen years, Monty McKillip and crew have treated the earth to remove industrial contaminates. Thought they have made great progress, though earth will not yet grow edible corn. We hope that Monty will convince chevron to undertake immediate construction of a solar energy field; His bosses should be reminded that every stockholder in the area has that corporate stock, converted in the area. Texaco merger. For many, it is their life savings. Large government grants are available; Chevron park will be a beacon of light for this deserving community. The curious would come from afar to see the land of the midnight sun.

July 18, 2019

Lawrence County is awash in meth abusers. The stupid appear to have turned to that very destructive drug as some form of escapism from their unhappy life.

The certainty is that unless immediate, effective steps are taken this mind altering phenomena will paralyze the young and the upper class of the entire society.

Sometimes we think that the opium dens that the British and Chinese established in that county 100 years ago might be society's only protection against this growing menace.

Before surrendering to the easy solution of penning the addicts, and supplying them with the drugs they crave, morality requires a further, desperate effort to reform any who are susceptible to rescue. The court system, the prosecution and the police that each are sworn to protect public safety must impose maximum penalty on every drug abuser apprehended.

We believe that the deterrent effect of such harsh policy would bring favorable results immediately. The alternative is a serious lessening of public safety for small communities.

Tragic that Carle Clinic, acclaimed for its expertise has no drug rehabilitation program for Lawrence and Richland counties.

Of course the greatest need of all is a return to moral values inspired by government leadership. It is a waste of time, or prayer, to expect that leadership from the present governor. His choice for the future, as rubber stamped by his control of the General Assembly, is recreational marijuana. His only test appears to be: will this activity bring more revenue for the state?

The experts are almost unanimous that using marijuana often causes the user to abuse stronger drugs, particularly meth.

July 25, 2019

Dear Publisher,

Belatedly, it has been brought to my attention that the publisher of the Sumner Press until recently was unaware that the Press' favorite guest writer (unless, of course, Allen Johnson has a story in the latest Press edition, in which case the favorite becomes "second favorite" guest writer) compiled several stories that first appeared in the Press, added some extra material, provided pictures and other visual stimulation, and offered it as a book.

The Lawrence County Historical Society accepted that challenge, put it's crack publications team to work, and the result is a book named A Little Railroad Saga. The book was presented to the public when the author, John Hamilton, presented an illustrated program for the Society at its regular July 2017 monthly meeting at the History Center in downtown Lawrenceville, the county seat of Lawrence County.

The presentation was wildly received by a near-overflow and near-standing-room-only crowd and the society moved a few books in the process. Hamilton graciously lingered at the end of the presentation and signed copies of any newly purchased books (including the one he authored). The Society financed the book project and enjoys whatever profits might ensue from its continued

over-the-counter and Internet sale [\$10 in person; \$15 by mail].

Due note is made in the book that most of the stellar writing was first published in editions of the Sumner Press, and dates of publication are included.

This gift (and it is a gift since even the author has to purchase copies) should ease somewhat the stress and pain of the Publisher's being left out of the loop as it pertained to A Little Railroad Saga, a book by John Hamilton, favorite Sumner Press guest writer (unless Allen wrote something for the latest edition).

With all the sincerity I could muster in correcting the oversight, I remain,

John R. Hamilton

Favorite Sumner Press Guest Writer

(unless Allen Johnson wrote something for the latest edition)

Dear John,

We have reviewed your "A Little Railroad Saga", and find it splendid. We recommend your book to all Press readers without reservation. We have mailed check to Lawrence County Historical society in payment. We are placing your book in our library, adjacent to thirty books written and published by Allen Johnson.

With personal regard and best wishes,

Roscoe D. Cunningham

August 1, 2019

We erred. Please forgive us. The Democratic Presidential candidate hopefuls' debate in Detroit was this week, Tuesday and Wednesday, rather than last week's Press (matters not except the injury to our determination to be accurate). Tuesday night, the candidates rehashed their concern for immigration, affordable healthcare and giveaway programs which would bankrupt the nation and hasten the socialism which a majority of the candidates appear to seek.

Of greater concern to us personally was an apology that we may have owed to the late Karl Albert, Democratic Congressman from Oklahoma, Speaker of the House of Representatives during the tumultuous period in 1972-74 as the war between President Nixon, Washington Post, New York Times, and most of the Democratic Congressmen waged endlessly.

When Spiro Agnew, the VP, resigned to avoid jail time for corruption and tax evasion, October 10, 1973, Speaker Albert became next in line for the presidency, under the 25th Amendment xx 5 if

Nixon resigned or was removed before a successor VP was appointed by Nixon and approved by both houses of Congress.

In the tumultuous days that followed Agnew's resignation, rumors flew. It was widely reported that Speaker Albert at 5'4" believed himself too short to govern this nation. We were incredulous. Even discussed Albert with our dear late friend Margret Kolter who worked with us him for Marathon at Marshall in the late 1940's. She thought him brilliant.

We thought Albert in over his intellectual depth and unmindful of Napoleon. Researching his memoirs, we discovered that in contradiction of newspaper rumors that he believed himself inadequate were totally false and that he relished the idea of becoming President. He even appointed Ted Sorenson, JFK's brains and speech writer, to draw up a plan for the first days of his office should Nixon be impeached or resign.

After almost 60 days of tense uncertainty, Gerald Ford was confirmed as Vice President on December 7, 1973, and according to the false newspaper accounts the Speaker breathed easier. Richard Nixon, to his eternal credit, spared a confused nation the disgrace of impeachment proceedings for offenses which in retrospect look like poor jokes. Nixon resigned August, 1974. Ford assumed the Presidency until predictably ousted by Jimmy Carter in the 1966 election.

If Albert were alive we would apologize to him for believing the newspapered accounts that his height negated his ability. We would also suggest that he, Sorenson, and others involved in the secret conspiracy might have been prosecuted for treason.

Nixon's impeachment, and that of Bill Clinton were democracy's most disgraceful hours in the USA. We are not a Banana Republic, and must not act as such.

August 8, 2019

Hypocrisy has become a major component in the fine art of American politics. In the two televised debates by candidates seeking the Democratic Presidential nomination in next year's election each of the twenty candidates has railed loudly against the big wicked drug companies and similarly shaped insurance companies. We predict the four mini Presidential nominee hopefuls will similarly denounce big wicked drug and insurance companies, as threats to humanity, when their moment in front of the television camera arrives.

Paradoxically, major advertisers in each of these debates have been the big wicked drug manufacturers and insurers. Does any thoughtful American believe that the CEOs of the drug and insurance companies would spend millions for their own assassination? No! These titans of industry believe the verbal assault against their product is a harmless appeal for audience enlargement, almost entertainment for the viewers. Danger is that the drug company and insurance CEO's have miscalculated and they have overestimated the discernment/IQ of the American voter.

We would wager all we have that every candidate has health insurance and is dependent upon miracle medicines for their lives to continue. It is the ultimate hypocrisy that these candidates thusly believe in the industries they denounce.

Over the weekend there were two terrible mass murders - El Paso, TX and Dayton, Ohio. Thirty lives were lost, many more injured. These tragedies are occurring throughout this nation with increasing frequency and are undeniably the result of the mental illness of the cowards who put on body armor and commence slaughtering other human beings for no logical reason.

Within 24 hours of the Dayton murders three Democratic Presidential Hopefuls: Congressman Beta O'Rourke, TX; Senators Cory Booker, NJ; and Bernie Sanders, N.H. despicably sought political advantage by blaming President Donald Trump for the acknowledged mental illness of Patrick Crusius and Connor Betts. Do they believe that mental illness is a contagious disease? Political expediency shouldn't be substituted for scientific trending in psychiatry.

The three named candidates would stoop so low in this moment of national crisis clearly disqualifies each from ever leading our nation. We think the decent thing for O'Rourke, Booker and Sanders to do is to immediately withdraw from the presidential candidate circus.

Others who should seek immediate retirement are the police responders at the El Paso murders. They should have riddled his miserable body with bullets on the parking lot as he meekly surrendered. We are not sadistic. Brutal summary execution urged is necessary to create a deterrent for future would be mass murderers. Humanity is not well served by spending a year and millions of dollars in courtroom proceedings to determine proper punishment of the El Paso murderer. The future safety of our beloved nation depends upon the courage and willingness of police of the Dayton variety.

We must help God Bless America. He can't do it alone.

August 15, 2019

Early Saturday morning a demented 66-year-old billionaire hanged himself in his cell in the federal jail, Lower Manhattan. Jeffery Epstein had been held in such jail 5 weeks, bail denied. His alleged crime was "sex trafficking of underage females" and asserted related criminal offenses.

The deceased had plead guilty on a negotiated plea 11 years earlier and served a year in a Florida jail, with right to go to his office daily, and pay a relatively small fine.

When a few now middle aged "victims" went public with lurid accounts of their having engaged in sex with numerous prominent men at the direction and command of Epstein and his procurers, one of whom was named Marshall, the national news media went viral. Epstein's alleged misconduct with teenage girls was a top story on the evening newscast for days. He was tried and convicted in the court of public opinion by the self righteous hypocrisy of news networks more

interested in satiating the public thirst for scandal than in the orderly process of criminal prosecution. That the accused came unraveled and destroyed himself was understandable. We liked the news release of one of his high priced lawyers. His withering blast to the newscasters, "Mr. Epstein's blood is on your hands."

Cynics will say the lawyer was merely expressing his disappointment of not earning and receiving a huge fee for his client's defense. We'll give Epstein's lawyer the benefit of the doubt. We think his outrage at news media crucifixion of his client was genuine.

The decedent despaired too easily. Possibilities for his defense were unlimited. Character of the "victims" was evident by the public wail of several that their lifetime injury would have been cured if he had been tried in court, sentenced to jail for the remainder of his life. The law in regard to underage sex trafficking is a remnant from a more moral period in human behavior--when use of mind-altering drugs was a serious criminal offense, and gambling a cardinal sin. Now, Illinois has joined several other states in promoting gambling casinos as a source of revenue for the government's operation. Equally reprehensible has been our state's legalization of marijuana. Experts are many that that "harmless" mind-altering drug will lead its stupid users to even more lethal methamphetamine, opiates and heroin.

Of the future for the alleged victims, it is apparent that their primary concern is greed, the desperate hope for a few of Epstein's millions. We doubt that any of the victims was inexperienced in sexual matters when recruited. We note, hidden in the sensational newscast tidbits the fact that one or more was a hostess in a bar notwithstanding her teenage status. To say that her purity was diminished or her life ruined by encounter with Epstein is nonsense.

If all of these victims would have chosen the world's oldest profession even without the Epstein chapter why should they be enriched in a phony display of claimed public morality?

Final thoughts on the Epstein affair. We have long believed that total confiscation of the property of wealthy defendants makes more economic sense than locking up such animals for years at the tax payer's expense. The convicted would be given a choice--surrender all assets or go to jail for x number of years. Everyone wins, particularly the tax payers. All charged with the safe detention of the troubled Epstein should be severed from the public payroll, without pension.

August 22, 2019

Genteel Republicans offended by President Trump's crudeness should consider the viciousness of the Democrat/Socialist critics. Not even FDR's infamous threat to pack the Supreme Court after it held NRA unconstitutional caused comparable personal criticism of the incumbent president.

Weigh for a moment that hypocrite Bernie Sanders' snarl on national television, "Trump is a psychopathic liar." We think President Trump shows restraint as well as amazing stamina that beneath the bludgeonings and fouls of his opponent his head is unbowed and his determination undiminished.

He lucked out on his debatable tweet to Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu, a scoundrel according to the Israeli top lawyer, when Michigan Congresswoman Rashida Tlaib declined Israel's permission for her to visit her 90-year-old grandmother in occupied West Bank. Refusal of the visa offer, based on human compassion and world wide outrage, unmask the truth--Rashida and Minnesota's Ilhan Omar were interested only in agitating a very delicate problem in Israel, Grandmother was a convenient afterthought. We thought the relationship was fictional, until some sharp tongue elderly Palestinian in the West Bank was interviewed on television and prayed that, "God ruin Trump."

Unfortunately, Trump's tweet/direction to the PM confirmed world wide opinion that Israel is a puppet of the U.S. Without American financial support the Israeli government would collapse in 90 days.

Trump's enemies need to remember that he inherited the problem, President Harry Truman

recognized as a sovereign state the bandits who had seized at gun point Palestinian farmland May 15, 1948. The dispossessed had used their homeland for raising sheep instead of soldiers to fight off the invaders.

What must be done now, if we are to ever have peace with one billion Arabs is to give the two million Palestinians involved a homeland within Israel, even if surrounded by the six million Israelis. Both sides in this titanic struggle were almost reconciled to that common sense solution until Netanyahu alone forbade it.

Let there be peace on the Earth starting with a reconciliation between the tribes of Abraham.

We were startled that the murder of 63 and injuries to hundreds of Shiite Muslims by a crazed Sunni suicide bomber Saturday in Kabul, Afghanistan, was reported as a top news item on our national TV for four hours and thereafter ignored. When the Democratic presidential hopefuls learn of this tragedy they'll blame President Trump for not bringing home the 14,000 American service men who train the Afghan army. Our longest war must continue awhile longer if the world is to be spared terrible internecine slaughter.

August 29, 2019

Just before midnight Wednesday a week ago the thunder and lightning show commenced. It was marvelous; lasted more than the 30 minute standard for man made Fourth of July copy. Angry clouds bounced against each other and emitted tremendous collapse. The lightning was more brilliant than any we had ever seen. It was awesome.

One must live at the end of a 25 foot oxygen hose to fully appreciate the show. There is a matter of major concern, power outages from such spectacles cause immediate serious problem. We listened to the gentle purr of our compactor throughout the show, never doubting that it would continue uninterrupted. In other years, in other places, a power outage of some time would be expected. At the finale, we gave thanks to the brave men and women of Ameren-CIPS. They had performed magnificently, too. We also remembered, with appreciation, the coal miners who dug

the materials that made this most helpful form of energy available on signal.

We note the public retirement of Indianapolis Colts quarterback Andrew Luck. At 29, this Stanford University graduate has suffered numerous, serious personal injuries during his seven year career as a highly paid professional entertainer in a sport based upon its savagery.

Luck realized that the price of anything is the amount of life that must be exchanged for it. He obviously concluded that his salary, though huge, could not restore health, and even life, from injury. The stadium filled with fans wanting blood greeted the retirement announcement with a roaring "boo." A more gracious group would have stood and recited together, "thanks for the memories."

Our so called civilized society needs to reexamine the game of football. No longer can we sniff at the Romans for throwing the Christians to the lions for the entertainment of the Emperor, his cronies and the masses. Too many professional football players are physical wrecks, with lives greatly shortened for having amused the roaring crowd for salaries thought irresistible, even measured against the risk.

Shame on the University of Illinois. Commencing next month it has authorized the sale of beer at football games. Reason given for such unwholesome decision was that only the stimulus of alcohol could boost the attendance at Memorial Stadium. Our personal opinion is that drinking beer is as dangerous to one's health and life as many other forms of addiction. There is an additional moral restraint involved in this instance--the legal age for drinking in Illinois is 21 years. It is simply impossible to card a crowd of thousands clamoring to buy a bottle. We assume a gesture will be made toward the individual carding of every sale. The inescapable result will be a generation of underage drinkers bright enough to be students at a major university. When they observe how totally authority has capitulated, the bright underage drinkers will also become "scoff law."

September 5, 2019

Texas law recognizes the right of every citizen to carry a firearm, open or concealed. As in most states, preliminary requirements for purchase of guns, including assault rifles, is easy and all are sold by Wal-Mart. One can even carry a gun into a church service unless the congregation has adopted a rule of forbidding such display.

Two tragedies last month strongly suggest that the Texas government should take another look at its posture on gun control and its subservience to Wayne LaPierre, CEO and executive vice president of the National Rifle Association. 22 innocent individuals were slain at an El Paso Walmart parking lot early in August. On the last day of the month seven were killed between Odessa and Midland.

This rate of human slaughter of innocents cannot continue. It is an unreasonable interpretation of the Constitutional guarantee of the citizen's "right to bare arms" should apply to machine guns and to person's with demonstrable mental disorder.

All politicians fear the NRA. A few appear to love it. In either event, public safety must be restored in Texas and throughout the U.S.A. It is unacceptable that a Texas State Trooper cannot safely make a traffic stop without having his drawn pistol in hand.

President Trump cites the obvious as he insists that better mental health care is needed. The director of Lawrence County Public Aid 60 years ago, Ruth Garrett, startled our group with the observation that mental health was the greatest health problem confronting our county, and by implication the state. Unfortunately, effective research for it's treatment during the intervening years has been nonexistent.

In addition to the clamp down on gun sales, there must be an all out program to treat every "loner," "road rager," "peculiar," or "suicidally inclined," identified within our midst.

Science has made great strides in the treatment of malignancies within the human body. Now it must cure the minds of those afflicted.

September 12, 2019

Hundreds of years ago the Greeks invented a system for the orderly government of a free people. It was based on the principle that all members are equal and that majority rule in each decision proposed for the group. It was called Democracy, and has swept the world.

There is a side component to Democracy, the workers who beat the bushes and cause the people to participate in this splendid tool of freedom. They are called politicians, in the U.S. and in most countries the number of major parties is limited to two; England, France and Italy often have several. Our interest in politics has been life long. In 1932 we persuaded the students in the fourth grade of Sumner Public schools to vote for Herbert Hoover's reelection. We had an potent ally, our dear teacher the late Imogene Osborne. Sniffed Betty Scaggs, the leader of the Students for FDR for President, "you beat us here, but we beat you uptown where it counts."

In the intervening years a large factor has seized control of the machinery of politics. It is the opinion moulders who under the guise of public opinion poll taking and television ads actually determine the public's will as to who they wish to choose to represent them in the halls of government.

This factor has become so dominate in the scheme of things that Democracy at the present time as practiced in the U.S. A. is a sham. Winner in almost every encounter is the candidate who gets off to an early start and amasses a huge war chest. They bombard would be opponents in the general public with such torrents of confidence that their targets believe that it is futile to resist their election.

How significant the development of a large war chest has become is indicated by the inclusion of a requirement that any democratic hopeful for the Presidential nomination to participate in tonight's Houston televised debate must have raised \$650,000.00 from donors in 20 states, and have a public opinion nationwide poll rating of at least 1%.

Obviously the Greeks did not foresee television and the distortion of public opinion it can cause. Nor did the creators of our forms of election foresee the tremendous advantage of incumbency in public office. Latter will win unless inept or on the wrong side of a landslide.

Another problem that time has uncovered is the need for an impartial truth squad to patently correct dishonest candidate claims. Presently, we have a candidate for State Senator whose slogan on his campaign literature is; "Make Illinois Great Again" Irony of this lift from President Trump's hit phrase - that same candidate is sponsoring a bill to sever Chicago from Illinois! A truth squad must prevent candidates from willfully traveling in opposite directions of his campaign promises.

We suggest that in addition to restraint on the amount of money that any candidate can spend to seek election or re-election, there needs to be a strict rule on term limits.

We are confident with the changes noted democracy will continue to light the path for freedom for mankind far into the future.

The miracle of electronic communication is an accomplished fact. It would be feasible to poll every American Voter on every important issue and receive an immediate tabulation of the collective decision. The original Greek plan for every voter to participate in every decision would be fulfilled. That dream is now within reach. Before this radical change enlarging the Congress from 538 members to 270,000,000, a massive educational effort would be needed. Teaching of Civics as a High School subject would be paramount, and not a mere curriculum filler.

September 19, 2019

Facetiously, we suggested a while ago that we would vote for Andrew Yang for President if we went into the Democrat Primary March 17, 2020. Our implied voting recommendation to our friends in that primary was more prescient than we realized. Andrew Yang is fast becoming the dark horse with the best chance of upsetting Donald Trump in the main bout, November 3, 2020. Some of Yang's opponents in the televised debates snickered when he suggested \$1,000/month for every American over 18 years of age. He called his startling idea Universal Basic Income. His opponents thought UBI so impractical that it was only a joke. Greed caused the rest of us to say we like what this candidate is saying.

In the September 5 debate from Houston, Yang was given less time at the microphone than any of the other nine hopefuls for the Democrat Presidential nomination. In the seconds allotted to him he outthrought and outmaneuvered them all.

On his website he announced a "Freedom Dividend": He will give \$1,000/month for one year to ten families chosen by lottery. To enter such program one only needs to send names, email addresses, and zip code. In fine print, he stated no campaign contributions were required to win.

The response was tremendous – almost half a million potential voters applied for the "Freedom Dividend".

Yang's opponents are apoplectic. Several have claimed that his clever maneuver is illegal. Yang confidently notes, "that if he gave \$120,000 to television advertising or to campaign managers no one would lift an eyebrow. It is better to give the money to the people than to the television stations and campaign managers." There is too much truth in such observation to be ignored. The experts appear divided on legality of The Freedom dividend. The Federal Election Commission lacks full membership and is unable to make a ruling. Andrew Yang has moved from 10th place to 6th in the Democratic Presidential Primary race based on campaign funds raised and poll ratings.

We think Mr. Yang will continue to rise. He has made his opposition look foolish, and made the Press appear wise. A race between Donald J. Trump and Andrew Yang would go down to the wire.

September 26, 2019

Reverend Tom Akers sermon Sunday morning was a careful analysis of one of Jesus' well known parables, the rich man who believed his steward had embezzled, ordered an accounting. Fearing dismissal and the need for future allies the steward attempted to ingratiate himself to his employers tenants by instructing each to reduce amount owed by each to the employer. In the face of this patent dishonesty, Jesus praised the steward for his shrewdness.

Readers of the versus involved, Luke 16: 1-13 are startled by such praise. That the stewards dishonesty is in direct violation of every Christian principle needs no laboring. Then why is it set forth as the inspired word of the Lord?

The Reverend explained that the real purpose of Jesus in this parable is to instruct his disciples that they should rely upon their own ingenuity and resources to resist and overcome challenges and difficult situations.

We found this explanation far from persuasive. Not even our Lord and Master can speak out of both sides of his mouth at the same time.

The conduct of the steward being investigated is simply too violently opposed to every Christian principle to be acceptable as background and support for the hidden meaning which the reverend found.

For what purpose is prayer to escape a problem if the prescribed modus operandi is one's shrewdness alone?

Purposeful people will fit into the scheme of things better if everyone says what he means and means what he says, ever mindful of the fact that there is no substitute for the truth. Nor is "the ends justifies the means" an acceptable defense.

Had we given the sermon we would have said that this parable is a translation error, misprint, or the parable is incomplete. Was the servant dismissed, or reinstated?

Our confidence in Reverend Akers is unshaken.

We are discouraged how many pews at First Christian have no bottoms on them each Sabbath. Even Sundays service which was followed by an advertised reception, had only 50 in attendance. One would have thought the tasty refreshments, coupled with the food for the mind, would have drawn twice that number of worshipers.

We will appear again before the Governing Board and offer lottery prize for the one who sits on the chosen number chair.

October 3, 2019

We believe most of our readers are familiar with the ancient story of the individual who was overwhelmed, sympathetic almost beyond description by the pain and anguish of another human being. The Observer noted aloud that he would do almost anything to alleviate the obvious suffering of the individual. who appeared emaciated crushed and in great pain from the load that he was bearing. Said the observer "I will do anything within my power to lessen this poor man's suffering except getting down off his back".

We suggest that Speaker Pelosi and Senator Shumer are in precisely the same position as The Observer in the foregoing true to life recital. Those Democrat leaders ring their hands and cry aloud against the division of America. Yet, no one on earth has caused that division more than Pelosi and Shumer. They need only to recite the famous question of Rodney King, the black who was beaten by Los Angeles police, "Can't we all just get along?"

If this were to happen, it would be a historic moment of a nation re-healing itself instantler.

Alas, neither of these political opportunists have the slightest interest in uniting America for it's survival struggle in an envious world. Incredibly, each appears more determined to destroy Donald Trump than in rescuing America.

The role of the national news media in this tragedy is almost as despicable as that of Pelosi and Shumer. The news people fan the story to attract more viewers to sell more advertising. They appear utterly indifferent to the fate of our government. They should remember when the unsinkable Titanic sank, there were only 700 survivors; 1500 perished. That could be the fate of the United States of America if its members cannot stand together in mutual trust and support.

Less than 13 months from today we will have a Presidential Election. If a majority from the electoral college vote against Donald Trump, a new President will be installed on January 20, 2021. Does it make any sense whatever to inflame public opinion about our differences as to how the government should operate, and the Presidents role therein by an impeachment proceeding?

The Democrats should cure themselves of "Impeachmentitis." It is a disease, and has no place in a democracy where the ship of state is so close to harbor.

October 10, 2019

Time is cruel, utterly merciless. If Bernie Sanders had won the 2020 Democratic Presidential state primaries as convincingly as he did in 2016, he would have been the Democrat Presidential candidate and might have beaten Trump. Alas, his 78 years were unforgiving. They struck him in Las Vegas, last week. Though he loudly vows to shake off the heart attack, that isn't the way Time works. He will probably appear Monday night with the Democratic Presidential hopefuls at Otterman College for the scheduled televised debate. His welcome by the other candidates will be warm and somewhat sincere. It will be apparent to all from the moment that he opens his mouth that the fire of ambition is gone from his belly and that his lifelong dream of being President is finished.

The campaign financing laws are such that Sanders must remain in the ring or refund millions to the donors. It is a sad ending of this campaign. Strangely, the bell may have also tolled for Senator Joe Biden's hopes. He'll be 77, November 20. No other candidate has run for president at that age. Time makes no exception.

Continuing Time's inexorable march, we think that terrible force is a greater danger to Donald Trump's reelection than all of the impeachment prattle and income tax rattle combined. He was born 6/14/46. If Time does not intervene, we think he'll win the election. We wonder if his body and mind can endure four more years of disgraceful attacks from the other party. America has copied Great Britain's form of government sans royalty from the earliest days of our beloved nation. The British have a quaint description for the party out of power, "the loyal opposition." We need to add that term and policy to our system of government.

Back to Senator Sanders, we were startled that he often centered his fire on the big wicked drug corporations. Did he foresee the state of New Hampshire filing suit against Purdue Pharma and the Sackler family? If the news media account is correct, that is the most amazing suit imaginable. The charge is that three psychiatrist brothers established a family owned corporation that skillfully marketed Oxycontin worldwide. The suit claims that the Sacklers knew that this wonder drug was more addictive than morphine, would cause death to millions of users and netted billions from its sale. Plaintiff's problem is that the Sackler family have created a world wide image of philanthropy by lavish gifts to every major art gallery. Could any family so demonstrably

generous with their billions willfully contribute to the despair and death of their products users? We've asked our legal researcher to find what role New Hampshire believes the Federal Drug Administration played in the strange story.

October 17, 2019

Their work is far from glamorous. It is never heralded by the roar of public approval. It is dirty, tedious, and often underpaid. We're writing about nursing home caregivers.

Our population is aging nationwide. The God who created us, for reasons we may never know, provided that most of mankind would endure a period of years at the end of life during which they're incapable of caring for themselves. This ever increasing multitude must rely on the care of others to sustain their life on this Earth. That care is dirty, tedious, and avoided by all segments of society who can earn a livelihood in any other occupation.

One rarely sees a college graduate washing the backside of a feeble resident. We doubt that any parent ever hopes that his/her child will become a caregiver in a nursing home. That avoidance of contact seems strange when measured against the reality that caregivers represent society's grandest demonstration of one worker's love for another human being imaginable. When that status does occur, we are certain that the parent is proud to the soles of his feet that his offspring is making such a contribution to the well being of another human.

Caregivers are literally "life-extenders." They are as essential as air and water, food and shelter, for human life to continue.

We've all heard the canard about Eskimos pushing elderly couples out to sea in a boat with a few days' rations. Fortunately, the conscious of the able bodied prevents similar disposition of humans at the end of life. We wish that society would show more admiration and respect for these caregivers in this lifetime.

Forbearance required of a caregiver is monumental. For example, if the resident deliberately spit

in the face of the caregiver, latter must not retaliate in kind or his employer will be severely fined by the pontifical Illinois Department of Public Health.

In the language of Abou Ben Adhem we believe that when the Book of Gold is opened, listing the names of those "love of God has blessed, nursing home caregivers will lead all the rest."

Though Andrew Yang scored no breakout in the televised Democratic Presidential Candidate Debate Tuesday night, we yet believe he will be a strong candidate for his party's nomination at it's July 13-16, 2020, national convention. We seek his symbolic cap with math imprinted, Yang Gang's enthusiastic slogan for their candidate--Make America Think Harder. He attracts the same youthful enthusiasm Senator Bernie Sanders captured in 2016.

Of Sanders, he had the audacity to say that front runner Elizabeth Warren believes in capitalism in her bones. How ungrateful of either Sanders, or Warren, to bemean capitalism. Forbes printed that each of those ingrates has a net-worth of 12.5 million dollars! Talk about biting the hand that feeds you.

We were reassured this week to receive a socialist manifesto from our old friend, Karl Koertge. Several months' silence had lead us to fear for his health or certitude. Inconceivably, he continues to support socialist candidates for president. When that happens, we'll own a small fractional interest in his farm, with the rest of the Americans. Doubt that he will approve of that change in ownership.

Common sense should persuade him, and all others who own their own home, to vote Republican.

October 24, 2019

"Foolish consistency is the hobgoblin of little minds"---

President Donald Trump has learned well that plausible sounding explanation for inconsistent statements. Of recent days there have been too many instances of our President reversing direction of his omniscient tweets. His many critics seize on these direction changes in calculated effort to challenge even his mental health.

Republicans who would well serve the nation have no alternative than to stay with Trump regardless how virulent the attacks upon him become. There is no historical precedent for an elected President to be daily assailed for the first 1000 days of his term. A lesser man than this braggart Trump would have folded under the onslaught of having so many leaders of the opposition publicly brand him a "pathological liar".

The rhubarb over Trumps's proposal to host an International Conference of World Leaders at Doral, his Florida Resort, is the latest tempest in the teapot. Why that proposal was so offensive escapes us. Our wealthy Florida friends who have toured Doral assure us that it is a splendid group of small castles that would impress the International Peacocks which he proposed to house there.

The thought occurs that in the final analysis all the complaints against Trump boil down to money. His enemies fear that Trump will have more money than they. Which appears a certainty. Had our founding fathers foreseen how overwhelming the pursuit of the mighty dollar they would have provided that the President serve his country for minimum wage and that his family not profit in any way from their association with government. We would vote to amend the constitution to that end but it is certainly unfair to hold Trump to non existent profit limitations which hindsight suggest should have been in our Constitution.

Pursuing our musing about money and government it is obscene that there be such a disparity between the rich and the poor. We think the law should be that the net worth of no individual can exceed 100 million dollars and that any property interest he/she in excess of that amount be

forfeited to the state.

Such Draconian Rule would work wonders in reducing the National Debt Nor would it diminish jobs and opportunity claimed to trickle down from extreme wealth.

Long live the U.S A.

October 31, 2019

United Nations Charter was signed June 26, 1945, San Francisco at the Veterans Memorial Hall. Broad outline was agreed at Dumbarton Oaks Conference 1944, confirmed at the Yalta Conference in early 1945. For the relative peace that has blessed the world for 75 years, it is time for all who participated to take a bow for exemplary service rendered mankind.

The United Nations has reigned 75 years and appears to grow stronger each year. Compared with the less than 20 years that the League of Nations was a viable referee in world affairs, the UN record is spectacular.

Detractors of the concept of United Nations will point to the numerous small wars that have occurred during its existence, including the U.S. battle in Korea, Viet Nam and war against terrorist Muslims. Notwithstanding, is our opinion that The United Nations continues to represent mankind's greatest barrier to a world wide conflict that would surely destroy civilization.

One farsighted patriot never received the credit to which he was entitled - for his key role in founding of The United Nations. John D. Rockefeller Jr.. The striped pants diplomats explained to Rockefeller they needed a site. He promptly bought the old stock yard area on Manhattan Island and gave it to the United Nations. Without him history might have been quite different. The UN might be convening for its annual meeting in some faraway place like Athens.

The Sumner Press congratulates the United Nations for Seventy five years of service to the cause of humanity, and wishes it many more.

Though we have written unkindly of Congresswoman AOC. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez for her silly comment about emptying the prisons and thereby destroying public safety. Her question last week to Facebook founder Zuckerberg was vital, "Would Facebook refuse a political ad which it knew was totally false?" His answer was he didn't know if Facebook had legal authority to reject ads on its determination alone of truth.

As we approach the 2020 election, the role of Facebook therein must be determined in advance. We think it frightening the degree to which that bellwether can form public opinion.

The very basis of Democracy depends upon the judgment of its members. Unfortunately a large segment of our voting population is totally uninformed and indifferent as to the power of their vote.

If Democracy is to work it may be necessary to reintroduce some form of literacy test as a condition for voter registration. Though the Supreme Court threw out literacy test and poll tax, as an scheme to disenfranchise blacks, it needs to take another look at the question: Is common sense required for eligibility to participate in guiding the mighty ship of state .

November 7, 2019

All major stock indices closed at record high over the weekend. Dow Jones Industrial Averages closed at 27,432, Monday. There is no more reliable barometer of a country's economic condition, including the availability of jobs, than these indices.

Notwithstanding above good news, "Lynch Trump" Gang leader Nancy Pelosi, Speaker of the House of Representatives, introduced a resolution last month to impeach President Donald Trump for alleged improper request that the Ukrainian president investigate Hunter Biden, son of Joseph Biden, a candidate for the Democrat presidential nomination. Under this admitted fact scenario it is insanity to rock the boat by attempting to impeach the captain of the ship of state. If the American public subscribes to the irresponsibility of Pelosi et al., they deserve to be unemployed.

Particularly galling was the Pelosi claim that she sought to unify a divided America by her impeachment motion. If the rebels who shelled Fort Sumter in 1861 had tweeted @ President Lincoln that they were seeking only to unify America, would he have forgone the defense of Washington?

All who believe in the American dream should rally behind our president who has been unfairly assailed from the day of his election. We must not let our grand country become another banana republic whose leadership depends on which thugs have the greater firepower.

We were impressed with Mayor Lori Lightfoot's handling of the teachers' strike.

We trust we'll hear no more about the dedication of Chicago's teachers to their students. Those teachers are more mercenary than lawyers.

We hope that Mayor Lightfoot can persuade the General Assembly not to make the Chicago School Board membership elective. Such would grant union control and work terrible hardship on every Chicago property owner.

November 14, 2019

We remember a very solemn exercise from the 3rd grade in Sumner Public School. On November 11 at 11 a.m., each of the students stood at the side of his desk, facing the east with his right hand on his heart for a moment of silence. Ms. Imogene explained that this gesture was in recognition and appreciation of the end of a great war twenty years earlier. She also explained that we were honoring the sacrifice of all Americans who fought in that war.

Then we returned to our studies. A similar process occurred each November 11 thereafter. We suggest that above recited ritual was a far finer tribute to the soldiers, living and dead, than depriving the students of an entire school a whole day's education that the teachers might receive paid holiday.

Another vivid memory we have of post war observance occurred in Paris, a few weeks after the shooting stopped, May 8, 1945. We entered the crowded Metro train. A sign written in French on the inside wall of the carriage translated, "give your chair to the war wounded."

Though we had escaped unscathed in combat, we immediately developed a limp. An elderly lady sprung from her chair, motioning that we could sit down.

A large battle scarred infantry captain, wearing a 69th Division shoulder pad, snarled "if you take the seat, I'll break your jaw." We politely told the lady to keep her seat.

We were saddened that weather caused courthouse lawn ceremony transfer of this year's observance. We salute VFW Post 2244 for furnishing an immediate alternate site for the observance.

Michael Bloomberg's Last Hurrah was a fizzle. That arrogant 77-year-old three term mayor of NYC announced last week that he was seriously considering entering the race for nomination as the Democratic candidate for President, "because none of these announced candidates can defeat Trump."

A rash of public opinion polls quickly confirmed that nationwide support of his candidacy would be insignificant in number.

There are things beside health that a billion dollars can't buy, one is the U.S. Presidency.

November 21, 2019

Most recent polls reveal that Mayor Pete Buttigieg has jumped into the lead in the Iowa caucus for Democrat nomination for President of the United States. Caucus will be held February 3. Biden, Warren, or Sanders may regain the lead when caucus held.

It is a cruel delusion of ambitious hope for Mayor Pete as he has no more chance of being the nominee than any reader of this column. A majority of the American voters is simply not yet ready to accept a male First Lady.

Tolerance of different lifestyle is commendable, but it should not be extended to the mockery of marriage as defined in the Bible. The combination is a "civil union" and should be so designated.

Sunday at First Christian, Reverend Tom Akers spoke on the Second Coming of Christ. He said Christians should not be concerned as to the time of such coming, "whether very soon or a million years from now." It was the million that startled us. We assume it was a mere slip of the lip.

In this world most thinking people agree that a supernatural Jewish rabbi walked the earth 2,000 years ago, performing miracles, including raising of the dead, and promising to return soon. The numerical gooblygock of geologists, and politicians measuring the national debt, should not hijack the Biblical promise. While Clarence Darryl embarrassed William Jennings Bryan at the Scopes Monkey Trail, Tennessee, 1925, in Bryan's contention that humans had existed on this earth only about 6500 years, we simply cannot accept a distortion of the Bible to contemplate that the Second Coming could be a million years away.

Only since 1945 has mankind possessed the weapon that could literally destroy civilization. It was not by chance that Dr. Robert Oppenheimer, the brain who took the lead in building the A-bomb, became hysterical and moaned that he had created death. His reference was not to the Japanese targets but all of mankind.

National leadership of nations possessing the ability to create and ignite the Hydrogen bomb-- a weapon far more powerful than the A, has negotiated among its' members for 74 years, persuading each other not to pull the trigger.

The prayer is that this deterrent of mutual fear can prevent the firing of H-bombs forever.

Human nature is such that it is a simple bet that within the next century some mad ruler possessing H-bombs will unleash same. We think Christ will arise immediately thereafter.

November 28, 2019

"I have insurance." Quoted three words from news media interview of Rudy Giuliani have raised speculation among all political aficionados. Question to President Trump's personal lawyer was whether Giuliani had any fear that Trump would "throw him under the bus" by claiming that Giuliani exceeded his authority if he promised the Ukrainian president release of American military weapons for Ukrainian investigation of Joe Biden and son.

Rudy prefaced his insurance remark with a confident assertion that he never doubts the loyalty and judgement of President Trump.

Fact remains the reference to insurance is clearly a threat, a warning to Trump. Our question became if Giuliani had proof that he was acting in accordance with the President's instructions, what is the point of publicly playing such Ace? We think Giuliani was bluffing.

We repeat prior conviction: it is insanity for the Democrats to continue with this impeach-itis, "to bring the country together," Comrade Pelosi.

On this Tuesday, there has been some indication that the impeachment investigation will be transferred to another congressional committee to strengthen the subpoena to compel the testimony of John Bolton. Trump fired Bolton in September as security adviser apparently because of his urging military action against Iran and/or North Korea. He should have been fired years ago. Negotiations ad nauseam are always preferable to declaration of war.

We thought November 22, 1963, would go down as a day of infamy in history (to use President Roosevelt's reference to Pearl Harbor), we were surprised to discover that none of the public that we encounter remembered that that was the day Lee Harvey Oswald assassinated John F. Kennedy in Dallas. Most of the public had even forgotten that JFK was that century's most charismatic president.

We reviewed the assassination on that marvelous instrument called the internet. We relived Jack Ruby publicly executing Lee Harvey Oswald, manacled to a huge Deputy Sheriff, in the basement of the jail in Dallas within 48 hours of Kennedy's death. The agony on Oswald's face as Ruby's single .38 caliber shot, fired within two feet, tore a hole through his chest was classic retribution. Should be a warning to future would be assassins.

Surprising that a Dallas jury convicted Ruby of murder. He was sentenced to be executed, but the

Texas Court of Appeals intervened and ordered a new trial. Ruby died of cancer before he could be further punished.

We think Jack Ruby rendered a public service.

December 5, 2019

Only newspapers in America that aren't losing money big time are the Mom and Pop variety whose owners each work 40+ hours weekly with \$0 salary.

Even the largest newspaper, The NY Times, is so financially insecure that its primary editorial target, President Trump, can return its jabs with claim, "Shaky Times." Another large opponent of our President, The Washington Post, the world's richest man, Jeff Bezos, standing in the shadows to rescue it from financial collapse. The absurd analogy follows that we are a junior size Jeff Bezos. We intend to continue to publish the Sumner Press as long as our lenders permit us to do so.

The Salt Lake Tribune has found a solution for palsied American newspapers. It persuaded the IRS to recognize that newspapers can be published by not-for-profit corporations, latter could solicit tax-deductible contributions from civic minded citizens determined to maintain a hard copy historic record.

Alas, the Tribune's solution is not available for The Press as IRS would not permit political endorsements by any newspaper using this shelter. We believe it is our duty to advise our readers as to the relative merits of all seeking to be their public servants.

Forgoing admission of how financially precarious Facebook and its ilk have made newspaper publishing might deter thoughtful citizens from subscribing, or renewing subscription to the Press. To allay the fears of our thoughtful renewals and new subscribers, we make the following pledge: If the Sumner Press should discontinue publication during our lifetime, refund of the

unused portion of any subscription or renewal purchased after December 1, 2019, will be available with prior notification of pickup at The Press office. Those entitled need only produce the receipt for payment under which refund claimed. If demand made by mail, enclose stamped addressed return envelope.

If you love Lawrence County, we urge that you subscribe to the Press today. Together we shall overcome.

December 12, 2019

Last week, Speaker of the House of Representatives Nancy Pelosi started the procedure to impeach President Donald Trump. A reporter asked the Speaker why she hated Trump so much. Her reply, "I'm a Catholic. I am taught to not hate anyone. I pray for President Trump."

The Speaker's reference to prayer is a stale joke. It is Alice in Wonderland, "words mean what I say they mean," to twist the accepted meaning of words so incongruously. Pelosi can't have it both ways, God rescuing the one she seeks to destroy. We hope that her Priest is also a practicing psychiatrist.

The DJIA index as accurately reflects the national economy as a thermometer the temperature. On past two Fridays the DJIA closed above 28,000, historic highs.

It is immaterial whether a worker plays the stock market, the market furnishes the capital which creates his/her job. The market is the foundation for the 401k. Any worker with a 401k who votes against Donald Trump for president needs to seek psychiatric help.

It is pure insanity to seek to replace the captain when the ship of state is so steadfast on its course.

We prefer to cite Press columns but we were startled how closely Mary Schmich's thoughts of December 5 paralleled ours of the same date. On the need of vanishing newspapers to find sugar daddies--for orderly government and historic accuracy.

Incidentally, John Cass, also Chicago Tribune, spelled out President Trump's defense against impeachitis more eloquently than can we.

Proud Americans should rally around the flag.

December 19, 2019

Our energetic neighbor, Linda Collier is a house painter extraordinaire. Some years ago a patronizing male inquired of Linda whether his house too tall for her to paint. Her reply, "I have never found that house."

There may be winter storms severe enough to justify closing school in Lawrence County: we have never found such storms. Disgraceful that those in charge surrender opportunity to brighten young lives so quickly. We are no fan of home schooling, one wonders if that group followed the path of least resistance too.

Democrat Presidential Candidates' televised debate must enliven their act or they'll lose their sponsors. Last night's performance in California was particularly ho hum.

Are we alone in the conclusion that "Pocahontas", aka Senator Elizabeth Warren shot herself in the foot when she proposed to confiscate 6% of the net worth of every American Billionaire? That endangered species promptly shut off the publicity spotlight which had glowed upon her head nonstop throughout the six month spectacle seeking public approval.

We hope our readers will permit us to change our prediction a bit, we again believe that the Democrat nominee will be Joe Biden, with either Senator Booker or Andrew Yang as his VP. We admired the tenacity of Bernie Sanders and of South Bend Mayor Buttigieg but neither created the enthusiasm for an upset. Likewise, billionaire Bloomberg and his \$35 million dollar television blitz. We are almost ashamed to admit that we sent a press advertising chart to Bloomberg. Our justification is that we must meet a payroll.

Is it meaningless that the Dow Jones Industrial Average hit new highs daily while the partisans bereft of reason seek to impeach the Captain of our Ship? We note that Speaker Pelosi did not again claim that she prays for President Trump. That debasement of faith was simply too much for the Speaker to repeat.

God bless America and its elected leaders.

Whittier wrote a very short prayer which improves upon the Lords Prayer . He added, " re-clothe us to our rightful mind"

December 26, 2019

A wise man observed years ago the fatal flaw of Democracy was the certainty that the rabble will predominate when they get their act together. That sad moment for America could come November 3, 2020.

The Democrat-Socialist candidate, regardless of which of the "want to bes" he/she is, have the ghettos: NYC, Chicago and LA already in his corner. Trump must take Florida, Texas, Michigan, Ohio, and Pennsylvania to win. We are uncertain that lightening can strike twice to save America.

We would not disenfranchise the poor but strongly urge that a literacy test honestly administered should be required for a voter's registration card.

It was monumental hypocrisy of a religious publication long ago associated with the late revered Billy Graham. That despicable rag hid behind its religious label to urge believers to vote against Trump. The great evangelist's splendid son, Rev. Franklin Graham rose to the occasion and assured the faithful that his father supported Trump, with clear implication that they should do likewise. His reassurance was priceless.

Last December, Congressman Dingle, Michigan, loosened a mirage of false statements against Trump. Notwithstanding, our President ordered flag at White House to be flown at half staff when Dingle died shortly after his vicious attack turning the other cheek in grandest style. The grateful widow immediately appointed to fill her late husband's Congressional seat was "eternally grateful" to Trump for his kindness. This December, the grateful new Congresswoman Dingle voted to impeach Trump.

We thought our President's counter punch at the Battle Creek rally was classic, deserved . though the Trump haters everywhere feigned indignation by the President's implied late nemesis was now in Hades, One turn of the cheek should suffice for these phonies.

Winter came early Sunday morning. It's the Grandest Season of the Year!

2020

49 COLUMNS

January 2, 2020

Hospice is frighteningly close to euthanasia. Only medicine that they prescribe is morphine. If Dr. Jack Kevorkian were alive, he would be hailed rather than jailed. We fear that some form of euthanasia will become widespread in this country in the near future. Americans should be taught that this is the best world anyone has ever lived in and none should hasten his departure regardless of his faith in the after life.

Words have unlimited ability to change the appearance of reality, as suggested by the above. Last week a worker making greeting cards in a Chinese jail inserted a card with his location and pleaded contact for someone to help him. The card importer was horror stricken, He temporarily cut off imports, "We don't have slave labor in our chain of supply." We think the public reaction to this episode would have been quite different if the importer had said, "If jailed inmates were asked to work was for their rehabilitation."

Fifty years ago as a freshman state legislature we asked the union lobbyist, Stanley Johnson whether his group would be offended if we offered a bill to return license plate manufacture to state penitentiaries. The smooth Mr. Johnson was outraged. "we cannot permit slave labor to deprive or workers of employment." We regret our decision to forego the rehabilitation of prison inmates through manufacture of license plates and any other product of community value as along as safety of the workers and their keepers is protected. Prominently displayed on each shipment of finished product would be, "Rehabilitation Labor." the physical and mental health of the prisoners thus improve. It is a crime against common sense that Illinois wastes the lives of more than forty thousand inmates. Each should be working full time at some product, any product for which there is a market demand.

I should have said to my friend, Stanley Johnson, "we can cure the objection by making employed prisoners dues paying members of the union."

New Years Resolutions 2020 are good for the mind and body. Ours is to make every day of the New Year count for something worthwhile for our fellow man. We may not write to Governor J.B.

Pritzker or any of our legislatures, state and federal, everyday but we promise Press subscribers that we will plead this areas need for governmental assistance with one or more of those from whom help could come at least three times each week.

When we served as your public servant in Springfield we marveled at the tenacity of Representative Wyvetter-Young. When that gracious lady rose to offer a legislative proposal, the 176 other members of the House knew that such proposal would include money for her district. Though many groaned inaudibly when she spoke, she knew better than all why her district had sent her to the legislature.

When the legislature reconvenes in a week we hope our public servants will remember Representative Wyvetter-Young as an example and the happy fact that a four lane portion of Route 50 in St. Claire County has been named in her honor.

Be assured Governor Pritzker has been reminded; 2020 must bring progress on Four Lanes for Route 50. It is unthinkable that this main artery for our community to the outside world, now named J.B. Pritzker Expressway be only two lanes wide. That was its lane number 90 years ago when hard roads rescued Illinois from the mud paths.

We are also resolved to speak to our Masters about doubling the size of the Sumner Correctional Facility, finding an aeronautical use for George Field and constructing a low level dam on the Wabash at Pulleyville.

Happy New Year!

January 9, 2020

Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, top dog in Iran would join Congressional Democrats in sponsoring Trump impeachment if rules permitted. Perfect erasure of Gen. Qassem Soleimani Friday in

Bagdad is a game changer of historic proportion. We think it ranks with the A Bomb and walking on the moon as world wide proof that America is destined to lead.

It is poetic justice that no longer the lives of Privates and low ranking officers be sacrificed almost exclusively to resolve international disputes. The leaders who found the cause for war for which impeachments were ordered to die are surely the targets.

When we first learned that Trump had cut off the head of the snake rather than the tail we remembered a weather forecaster from Olney, 1939, Mr. Murray - As the clouds of coming war were gathering Murray wrote that The National leaders should be put in a boxing ring to resolve the issues, adding that America would be handicapped in that solution as FDR was in a wheelchair. Murray was prophetic.

Donald Trump, though lacking the phony veneer of manners and human compassion, had the courage and judgment to assert American World leadership. His personal courage when faced with the knowledge that every fanatic Muslim on Earth would assassinate him sacrificing his own life if given the opportunity should inspire every American. In lieu of National Pride, we have a bunch of snively politicians seeking to drive Trump from office. In less than 300 days every American voter will have an opportunity to say who shall lead our great Nation for the next four years. If there be any sanity in Washington, Pelosi, Schumer et al will each ask themselves whether his loyalty is owed to IRAN, or the USA. National faith in Representative Government would be grandly boosted if named Trump Haters would dismiss their impeachment assault upon America. In retrospect Republican Congressional leadership in impeachment of Clinton, 1978 was almost as reprehensible. Only significant difference was that Clinton was not simultaneously defending America against bellicose sworn enemies.

Next week January 14th Democratic Presidential candidate want to bes. have their seventh debate at Drake University, Des Moines. Should be worth staying awake to hear. Polls show that Bernie Sanders could top Biden in the Iowa caucus February 3 and beat him in New Hampshire Primary the following week. If this should come to pass, will be a disaster for the donkeys.

Sanders has no more chance of winning the Presidency than Donald Trump had in 2016.

Ancient cultures included sun worshipers. Humans believe that the Sun is God in these glorious sunny days as we experience the emotional boost of every ray of sunshine and reflect on the end of human life on Earth. If the sun failed to shine for a couple of days not just hidden by clouds but banished from sight everywhere all life would cease. Could the Sun Worshipers be right?

January 16, 2020

The moment of truth in determination of effectiveness of T.V. advertising for political candidates is now. Michael Bloomberg, 77, late starter in the Democratic Presidential Candidate sweepstakes, apparently will not appear on first four primaries: Iowa, Feb 3; NH, Feb 11; NV Feb 22; SC Feb 29. His rating in the public opinion polls were below entrance requirements for Tuesday debate held in Des Moines.

Notwithstanding his gloomy present standing, Bloomberg is spending millions on T.V. advertising. He has said that he might spend "one billion or more". Surely, this was a hyperbole not to be taken seriously. Then we thought of an early campaign statement of Illinois Governor J.B. Pritzker to reporters, "How much will you spend in this election (against Rauner)?" His answer, "Whatever amount is required to win".

These billionaires talk a different numerical language than the rest of mankind. Bloomberg's recent tour of important Texas, suggests that his campaign is real, not an old politician's last hurrah. It is reported that Bloomberg and Trump will each have a televised ad in the super bowl. We doubted the accuracy of NY Times guess that each will spend \$10 million for his Super Bowl ad. It is an obscene amount of money. We do not believe that the American electorate is so stupid to choose its leadership on the finesse of the television ads. Fourteen State Primaries on Super Tuesday, March 3 will reveal whether Bloomberg's calculation correct, or whether voters will analyze the candidates and their positions. If the almighty dollar proves who shall lead us into the future, there is no hope for democracy as conceived by our forefathers in Philadelphia in 1776. It is

a wicked perversion of Democracy that the winner be the highest bidder.

Since the Super Bowl has become this nation's religion, we think it would be appropriate that the Federal Communications Commission order the following ad be run without charge at half time for at least 15 seconds: "Where Will You Spend Eternity?"

The lure of national television exposure is simply irresistible to most Senators and Congressmen. If the U.S. Senate would adopt a rule that President Trump's impeachment trial not be televised, the fury of the Democrat Senators and Congressmen would vanish. The national process of free people governing themselves should not cause such mindless anger and public confusion. Why not turn off the T.V. cameras and let sanity return to the U.S. Congress?

January 23, 2020

Someone observed of the Colt revolver, "The equalizer of men." We fear human intelligence has been equalized by Alexa, Siri; Google and other dispensers of artificial intelligence. The empty headedness person you know can confer with equal insight with the brightest if equipped with one of these electronic miracles. Ask any under fifty person you know the world population on any date; within seconds the answer will be boomed out. Problem is that these users of artificial intelligence bright or stupid depend on Siri for every question. We heard the hostess ask an average bright citizen "are you hungry?" He asked Siri the answer!

Our fear is that the natural reasoning process of every citizen will atrophy from nonuse. At that point mankind has been captured by the digital wizardry

Might it be permissible that artificial information devices be banned for a couple of hours each day to preserve the human race. The informational delay would be small price to pay for world sanity.

The Democratic assault upon constitutional government in the U.S.A. continues with amazing tenacity and duplicity. We believe the Democratic Congressional conspirators are more of a menace to survival of U.S.A. than Putin, The Chinese Xi Jinping, North Korean Kim Jong-un and the Ayatollah Ali Khamenei of Iran combined. It would have made better television if a monkey

had been trained to carry the Articles of Impeachment and the 1000 pages of supporting testimony from the House to the Senate. We trust Senator McConnell to limit the trial to not more than one-half day - though the lure of the television spot life for many of the Senatorial peacocks will be almost irresistible.

Any verdict other than "Defendant Acquitted" is a cruel perversion of justice and grave danger to a country the perverters claim to love.

January 30, 2020

As we listened to Michael Bloomberg's speech to the Orthodox Jewish Temple in Miami Beach Sunday evening we concluded that we should apologize to President Donald Trump for having described him as an egomaniac. If Trump's ego is compared with Bloomberg's, any analyst would find our President has an inferiority complex.

Incredible were the words of this elderly (78, 2/14/20) thrice mayor of New York City. He actually sees himself as Moses rescuing Jerusalem and Washington from an evil monster named Trump. This messenger from Mount Sinai seems to believe that a free people will elect him president by acclimation of both the U.S.A and Israel.

Our guess is that as soon as the ravenous television industry has tapped Bloomberg for whatever portion of his billions he is willing to squander, they'll tell him to get lost.

He has no more chance at being the Democrat nominee for president than we.

Other candidates for the Democratic Presidential nomination surely breathed easier as they saw how out of touch Bloomberg is with reality.

If one could look inside the skull of each of the other wanna-be's, he would find this question, "why were we afraid of Bloomberg?"

We wish Mayor Bloomberg a happy old age in the security and safety that Donald Trump's preemptive strike (Qasem Soleimani) brought Americans worldwide.

We'll stay up late Monday night for the results of the Iowa caucus. Our guess is that Biden will clench his ultimate nomination by winning in Iowa and that Trump will be reelected November 3.

February 6, 2020

We were appalled to read that a second Monarch butterfly conservationist had been murdered in Mexico. Authorities believe that the victims' desires to protect the Monarch butterfly's normal flight pattern were a principal cause for the death of each. If the supposition is correct, we are reminded anew how dangerous a major change in living habits regardless of how well intentioned.

Why a steel and concrete wall would significantly bar the butterfly, or deprive that beautiful insect of plants required for its survival escapes us. We must be sensitive to unforeseen problems and must strive mightily to let all lifeforms live in harmony. We had hoped that our government would try further to make life more bearable for the peasants in Honduras and Guatemala before wasting billions on the wall.

Instead of the wall this year lets make Route 50 four lanes wide, Lawrenceville to I-57 in Salem. This would be a significant joiner of I-57 and I-69. The J.B. Pritzker Expressway is all ready four lanes from Lawrenceville to Indiana and continues thusly until it intersects with I-69. Press has written to a dozen public officials urging progress for four lanes for 50 during the past week. It would be helpful if our readers would add their weight to this plea for our economic revitalization.

We search for attractions to bring new citizens to County Lawrence. We remain persuaded that we should tout our area as the Riviera of Illinois. This obvious link to the French playground is deserved by the almost absence of snow. It were as though we were in a sheltered valley. We listened smugly as Terre Haute and Evansville report snow and ice on the way. We are confident that neither of those plagues will hit us in Lawrence County. Let us share our good fortune with others. For this strategy to have any validity there must be a low-level dam on the Wabash at Pulleyville. We must elect representatives, State Senator and a Congressman who share our dream. Dam contemplated could be installed for peanuts this summer.

We urge as many as will, to the Lincoln Day Banquet, 5 p.m., Saturday, February 29, Central Christian Church Fellowship Hall. Question will be posed to each candidate where he/she stands on the low level dam which will turn the Wabash into a boating mecca.

February 13, 2020

More than a century lapsed between impeachment of Andrew Johnson and threatened impeachment of Richard Nixon. Thoughtful Americans hope that this rare Constitutional tool will never be used again without significant partisan support. Latest foray into untested waters was a Democratic attempt to lynch the duly elected President detested by his accusers. None would contend that Senator Mitt Romney's vote to convict constituted legitimacy for the proceeding. His vote was pathetic. He is not the same Mitt Romney, son of a skilled automaker, rescued the Olympics at Salt Lake City twenty years ago, served with distinction as the Governor of Massachusetts and was a credible candidate for President, 2012. At 72, he either suffers from early senility or sought vengeance against Trump for some imagined wrong suffered. Either way, he is through.

Another national leader whose time on the stage expired was Speaker Nancy Pelosi. She grimaced at the smoothness of Trump's State of the Union address to Congress and kept a bad finale by tearing up on camera some papers. Other presiding officer at the Joint Session of Congress VP Mike Pence was uncertain the destroyed paper was a copy of the President's speech or of the Constitution.

He speared her beyond recovery. One wondered if the other Hoosier, the bird that served as VP

under Reagan would have come up with so apt a condemnation of her misconduct.

Though Speaker Newt Gingrich believed Clinton's impeachment would net Republicans a 40 seat gain in the 1976 election, the voters punished the GOP with loss of several seats. We predict similar decision, November 3, fewer Democrats in Congress.

Before we leave this fascinating topic, we believe Richard Nixon would have survived as President if he had had a Mitch McConnell in his corner.

Turning to matters of more immediate concern. We hope the voters in Lawrence County will pay close attention to the desperate need of our county for improvement on several fronts including Four Lanes for Route 50, doubling the size of the Sumner Correctional facility, increase in size of Toyota plant, aeronautical use of George Field, activation of Red Hill State Park, races at Red Hill Raceway, and all season boating at St. Francisville via low level dam at Pulleyville. When the Republican candidates for the State Legislature and the U.S. Congress appear at this year's Lincoln Day Banquet, February 29, Central Christian Church, Lawrenceville, each should be offered an opportunity to tell the party faithful what he/she will do to advance any and all of these recited goals. Only through their happening can our county regain the area leadership it held so long.

February 20, 2020

My affection for Facebook is limited. Will never forgive it for destroying the noble institution of newspapers. Did see interesting comment among the garbage in recent peek. A talented former law partner from forty years ago, Wanda Wakefield, Rochester, saluted Minnesota for creating a bee sanctuary. We were impressed, as was Wanda that Minnesotans were clever enough to exempt property owners from the usual municipal command to mow lawn at least weekly until dirt shines through. Purpose of such exemplary leniency by all powerful city is that starving bees will find white clover in the unkempt yards. Those insects are an endangered species. Significantly, without the honey they provide, the human race might be endangered too. More scientifically oriented have opined to us that bees are also essential pollinators for numerous human food.

We thought of a personal problem. We own a vacant City lot in Lawrence County. The City masters have filed a lien against our title for failure to mow nonstop.. We can prove that the abundance of precious white clover was growing on the lot. We might find a receipt for having bought clover seed. Bees were aware of the bonanza and were thriving. Without any other encouragement from us they manufactured the honey.. An entrepreneur in Bridgeport named Hammel bottles that tasty product and thereby perfected our diet.

After we retraced the timeline on this pending tragedy, we recognize we should have pointed out these realities to the operators of the unwanted mowing machine. Omniscient as the city is, should have included in the glance that we were serving a noble purpose in the cycle of life and not defying municipal authority. When this case comes to trial we may fly Wanda from New York to present our defense.

We will urge our lawyer to pull out all stops. We are fearful that she will include that our defense would have more certainty of acceptance if the lot were located in Minnesota.

We are anxious that we haven't diminished the splendid lawn care provided locally by Weston, Hartz and others. They are job creators extraordinaire, as essential in the scheme of things as the bees.

Nonbelievers have removed the house of the Lord from too many marriages. While quirk locations gain popularity for marriages we doubt that church involvement in burials will ever fail. Mankind needs hope of another world.

February 27, 2020

Only 2.1% of Americans are of the Jewish faith.

Yet, this tiny sliver of population plays a leading role in managing every branch of the world's greatest democracy.

We think President Donald Trump is a pawn for his son in law, Jared Kushner. Apparently, Trump's opposition in November 3 election will be either Michael Bloomberg or Bernie Sanders. Each is Jewish.

Congressman Adam Schiff tells Speaker Pelosi when to grimace. Senator Chuck Schumer is second most powerful member of Senate.

The Supreme Court has three Jewish Justices. Their opinions are invariably the Court's. Jewish domination of American banking and Hollywood is total. Though Ogden Nash wrote, "odd that God choose Jews," the evidence confirms their favorite role in the scheme of life.

Above are the reasons the Press advocated many months ago that every Israeli be transplanted to Southern Illinois. Effect of this large population change would be: a. end of 75 year war between the Israelis and the Palestinians; b. partial replenishment of Illinois (even with these new citizens, Illinois would have fewer residents than in 1940), c. Southern Illinois would no longer be treated as Springfield's stepchild.

This needed population switch could happen.

March 5, 2020

Saturday night's Lincoln Day banquet at Central Christian was a grand success.

Success was not primarily due to the politicians' words; many of the speeches were puerile. Nor was the success due to the food, though that essential was tasty and well organized.

The banquet proved anew that if there is a large crowd, the event cannot fail. Conversely, if the turnout is light, it cannot succeed.

It was a full house at this year's banquet. Extra tables were set up as the nervous ticket holders noted that there were more bottoms than chairs.

Predictably, the one dozen candidates who spoke each sought words that would meet with the approval of their audience. Alas, many of the candidates, or their proxies, ignored Lawrence County's need for jobs, population growth, hustle. They assumed that we're all rednecks whose only interest in life was to fight abortion and gun control. Those speakers surely knew, or should have known, that Lawrence County has far greater problems than those two worn out issues used to harangue a crowd.

We were disappointed that none of the candidates, particularly those for the General Assembly, spoke of the tremendous insult that has been inflicted on Lawrence County for ten years. We are divided in half. The v-shaped wedge in North part of county, including Lawrenceville, is in the 110th Legislative District. Remainder of the county is in the 109th. Effect of dividing the county in half for district representation does not double the county's influence in Springfield. Rather, such unnatural district apportionment marginalizes each section of the county. The Press wants State Representatives and State Senator who will promise to move heaven and hell that Lawrence County not be divided in the reapportionment map, which will be adopted next year. That goal is possible only if those we send to Springfield have the savvy and determination to make it happen.

It would have been helpful if Representative Miller and Representative Bailey had enumerated for their audience what each had done to benefit Lawrence County during his term in office. Neither touched that vital in either way. The answer is o. We appreciated pledge of Senatorial candidate Jeff Flemming that he would push for four lanes for Route 50. Likewise, State Representative candidate Andy Hires pledged to push for Lawrence County.

Politicians' wives often hate the delicate process of begging all within earshot for their vote. Judicial candidates Matt Hartrich and Courtney Cox are fortunate Lisa Hartrich and Leslie Cox are beautiful exceptions to cited rule, as was Kay.

We congratulate GOP County Chairman Aaron Ferguson and all from the Committee for bringing this annual event to our community.

March 12, 2020

Attendance at First Christian is discouraging. We recognize that the problem is not unique, but our Church should lead the way. Nor should anyone ever espouse the nonsense that one can be a faithful believer and never darken the door of the church. Religion is the pathway to faith. First Christian is the main road.

We believe a principal cause for the few bottoms on pews at Sunday morning worship is a shrinkage of the Sunday School department. Sixty years ago there was a Sunday School division for every age group, even a separate Men's Group. We were proud of our High School members. None has ever gone to penitentiary. A church without a strong Sunday School program is a dying institution. In spite Our present state of very small Sunday School must be energized. In spite of the heroic effort of Cookie Newell, Shandra Kasinger et al the program needs steroids. .

Not unrelated to the above when we were discharged from the U.S. Army, August, '46, we were issued a life insurance policy. Catch was that we were required to and did in each February and each February thereafter to pay an annual premium of \$155.10 until this year. Happily, commencing about twenty years ago the VA sent us an annual refund, sometimes twice the amount of the premium paid. Then came the note from VA in February, we have deposited the face amount of your insurance policy, \$10,000.00, in your checking account. We were aghast, slightly amused that we had overlooked the fine print in the original policy of early pay off to long lived insured. We then remembered having learned of this quaint provision in many life insurance policies while reading of some baseball player's Father cashing in at home plate in Yankee

Stadium. So much for an old insured reminiscing. We have mailed full policy proceeds to First Christian this date with direction that same be expended as Cooky Newell, Shandra Kasinger et al decide will best boost the Sunday School program at our church. Would gently note ninety years ago in the Congregational Christian Church, Sumner, children who had perfect attendance for a year received a small metal pin. It was worn with great pride and augured well for the wearer's future

March 19, 2020

"The time for persuasion and public appeals is over — the time for action is here. I order all bars and restaurants to be closed March 16 until March 30," Governor JB Pritzker.

Thus, the Governor showed the people who is boss. Most of mankind will believe that control of the strange coronavirus which has brought such terror worldwide was upper most in His Excellency's mind when he issued the above command. Not so. He was making a highly publicized and dramatic pitch to be the Democratic nominee to oppose President Trump in the November 3 election. Pritzker saw two desperate old men arguing violently with each other Sunday night in a televised debate to determine which would be the party's standard bearer. We admired the effort of Senator Sanders and former Vice President Joe Biden, but the awful truth is, as the television screen revealed they're each too old to lead this nation into the future.

In comparison each is older than the oldest president, Ronald Reagan, was when he left office. For the last year of his second term, Nancy led the President as though he were a child. These realities were not lost on JB Pritzker. The framers of our constitution did not include an age ceiling for Presidents, a greater power has imposed same. We think He/She has fixed present limit at 75 years.

What will be interesting as the Democrat showdown in Milwaukee in mid-July approaches and the realization becomes apparent to all that Biden is simply too old for the job will be the reaction of all of the other candidates. There never was a candidate for President who lacked a Messianic Complex. How bitter will be the disappointment of each as he discovers he cannot re-enter the arena.

Of the COVID-19 pandemic, ironic that Pritzker singled out bars for closure: he and family are among the largest purveyors of booze in Chicago, through their Hyatt hotel chain.

We would wager that his brother screamed at the Governor, "we need the business!" Mattered not. The Governor saw the opportunity to launch his campaign to be the Presidential nominee. He can't outspend Bloomberg's marvelous generosity and financial stimulus to the world of politics, but we believe he has an excellent chance.

Notwithstanding or leading you into the mind of your Governor, and ours, we agree with him and with our great President Donald Trump. COVID-19 is a threat to mankind unparalleled in history. Stay at home. The life you save may be yours.

March 26, 2020

How quaint, our Masters have decreed which of us are "essential", which are "non-essential". Had any of us been making that list we would have held that all workers involved in food preparation and distribution are essential. Likewise, those who produce electricity, water, heat and housing.

After the designation of the easy professions so demonstrably necessary for the preservation of human life, the road gets murkier.

What about food for the mind? We were smugly gratified that our Masters included newspaper preparation as "essential".

We were startled that lawyers were not declared "essential". Can you imagine a society in which there were no lawyers: every fearful member would need to carry a club to protect his body and worldly goods from human predators.

Though Shakespeare in an uncharacteristic moment wrote, "first, let us kill all the lawyers," all reasonable people agree that that noble profession deserves the magical rating "essential".

Another glaring omission from the coveted essential rating was the workers at the state correctional facilities, including Sumner's.

The havoc in County Lawrence would be total if the quarantine were deemed to apply to those who care for the 2400 human beings at the Sumner Correctional Facility.

Life for each of us would become unbearable if the gates were opened and the pent up anger were spewed upon mankind.

We pause to say "thank you" to all who risk their lives to make ours secure.

Though our conclusion is it is inescapable that every man, woman and child is essential to a fellow human being, we do not advocate disobedience of the quarantine our leaders have decreed. Strange, but true in mockery of all the scientific breakthroughs, isolation remains the most reliable deterrent to the virus' deadly grip, hundreds of years after first tried.

We must not despair. Americans will lead the world to a better tomorrow.

Tardily, we note that spring arrived last Thursday. It is the grandest season of the year.

April 2, 2020

Economics II at the U of I in the Fall of 1942 was a challenging study of mankind's relationship with material things and valued money and credit. Course was designed for non-Commerce majors. The nation, 134 million strong, was geared up to fight Axis-Powers in WWII. Expense of the startup had pushed the national debt created through bond sales to a worrisome 72 billion dollars. Many feared such large national debt would cause runaway inflation in cost of goods and services, or that the government might be forced to default on the debt and thereby destroy its credit worthiness.

A 1941 graduate from SHS stood up in class and said: "the national debt is money we owe ourselves. Rather than have that debt crush the economy we should persuade our fellow citizens that since the debt is owed to each other in final effect it could be canceled without diminishing nation's credit worthiness by a national referendum. Question submitted to the voters would be, 'Shall the national debt be canceled?' If a majority voted in favor of such cancellation, the debt would be swept away without damage to the national credit."

The teacher was apoplectic. "This is the craziest idea I've ever heard. Those of you who have no government bonds cheer Cunningham, those of us who have put our life savings in those bonds would be ruined."

Wished that I had had the presence of mind to respond, "it is the risk that every minority stock holder in any property must take."

Instead, I wore an unrepentant smile. The teacher was gracious, generous. Did not punish me in any manner.

Relevance of the above is to the present national debt, more than fifteen trillion dollars (\$15,000,000,000,000.00).

In the intervening years, our national population has grown to 330 million, and our gross national product has multiplied many times, but servicing a debt of that size requires a tremendous amount of money each year. Government can obtain that needed money for debt through taxes, rather than by wild inflation of money so long as productivity is strong and growing. Should such source falter, government will have no alternative than to default on the debt, or endure wild

inflation. Latter would occur through issuance of more money. 60 years ago injection of more money into the system was a cumbersome process, involved actual printing pieces of paper that recited "we promise to pay--". Such bonds were then sold to every available purchaser. We saw last week how frighteningly easy it has become for government to increase national debt \$2.2 trillion: Congress, in rare bipartisan move authorized such new money, the president signed the bill; Secretary of Treasury Mnuchin pushed a button and all of us, and our ancestors, became obligated to repay the nation's debt, or at least the interest thereon.

Obviously our suggestion 78 years ago of cancellation of debt by national referendum was premature and our professor's fears did not happen.

When one notes that the national debt did not reach the 1 trillion mark until 1982, and considers the likelihood that another \$2.2 trillion may easily be borrowed to restart the engine of productivity, the probability is great that society will take another look at our suggestion of national debt cancellation by referendum.

Let the good times roll.

Transcriber notes (part-212): All 8 editions carried a live column at top-right of page 3; none continued to page 5. Original typos preserved verbatim, e.g. "in the 1976 election" (2020-02-13, context = Clinton impeachment midterms), "nonstop.." / "honey.." double periods (2020-02-20), "In spite Our present state" and trailing ". ." (2020-03-12), the 2020-03-12 column ending without a period ("...the wearer's future"), and "our ancestors" (2020-04-02). Plain paragraph breaks without `\*\*\*` inside sections match the print layout (2020-02-27, 2020-03-26).

April 9, 2020

America's treasured free speech needs always to be responsible. We fear that Facebook often fails and can become a menace to public sanity. Specifically our erudite friend, Mike Neal, Mattoon, was quoted to opine that COVID-19, aka the Chinese Flu, was man made. We were afraid to resolve the uncertainty whether he believes the causation was intentional. Probably should have inquired of Mike but did not wish to spread the implication.

Companion tweet from another source mentioned the Army's interest in germ warfare. Another post ominously reported that the FBI had arrested the dean of Harvard chemistry department for selling to the Chinese research on how to propagate and spread the virus.

We confess bias against Facebook probably because it is such overwhelming competition to newspapering, which we love.

The public is simply too stupid to separate fantasy from fact. Discerning inquirers would have concluded instantly that Harvard is not the most prestigious chemistry school in America. That honor belongs to the University of Illinois. Since the early 1930's, when Professor Roger Adams, a giant in organic chemistry, was named dean of the U of I chemistry department, our alma mater has been the bellwether of chemistry in the USA. Near claim to fame, this freshman at U of I sat in a pew close to Dean Adams one Sunday morning in the Fall of 1941.

Is this hero worshiping or space filling? We do not wish our readers to believe that we waste much of life on Facebook. Our conclusion is that much of the content is meaningless gossip and that its wide popularity has caused average Americans to abandon newspapers though latter have nobly served public enlightenment since the childhood of Benjamin Franklin.

Lest our gloomy fears for the future of newspaper persuade a single person not to subscribe or renew his copy of the Press, we promise herewith to refund on demand unused portion of prepaid subscription price if this newspaper should fold.

Further, starting April 13 we will make a similar refund if after six week's trial such new subscriber decides that the newspaper is not worth his money or time to read. Of course, these guarantees

are limited to our own mortality.

Meanwhile, stay well, and continue social distancing as long as your mind and body can endure.

April 16, 2020

We had forgotten the perfect setting that comes with the solitude of quarantine. The quiet of recent days has been eerie. Strangely, the shelter in place order has caused us to reminisce and enjoy again in our mind happy events from the past. Obviously, politics has always had a fascination. We recalled the presidential election of 1936. FDR had striven mightily for four years to rescue America from the Great Depression. Even Republicans recognized that he was a powerful symbol of hope. Notwithstanding, local effort to defeat him was strong. We recall the slogan, "off the rocks with Landon and Knox." It was whistling in the graveyard in purest form. The party faithful believed the impossible. Our confidence was such that I bet a dear late friend half of my savings from paper route, 10 cents, that Landon would win. Said John K Brown, "I'll give you a chance to break even by same wager that Landon won't carry his home state of Kansas." Party pride compelled our acceptance of the second wager. Our entire savings were gone. FDR carried every state except Maine and Vermont. John K remained my friend until his death, 2017, at age 100.

Forty years whizzed by. The RNC was in KC. July '76. Son RD was an alternate delegate. Kay and I drove far into the night to savor the excitement. That commodity was furnished by the retired governor of California, Ronald Reagan. Clear headed strategists believed Reagan would be more electable than incumbent Gerald Ford, who inherited the White House when Richard Nixon resigned. Difficult to derail an incumbent president. Reagan strength in the Illinois delegation made Ford's Illinois campaign manager, former Governor Richard Ogilvy nervous. We gently confided to Ogilvy that son RD favored Reagan. That embattled nose counter gave a sigh of relief as he muttered, "thank God he doesn't get to vote." Convention-wise, Ford's delegates rallied. Reagan saw that the incumbent had a majority and withdrew. We assumed that Ogilvy had a promise of a cabinet position if Ford elected. Old politicians dream always of a comeback. Reagan would have easily defeated Jimmy Carter in '76, had he been the nominee.

The 1980 RNC convention was in Detroit. We knew we were needed in Detroit to save the nation

from Carter and the 18% loan interest which doomed his presidency. We were appalled what a neglected ghetto that sprawling shiny city had become. Nomination of Reagan and George HW Bush was a forgone formality. Most delightful experience in Detroit was time spend with Hal and Joann Heidbreder, who had moved from Lawrenceville a few months earlier. We spent an hour or so looking for Jimmy Hoffa's grave, near the tavern where he was last seen alive. Subsequent evidence suggested Hoffa was buried in a New Jersey trash disposal area.

Though no suspense, the convention bug bit us again in 1984, Dallas. Our closest friends, Frank and Laura Irwin, Bridgeport, suggested that Memphis was on the way to Dallas, that they would enjoy seeing Laura's sister, Maye Judy Cox, at her ranch in Memphis while we partook in the political magic in Dallas. Maye and her husband, Claire Cox were Lawrence County natives who also resided in Olney and Michigan. After Claire's death, Maye moved to Memphis to be close to their distinguished son, Dr. Claire Cox II, and his family. Dr. Cox headed the Urology Department, University of Tennessee. He's a nation wide authority on that delicate specialty. Trip was delightful. Happy memories from the night at the ranch are many in my mind's eye. We saw the lively Maye and our teenage daughter, Lorie, checking each other's derriere to be certain each wearing blue jeans that were "hip". Next morning, Maye drove me in her Jeep to inspect her cattle, including a Hereford bull, which she had name "Roscoe" in our honor. Wasn't a particularly handsome animal. She assured us that his progeny had won prizes in area competition. The RNC in Dallas was so routine it would have been dull, except for Jeff Gaddy. He lived in Dallas, now lives in San Francisco. Jeff shared our interest in politics, he feared that we would tell his father, the late Tom Gaddy, that he had attended a Republican rally. We assured him that his fears were well founded.

We don't remember why we didn't attend the RNC at New Orleans, 1988, or the '96 in San Diego. In 2000, we again fanned the draft to be a delegate to the convention in Philadelphia. Before the opening gavel, all knew that George W. Bush would be the nominee and would easily beat Al Gore. First part came true, but the win over Gore needed a fortuitous Supreme Court decision stopping the recount of "chads" in Florida. Remembered most in the City of Brotherly love, was a delightful cruise on somebody's yacht, and walking a mile to bring Sue Gerhart to the seat we had promised. Incidentally, Sue has attended more conventions than have we. We hope she will represent the Press at Charlotte in August.

April 23, 2020

During the week we have pondered the fate of The Mighty Elm which has ruled majestically over 904 State for at least 150 years. A word about its credentials. We thought it an American Elm. Obviously, we had read somewhere that that variety is more elegant and rare than the common Dutch Elm which abound. Fifty years ago we summoned a dear friend, the late Phil Stansfield, a Lawrenceville native, U of I Graduate, Farm Adviser in Indiana, and requested he certify that our noble tree was American. Phil understood our desire to separate our treasure from the common herd but declined to elevate the tree to the ancestral pedestal we sought. He observed, "In view of its size and age natural history experts from the University would have surrounded the tree and proclaimed it a wonder if they believed it American." Our friendship was not lessened though we believed his tree classification in error.

The Mighty Elm was intended to shield the castle of Henry and Gertrude Johnson from the Thorn Sisters residence. When Gene Miller bought that lot, razed the dwelling, lowered the supporting soil two feet and poured black top for a used car lot, the tree's well being was in jeopardy. Miller's successor Bill Albright surveyed the lot, found that the tree trespassed about a foot and graciously refrained from weakening our pride and joy and endangering the tree's well being by removing the trespass.

Then came another peril, Dutch Elm disease it decimated that variety throughout the city, particularly in the Lawrenceville City Park. Our dear kinfolk, the late Clyde Smith and Russell Scherer summoned experts to inject our "American Elm" with protective fluids.

Assault upon the tree continued. State Farm said, "Cannot renew your insurance policy. "Tree too great a threat to building", a parade of well wishers assured us that several limbs extending over our castle would crush same in a tornado. Our caregivers each volunteered to wear steel helmets if such storm forecast.

A final crisis came last week when medium sized log fell out of the tree and crushed a portion of the porch overhang. There comes a point where bravado must give way to reality. Greg Ericksen

and company were summoned. They removed limbs that presented imminent danger to the house and will return shortly to take the tree down or to create a natural Picasso, like the sculpture at the State of Illinois Building, Chicago. We are considering topping the tree at 16 feet and shaping the limbs to mimic that famous sculpture. We are determined that this noble edifice not end as fodder for someone's fireplace. We envision a tourist attraction nonpareil. Greg Ericksen thought the tree "Dutch", from the "bark". Our reaction was that his forty years of experience entitled him to be in error in this instance.

April 30, 2020

Eighty years ago, students at Sumner High were taught that the Gettysburg Address and the Lord's Prayer were splendid examples of succinctly stating the message sought to be conveyed. Without diminishing the acknowledged fact that SHS was top notch, excelled by no other high school in Illinois, we have concluded slight adjustments would be helpful to improve each of these literary masterpieces specifically.

Lincoln should have qualified the clause, "all men are born free and equal." No one could argue that the shiftless are equal to the energetic, determined to excel. The Address would beat the test of common sense if the clause were modified, "free and entitled to equal treatment by authority."

Of the Lord's Prayer, though a revered anchor to faith that binds believers together world wide, the prayer omits mention of a monumental problem to mankind--mental deterioration in old age. Tragically, most of mankind suffers progressive memory loss after the 70 milestone. As they approach the 100 marker, few can quote their social security number from memory. Their lives are diminished to the extent of this prevailing affliction.

Perhaps Whittier sought to remedy the omission when he wrote a powerful prayer, almost equal to the Lord's, using half as many words.

When the savants next revise the Bible, we suggest the following sentence be added to the prayer: "reclothe us in our rightful mind." Thus amended, the Lord's Prayer will be truly perfect.

We are discouraged that no one responded to our offer of a year subscription to the Press to the first person who called or mailed name of war production czar in WWII. This federal appointment was strikingly similar to Speer's role for Germany in that great war. The answer to our question was Donald C. Nelson.

May 7, 2020

We believe democracy would work better in government if it were less politicized in recent years. Every move by elected officials from the president to the township supervisor is measured by its political effect.

This total fascination with the political implications has captured public opinion polls to such an extent that the dullest observer knows without label which of the two political parties is favored by the questioner.

Would it not be helpful to unfetter progress if there were a moratorium on politics the moment election results were determined and announced? That lifeblood for discord among humans would return, as by magic, four weeks before each scheduled election. The partisans would have that short period, or whatever different period becomes preferable, to vent their determination that their side alone is right.

If such an arrangement were installed, the verbal venom that presently permeates all life would vanish.

We suggest above procedure deserve a trial before being dismissed as meaningless.

What does freedom of religion mean to each of us? Is it mere tolerance and acceptance of what we believe the err in judgment of another individual or group? For example, when we drive by an Amish buggy in Arthur, Illinois, or south of Sumner, do we feel admiration, pity, or annoyance for the occupants in the buggy? We witness a desperate rear guard defense by the buggy occupants of their way of life. Where they compete with nonbelievers armed with power tools, they increasingly avail themselves of similar equivalent. Obviously, if this bending of the rules continues, they will become as indistinguishable from nonbelievers as are Methodists from Presbyterians. Another group which has suffered from society's concealed pressure for every member to be as others are are the Mormons. How bitter must be their thoughts when they recall that the righteous majority

of mankind forced them to renounce multi-wives, even as their oppressors professed religious tolerance. Now, as a majority so broadly rejects need for the formal marriage contract, Brigham Young surely must say, "I told them so."

May 14, 2020

Seeking escape from the loneliness of quarantine, we have listened to numerous audiotapes on the lives of famous men in recent days. Perhaps this odd pursuit was inspired by the poet Longfellow:

Lives of great men all remind us

We can make our lives sublime,

And, departing, leave behind us

Footprints on the sands of time.

Footprints, that perhaps another,

Sailing o'er life's solemn main,

A forlorn and shipwrecked brother,

Seeing, shall take heart again.

We heard the story of British Prime Minister Churchill; Presidents Reagan, Eisenhower and Truman; Generals MacArthur, Eisenhower, and Patton.

The common thread in each of these stories was the confidence that each had in himself. The poet who wrote, "trust thyself, every heart doth vibrate to that iron string" --Emerson, was squarely on target. We shall not attempt to persuade the reader who was the greatest of these giants. We were surprised how many new facets we found on the leaders enumerated. Patton believed in reincarnation--he was utterly persuaded that he was a General in the forces of some world conqueror of long ago. He wasn't specific whether Alexander the Great was his mentor or Napoleon. He was brash, had a drinking problem and was handicapped in Army command assignment by his antisemitic mindset.

MacArthur's ego lead the group. He believed he was infallible. Though a brilliant military

strategist, his historic pinnacle was reached as he molded war crushed Japan from a feudal state which worshiped the Emperor into a democracy, comparable to Britain and the USA. We shutter as we realize how close MacArthur came to persuading a reluctant Truman to join with Chiang Kai-shek and his Formosa based army for attack on Mao and mainland China, 1951. MacArthur acknowledged the need to use nuclear bombs to drive Chinese forces from North Korea: could not understand Truman's reluctance. It would have surely brought all out nuclear war and the end of civilization. Truman was right, MacArthur was wrong. President Eisenhower effectively used threat of nuclear attack on Mao, earlier 1953, to cause North Koreans to agree to new demortician line with South Korea. Chinese troops withdrew from North Korea.

News accounts of the underlying policy difference between the Commander-in-Chief and the mighty MacArthur did not reveal how clearly the issue was defined. Public opinion polls at the time of Truman's ouster of MacArthur from command of the Pacific armed forces showed 70% of the American public sided with MacArthur. So much for the theory that true democracy requires equal voice in determination of a nation's directed effort. The uninformed should have no voice in directing the ship of state lest disaster outlined occur.

We found nationalistic pride in comparing Reagan's speech to the British Parliament with the formidable Churchill welcoming the U.S. Congress into this "holy struggle." Reagan represented well the USA at home and on the world stage.

As one compares Reagan's first inaugural address with his interview with Tom Brokaw as he left office eight years later, conclusion is inescapable that at 77 his mental processes had slowed painfully. That's the reason we continue to predict that one or both of presumed candidates for President, Trump and Biden--74 and 78, respectively--in the November 3 election will be replaced before the opening bell.

May 21, 2020

Gus and Martha Adriaenssen were residents/managers of the hotel during the late 1960's. They were a remarkable couple, Lawrence County's most cosmopolitan. Gus was of Belgian origin; Martha, German. We believe each was born in those respective countries. They came to Lawrenceville from NYC, to be close to their daughter who had married a fine young American soldier named Shoulders. Some of their grandchildren are yet leaders in this community, including a grandson who has retired from the Olney Police Department.

Martha had an expression we thought priceless, to wit: "everyone must justify his existence by what he has done for his fellow man."

We have found that many leaders in government, royal and elected, left acts or phrases to justify their existence. Franklin D. Roosevelt, a great American president, sought always to show his concern for the poor and the downtrodden. Such tactic made him unbeatable at the polls. Critics charge that FDR took the "p" out of pride which all should feel toward their country.

John F. Kennedy was a president of unequalled personal charisma, though his record of legislative achievements in the Congress was zero. He was literally worshiped by a majority of Americans when cruelly assassinated in Dallas, November 1963. Most Americans cheered when saloon keeper Jack Ruby blew a hole through Lee Harvey Oswald's stomach. They murmured, "deserved," when the summary execution of the assassin was shown on television. JFK sought to be remembered by a famous speech, "ask not what your country can do for you, ask what you can do for your country."

In one sentence, he met Martha's justification for existence test that will be ever remembered. Now, a majority of Americans expect/demand regular aid from their government. Repeat of Kennedy's trademark "ask not--" by a President, or candidate for that office, would bring laughter.

JFK's vice president was a tireless worker to improve the lot of the poor and the downtrodden, but even his monumental success in promoting racial equality has not brought great historical appreciation from the beneficiaries. Many can't even remember his name, though he would have been unbeatable had he run for another term in 1968. Instead, he declined and retired to a ranch home in Texas, raised chickens. We can almost hear the wife's complaint, "had you run for reelection, someone else would be taking care of these smelly birds and your place in history would have been secure."

The royal peak in the struggle for historical justification, of life and service for others, is in the story of King Edward VIII. At age 40, he fell in love with a designing American divorcee. Winston Churchill is claimed to have crafted a radio speech in 1936 wherein Edward announced his resignation as King of England, an empire so vast the sun never set on some portion of its lands. "I cannot continue to bear the burden (of government), without the woman I love."

It was a love story that one would have thought would put Romeo and Juliet in the shadows.

According to a French chambermaid where now Prince Edward and Wally Simpson honeymooned, she shrilly exclaimed, "you fool! Why did you let the Arch Bishop of Canterbury drive you from the throne? Now you must carry my poodle."

He did so for 35 years. He failed miserably Martha Adriaenssen's justification for life test.

May 28, 2020

"Full many a gem of purest ray serene

The dark unfathom'd caves of ocean bear:

Full many a flower is born to blush unseen,

And waste its sweetness on the desert air."

--Thomas Gray

We believe the above is the siren call that has lured too many of the talented young from the small town villages in which they were reared. Result has been catastrophic: NYC, LA, Chicago, and Miami have grown ever larger, villages under 10,000 population in Illinois and throughout the nation have shrunk almost to nothingness. Somehow, somewhere, we must find a way to reverse this pernicious cycle wherein desirable communal life is turned into an economic wasteland by the brain drain of its youth.

We look back in Lawrence County 72 years ago when we became a lawyer. When we compare Lawrence County then and now we shudder how far we have fallen.

We must not despair. So very few of the talented need to return that our county can again offer the amenities that make life here more than worthwhile, desirable. Daily we see in adjoining Wabash how the return of one talented youth, Dr. Joe Fullop, can create in Mt. Carmel a healthcare mecca.

Locally, Donn and Kay Hammer reared two extra bright children while they each spent a lifetime educating other people's children. Ryan Hammer is a big time lawyer in Las Vegas. Dr. Jan Hammer is a big time pediatrician in St. Louis. If those Lawrence County natives would come home, and bring their families with them, the resurgence of Lawrence County would be well

underway. Happily, their presence here would attract others who have strayed too long in distant lands.

Another family with the instant potential to rebuild Lawrence County is that of Dr. Larry and Jeanie Herron. Three Drs Herron practicing their skill in downtown Lawrenceville would lift an entire county from the depths of despair. None should believe that though we emphasize the county's need we are unappreciative of the splendid effort of a very few who labor tirelessly to keep us afloat.

Calvin and Wanda Sechrest at their big league art gallery, Finishing Touch. Jan Loeb's effort is total. As is that of Tony Weston and Rusty Hartz.

We wish every citizen dedicated to the revival of Lawrence County Godspeed.

We salute Ed Brumley for a thoughtful comment on Facebook. He reminded all the importance of full census count. Deadline for reporting to the census bureau all who reside within your home was April 1, has been extended to July 1. Please follow Brumley's recommendation, fill out the questionnaire and mail it back to the census people immediately. Every possible resident of Lawrence County is vital.

Law requires the General Assembly to reapportion the representative districts in this state after each Federal census. It is of utmost importance that Lawrence County never again be divided in the reapportioned map enacted. Result of its division during the past ten years, half in 109th and half in 110th legislative districts, has been that our county has little influence with the representative from either district.

The plague that has paralyzed normal life for almost three months is about to lift. When you encounter a starry eyed candidate who seeks your vote for his/her election to the General Assembly, either chamber, make him promise that if elected he will filibuster if necessary to prevent the adoption of any reapportionment map which splits Lawrence County for the next 10 years. If the candidate will not swear on his mother's honor to thus help Lawrence County's resurgence, you cannot in good conscience vote for him.

June 4, 2020

We dread the first three weeks of each June, because they come so quickly and are gone even faster.

From mid-February, we daily treasure an additional minute of daylight. No longer will the children go to school in the darkness. There's glorious daylight after supper. Moment June 1 arrives, we know that time will speed up as though the Earth's rotor motor were on steroids. The three weeks are gone, and the descent to darkness begins. We seek to avoid the emotional let down by concentrating on the coming golden days of autumn. Our innermost conviction remains that climbing the hill to daylight is grander than the swift sinking into darkness.

Midst the quarantine and pandemic paralysis, we listened to an audiobook, Mark Twain's autobiography. He used his real name, Samuel Langhorne Clemens, instead of the nom de plum by which he was universally known. We were fascinated that Clemens was so determined to find direct family lineal descent from a court member involved in the execution of King Charles I, 1625. He was also an aggressive marketer of books written by famous people, including a dying former President's, Ulysses S. Grant. Latter painfully dictated his autobiography that profits from sale thereof would pay creditors without resort to bankruptcy. Modern debtors have no such reluctance to escape obligation by bankruptcy.

Clemens' autobiography had a surprising literary style. It was a riveting account of daily high points.

My immediate reaction to his writing style was, had he copied my treasured friend, Allen Johnson? This could not be accurate, Clemens was born a century earlier. Has our contributing editor plagiarized the writing style of Clemens? Of course not. But Allen did run afoul of the rule: "we were born too late, in a world too old to be original in writing."

We had thought that truth was attributable to Somerset Maugham. Google couldn't confirm, so, we propose to claim it as Roscoe's Rule.

June 11, 2020

Sunday's reopening of First Christian was marvelous, though the turnout was pitiful, 26.

If next Sunday's attendance doesn't double, Press will hire "pew warmers" for following Sabbath. The music department, pianist Johnathan Clark and soprano Lorie Cunningham were each in rare form. As were Reverend Tom Akers and Jeff Shick. Latter's sermon was from Genesis. Difficult to reconcile that book with words and events as now understood.

No criticism of tireless moderator Mary Jamerson, her copied social distancing instructions included, "Use the bathrooms only in emergency."

Seemed redundant; what visit to a church bathroom isn't an emergency?

Missing essential for proper observance of the Sabbath was no Sunday School class. Church without Sunday School becomes a social welfare gathering to allay the fears and strengthen the hopes of the elderly participants. See you next Sunday at First Christian, if you're not running a temperature.

We thought Senator Mitt Romney's participation in Sunday's Black Lives Matter parade, D.C., shameless opportunism. This newspaper became pro-Romney when he saved the Winter Olympics for Salt Lake City 20 years ago. We thought his lone vote to impeach Trump was shameless. If that chameleon is determined to make another race for the presidency, he should challenge NY Governor Cuomo to be the Democrat nominee as soon as "presumptive" front runner Joe Biden stumbles out of that competition.

Vegas is right. Trump will be re-elected.

June 18, 2020

Last week's Lawrenceville Daily Record published a splendid article by Bill Richardson of the testamentary generosity of a late mutual friend, Richard Poppe. Since his wife Patricia Wells Poppe and two sons had each predeceased there are no direct descendants. Dick Poppe's will, caused the estate of more than a million dollars to be divided among several deserving Lawrence County institutions, including Lawrence County Memorial Hospital, Library and Senior Citizens.

He was a generous citizen.

Our admiration of Poppe was large. In our minds eye, two pictures appear when we remember him: Kay and I were at the Saturday night dance, Bridgeport at the American Legion sixty years ago. The specialty was a snake dance. Dick and the beautiful Pat were on the end. His animated motion was the envy of every male in the room.

Second occasion is of the tragic Ohio Oil Company fire, October 9, 1961. In the dark of the night flames erupted and lethally burned four employees including Bridgeport Major James Neely, Lee Askren, Muril Magee and Walter Burton. The fire also seriously burned three other employees: Rue Peneton, Robert Ernst and Richard Poppe. Unscathed by the first blast Poppe jumped in to help rescue the others.

We agree with Richardson, it was a great day for Lawrence County and the lives of all he encountered when the young engineer from Ohio chose to live among us.

The three weeks before the summer solstice sped by as rapidly as we feared. They always do.

Summer comes this weekend. It is the grandest season of the year.

June 25, 2020

We are appalled how frequently a conviction becomes firmly implanted in our mind and then we discover that our conclusion was totally in err. For example, we had assumed that the life of every astronaut was shortened by the rigorous, unnatural procedures endured, especially astronauts who walked on the moon, or spent time in space. We googled lifespans of Buzz Aldrin, Neil Armstrong, Michael Collins, Alan Shepard and John Glenn. We discovered Glenn lived to 95; Armstrong, 82; Shepard, 75. Aldrin and Collins are yet alive at 90! So much for our plebeian theory that recycling one's urine and greatly reducing solid food intake for days destroys longevity.

Matters not to us--every astronaut is a hero, a national monument, bigger than Nathan Hill and Paul Revere combined. We marvel at his/her confident smile as each is strapped into the rocket

for blast off. We think of the ill fated Challenger, which exploded 73 seconds into flight. Seven brave souls went to heaven early.

As one contemplates the wonder of the space program, the skill of the scientists who push the button to probe the meaning of life for the benefit of all, we would expect humble awe from all of mankind.

The news media have ignored this monumental event. Robert Behnken and Douglas Hurley from the Dragon have been at the Space Station for almost three weeks. They are joined by fellow NASA astronaut Chris Cassidy, and by Russian cosmonauts Anatoly Ivanishin and Ivan Vagner, who have been there for more than a month. We pray for the safe return of each. We gently chided Reverend Akers Sunday morning for failure to include mention of the astronauts in the prayer. We must never become as blase that heroism beyond description is treated as part of their daily exercise. These brave men and women are heroes.

From the sublime to the ridiculous, we were encouraged that proud Americans of Italian descent surrounded Columbus monument at NYC to prevent its defacement, even destruction.

Present desecration of tributes to the memory of brave leaders of the Confederacy is an abomination, insanity, deserving the contempt of every true American. Our terrible Civil War ended 155 years ago. Common sense suggests that all Americans should close ranks and march forward together in their God-given destiny.

July 2, 2020

Four months from tomorrow America will go to the polls. Some think it trite to emphasize how serious to the future existence of this nation is every election. Four years of unrelenting hostility by national news have left a mark on President Donald Trump, his administration, and threaten his reelection.

His opponent is the virtual presumptive" [National News Media] Democratic nominee, Joe Biden, who will be 78 years old two weeks after the election. We have repeatedly opined that Biden will not be the Democrat nominee, and repeat such prediction here. But since he issued a statement from wherever he has hidden from the virus that he would accept his party's nomination, August

18, at Milwaukee, we suggest that now is the appropriate time for realistic comparison of the incumbent President and the virtual, presumptive nominee.

The U.S. Constitution specifically provides that the President is Commander-in-Chief of the Armed Forces. As VP sitting at President Obama's right hand, Biden did nothing to rescue four security personnel at the American Embassy in Benghazi. Despite their plea for assistance, these brave men were murdered by a Taliban inspired mob, 2012. In December 2019, a strutting Iranian General named Qasem Soleimani incited a mob to take action against the American embassy in Baghdad. Matter festered for a few days. President Trump reviewed intelligence that Soleimani was a leading Taliban threat to American lives. He promptly authorized the drone to dispatch Soleimani on January 3. Peace and harmony has surrounded American embassies throughout the Middle East since that decisive moment. No longer is shooting of Americans by Taliban radicals as inconsequential as killing rabbits.

This development is not without great personal risk to President Trump. Within the last two days, the Ayatollah of Iran's top prosecutor has publicly announced that he seeks a murder warrant against our President and 30 Americans for the elimination of Soleimani. We again salute the President and his splendid technicians who protect every American.

On basis of comparison of C-n-C performance, there can be no honest argument who is the right person to lead this country into the threatening future.

Unfortunately, public opinion polls show that national survival is far less important to a broad section of our country than is affordable health care. Somehow, very soon, President Trump and his supporters must convince more Americans that affordable health care is important and will be made available to all if Trump is reelected.

Another measure for comparison between the two presumed candidates is their selection of a running mate. Michael Pence has admirably served during the first term, and should be again the nominee.

It is time for Joe Biden to quit playing hide and seek as to who he has chosen to be his running mate. If he keeps his promise and selects a woman for that obvious awesome future responsibility

we think he will choose Kamala Harris. How bitter must be the regrets of Amy Klobuchar that a black was murdered by a policeman in her Minneapolis. Kamala Harris must have similar regret as she has a record of being a hard-nosed prosecutor, in the mold of Chicago Mayor Lori Lightfoot. It might be unacceptable to the blacks. As for Senator Elizabeth Warren, once a shoe-in for VP, discarded because she would confiscate 6% from the billionaires and ran third in her state's primary.

If Cuomo is the nominee, readers will disregard our conjectures.

July 9, 2020

It was a sad moment, a sixty-five year old television reporter inquired of Joe Biden, "presumptive Democratic nominee for President": I'm sixty-five and note some loss of memory. Do you think your age a problem? Biden bristled and said, "he would welcome a cognitive test comparison with President Trump."

Interview persisted, "How will you beat President Trump?" Biden's reply, "Joe Biden will beat Joe Biden". He repeated that answer. The DNC reporter seeking to salvage Biden's campaign explained to the listeners what the presumptive candidate said "Joe Biden will be Joe Biden." Problem is that he intended to say "be". Thousands of ears heard "beat."

We believe Joe Biden remains hidden in his basement not out of fear of contracting the virus but rather his handlers' fear that their candidate would make mental slips between now and August 18 in Milwaukee.

We herewith repeat our prediction first made more than three months ago Biden will not be the Democratic nominee for President. He will be seventy-eight years old two weeks after the November 3 election.

We think Shakespeare's observation about actors, particularly prescient to candidates "he that struts and frets his hour upon the stage, and then is heard no more." Biden's hour has been almost 50 years in the spotlight.

Oddly, Biden is not alone in this sad group. Presently, so prominent in political news Nancy Pelosi is 80; Bernie Sanders will be 79 before the election; Michael Bloomberg is 78.

Might be a nice sentimental addition to the DNC to give each of these oldsters five minutes in the spot light for their last hurrah.

Bloomberg was short changed. Spending almost 400 million dollars for one delegate, from Puerto Rico was wasteful. After all, why would anyone think that a man 5' 4 1/2" tall could lead this nation. Insignificant that he demonstrably possesses more mental capacity than any of the other candidates.

We note with hope that U of I commenced welcoming students back to the campus. Claim had been made that a Covid 19 saliva test is available and will be used on the 47,000 young minds seeking to make their lives more meaningful. We hope Lawrence County schools will follow the University's lead.

We are desperately anxious that more inquiring minds subscribe to *The Sumner Press.* We will be grateful if every reader of this paper urges a friend to subscribe and point out the prospects that Facebook is for the mentally lazy. To be truly upperclass one must read a newspaper.

Final thought: there needs to be more transparency in Parrott's electronic auction. Rules appear too flexible as to when a sale is final. For several days they have attempted to sell the Albright Motor Real Estate almost in secrecy. Are we alone in the prayer that old fashioned auctions return?

July 16, 2020

Naming Swimming Pools - Ninety two degrees or higher in five consecutive days brought out the inflatable swimming pools.

At Rainbow beach there were no snakes or mud. It was truly heaven on earth.

Neighbors Kristin and Lexi Coonce promptly erected theirs. They sought a name for this much

enjoyed addition. They rejected "Skinny Dip Pool", sent a false notion. They settled on "Olympic" : seemed too grandiose for a pool whose side walls are less than 36" in height.

We thought of our swimming pool 85 years ago. It was called "Bozart's Pond". It was a bend in a small stream across someone's cow pasture just south of Park Street in southeast Sumner.

Bozart's was for boy's only. There was no bathhouse, no need for same. Occasionally two girls picking blackberries were seen within 50 yards. We were afraid of Bozart's because a snake had been seen. We inquired of an older and wiser boy if there were danger of being bitten. His reply was that when the snake opened his mouth to bite water would rush in and strangle it. Seemed a flimsy line of defense but we didn't argue. Our pool was also very muddy. We assumed that the name was that of a prior owner. Years later we encountered the french term, "Beaux Arts" means fine art. We thought perhaps some wit had tagged our pool with the name which had anglicized to Bozart. Perhaps John Hamilton or the Lawrence County Historical Society can tell us which hypothesis is correct. Happily, our Sunday school class at Congregational Christian went twice that summer to Rainbow Beach, Vincennes. Boys and girls were in the class; everyone wore suits. It was indescribably beautiful. One could walk down into a room near the center of the pool and marvel at the colored lights filtered through the glass walls. It was truly heaven on earth.

July 23, 2020

Long overdue: the voters of Alabama wrote "R.I.P." over the political career of Jeff Sessions last week. A more deserved death there never was.

Sessions was a freshman Senator who endorsed long-shot Trump for president in 2016. He was rewarded by Attorney General appointment. Even before President-elect Trump was sworn into office, January 20, 2017, mad dog character assassins Nancy Pelosi and Congressman Andrew Schiff had launched congressional probe to impeach Trump for colluding with the Russians to win the election. If these vicious attackers were real canine, instead of merely acting as such, they would be required to wear muzzles.

Strangely, the national news media supported the inquiry of veteran investigator, Robert Mueller. This type of proceeding requires the involvement of the Attorney General. Jeff Sessions was up to bat. He could have stopped a two year effort to prove Trump campaign collusion with the Russians. Instead, AG Sessions recused himself from the case on the flimsy ground of conflict of interest since his prior role in the FBI had been involved. Tax payers would have been saved as

much as \$50 million had the AG had the courage and moral strength to stop that political lynching before it got underway. How much better would it have been to spend the money on Four Lanes for Route 50?

Though Mueller's report after two years of determined searching found no evidence of collusion, Pelosi and Schiff persisted an impeachment vote against Trump. Only the shameless Mitt Romney broke rank. Trump was acquitted.

Is it any wonder that our President resented Sessions' failure to protect decency and fair play?

Relevance of the above recital of history is the frightening fact that Donald Trump would be defeated by a puppet if the election were next Tuesday instead of fourteen weeks thereafter.

We say "puppet" because even the partisan national news media realize that old age, including mild dementia, has caught the presumptive candidate. Conceivably Democrats could nominate in a virtual proceeding Joseph Biden for President and Kamala Harris for Vice President at Milwaukee August 18, and hide Biden from the public view for the stretch run.

Public opinion polls have become deadly accurate.

Biden and his handlers need do nothing so long as those polls show a present lead over the incumbent. There is historical precedent of the Democrats running a puppet for president. In 1944, before television became so controlling, whispers were constant that FDR was dying. His handlers propped him up in an open campaign car through a driving Philadelphia rain a few days before the election and loudly proclaimed, "see how robust."

FDR was elected and dead within six months.

If you believe in private ownership of property, you need to do more to persuade your friends in Wisconsin, Michigan, Pennsylvania and Florida to vote for the reelection of Donald Trump.

July 30, 2020

. Reuters T.V. has a dubious distinction of Sumner Press' selection as the top dispenser of political advocacy under guise of National News headlines. Example: Reuters repeatedly presented Jimmy Tosh as a "rich pig farmer" as the financial inspiration of a group of Trump haters who use Lincoln's name to conceal their vicious attacks upon President Trump. This deceptive politician piously recites that though he agrees with Trump 80% of the time he will do all within his power to defeat Trump because he believes he's told a lie. Most happy, long time marriages would collapse if the partners were required to agree with each other 80% of the time. Reuters' phoniness would gag a horse if chewable. Press readers are too savvy to be misled by such cloaked political advertising. We must each strive with all whom we touch to encourage political discernment, to not abandon a President who has been attacked unfairly nonstop by unscrupulous opponents.

If you believe in Private ownership of property you simply must vote yes to President Trump's reelection 97 days from today and urge everyone you can influence to do likewise.

Daughter Jan confided to us that her neighbor, Dr. Rosen, needed human guinea pigs for testing a COVID-19 vaccine for which he had great hopes. She indicated an intent to be a volunteer guinea pig. The thought occurred to us that our prisons are filled with thousands of humans of all age groups who would be available to test vaccines in exchange for a reduction in their confinement. We researched our brainchild and learned that our "discovery" was rejected old hat. During WWII, when malaria was such a problem with the troops in the Pacific, specialists used prisoners as guinea pigs in desperate effort to protect soldiers. After the war, researchers were in agreement that public outcry against such contribution by incarcerated, even if voluntary, was unacceptable. Present state of the law is that prisoners cannot be used as guinea pigs, even voluntarily, even if they demanded to render such service to humanity.

In our opinion, that provision of the law is silly. The whole matter should be reexamined. The law of common sense has never been repelled. Neither has the law that we claimed as our own some weeks ago, "borne too late, in a world too old to be original."

In spite of our rebuff, there is a substantial light at the end of the tunnel. Our government, through Pfizer, has contracted with a German pharmaceutical group to spend huge amounts of money for a vaccine against COVID-19. Those pushing this game saver believe requisite FDA

approval of the vaccine will be obtained by October 1, 2020.

Stay hunkered down. It is our belief that humanity will be rescued from the deadly grip of COVID-19 commencing October 1, 2020.

August 6, 2020

While the Press periodically rails against too many holidays in the U.S.A., one event does not receive the annual notice that its importance to mankind earned--dropping of the A-bomb on Hiroshima. Today is the 75th anniversary that historic change of manner nation's resolve their differences as General MacArthur wisely observed a few years later in a California flag dedication ceremony, "war has become too terrible to be an acceptable arbiter of national differences."

Except for the total destructiveness of nuclear war, WWII would have occurred long ago. Happily, this mutual terror of world destruction by nuclear war will preserve peace among the large nations far into the future.

We do think President Trump should send a picture of Hiroshima to his "friend" Kim Jong-un of North Korea. Ironical that Robert Oppenheimer, a major contributor to the development of the A-bomb, had such a guilt complex that he had murdered all of mankind that he lost his sanity. He cried that he had brought death to the world. In truth, he brought everlasting peace among the heavyweights.

Mohammed Ali wisely observed, "it ain't bragging if you can do it."

Readers may remember that some weeks ago we repeated our formula pronounced at the U of I, in Ec III '42 to prevent the then tidy national debt crushing the U.S. economy. Our professor lost his cool upon our suggestion that the national debt be cancelled by a referendum of all the people. Our fellow students cheered. While everyone loves Santa Claus, there simply must be an end to these massive giveaways of the public treasury. No longer is it necessary to start the printing presses to debase the currency. All that is required is a few strokes on the electronic record system. When the U.S. Treasury Secretary Steve Mnuchin pushes the buttons within a couple of weeks, the national debt will exceed \$26,000,000,000,000 (trillion). Inescapable result of that

level of indebtedness is wild inflation, pure socialism, or cancellation of the debt by public referendum.

For the many greedy states, including Illinois, to clamor for more federal aid that their bonds remain sellable is to add insult to injury.

Americans must go back to work, and quit demanding government hand outs if the land of the free and the home of the brave is to endure.

August 13, 2020

. A fascinating drama is playing in Springfield and Chicago--should embattled longtime Speaker of the House of Representatives resign, or should he defy his critics? The sanctimonious New York Times has editorially demanded that Speaker Michael Madigan immediately resign. The case against our friend is that he's mentioned in an FBI investigation of Commonwealth Edison bribery of Illinois State legislators wholesale. Not surprising, Madigan's political allies, Governor JB Pritzker and Mayor Lori Lightfoot stabbed him in the back. The wound was superficial, no loss of blood. Condemnation of each was conditioned, "if convicted."

Problem with the grandstand by each is that Madigan is not charged with any criminal offense. It follows as the night to day, he can't be "convicted."

When a public official stumbles, the ghouls come rushing in. Even the Chicago Tribune editorially demanded that Madigan resign. This political crisis is not analogous to background that lead Richard Nixon to resign as President. While we would have preferred Nixon defy his accusers, it was evident that the Republican sheep, minority in both the House and Senate, had turned against him for a non-monumental offense--failure to stop his underlings from illegally spying on their political opponents.

Madigan has suffered no comparable erosion of support from the House members who have chosen him as their leader for 34 years. Nor is there any danger that Governor Pritzker will call the Legislature into special session between now and election day to debate the Speaker's future.

If a Democrat must be the Speaker of the House of Representatives, Southern Illinois will be better served by Michael Madigan than by some pious caretaker from that party's controlled

delegation.

While the entire nation continued to reel under the awful grip of the pandemic, New York Times' largest news story was demand that the Mayor of Lunay, VA, resign for suggesting on Facebook that Joe Biden should pick Aunt Jemima as his running mate. The chorus of buffoons who joined that lynch mob have never met Aunt Jemima. We brought her to learn that Joe Biden has the moral courage to drink fruit juice, even while surrounded by political associates determined that alcohol shall cause cirrhosis of their livers, a fatal disease. It is unfortunate that Biden is a prisoner of the socialist wing of the Democratic party.

We repeat our prior prediction, Biden will announce Kamala Harris as his running mate by the time the reader receives this copy of the Press. Her selection was strengthened by discovery of a China-man in her family tree. She has an Indian (spot in forehead), Mother, and a Jamaican father. Would seem all racial bases covered. Catch is we continue to doubt that Biden will be the Democrat nominee. If he will step aside, and instruct his delegates to pick his wife as the nominee we'll vote for them, and the life of a 78 year old politician will be spared the riggers of political battle.

August 20, 2020

. Former Illinois Governor James R. Thompson, 84, died in Chicago, Friday. "Big Jim's" political strength was his length, 6'6". We mostly never clicked with Thompson, and vice versa. Our hatred of him commenced in 1978. His leg man came repeatedly to our desk on the House floor to persuade us to enter the Republican primary for the U.S. Congress position. We were reluctant because principle opponent was alleged brightest of a family group widely touted as the Republican version of the Kennedy dynasty.

That opponent was the son of a syndicated columnist, brother of a congressman, lived in populist north part of the district and was photogenic. Notwithstanding, we knew that an incumbent governor not being challenged for his leadership can easily control nominations in primary contests. Our suitor had to be acting with Thompson's approval. We threw caution to the wind, abandoned our safe spot in the House and announced our candidacy for Congress. We confidently told a Danville rally, "the Governor is with us."

Within a couple of hours, the Tuscola radio station broadcast a statement from the Governor's

office, claiming neutrality. Our fate was further sealed in a February blizzard that marooned Kay and us in Paris two nights. Ironically, the winner's family surely concluded their victory was pyrrhic for the shame that he brought to the family name while in Washington.

To be retired, pensioned at 55 is a fate almost worse than death. We would have perished. The fire had gone from our belly. Nevermore could we seek elected office. Loving family, many friends, another twenty years with Golden Age Club #1, and the Sumner Press rescued us from the hole in which we thought we'd been pushed.

Practicing law in the country is more profitable than exciting. For many years we would have publicly proclaimed upon Thompson's death, "good riddance."

May we be forgiven for such hatred. We had overlooked the wise observation, "never a man large or small came to naught, but by his own hand." --Wilde.

We have tried desperately every day following our personal disaster to make a contribution toward the well being of Lawrence County and our priceless friends therein. We will continue to do so so long as we know. As my inspirational grandfather, Bainbridge Lafayette Cunningham instructed my father, at age 95: "David, do not tell the people downtown that I am just sitting at home, waiting to die. This is the best world I ever lived in."

We hope our readers will know that BL had it right and will maximize their own lives in this world.

August 27, 2020

. We thought the acceptance speech by the Democratic Presidential candidate Joe Biden the best we've ever heard him speak. It took full advantage of the out of office challenger's opportunity to promise the moon. To voters being wooed, every segment of the party was promised whatever it wished. No explanation was offered of how each of those promise fulfillments would be financed. The speech was delivered with a smooth style that put to rest a lot of Republican wishful thinking that dementia had overtaken Biden, who will be 78, 11/20. His supporters savored the triumph of his speech and staged a firecracker celebration in the streets of Wilmington outside the

auditorium in which he spoke.

There was one failed line in this extraordinary performance: "no miracle is coming."

When we hear together tonight Donald Trump's acceptance of his party's nomination for reelection, we predict he'll make Biden regret so casual a dismissal of the miracle of hope. Miracles do exist in our lifetime. One need only pick up his smartphone to see a most useful tool that defies all laws of nature. The miracle that Biden decried was a shield for humanity against total destruction by COVID-19.

We think Trump will assure a frightened nation Thursday night that a miracle vaccine will be in full operation by October 15. Instant turn around of present public opinion polls is safely predictable. Even if Trump must hedge his re-election is safely predictable based on the stock market's strength--even midst the terror of quarantine.

There is no more reliable barometer of business future than the market, and the jobs created thereby.

Addressing this flood tide of character assassination being launched against Trump by the desperate demos, including purported tapes by his sister who boycotted their brother Robert's funeral last week.

A president's reelection, or rejection, should depend on how well the nation is doing under his guidance, not personality characteristics of the leader himself.

Jimmy Carter was unquestionably the most devout man ever elected, but his presidency was a national disaster.

Long ago, a cynical Italian named Machiavelli laid out the rules for governing a nation in a

manner that best protects all of the inhabitants thereof. Thoughtful voters 68 days hence will conclude that Donald Trump has the right instincts and determination to lead America.

September 3, 2020

. The wind blew, even howled as we lay awake in our bed in the middle of the night. We gave thanks for the security of our brick mansion and the skilled hands that created it.

Lightning pierced the sky, creating daylight everywhere. Then came the thunder. It were as though a train wreck had occurred on State Street.

As the rain came down in sheets we began to wonder: would we survive this mighty storm? Then we heard the soft purr of the compactor which pumps oxygen into our lungs, 24/7.

We gave thanks to the men and women of Ameren whose tireless efforts make their life extending product constant.

Strangely, we found this tantrum of nature calming. Finally, the first sign of another day appeared. Then it was 6:30, we were alive and well. We gave thanks to Almighty God for another day of opportunity to make our life worthwhile for humanity.

Since third grade, Sumner Public Schools, mental numerical manipulation, in all four directions, has been our forte. Last week our youthful caregiver, Rosie, beat us on an easy test: if x left Lawrence County in 1982 and returned in 2019, how many years was she gone? Imagine our shock. Fortunately, we were alone or such lèse-majesté would have required retaliation: either dismissal of this needed employee, or at least salary reduction.

Wound to our pride and ego were momentary. We have resolved to try harder to resist the ravages of time.

We have not copyrighted above test for determining numerical agility of readers' associates.

September 10, 2020

. COVID-19 has so paralyzed the nation that an equally newsworthy story has gone unmentioned. We refer to the purchase of Prince Harry, Meghan and Archie from the British Royal Crown by our royalty, Hollywood and its financiers. We think the bidding started when the moneyed people

in our royalty saw Prince Harry, a dashing young knight of great potential, had been smitten by the charm of our royal Princess Meghan. The British royal family is an historic wonder whose continuous place on the throne has been held for more than 1,000 years. The sales potential of such a jewel caught the attention of the billionaires standing in the shadow behind our Hollywood. They made immediate offer to Prince Harry's owner, the Chancellor of Exchequer of Great Britain. He's the public official who pays the numerous British royalty their monthly allowance, provides housing and all the trappings of royalty for the show pieces.

After several offers and counteroffers Prince Harry and his agent, the Chancellor, accepted the offer of \$100,000,000. Problem was other royalty, including Queen Elizabeth II and Prince Phillip feared it would diminish the total value of the crown if Prince Harry, Meghan and Archie moved to a Buckingham Palace in Hollywood.

These priceless chattels agreed to live in that enchanted faraway land and become the jewels of the Hollywood crown. We remember a sign in a window of Selfrdg's, Oxford Street, London proudly proclaimed, "Purveyor of sun lotion to Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth II."

It is a safe bet that similar advertising blockbusters will appear in every upscale shop in America, with our new royalty's endorsement.

One can imagine what the price would be if our Hollywood kingmakers decide to buy Queen Elizabeth II and Prince Philip. It would require a consortium of our billionaires, at least Musk, Bezos, Zuckerberg, Soros and Bloomberg, to finance so grand an adventure. Unlikely that the British Chancellor would agree to that sale, regardless of the price, unless the royal couple retained their residence part time in London.

The scenario we've outlined will come to pass in this century if the initial purchase for portion of the crown proves as profitable as projected. When the royalty difference between our two nations has been thus accommodated it is inescapable that all of Great Britain will become part of the United States. Their total population is such that their negotiators might insist on being as many as three new states. That shouldn't be much of a hurdle to negotiate. Just ponder this all came to be because Prince Harry and Princess Meghan fell in love. Love and the all mighty dollar are irresistible.

September 17, 2020

. Why American Soldiers Should Remain in Afghanistan

Last Friday, America appropriately remembered 9/11. It is an anniversary of a historical attack on the United States as significant and treacherous as Pearl Harbor. 19 religious zealot assailants

murdered more than 3,000 Americans, destroyed The World Trade Center, NYC, severely damaged the Pentagon, Washington, and caused many more to suffer and die from lung complications directly connected to the infernos they created. Except for the bravery of unknown American passengers aboard the fourth hijacked plane who caused it to crash in Pennsylvania, they might have destroyed their target, the White House or the Capitol. Never in the history of mankind have so few reeked such havoc upon a target.

Al-Qaeda was in charge of the operation. That terrorist group was sheltered by the Taliban, a group of male chauvinistic pigs who governed Afghanistan. When the origin of this dastardly, unprovoked attack upon the U.S.A. was determined, President George W. Bush had no practical choice but to declare war on October 7, 2001, on Afghanistan and its Taliban rulers. Fortunately for Bush's place in history, and for Donald Trump's reelection campaign, a Congressional vote was taken on our going to war. Senator Joseph Biden, Delaware, voted aye. That's why Biden will not attack Trump in the debates for America's longest and ongoing war wherein more than 15,000 American soldiers are yet in Afghanistan. Every other windbag Democrat Presidential aspirant assails Trump non-stop for his failure to "bring our soldiers home."

Quoted phrase reaches the heartstrings of an ignorant American public. Our brave American soldiers went to Afghanistan to oust the Taliban and to free the women of that country from the wicked enslavement the Taliban has forced upon them.

First Lady Laura Bush broadcast a message of hope and freedom to the oppressed Afghan women on as our troops descended upon that backward land.

The Taliban is wickedness personified. None have offered better proof of that rating than the Life magazine story 3-4 years ago. The Taliban had destroyed historic works of art, forbade girls to go to school. After our soldiers chased the cowardly Taliban from office, they captured Kabul and installed a moral government which permitted little girls to again attend school. Life's intrepid reporter found a young Afghan girl thrilled that her government again permitted her to attend school. The sequel to that heart wrenching story was to see what happened to this girl in the course of not more than six years. After much searching, the reporter found her. She had run afoul of the bestial mindset of the unregenerated Taliban, was married to a male from that group who treated her similarly to the family cow. Her picture in the sequel showed that the light of hope had vanished from that poor woman's eyes. Her life again was crushed by ignorance.

We may shrug and say that it was bad luck of a female in a faraway land but our duty to mankind, and to women is quite different.

Bowing to witless public opinion pressure, President Trump is presently negotiating with the resurgent Taliban in Kabul. It is a surrender to ignorance. We think that America should double the number of soldiers in Afghanistan and continue the battle against the Taliban until the lights go on again in the eyes of little girls in that godforsaken land.

September 24, 2020

. Random thoughts:

"Words are like Leaves; and where they most abound, Much Fruit of Sense beneath is rarely found." - Alexander Pope

When one runs out of things to do, the mind is asleep.

The agony of numerous nightly furniture crawl to answer nature's call becomes quite bearable when the terror of awakening signal becomes a false alarm.

Though we disagreed in political matters almost totally with Justice Ruth Bader Ginsberg, we admired her determination to live and to be heard.

"Abortion should be legal, and rare." --President Bill and Hillary Clinton.

We had hoped to live long enough to participate in a national election in which the Republicans did not get mired down in senseless debate about abortion.

"When we criminalize all abortions, life for rich women is little changed, but the frightened poor women are driven into the alley butchers." -- Representative Murphy (?), Illinois House of Representatives, 1971.

We doubt that Senate Majority Leader Mitch McConnell and President Donald Trump can get a Supreme Court replacement nominee confirmed within the next 40 days.

If President Trump fails to reach that stated goal, it may be a blessing in disguise--educated women, the weak category in his political armor, will not be further alienated.

This is exciting political drama. We are fortunate to live at this time in the history of our great nation. We must not be diverted and forget to remind our elected representatives that the primary need for County Lawrence is jobs, industry, infrastructure, recreation, and health care.

Autumn came early Tuesday morning. It is the grandest season of the year.

October 1, 2020

. Monday we had a totally unsatisfactory telephone conversation with Jeff Myers, Regional Director, Illinois Highway Department. Six months ago, The Press commenced bombarding IDOT with questions as to the progress of making Route 50 four lanes wide, Lawrenceville to Salem. Telephone calls always terminated with the ubiquitous recording mechanism. Response was that humans sought would get back to us. They never did.

We received a letter from Director of IDOT that all progress on Four Lanes for 50 stopped in 2007 when it was determined in the environmental study that there was no need for such highway improvement and that we should contact Jeff Myers, Effingham, Regional Supervisor for further information. Charles Gillespie and other Four Lanes for 50 workers forwarded facts that refuted such unconscionable government abandonment of so wide an area of Illinois. Press noted in phone call, email, and U.S. mail, with stamped and addressed envelope enclosed, that increased activity at the Wal-Mart distribution center, Olney; at the Sumner Correctional facility; and at Toyota Boshoku, Lawrenceville, should cause a reopening of the study and a quick finding that the area needs deserved immediate high way construction. A catastrophic wreck on the present crowded two lanes should not be required to persuade officials of our area's desperate need.

David Lane, retired Indiana Department of Transportation official, contacted Engineer Myers, by phone, electronic and regular mail, pointing out that I-69 in Indiana and I-57 in Illinois are joined by Route 50 and that the utility of the entire highway system would be enhanced by construction sought. He further noted right of way had already been acquired by the state and the improvement sought consists mostly of the ground in a straight line, minimizing construction cost. Press supplemented its plea by noting that Route 50 is historic, first transcontinental highway, already four lanes in most of the route, that ten miles in Lawrence County had been constructed 50 years ago and has been christened "J.B. Pritzker Expressway."

Of our conversation with Engineer Myers, after he stated that he would be talking with this Federal counterpart as to whether the combined additional information justified regional environmental study and an immediate finding of area need our question was blunt, "are you with us, or against us?"

His reply, "I'm in between."

That won't get it. We've been pushing for four lanes for more than 50 years. We had thought to

snarl at Engineer Myers that we knew where he lived; paradoxically we believe he resides in Springfield.

We considered a better strategy would be to organize a motorcade to Effingham as soon as the COVID plague lifts to confront that public official with our area's need for survival. We fear that it is futile to appeal further to Governor Pritzker and/or President Trump. Each might conclude that if we could not persuade that lowest peon on the supervisory scale our area need for four lanes was imaginary. We must not despair. Together, we can snatch victory from the hands of defeat.

October 8, 2020

. When we graduated from Sumner High School, 1941, we thought we knew every word we would ever need in life. We were startled last week to learn a new word, which splendidly describes a malignant mind. The word is schadenfreude, of German origin. Means one who derives pleasure from others' misfortune. How better could one word describe Pelosi, Schiff and Schumer? One jerk on Facebook posted, "hope Trump dies."

Another, more compassionate user of that remarkable communication device posted, "don't be schadenfreude!"

Surely to God overwhelming majority of Americans hope for the immediate and total recovery of President Donald Trump and all others infected by this dreadful disease.

We heard one pious medical expert, as though anyone understood COVID-19, almost say "President Trump got what he asked for."

It is difficult to imagine how morally wrong that condemnation of our national leader.

The President of a nation of 330 million determined to live human beings has no alternative than to put up a brave front regardless of how dangerous that front may be to his survival. He is the commander-in-chief on the front line leading the troops into the enemy. The nation simply cannot be lead by a wimp in the basement, praying for the dawn.

Our guess is that when the reader gets this Press, President Trump will be back in the White House acting as though the hospital stay was a bad nightmare. Further, we think the voter reaction to his determination to continue to lead will be very positive. Of course, if he comes out of the hospital with an oxygen hose in his nose you can safely bet the farm that Joseph Biden is the 47th President of the USA.

At SHS we were taught presidential succession after death or disability of the president, and the vice president, successive presidents were ST WAP-NACAL. Letters stand for the cabinet posts. 25th Amendment to the Constitution changed the order of succession after the vice president. Now, next in line is the Speaker of the House, after her the Majority Leader in the Senate.

Fortunately, very few Americans realize that Nancy Pelosi is exactly two heartbeats away from becoming the President of the USA. What a tragedy that would be for the land of the brave and the free. None did more than she to harass President Donald Trump every day that he has risked his life for thee and me.

We can do more than merely pray for his recovery. We can importune all we encounter to vote for his reelection 26 days from today.

Your duty to your God and your country requires no less. Don't be schadenfreude.

October 15, 2020

. Any resident of Lawrence or Crawford County who intends to vote for Biden for President nineteen days from today should not be out in the dark alone. Reasons for our concern of the voter IQ are two: community self interest and the forces behind the Biden candidacy.

In 1906 oil was found and wells drilled in named counties. From that date to the present, production of oil has been a main stay in the economy of each county. Lawrence County production has dwindled greatly in recent years, but showed promise of grand improvement through a process called fracking. Means deep hole pressure to break up geological formations and permit the recovery of great reservoirs of trapped oil according to many expert geologists. A process called horizontal drilling is involved in the utilization of fracking. Means as it sounds: at various vertical depths the drill is turned 90 degrees to cut through these walls believed to be holding back pumping of oil from that particular location.

Some years back self appointed "environmentalists" shrilly warned that fracking was a terrible danger to the Earth itself, that it would cause earthquakes and release great quantities of gasses harmful to human life. The eagerly awaited oil drilling boom in our county was halted. Hope for the counties economic rejuvenation through another oil boom was put in jeopardy. While the jury has not yet made the decision as to whether fracking is the salvation or the curse of mankind, candidate Biden has proclaimed that he will halt all fracking and horizontal drilling in connection therewith if elected President.

It would be a fatal blow to any hope Lawrence County could be revived through a new oil boom.

Second reason Biden's election would be a disaster is the sinister people for whom he is but a puppet. They are left wingers who envision a totally different USA than the one we sing about on the 4th of July. A major player in this group of these string pullers hidden behind the candidate is George Soros, and an enigmatic multi billionaire, self described as the world's greatest philanthropist who has been accused of spending 50 billion dollars to change governments world wide. No informed observer of the political process will dispute that Soros owns the Cook County State's Attorney. We repeat that his ambition is to own the world. When he is described as a grand philanthropist should be added, "world wide anarchist".

The brilliant Chicago Tribune columnist, J Kass, noted Soros control of State's Attorney Fox. Tribune editorial board demanded Kass dismissal for "anti-Semitic" attack on Soros. Flood of emails from Kass's readers, including Press prevented his dismissal. We are immune to any nonsensical charge of being "anti-Semitic". Our closes associate in WW2 service was Frank Diamond, who became a Philadelphia stock broker and posed as parade marshall in the Press Mobile in St. Francisville Chestnut Festival Parade. We cite also our connection with Benny and Mandell Yosowitz. A Chicago supplier demanded character reference in connection with a building project. Explained our need to Benny. His endorsement was, "He is one of us".

Odd reality of this claim of grand intrigue is a fact that Soros is 90 years old, his determination to make every nation, including USA totally socialistic appears unquenchable.

We think Joseph Biden a nice old man and his election as President would be a disaster for the country we love. Another causality of a Biden presidency would be the Marathon refinery at Robinson. It would be gone before the end of Biden's four years in the White House. This must not happen.

Roscoe's Journal — part-028

October 22, 2020

Why Federal Income Tax Will Rise for All, Except the Relievers who Pay No Tax

We told you the parable of the SHS graduate who risked a failing grade in Ec. II, of t, 1942, by suggesting a national referendum to cancel the debt lest it stifle business, jobs, human progress. Contra the opinion of the apoplectic bond owning teacher, radical remedy proposed by this student might become government policy within the next four years. If that should come to pass, the referendum to cancel the debt, this student cannot claim he was prescient; 80 years is too long to wait for a prediction to come true.

Growth of the debt has not been uniform. Actually, there were some years in which government receipts exceeded expenditures. Surprisingly, under President Clinton, 2000, there was a small positive balance.

Notwithstanding, the Vietnam, Gulf, and ongoing Middle East wars, which increase the national debt, latter did not reach the 1 trillion mark until first term of President Reagan, 1981.

Obviously, the national debt level has risen as though on steroids in recent years. The pandemic has caused the level of debt to jump farther, faster than the wars. The House of Representatives has passed another stimulus bill--which would add \$2.5 trillion to the national debt. When the political hypocrisy is discarded and the frightening numbers examined, it is apparent that there must be another stimulus bill.

Our leaders apparently have agreed among themselves without consulting we the tax payers to postpone decision on size and shape of new stimulus bill until after November 3 election. When the Secretary of Treasury is elected by the Congress and the President to pay out money the debt he doesn't have in the till, he must raise the interest rate to make government bonds more attractive to purchasers, or persuade Congress to raise tax rates. The higher interest rate increases the debt. It should be easy to understand that if present tax rates create a budget shortfall in excess of \$1 trillion before the surplus payments, the shortfall will jump to 3 trillion, perhaps more. Interest rates on bonds must be constantly raised to make same sale-able, or increased taxes must provide revenue the government needs to pay its bills.

When the bonds become too risky for any investor, Secretary Mnuchin must persuade the Congress to raise the taxes in leaps, rather than a crawl. Otherwise, the USA becomes another Venezuela. We pray Secretary Mnuchin and the Federal Reserve board, which gives the signal to print more money, be each imbued with the wisdom to maintain the proper balance between government expense and government receipts that the public confidence in payment of government debt not be lost. When that happens, the entire financial system collapses, causing total chaos. We approach a debt level very simply impossible to continue to service the debt, taxes are too high for the public to pay. To avoid that crisis we might be well advised to have a national referendum on the question: shall all United States financial obligations be canceled? We are back to the student's proposal in 1942. Thought occurred to us that precarious as the financial picture is presently in the US Treasury, could be worse.

For example: what if one worked in that desperately needed machine to maintain government stability and did your arithmetic in Roman numerals? Few Americans give the Arabs credit

deserved for Arabic numbers and the decimal system which makes book keeping possible and is a basic boon to mankind.

October 29, 2020

Should Illinois Amend State Constitution to Permit Graduated State Income Tax?

Two determined billionaires, J.B. Pritzker and Ken Griffin, stand toe to toe on opposites on how you should vote on ballot next Tuesday. Each has pledged \$50 million to support vote for his side of the question. The Governor urges "yes," noting that the graduated income tax is authorized for national returns for more than 100 years (16th Amendment).

Griffin urges "no" vote, observing that if proposed amendment adopted, state legislature taxed authority would be greatly expanded and claiming that a graduated state income tax would hasten the business decline of Illinois disastrously. We find Griffin's second point persuasive. Each census for the last 60 years shows that Illinois' population growth is smaller than that of most of the states. If big monied would-be employers are driven from Illinois, our state's decline would disrupt thousands of lives. Already, our congressional districts have shrunk from 24 in 1960 to 15 in 2020 (projected).

Voters should note that a failure to vote on the separate constitutional amendment helps the proponents because constitutional amendments can be adopted by a majority vote of all who voted, or by 60% affirmative vote of those who voted on the constitutional question. Don't leave the voting booth until you've voted against the constitutional amendment.

Why I'll Vote For Trump's Reelection

The soft, continuous purr of the oxygen compactor in my room is of no consequence to most Americans, to me it is a matter of life or death. It pumps the oxygen through a 25 foot hose to my nose 24/7. During the past two years that I've worn such lifeline there has not been a single unscheduled stoppage of Ameren's energy. Our gratitude is imaginable.

Candidate Biden is opposed to fossil fuel. Though Ameren's recent source percentage reveals 43% of its electricity created by gas, there's no indication that Biden and company would diminish their promised war against fossil based fuels.

A second major factor in our Presidential preference is Biden's opposition to "fracking" we have previously pointed out what a boon that process could be to Lawrence and Crawford Counties. Within the week, Candidate Biden spoke in Pennsylvania and renewed his opposition to fracking.

Mindful of how important that process would be in Pennsylvania, his Vice Presidential running mate, Kamala Harris hastened to Pennsylvania to claim that Biden's remarks were quoted out of context, that he was not against fracking, his opposition was against government subsidies for fracking. Her defense of Biden's ill timed reminder was an insult to every informed voter. Government subsidies of the alternate fuel sources, wind and sun, are far greater than those granted fossil fuel powered energy. Translated to plain English, Harris's remarks firmly renewed the Green crowd's dangerous commitment that the nation rely on renewable energy, regardless how painful the process.

Final thought on the billionaire leaders: we doubt that the Greeks when they invented democracy foresaw that the process would be lead on each side by the community's wealthiest family.

November 5, 2020

11th month of the worst year in the history of U. S. A. is here no evidence the plague is lifting. Need is to concentrate on positive news. Coming of daylight savings time Sunday Morning was a ray of sunshine. Should persuade every American to know that this is the finest world in which he/she ever lived. So, each should maximize the joy of the ride. Most governmental programs cause dissent which borders internecine.

DST is the exception. A program that covers the nation, accepted by all, except Arizona.

Benjamin Franklin, America's ambassador to France, saw how wasted the early morning hours. He urged national interest to consider moving the clock as a strategy to get people to go to work. This is the problem which Henry Ford shrewdly observed a century later, "no one would work if he didn't have to."

Strangely, it was the Germans who first moved the clock In WW 1. It was a concept that met the critical test of common sense. After Versailles, the clocks world wide returned to where the British set them, Greenwich Mean Time, when British power ruled the world.

WW 2 brought again urgent need for the productive labor of all. President Roosevelt and production Czar Donald Nelson did not hesitate, CDT was reinstated. Surprisingly few

governmental adjustments required to retain this annual tradition, codified by President Johnson, 1964.

Presently Daylight starts at 2 a.m. on the second Sunday of each March and ends 2 a.m. on the first Sunday of each November.

After we express our surprise how smoothly the change in time progresses. We confess we became confused Sunday morning and feared we slept beyond starting time, to bathe, shave, and get to First Christian on time. Our fears were well founded. We hope Reverend Akers and other faithful members at The first Christian will forgive us for arriving late. Next week we will do better.

Could have been worse, the Reverend mentioned it was his birthday. We waited, and waited and waited, for someone to rise and lead the Happy Birthday song. None did. Our thoughts of our fellow parishioners were not charitable. Reverend Tom did not deserve such flagrant affront. Little did I know that the congregation had already sang Happy Birthday before starting the service. Happy Birthday Reverend Tom!

November 19, 2020

Four restaurants in Sangamon County that continued to offer indoor dining in defiance of Illinois Gov. J.B. Pritzker's COVID-19 mitigation plan were ordered to shut down temporarily Tuesday.

The Sangamon County Department of Public Health issued citations and \$500 fines last week to the restaurants for violating the indoor dining ban that went into effect on Friday, Nov. 13.

The entire state came under stricter COVID-19 restrictions earlier this month after all 11 of the state's mitigation regions experienced positivity rates greater than 8 percent for three consecutive days. Those restrictions included a ban on indoor dining and bar service, as well as limits on in-person capacity and six-foot social distancing requirements.

As of Tuesday afternoon, Sangamon County had reported 7,913 positive cases and 76 deaths related to COVID-19.

After issuing the fines and citations, the Sangamon County health department suspended the restaurants' food services licenses, but they continued to operate without licenses.

A couple hours later, Pritzker announced during his daily news conference that the entire state would be subject to additional restrictions to curb the spread of COVID-19.

He was also asked about whether local officials should issue fines to business that don't comply with his executive orders.

J.B. Pritzker's COVID-19 mitigation plan were ordered to shut down temporarily Tuesday.

"Yes they should," Pritzker said. "Just as they should enforce state laws, state executive orders are also enforced by local law enforcement and local state's attorneys."

The holiday shopping season is also on the verge of making or breaking small business owners who find themselves stymied at the hands of government orders.

There are thoughts that independent workers are being reduced to make way for guaranteed income via the government. This comes with compromise as the government may also issue mandates in order to access those benefits.

Students enrolling in the public school system have long been subjected to the necessity of immunizations prior to admittance into the classroom.

A vaccine is on the verge of being available to front line healthcare workers, the elderly and vulnerable population. Some remain vigilant to mask-wearing, hand-washing and social distancing. Others are rebelling with COVID fatigue.

THE FOLLOWING IS REPRINTED FROM A PREVIOUS ROSCOE'S JOURNAL:

Gus and Martha Adriaenssen were residents/ managers of the hotel during the late 1960's. They were a remarkable couple, Lawrence County's most cosmopolitan. Gus was of Belgian origin; Martha, German. We believe each was born in those respective countries. They came to Lawrenceville from NYC, to be close to their daughter who had married a fine young American soldier named Shoulders. Some of their grandchildren are yet leaders in this community, including a grandson who has retired from the Olney Police Department.

Martha had an expression we thought priceless, to wit: "everyone must justify his existence by what he has done for his fellow man."

We have found that many leaders in government, royal and elected, left acts or phrases to justify their existence. Franklin D. Roosevelt, a great American president, sought always to show his concern for the poor and the downtrodden. Such tactic made him unbeatable at the polls. Critics charge that FDR took the "p" out of pride which all should feel toward their country.

John F. Kennedy was a president of unequaled personal charisma, though his record of legislative achievements in the Congress was zero. He was literally worshiped by a majority of Americans when cruelly assassinated in Dallas, November 1963. Most Americans cheered when saloon keeper Jack Ruby blew a hole through Lee Harvey Oswald's stomach. They murmured, "deserved," when the summary execution of the assassin was shown on television. JFK sought to be remembered by a famous speech, "ask not what your country can do for you, ask what you can do for your country."

In one sentence, he met Martha's justification for existence test that will be ever remembered. Now, a majority of Americans expect/demand regular aid from their government. Repeat of Kennedy's trademark "ask not--" by a President, or candidate for that office, would bring laughter.

JFK's vice president was a tireless worker to improve the lot of the poor and the downtrodden, but even his monumental success in promoting racial equality has not brought great historical appreciation from the beneficiaries. Many can't even remember his name, though he would have been unbeatable had he run for another term in 1968. Instead, he declined and retired to a ranch home in Texas, raised chickens. We can almost hear the wife's complaint, "had you run for reelection, someone else would be taking care of these smelly birds and your place in history would have been secure."

The royal peak in the struggle for historical justification, of life and service for others, is in the story of King Edward VIII. At age 40, he fell in love with a designing American divorcee. Winston Churchill is claimed to have crafted a radio speech in 1936 wherein Edward announced his resignation as King of England, an empire so vast the sun never set on some portion of its lands. "I cannot continue to bear the burden (of government), without the woman I love."

It was a love story that one would have thought would put Romeo and Juliet in the shadows. According to a French chambermaid where now Prince Edward and Wally Simpson honeymooned, she shrilly exclaimed, "you fool! Why did you let the Arch Bishop of Canterbury drive you from the throne? Now you must carry my poodle."

He did so for 35 years. He failed miserably Martha Adriaenssen's justification for life test.

December 24, 2020 (*MEMORIAL REPRINT — orig date not printed*)

(EDITOR'S NOTE: THE FOLLOWING IS A REVISITED 'ROSCOE'S JOURNAL.' TAKE NOTE THAT SOME ENTRIES RELATE TO TODAY)

Ron Paul is a crotchety old soul who mixes silliness, "return this nation to the gold standard," with wisdom, "great caution must be exercised in limiting liberty for security." Fellow Republican presidential candidate, Newt Gingrich, gleefully speared him on latter position in most recent candidates' debate. Gingrich's point was that tighter domestic surveillance might have intercepted Timothy McVey before that psychopath murdered so many in Oklahoma City bombing.

xxx

We hoped that the moderator would ask Paul his position on racial profiling, to intercept terrorists. While we often admire Paul, we would not object to strip searching any airplane passenger who might be a Muslim. Realistically, it is that breed that poses the greatest danger of large tragedy within our borders. McVey was an irreligious exception who should have been spotted by our overworked mental health personnel.

xxx

Basis of Paul's concern is demonstrated with the ease with which an FBI agent can obtain a warrant to search anyone's home. The agent files an affidavit that he believes, "x's home, office, or any structure within the target's control, contains cash which may be the fruit of activities in violation of the Federal criminal code.

xxx

Thus armed with a warrant to search, the FBI swoops down upon the "victim" with official wrath and seizes whatever it wishes.

xxx

The simple who sing, "land of the free, home of the brave", who believe that a man's home is his castle inviolable, should awaken to the large degree that under checked FBI power has eroded liberty in the USA. Congress, the judiciary and executive branch of government have caused this threat to the liberty of every American. They should correct that error.

xxx

Perhaps it would be helpful to the reigning in of the FBI if its leaders were reminded that the Russian despot, Josef Stalin, found it advisable to periodically execute the head of his secret police.

xxx

A friend sent us a NY Times editorial suggesting mandatory voting might be helpful for a more vibrant democracy. For more than 20 years the Press has urged that right to receive Social Security, or driver's license, should require proof of voting in every election. Many now recognize that voting without term limits for every public office is an act of futility, merely the system's safety valve by which the disgruntled let off steam.

xxx

On a more hopeful note, we are delighted that NASA has sent a rocket to Mars, to determine whether life in any measurable form exists, or ever did, on that planet most similar to earth. We eagerly await its findings in late August, 2012.

xxx

Tardily, we give thanks for our rocket scientists who expand the field of human knowledge exponentially.

December 31, 2020 (*MEMORIAL REPRINT — orig date Dec 28, 1989*)

(EDITOR'S NOTE: The following is one of the first writings by Roscoe D. Cunningham when he became an owner of The Sumner Press. The article was printed December 28, 1989.)

"All that glitters is not gold, often you have heard this told, had you been as wise as bold, your answer had not been enscrolled." Shakespeare may not have contemplated the mandatory liability insurance law which goes into effect for Illinois motorists, Monday, when he penned these lines 400 years ago. But we believe that Illinoisans would have been better served if the Legislature, the Governor, and other public officials had left well enough alone.

Commencing January 1, 1990, no person shall operate a motor vehicle unless the motor vehicle is covered by a liability insurance policy in accordance with Section 7-601 of this Code. This provision applies to operators and motor vehicles regardless of the state or jurisdiction in which they respectively are licensed or registered." Fines and ultimate jail sentences are provided for violations of this well intentioned , unnecessary law.

Our lawyers believe that Illinois' effort to criminalize non-residents' operation of their uninsured motor vehicles in this state is unconstitutional, in violation of the due process clause. Even California doesn't attempt to enforce its motor fumes emission statute against foreign motor vehicles which stray upon its highways.

Happily, for the lawyers, this new law will bring much litigation. But the larger financial windfall will come to the automobile insurance companies. The jail door alternative will prove a most persuasive argument for buying and expensive policy for the wheels so vital to the earning of a livelihood. These policies will attain the same priority as food in dispensing of the meager budget. Surprisingly, in prior years some insurance companies opposed compulsory auto liability insurance. One suspects "reverse psychology." Their glee at this time is understandable and forgivable.

Reason for the statue is unnecessary is that the "uninsured motorist" law has provided an adequate economical remedy, for more than 20 years, to the problem of poor people driving automobiles. In an age in which demonstrable compassion for the poor has become a requisite for good citizenship, this new law goes in the opposite direction. If vigorously applied, the new requirement will put many poor people on their feet.

There are many callous enough to mutter "if they can't afford an insurance policy, they shouldn't be driving cars on the highways." That thinking is out of step with the times, *incontra* the sentiments of the holiday season and disregards human nature. A kinder gentler Illinois requires

the strong to carry for the weak, the fast to run for the slow. Spending a little for the uninsured motorist coverage, by those able to afford, was a kinder expression of being our brother's keeper.

But the most pernicious effect of mandatory liability is one of the defects mentioned above, rather it is the additional horde of payrollers which will be required to administer the act. Hundreds will be added to the burden of the already overtaxed citizenry.

We recognize that the testimony offered when the bill was being considered opined that only a handful of "additional personnel" would be required. You watch the new jobs.-- Illinois State Police and Secretary of State enforcement officers, plus the clerical help, which will be authorized in each session of future general assemblies.

It has been suggested that mandatory insurance will result in a lowering of premiums. Experiences in other states has been otherwise. We find no states in which this law has been an unqualified success. Everywhere enforcement is a problem. Illinois officials have said that there will be no random stopping of motorists to confirm that the essential current certificate of insurance is actually in the car (When implied consent for intoximeter tests first enacted 18 years ago, no roadblocks were contemplated. Predictably they came, and predictable the Supreme Court held that they are legal.) You may make a bet on the proposition that roadblocks will come to establish compliance mandatory liability insurance.

Interestingly, the present statute is more Draconian than the driver's license act in one important particular. In latter the motorist is given a grace period to prove that he has a driver's license though same not carried on the person. We find no such tolerance in proof of liability insurance, you must have same in the car when any law enforcement official stops you on any pretext.

The certificate of insurance need to be kept in the car must be current. The next logical step in this endless regulatory treadmill will be to require the insurance company issued such certificate to notify the state agency, currently the Secretary of State, instantly when coverage of policy has terminated for whatever reason. When this happens, the state agency will need to install another full layer of bureaucracy to keep tabs on the citizenry in this land of the free, home of the brave.

The regulatory enforcement power which the act places in the Secretary of State is awesome. As with driver's license, he is the law. Occasionally the judiciary has bristled at the legislature having bestowed such administrative power in that office. The present holiday appears to have won most of the turf battles. But as general proposition to peoples' liberties can be more safely entrusted in the judiciary.

The whole concept is mandatory liability insurance shows how far we have strayed from the priceless Jeffersonian principal "that government best that governs least."

Alas, there appears no immediate solution for another governed population Neither Mr. Consentine nor Mr. Ryan, nominees for Secretary of State in the November election, has expressed any interest in repeal of this awful law.

If the statue is as bad as we've suggest, why there no organized opposition advocating its repeal. We suggest that the irritation many have felt when damaged by an uninsured motorist, invariably judgment proof, has created echoing refrain "this ought to be a law.." respectfully suggest that now that the politicians have brought you that law you'll find the cure worth more than the problem. You will also learn with Shakespeare that "All that glistens is not gold."